ScholarLed catalogue

Simon Bowie

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2.0.1 Walls: Multidimensional Essays

Author: M.H. Bowker

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

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M.H. Bowker's *Walls* is a contemplative essay that is sometimes playful and sometimes grave. At first blush, its subject matter would appear simple. *Walls* considers (1) the psychic meaning of walls and (2) the meaning of psychic walls. It turns out that these two subjects are intimately and interestingly related, such that meditating on one turns out to be fruitful in terms of our understanding of the other.

In a series of short, varied chapters *Walls* moves between the psychoanalytic consulting room and the border crossing, the philosophical treatise and the nursery rhyme. Bowker treats walls literally and metaphorically, from the "wall" between nature and civilization, to Franz Kafka's musings on the Great Wall of China, then to the walling off of a person's interior world. There is even a place for Humpty Dumpty. What emerges is a sustained meditation on interiority itself: How walls constitute the inside and outside of a self, how the barriers we raise in the psyche mirror and are mirrored by the walls we raise in the world.

In each of its short chapters, *Walls* has been written with an intention of inclusivity. That is, no advanced prior knowledge or specialized jargon is necessary for the reader to appreciate what may be found herein. This of course implies that, very often, the reader and the author find themselves beginning from first principles, which is always far more difficult than people seem to believe.

2.0.2 2×6

Author: Nick Montfort

Author: Serge Bouchardon

Author: Carlos Léon

Author: Natalia Fedorova

Author: Andrew Campana

Author: Aleksandra Małecka

Author: Piotr Marecki

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0580.1.00

2×6 consists of short "stanzories"—stanzas that are also stories, each one relating an encounter between two people. Appearing in English, French, Spanish, Russian, Japanese, and Polish, the stanzories are generated by a similar underlying process, even as they do not neatly correspond to one another the way a translation typically does to a source text. These sixfold verses are generated by six short computer programs, the code of which is also presented in full. These simple programs can endlessly churn out combinatorial lines that challenge readers to determine to whom "she" and "he," and "him" and "her," refer, as well as which is the more powerful signifier, which the underdog. As John Cayley writes, "Gender is the chief generative obstacle here—making more than two times six—distributed across the natural grammars of these micro-dramas, with their psychosocial, vocational, and hierarchical narrative vectors."

This title is a second edition of a book originally published by Les Figues Press, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

2.0.3 Who Will Speak the Truth? Buenaventura de Salinas y Córdova's Activist 'Memorial', Peru, 1630

Author: Buenaventura de Salinas y Córdova

Translator: Stephanie Merrim

Editor: Stephanie Merrim

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0532

'Who Will Speak the Truth?' brings to light the powerful seventeenth-century voice of the Peruvian Franciscan Buenaventura de Salinas y Córdova, whose 'Memorial on the Histories of

the New World, Peru' (1630) stands as one of the earliest and most forceful creole denunciations of colonial injustices against Andean Indigenous peoples. Framed by the apocalyptic imagery of the opening of the Seventh Seal in the Book of Revelation, Salinas's Memorial is both exposé and call to action, articulating a passionate plea for justice and reform within the Spanish Empire.

2.0.4 Zen for Record

Author: Ken Friedman

Contributions by: Craig Dworkin

Contributions by: Hanna B. Hölling

Contributions by: Robin McGinley

Contributions by: Christof Migone

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0588.1.00

Zen for Record gathers five essays around Ken Friedman's 1966 Fluxus event score instructing the production of "a phonograph record with no sound on it." Originating as a found object, the work has migrated across six decades and multiple incarnations, from an unrealized concept to the LP edition that occasions this volume.

These essays accompany Friedman's account of the Fluxus origins of the work, but they approach the silent record from radically different angles. Craig Dworkin situates *Zen for Record* within a broader aesthetics of negation and conceptual art's engagement with the zero-degree of content. Christof Migone spirals through the paradoxes of inscribing nothing and the impossibility of a truly soundless playback. Robin McGinley traces a remarkable counterhistory of the silent record as pop artifact, from 1950s jukebox novelties to Vulfpeck's album *Sleepify*. Finally, Hanna B. Hölling reads the work through sonic materialism, preservation theory, and the politics of silencing, asking what it means for a concept to survive the obsolescence of its successive carriers.

Touching on Fluxus event scores and Cagean silence, the political economy of streaming platforms, and the conservation of time-based media, these essays stage a sustained interdisciplinary meditation on silence as material, medium, commodity, and philosophical provocation.

2.0.5 Microscopic Life in Early-Twentieth- and Twenty-First-Century Literature and Performance

Editor: Liliane Campos

Editor: Sarah Bouttier

Editor: François-Joseph Lapointe

Editor: Sarah Montin

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0509

This volume provides a groundbreaking interdisciplinary collection exploring how literature and performance engage with life at microscopic scales. Responding to an era dominated by planetary thinking, the volume turns attention to the invisible biological dimensions that shape our imagination of life, community, and ecology. Drawing from North American and European case studies, the volume's essays and creative works examine how fiction, poetry, theatre, dance, installation art and museum practices render microbial and cellular processes perceptible, to enable new ethical and political relationships across species and scales.

2.0.6 Janky Materiality: Artifice & Interface

Author: J †Johnson

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0522.1.00

Janky materiality works by not working. It is the spirit in the machine, the ghost in language, the provisional operation. It is a musicological poetics run through a patchwork apparatus.

Janky Materiality: Artifice & Interface is a transdisciplinary performative critical investigation of analog-digital interface and materiality, language-oriented poetry and digital language art, experimental electronic music and modular synths, and the technology of film, album, and book.

Janky Materiality explores blurry intersections and cracked interfaces between page, screen and speaker, analog and digital practice. With reference to avant-garde poetics, digital language art, experimental electronic music and modular synths, chance operations and oracular knowing, Johnson thinks about the ways digital material practice extends the post-structural field, as page-based practices are (further) destabilized by computer-based experiments. Language itself is a janky technology that works (at least temporarily) through its own failures, so that digital mediation serves to further break and rewire language operations. Meanwhile,

the book also explores sonification and the study of waveforms: hybrid audio-visual objects that can be materially sculpted and analyzed.

Ultimately, *Janky Materiality* presents a theory of becoming-digital, where interface is a matter of thinking and acting between and among embodied and conceptual, analog and digital realms, whether we are thinking about a technology like language, audiovisual phenomena, or a tool at hand.

2.0.7 Hydrology for Sustainability

Author: Stephanie Kampf

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0551

Hydrology for Sustainability is an accessible textbook introducing the movement of water through Earth's interconnected systems.

2.1 September 2026

2.1.1 Nicaragua Azul: Natural History of Nicaragua's Subaquatic Ecological Heritage

Author: Fabio Buitrago

Author: Peltier Barahona

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0547

This volume invites readers beneath the surface of a country shaped by two oceans, vast lakes, volcanic lagoons, rivers and estuaries.

2.1.2 Tributes in Honour of Maria Lis Lange: Scholar, Administrator, Activist, Leader

Editor: Jonathan Jansen

Editor: André Keet

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891453

Through a critical engagement and treatment of the ideas, approaches, commitments and questions that defined Lis Lange's work, this Festschrift brings together colleagues, collaborators, friends and fellow thinkers in a collection that offers a rich portrait of one of South African higher education's most influential and uncompromising scholar-administrators.This book is a valuable resource for those interested in intellectually driven governance and leadership as forms of critical praxis and strategic institution-building.

2.1.3 A Refuge for Jae-in Doe and Other Fugues

Author: Seo-Young Chu

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0554.1.00

A Refuge for Jae-in Doe and Other Fugues is the lyric memoir of Korean American survivor Seo-Young (Jennie) Chu. It is also a meta-memoir, one that is aware of its makeshift nature, poses questions about the genre(s) it inhabits, and self-consciously reflects on what it means to write autobiographically. Throughout the book, Chu experiments with the first-person singular "I," tracing the polyphonies always implicit in the memoirist's first-person singular voice. Writing polyphonically allows Chu to explore the plurality within her "I," the uncanny homes she has found in dissociation, the appeal of other-than-first-person pronouns as sites of autobiographical consciousness, as well as the literal and figurative fugue states—from spells of incantatory writing to oneiric re-namings of the self—in which Chu finds refuge from intergenerational distress and rape trauma.

Moving from one fugue state to another, Chu explores a wide range of topics relevant to her meta-autobiography, including the nature of time, the history of the sonnet, code-switching, suicidal ideation, the model minority myth, late-stage capitalism, institutional violence, rape culture, standardized tests, the Korean Demilitarized Zone, what it means to read a book, and what it means to be a self.

2.1.4 Embedded Pedagogies: Digital Humanities Teaching and the Infrastructure of Change

Author: Brandon Walsh

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0544

This volume offers a timely and incisive exploration of teaching in an era of institutional instability and political pressure.

2.1.5 Customizing: Konfigurationen medialer Anpassung

Editor: Beate Ochsner

Editor: Markus Rautzenberg

Author: Johannes Bennke

Author: Andreas Beinsteiner

Author: Jacob Birken

Author: Bernd Bösel

Author: Mathias Denecke

Author: Sebastian Feil

Author: Anne Ganzert

Author: Ute Holl

Author: Jasmin Kermanchi

Author: Mona Leinung

Author: Monique Miggelbrink

Author: Stefan Rieger

Author: Jakob Schnetz

Author: Katia Schwerzmann

https://doi.org/10.14619/2423

Digitale Medien sind heute weniger Werkzeuge der Produktion als Systeme der Anpassung. Unter dem Begriff des Customizing bündeln sich Praktiken der Personalisierung, Konfiguration und kuratierten Auswahl, die Wahrnehmung, Handlung und Subjektivität grundlegend verändern. Was als individuelle Passung und Selbstermächtigung erscheint, geht mit neuen Formen der Vorstrukturierung, Normierung und algorithmischen Steuerung einher.Das Internationale Jahrbuch für Medienphilosophie und Medienästhetik nimmt Customizing als zentrale Kategorie gegenwärtiger Medienkulturen in den Blick. Die Beiträge untersuchen, wie sich ästhetische Erfahrung, epistemische Ordnung und soziale Öffentlichkeit unter Bedingungen datenbasierter und KI-gestützter Medien verschieben. Im Zentrum steht dabei die Ambivalenz zwischen Autonomie und Abhängigkeit, Sorge und Kontrolle, Singularisierung und dem Verlust gemeinsamer Horizonte. Der Band versteht Customizing nicht als bloßes technisches Feature, sondern als medienphilosophisches Problem von grundsätzlicher Tragweite.

2.1.6 Bioethics in Apocalyptic Times

Author: Henk ten Have

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0548

This book confronts one of the defining challenges of our age: how to think and act ethically in a world increasingly shaped by crisis, uncertainty, and a pervasive sense of vulnerability.

2.1.7 Selected Essays, 2019–2023

Author: Peter Valente

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0521.1.00

"There are floods that destroy entire contents of a library or publishing house; libraries and museums bombed during wartime; authors themselves demanding certain works or letters be burned at their death; those who attempt at their own risk to save what they can of a manuscript; manuscripts left in taxis and never to be found again; there are distracted painters who paint over an artwork not realizing what they are doing; finally, there are those works that never came to fruition for one reason or another, never to be known. We are given the misfires, the aborted works, the destroyed works, the mishandled works; the book is a catalogue of brutality, desperation, anger, shame and failure. It is like the negative of a photo, not the bright image we expect; it is the lack seething behind our feeling of abundance; it is a catalogue of the unfinished, the unknown, the unknowable. The effect of all the statements is quite devastating, and it reads like a kind of book of the dead. But it is also a magical book where the dead will live again in its pages."

So writes translator and cultural critic Peter Valente, in an essay about Henri LeFebvre's *The Missing Pieces*, a catalogue of lost and never realized artworks. *Selected Essays, 2019-2023* collects Valente's thinking and writings about books, films, poetry, digital art, dance, music, and other cultural objects that were important to him during the last decade. The essays cover a wide array of topics, from an examination of the new styles of music and dance in the UK to Gavin Douglas's 16th-century translation of the *Aeneid,* from Bernadette Mayer's *Memory* to John Ruskin's work, from an in-depth analysis of John Wieners's "A Poem for Painters" to an exploration of Maya Deren's experimental filmmaking. In these essays, Valente explores books by contemporary experimental poets such as Will Alexander and Adeena Karasick as well as prose writers such as Cookie Mueller and David Wojnarowicz. Valente's essays are not limited nor bound by current fashions in the poetry or prose worlds. His readings remain, as can be seen in his previous collection, *Essays on the Peripheries,* open-ended and adventurous.

2.1.8 Music and Dances from Central Nepal: The Works of Subi Shah: Volume 1

Editor: Anna Marie Stirr

Editor: Mason Brown

Editor: Hikmat Khadka

Editor: Lochan Rijal

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0246

Music and Dances from Central Nepal is the first English translation of Shah's works. This collection includes three published works— Madal, "Pangdure (Maruni) Folk Dances", and Glimpses of Nepali Folk Songs—and three unpublished manuscripts— Introduction to Nepali Tunes, Sorati, and Basic Theory of Folk Dance.

2.1.9 Labyrinths: New and Selected Writings

Author: M. Munro

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0572.1.00

"Why are penetrating questions so much harder to formulate than penetrating answers?" critic Louis Bury asks. Why, indeed. It's a great question, and also the throughline of *Labyrinths: New and Selected Writings*. In this collection, Munro formulates penetrating questions (punctums) again and again, and with style and economy. The stories that follow are never reduced to examples, illustrating one theory or another, but answer these questions in the most fitting way possible: by giving them an additional fillip, enriching each. This is the kind of twist only literature (and the humanities) can provide.

Labyrinths is Munro's seventh book and continues his tradition of gnomic-styled writings that have been described as "intellectual origami," "koan-like," "flower-like," and "rooted in sweetness," with lines of inquiry that "auto-deconstruct, bridges crumbling as the author crosses them." The current volume gathers into a fragrant florilegium the best of earlier writings with newer pieces that bring together in artfully whimsical fashion Aristotle, Gilles Deleuze, G.W.F. Hegel, Giorgio Agamben, Graham Harman, Fred Moten, the *Mahābhārata*, Marcel Proust, Andrea Long Chu, aesthetics, parables, kōans, autotheory, Franz Kafka, Ovid, Rey Chow, bell hooks, Lauren Berlant, Baruch Spinoza, and more.

2.2 August 2026

2.2.1 African Pastoral: Versions of Virgil's Eclogues

Eclogues" width="300"/>

Author: Richard Whitaker

Illustrator: William Kentridge

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0574.1.00

African Pastoral: Versions of Virgil's Eclogues presents a fresh and unexpected version of the ten pastoral poems that comprise the *Eclogues* of Virgil (70–19 BCE). Although these poems focus on the lives of shepherds and goatherds, Virgil makes their seemingly circumscribed existence a mirror of the wider world, a world that is both his and ours. The *Eclogues* deal with subjects that remain vital in the twenty-first century: erotic passion of many varieties, transformation and metamorphosis, the torments of unhappy love, and the nature and power of poetry (represented by different kinds of pastoral song). With striking originality, Virgil also allowed contemporary power politics to erupt into the world of his herders and small-scale farmers, as they face confiscation of their grazing lands and fields.

South African classicist and translator Richard Whitaker has produced eminently fluent and creative versions of Virgil's *Eclogues*. He reimagines the poems in an African landscape and evokes the troubled history of land dispossession in southern Africa, introducing local equivalents for much of Virgil's Mediterranean flora and fauna and making frequent use of words drawn from indigenous languages that have enriched his country's variety of English.

African Pastoral includes stunning images by South African artist William Kentridge, which interact with the versions of Virgilian pastoral in multiple ways, complementing and illuminating the poems, as well as raising points of contrast and difference between ancient and modern contexts.

2.2.2 Trespassing: The Subversive Travel of Indonesian Women in Literature and Performance

Author: Jennifer Goodlander

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0542

This volume explores how Indonesian women writers and artists challenge the boundaries of home, nation, and identity through acts of movement, both real and imagined.

2.2.3 Unvoicing Migraine: A Study of the Failing Voice

Author: Mariske Broeckmeyer

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0536.1.00

These writings spring from an observation: When migraine arises, the voice fails. It does so on many levels, ranging from a vocal-technical disintegration to migraine-specific symptoms like dysarthria and aphasia, up to the muteness forced upon the sufferer by stigmatization. As a migraine-suffering singer, Mariske Broeckmeyer witnesses and experiences these alterations. Frequently, routinely, and almost faithfully, she retreats to the blackened bedroom when migraine manifests. Lying in silence, she notices how little of her vocal instrument remains intact and how distorted our relations become under these circumstances. Migraine mutes—it occupies the body and leaves muscles, lungs, larynx, and tongue under its command. In the attempt to describe these sufferings, Broeckmeyer has indeed stammered and fallen silent, unable to name the pain. But could it be that this failure holds some sort of potential? What might vocal failure reveal about the nature of the voice?

To these questions, *Unvoicing Migraine* lends an ear. Shuttling between theoretical findings and artistic practice, the book turns to concepts provided by voice theory, disability studies, and queer theory to engage in an artistic research that studies the devocalizing impact of migraine. The book also attempts to redefine the artistic practice of a singer, the author, when her vocal apparatus falters: it questions the singer's relation to the stage and challenges the boundaries of performance. These aspects of vocality were not merely approached through an autotheoretical discourse, but through the creation of music and sound art that capture the failing voice and amplify it. Ultimately, *Unvoicing Migraine* looks at what lies *beyond* migraine, and makes note of its consequences and residues: stains the acid left on the carpet that transform into a woolly eye whose gaze morphs into a mouth that raves in a language we cannot always understand, but which Broeckmeyer transforms into migraine opera.

2.2.4 The Doctrine of One: Personal Encounters with Film, Art and Music

Author: Michael Beckerman

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0510

This volume is a bold and original meditation on how we interpret art, music, and culture—and what it means to listen, see, and feel differently from others. Drawing on Czech history and aesthetics, the book moves from filmmaker Hugo Haas's coded tributes to his murdered brother, to the haunting ex libris designs of Josef Váchal, to the deeply personal resonances of Schubert's chamber music, Dvořák's cello concerto, and Gideon Klein's tragic Terezín Trio.

Across these vivid case studies, the author asks whether meaning in art can ever be shared—or whether it always belongs to the individual observer.

2.2.5 The Diaries of Anthony Hewitson, Provincial Journalist, Volume 2: 1891–1912

Editor: Andrew Hobbs

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0270

Journalist Anthony Hewitson (1836-1912) worked in one of the largest sectors of the periodical press, provincial newspapers. His diaries, written between 1865 and 1912, reveal the people, processes and networks involved in the creation of Victorian newspapers.

2.2.6 Orienting Public Policy: Ethicists in Democratic Public Reasoning

Author: Frans W.A. Brom

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0541

In an era of increasing polarization, the book calls for a renewed understanding of ethics as a reflective public practice. It offers guidance for philosophers, policymakers, and advisors seeking to sustain a democratic ethos grounded in equality, dignity, and the rule of law.

2.2.7 My 1980s Gayboy Playlist

Author: Arved Ashby

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0535.1.00

In this remarkably intimate book, *My 1980s Gayboy Playlist,* award-winning music writer Arved Ashby muses over pieces that impacted his sexual and musical awakenings as a troubled gay adolescent—pieces by Tchaikovsky, Chopin, Beethoven, Anton Bruckner, Alban Berg, Prince, Kurt Cobain, and Tom Petty.

Ashby shares memories both intimate and far-ranging, but *My 1980s Gayboy Playlist* is not a memoir. Instead of trying to amplify an outwardly uneventful life, the author reengages with and renegotiates eight still-simmering touchpoints—some old musical flames, a few abusive

relationships among them. Ashby focuses on desire as it spilled messily across different avenues of expression, seeking connections between erotic experience and musical passion.

For Ashby, as a high school student in a small, rural Midwestern town in the early 1980s, choosing Alban Berg records over Van Halen counted as a perversion. When he recognized Tchaikovsky's melodic fixations and Prince's and Chopin's musical fires, he better understood his own kinks. As an inadequate piano student and a shy virgin on tricyclic psych meds, his lack of physical success taught him the limitations of the body but also showed the capaciousness of queer failure.

It was music that showed him how queerness insists on misappropriation, mishearing, and reading against the grain. Musicality, like sexual expression, amounts to a kind of role-playing—involving penetration and violation of identity as well as validations of the self. The author's queer musical loves have shown him the vital beauty of muck, unreason, and noise, and as an imaginative writer, Ashby offers the liquid self-reflexivity of Proust and the auto-theory provocations of Maggie Nelson, Paul Preciado, and McKenzie Wark. His prose is poetic and playful, and now and again chaotic. He outs himself in and through his work, with humor and radical intimacy.

My 1980s Gayboy Playlist ultimately illuminates what queer theorist Leo Bersani called the gayboy's inelegant "apprenticeship in desiring." Ashby's closest partners growing up were fantasy, seclusion, and music-dependency, and he found his awkward bliss at the start of the era that witnessed AIDS and the rise of the Moral Majority. In Ashby's early exurban environment, gayness was a thing feared, because unseen and unfathomed, but his musical intimacies made his personal closet endurable. They also helped him to survive his mis-education, to overcome failures of expression, and to craft a sexual awakening into something more rich and more strange.

2.2.8 Mobile Personalization: The History and Theory of Mobile Streaming Media

Author: Justin Grandinetti

Author: Charles Ecenbarger

https://doi.org/10.64629/pf8605cb.10dcf8f3

People were watching and listening on the move long before the iPhone's launch. The world of always-on streaming, accessible anywhere, has a pre-history: magic lanterns, drive-in theaters, and portable radios. In *Mobile Personalization*, Justin Grandinetti and Charlie Ecenbarger place Netflix, YouTube, Spotify, TikTok, and other corporate claimants in a lineage that includes the build-out of sprawling, invisible infrastructures—undersea cables, server farms, and adtech. These "architectures of mobility," together with their Silicon Valley underwriters, make seamless, algorithmic streams possible and profitable. The upshot is an evolving regime of mobile personalization, with entertainment for consumers and data-driven monetization for

companies. *Mobile Personalization* recasts foundational ideas from Raymond Williams, including "flow" and "mobile privatization," to account for the algorithmic delivery of targeted video and audio to lucrative audiences. As this important new book argues, the mobile streamers have delivered convenience, but also audience fragmentation and behavioral capture.

2.2.9 Jorge Luis Borges: At Play with Mental Models of the World

Author: Luis O. Arata

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0542.1.00

Jorge Luis Borges: At Play with Mental Models of the World explores mind-world relations through the creative writings and reflections of the iconic Argentine author, along with insights from corresponding findings in the field of cognitive studies. A selection of representative works—stories, poems, and essays—illuminates features of the constructive imagination that Borges sets in motion to personally blend mind and world, a venture to which he dedicated his life to the very end. This book is for readers from a broad range of backgrounds, interested in the interactive workings of mind and world through fiction, the imagination, and embodied cognition.

Over the years, Borges playfully created and tinkered with models of the self, time, fiction, reality, history, solitude, and reciprocity, among other cognitive objects. Arata focuses on a selection of representative works of Borges to examine how he modeled and then remodeled, over time, his perceptions of the world and his presence in it. Of particular importance was the onset of blindness halfway through his literary life, which led him to playfully remodel certain aspects of his early views of experiencing the world. There was also his surprising partnership with María Kodama toward the end of his life, when he went from prizing solitude to experiencing a sense of reciprocity hardly felt before. Arata concludes this exploration with a view of Borges's burial headstone that is in stark contrast to his youthful idea that his death would happen in Buenos Aires, with his vanishing engraved in cold marble. Instead, Borges chose to pass away in Geneva, and was buried next to an earthy, rough headstone engraved simply with what could be seen as his playful final story.

Ultimately, Arata's book asks, to what extent does the mind shape our perception of the world? Through his work, Borges provides us with a personal, passionate example of how fiction and reality blend to create a multiplicity of striking meanings and his writings trace the poignant human quality of a life devoted to conjuring meaning through the interactions of narrative models that emerge from weaving dreams, memories, observations, reflections, and choices.

2.2.10 Bourdieu and Literature

Author: John R.W. Speller

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0522

This study explores the impact of literature on Bourdieu's intellectual itinerary, and how his literary understanding intersected with his sociological theory and thinking about cultural policy. This is the first full-length study of Bourdieu's work on literature in English, and it provides an invaluable resource for students and scholars of literary studies, cultural theory and sociology.

2.2.11 Applied Psychology in Context: Stories and Lessons from Palestinian Villages

Author: Caesar Hakim

Author: Hamish J McLeod

Author: Mohammad Alkhatib

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0546

This book is an innovative, practice-oriented resource that reframes how psychology is applied in complex, real-world settings.

2.3 July 2026

2.3.1 Malleus Daemonum: The Hammer of Demons

Author: Alessandro Albertino

Translator: Andrew G. Traver

Introduction by: W. Thomas Branton

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0565.1.00

The *Malleus Daemonum* provides an exciting introduction into the religious world of early modern Italy. It consists of a series of personal exorcisms which the Italian Observant Franciscan Alessandro Albertino composed and which he claims have proven themselves by experience. It

bears witness to the end of a period in which priests could freely compose their own exorcisms as a regular part of their pastoral functions.

Albertino's exorcisms faithfully follow the Passion narrative in the four Gospels designed both to parallel and to empower the Vulgate text. His strategy is to employ the words and instruments used against Christ by his detractors against the demons occupying the possessed individual in order to expel them. Those words and weapons which were once used to torment, harass, and crucify Christ thus become spiritual weapons which the exorcist may use to treat their patient. Albertino introduces each exorcism with an epigram based on Classical mythology followed by litanies, invocations, and prayers, and he also includes a general exorcism to expel demons from specific parts of the body, along with general blessings and prayers to drive out all sorcery and diabolical intervention from particular articles of clothing.

This edition comprises a comprehensive historical and theological introduction, a Latin edition, and the first-ever English translation of *The Hammer of Demons.* The translation, research, and commentary unveil a long-buried gem of the seventeenth century, offering readers an alluring narrative about the evolving face of the ancient convention of exorcism. More than just a book, this introduction, edition, and translation are an essential contribution to the understanding of the intersection of exorcism, history, and religion in early modern Italy.

2.3.2 The Khan's Pifferi: Reading about the Musics of Asia in Late Fifteenth-Century Italy

Author: Tim Shephard

Author: Chenxi Xiao

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0531

This volume explores what Italian readers of the 1480s and 1490s could learn about Asian music through the expanding medium of print.

2.3.3 Rock-time (Vol. 4 in the FicSci Series)

Editor: Mehita Iqani

Editor: Wamuwi Mbao

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891422

What is science communication? This collection, the fourth in the series, continues to argue that it can be creative writing aimed at the heart, rather than information directed to the mind.

2.3.4 The Specter of AIDS

Author: Néstor Perlongher

Translator: Jorge Sánchez Cruz

Afterword by: Gabriel Giorgi

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0548.1.00

The Specter of AIDS is a transdisciplinary text originally written in 1980s Brasil in a time of pandemic emergency. It situates how HIV/AIDS reconfigured intimacy, sexuality, and power while also providing a minoritarian theory of desire lived by dissident sexualities in 1980s Latin America.

Perlongher's paper exposes a new barometer of life undergirded by medico-scientific reason, religious ideology, and morality — in other words, a re-actualization and intensification of normative reason. In nuanced prose combined with wit, rigorous scholarship, political alertness, and poetics, Perlongher delineates how HIV/AIDS serves as a blueprint for how viral threats shed light on the inequitable unevenness of this world.

Written in Portuguese in 1987 and then published in Spanish in 1988, this translation offers an un/timely reading for the 21st century as it shows how new contaminants threaten national public health's paradigms of gendered and racialized structures: their borders, bodies, and good comportment.

2.3.5 Autotheory and Its Others

Editor: Becky McLaughlin

Editor: Eric Daffron

Editor: Maria Gil Ulldemolins

Editor: Kris Pint

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0530.1.00

Ever since Maggie Nelson's *Argonauts* gave the word fresh currency a decade ago, autotheory has infiltrated scholarly, literary, and artistic practices. *Autotheory and Its Others* contributes to this nascent metacritical conversation. An inclusive discourse, autotheory embraces its uncanny double, allotheory, and, thus, this collection invites to the table a host of uncanny others: psychoanalysis, queer theory, and crip theory as well as art writing, postcriticism, and autofiction, among other genres and discourses.

Bringing together four editors and thirteen contributors from both sides of the Atlantic, this collection of critical and creative-critical essays grapples with what it means to couple the personal with the theoretical. The volume's chapters feature geographical settings as far-flung as New Zealand, Iran, and Mississippi and its wide-ranging topics include anecdotal theory and *dialogia–theoria,* the bodymind and illness, artificial intelligence and experimentation, accident and fantasy, collages and fragments, unlearning and autopractices, unknowing and the unconscious, uncertainty and art writing, narcissus and trauma, kudzu and pedagogy, memory and legend, autofabulation and religion, and lo-fi critique and academia. Ultimately, *Autotheory and Its Others* showcases this emergent genre's diversity while also charting its multivalent future directions.

2.3.6 The Philosophy of Julia Wedgwood: Imperfect Antithesis

Author: Alison Stone

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0543

Combining philosophical analysis with innovative digital methods for recovering lost texts, this study restores Wedgwood as a major nineteenth-century philosopher and offers a compelling new lens on moral and historical experience.

2.3.7 Communication Conduct in an Island Community

Author: Erving Goffman

Introduction by: Yves Winkin

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.baaa50ag

A republication of Erving Goffman's landmark 1953 dissertation, with a new introduction by Yves Winkin.

2.3.8 Rethinking Social Justice: Theory and Action in an Age of Transition

Author: Michael Karlberg

Author: Derik Smith

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0536

This book offers a compelling and original rethinking of social justice at a moment of global uncertainty and transformation. Tracing the emergence and evolution of modern social justice

discourse, it addresses two fundamental questions: what ends should we aspire toward, and what means are most effective in pursuing them? Moving beyond familiar critiques of injustice, the authors identify a shared, though often implicit, horizon that diverse traditions of thought all orient toward: contributive justice. This positive vision of social justice centers on the creation of social conditions that enable every individual and group to develop their capacities to contribute meaningfully to collective flourishing.

2.3.9 Verbal Multi-Word Expressions in Corpus Languages: Data, Methodology, and Analysis

Editor: Victoria Beatrix Fendel

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0478

This volume brings together a diverse, interdisciplinary cohort of scholars to shed new light on verbal multi-word expressions in corpus languages such as Greek, Latin, and Egyptian.

2.3.10 Distributed Productivities: Digital Transcreation and the New World Order of Cultural Production

Editor: Vinzenz Hediger

Editor: Matthias Krings

Editor: Bertram Lang

Editor: Cornelia Storz

Author: Tabitha Adler

Author: Añulika Agina

Author: Yonson Ahn

Author: Egbert Amoncio

Author: Sonia Campanini

Author: Casandra-Angela Chistinean

Author: Bakar Abdul-Rashid Jeduah

Author: Nico Nassenstein

Author: Izuu Nwankwọ

Author: Ute Röschenthaler

Author: Artemis Saleh

Author: Tom Simmert

Author: Solomon Waliaula

Author: Usaku Wammanda

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/0634

Digital distribution produces new global cultural flows from urban centers like Lagos, Mumbai or Seoul. But it also enables new forms of distributed production in which cultural entrepreneurs cooperate across continents and challenge and expand established notions of cultural and political space. In the "new world order of cultural production" (Fatima Bhutto) cultural specificity is no longer a matter of physical location, but of digital transcreation, the transport of meaning across multiple cultural contexts.The contributions to this volume trace such transports across Africa, Asia, and beyond.

2.3.11 Teaching Dido: Critical Perspectives on Aeneid 4

Editor: Ingo Gildenhard

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0540

A companion to *Virgil, Aeneid 4, with Study Questions, Vocabulary, and Commentary* (OBP 2026), *Teaching Dido* includes five essays that explore aspects of Virgil's poetry in a student-friendly way. They range from issues in poetics (verse design, allusion) to key themes ('historiographical Dido', religion, pietās). Six reprinted scholarly articles follow, allowing students and their teachers to engage directly with some of the research that informs the essays and the commentary and to broaden their appreciation of Dido, the Aeneid, Virgil, and the wider historical context. Topics covered include the ethics of hospitality, the interface of intertextuality and psychology in the construction of character, Carthage and Rome as imperial powers, racecraft in Aeneid 4, Virgil's authorial self-fashioning and negotiation of the Augustan new normal, the myth of Troy in Rome's cultural imaginary, and Dido's place within Virgil's philosophy of history.

2.4 June 2026

2.4.1 Digitale Gewalt: Politisierungen affektiver Öffentlichkeiten

Author: Julia Bee

Author: Jasmin Degeling

Author: Jennifer Eickelmann

Author: Katrin Köppert

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/2751

Digitale Gewalt, die sich in Form von Deepfakes, Doxing oder Voice Cloning gegen marginalisierte Gruppen richtet, ist politische Gewalt. Ihre gegenwärtige Konjunktur geht Hand in Hand mit der Proliferation rechter und faschistischer Politiken. Dieser Band untersucht Misogynie und Transfeindlichkeit, Rassismus und Faschismus unter digitalen Bedingungen und ordnet diese Gewaltformen mithilfe intersektionaler Theorien ein. Die Beiträge beleuchten die Regulierung und Politisierung Sozialer Medien, Rassismus in digitalen Erinnerungskulturen und kritische Politische Bildung. Durch diese Analysen interveniert der Band in Szenarien ungleich verteilter politischer Gewalt und zeigt auf, wie unerlässlich intersektionale Perspektiven der Gender Media Studies für eine zeitgemäße Analyse digitaler Medienkulturen sind.

2.4.2 Homo Textor: Weaving As (Technical) Mode of Existence

Editor: Ellen Harlizius-Klück

Editor: Annapurna Mamidipudi

Editor: Giovanni Fanfani

Editor: Alex McLean

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729425

Homo Textor aims to exemplify how weaving as a (technical) mode of existence provides concepts that help to rethink Homo faber and the way the Moderns talk about technology. It shows weaving as histomorphism, a generative process where intelligible forms grow out of the loom-weaver-threads system

2.4.3 Dotawo: A Journal of Nubian Studies 9: Nubian Homescapes

Editor: Anna Lucille Boozer

Editor: Anne M. Jennings

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0578.1.00

Dotawo: A Journal of Nubian Studies offers a platform in which the old meets the new, in which archaeological, papyrological, and philological research into Meroitic, Old Nubian, Coptic, Greek, and Arabic sources confront current investigations in modern anthropology and ethnography, Nilo-Saharan linguistics, and the critical and theoretical approaches of postcolonial and African studies. Dotawo gives a common home to the past, present, and future of one of the richest areas of research in African studies. It offers a crossroads where papyrus can meet the internet, scribes meet critical thinkers, and the promises of growing nations meet the accomplishments of older kingdoms.

The ninth issue of *Dotawo* takes a long-term perspective on Nubian houses and households to explore the distinctive material, visual, and phenomenological worlds of Nubian homescapes. A "homescape" is an array of features related to the home. It is the socially constructed space of human activity, understood as having spatial, conceptual, and emotional boundaries and delimitations. Contributors to this volume embrace the dichotomy of homescapes, demonstrating how Nubians adapt their homescapes over time and space even while adhering to a core identity. The cross-disciplinary contributions to this volume include sociological, anthropological, archaeological, and linguistic approaches to the topic, as well as photographic essays, artwork, and fiction.

2.4.4 Inner Conflicts

Author: Sana Sheikh

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0464.1.00

What should I do? What is the right thing to do? What do I do when I don't know what to do?

The difficulty in answering these questions does not come from a lack of knowledge but a deeper problem that requires us to look inward (and outward).

Inner Conflicts is meant to be read in times of upheaval. It traverses jagged terrain, giving voice to the unspoken doubts and contradictions that underlie our dearly held projects. Drawing from psychoanalytic theory, five chapters unpack, process, and – like psychoanalysis – free associate to the fundamental tensions in our lives that refuse resolution. Neither a simple

critique nor defense, *Inner Conflicts* contends that only through acknowledging all parts of the argument within us can we fully attend to the urgencies and particularities of ethical and political life.

2.4.5 Predictions: Volume 1: From speculative ethnography to apocalyptic testimony

Editor: Mél Hogan

Editor: Stefan Laser

Editor: Edward Ongweso Jr.

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729463

We make Predictions as a gesture of hope that goes against the current momentums that trouble us: planetary harm, war, AI hype, viruses, despair. The authors assembled in this series critically and creatively engage with what this uncanniness feels like, and how it helps us to redirect our engagement.

2.4.6 Virgil, Aeneid 4, with Study Questions, Vocabulary, and Commentary

Aeneid 4, with Study Questions, Vocabulary, and Commentary" width="300"/>

Author: Ingo Gildenhard

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0527

Poetry that has fascinated readers since antiquity is here presented in an innovative, student-friendly edition, with study questions, vocabulary, commentary and visual material designed to facilitate engagement with Virgil's text.

2.4.7 Echo Otherwise: A Poetics of Sound and Loss in Ancient and Contemporary Poetry

Author: Jocelyn Saidenberg

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0493.1.00

At the heart of this book is a story about reading, about reading and pedagogy, about pedagogy's readers, about readers who listen, listening while reading, about poems and their sonic materials, about the demands that poetic sounds make on writers and readers, about seduction, about echoes and repetition, about the resounding qualities of poetic matter. How might the inarticulate (or inarticulable) communicate in the sounds of poetry? And how might poetry teach us to attend to what is beyond language or even beyond figuration? Reading for the excluded or absent, that which remains after erasure, might be said to be a hermeneutical commandment. But how might we "read" for the faint echoes of words, the shared, phonic resonances that remain and continue to sound afterwards?

In *Echo Otherwise,* framed as a series of slow, recursive readerly meditations, Saidenberg sets about attending to these questions by bringing together two writers, Lucretius and Ferdinand de Saussure, whose selected works surprisingly disclose a set of interconnected and overlapping concerns with how sound works and in what sounds and resounds in the universe of poems and atoms, and they are also attentive to what sound tells us about poems and atoms. In addition to her readings of Lucretius and de Saussure on sound in the company of other readers — as reading, for Saidenberg, is a collective affair — there are garden walks in Little Sparta with Robert Glück and sustained engagements with m. nourbeSe philip's* Zong!,* several works by Saidiya Hartman, and the global pandemic. Ultimately, * Echo Otherwise* attests to the richness of the encounters that transpire in the process of reading and its transformative effects, encouraging forms of relation that would be receptive to and solicitous of unexpected otherness.

2.4.8 After the Before Times: Teachers' Experiences of Pandemic Pedagogy

Author: Sarah E. Barrett

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0529

After the Before Times documents how teachers experienced those early months of COVID-19 pandemic pedagogy—and what their stories reveal about the nature of teaching and learning

2.4.9 The Phonemes

Author: Frances Richard

Introduction by: Ronaldo V. Wilson

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0579.1.00

In *The Phonemes*, Frances Richard investigates perceptually distinct units of experience, such as sounds, energy surges, and scraps of national and natural history, to create episodes of disruption and dissolution. Organized into sequences that move from seismic notation and wave-form typography to lyric encounters with meteors, snakes, glaciers, and the domestic sublime, the poems break language into its smallest expressive particles and reassemble them at the threshold where sense tips into noise.

Richard's formal vocabulary is at once scientific and devotional: geological terms collide with fragments of political speech, advertising copy, lullaby, and prayer, while visual scores of nested parentheses, dashes, and radical signs interrupt the page like oscillograph readings of an unstable signal. What emerges is a poetics of phonemic attention, an insistence that a syllable, weather event, or fault line all can carry a full emotional charge and that the task of the poem is to hold open the instant in which raw perception has not yet hardened into meaning.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

2.5 May 2026

2.5.1 The Politics of Open Infrastructures: Power, Governance, and Justice in Digital Knowledge Practices

Editor: Katja Mayer

Editor: Astrid Mager

Editor: Renée Ridgway

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0528

This volume examines how openness is designed, governed, contested and lived in contemporary digital knowledge infrastructures. From open source software and internet standards, to citizen science platforms, public sector data systems and alternative computing practices, the book shows that infrastructures are never neutral technical backbones.

2.5.2 War Machine

Author: Richard A. Carter

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0564.1.00

War Machine is a speculative sounding of the myriad entanglements of technology, ecology, discourse, politics, and conflict shaping the contemporary environment. Taking the tools of geopolitical competition and control as its formal and conceptual basis—wargame simulations, artificial intelligence, weaponised drones, territorial enclosure, and extractivist economics—*War Machine* presents a series of digitally simulated conflicts over the most ecologically vulnerable areas of the Earth, using the data gathered to generate hybrid visual poems that stand in for the multitude of political, conceptual, and economic battles that are presently raging across the face of a profoundly endangered planet.

A hybrid work of generative criticism and poetry,* War Machine* depicts the intensive complexities of the present moment through conducting an experimental textual performance, attempting to enfold and perform, rather than simply describe, challenging conjunctions of competing discourses and activities. The resulting stream of outputs and interpretive potentials preclude the ascendency of any "definitive" critical narrative, refusing any straightforward integration with existing canons of worldly diagnosis, but also illustrating opportunities for resistant play and critical-creative possibility within the uncertainty.

The consciously unconventional gesture at the heart of *War Machine* is in attempt at modelling an adventurous, forward-facing approach, in both thought and practice, that refuses inaction when dealing with otherwise devastating scenarios. It is an approach that acknowledges head-on myriad worldly harms, seemingly insurmountable, while still contributing to the aesthetic, affective, and conceptual foundations from which alternative modes of knowing, being, and meaning are developed and justified.

2.5.3 Neoliberalism, Democratic Erosion and the Global Struggle for Social Justice

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Chris Tapscott

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891330

The global expansion of neoliberal capitalism and its contentious relationship with democracy remains one of the most pressing debates of our time. This book offers a comprehensive examination of how capitalism has adapted from merchant and industrial forms into the modern era of financialization which underpins the current globalising order. By tracing the evolution of the state, it explores the deliberate political decisions that have prioritised market efficiency over social welfare.The central thesis of this book is that neoliberalism is not an inevitable evolutionary endpoint of human development, but rather a crafted ideology designed to "tame" democracy through technocratic and judicial constraints. The authors argue that a fundamental tension exists between the market's "free play of forces" and the democratic principle of social entitlement. As the state shifts from an economic regulator to a market broker, democratic oversight is increasingly displaced by insulated, expert-driven authorities.

This restructuring has not only fuelled global inequality but has also turned technology into a tool for digital coloniality, where transnational firms extract value through surveillance and algorithmic optimisation. "Techno-feudalism" epitomises how the contemporary trajectory of datafication serves corporate interests over democratic publics.Unlike literature that merely critiques, this book identifies emerging "geo-economic fragmentation" and the revival of socialdemocratic ideas as openings for democratic renewal. Ultimately, the book argues that the current hegemony is neither inevitable nor irreversible. By analysing the rise of right-wing populism and the growing disillusionment with the neoliberal narrative, the contributors highlight the urgent need to reassert democratic control over economic systems to address the existential threats of environmental collapse and social polarisation.

2.5.4 Lifetimes: A Theory of Timescales and Life Forms

Editor: Helge Jordheim

Editor: Sine Halkjelsvik Bjordal

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0484.1.00

At the beginning of the twenty-first century, many of our most well-known and dependable forms of keeping, managing, and representing time are losing their grasp on the real. Clocks cannot measure how societies speed up, or come to a standstill during crisis, modern historiography is unable to come up with meaningful narratives about mankind as the sixth extinction event, and calendars are insufficient as tools for societal and political change. *Lifetimes: A Theory of Timescales and Life Forms* presents an alternative framework for studying lives and times, and the relationships between them.

Building on post-war theories of history, as well as several historical sub-disciplines, such as cultural history, history of science, and medical history, *Lifetimes* integrates approaches from anthropology, game studies, cultural studies, literary studies, critical heritage studies, science & technology studies, and critical time studies. Times are understood as always existing in plural, as embodied and emergent—in things, in assemblages of things, and in the relations between things. Among them are the lives of humans, but also the lives of viruses, plants, animals, rocks, computers, nations, concepts, policies, technologies, infrastructures, etc.

Lifetimes explores theoretical foundations while at the same time developing them through case studies in individual chapters. The result is a bottom-up theory of temporal multiplicity, conceptually and theoretically open enough to be productive across various academic disciplines. Rather than discussing how different disciplines relate to time, the authors in this edited collection present a theoretically sustained, empirically diverse range of cases, in which times in plural become politically and historically salient. Out of these case studies a new theory emerges: a theory of lifetimes.

2.5.5 The Unbearable Light(ness) of AI: Bright Promises and Hidden Shadows of Artificial Intelligence

Editor: Giuliano Pozza

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0530

This volume examines one of the defining tensions of our era: how to harness the transformative power of artificial intelligence while preserving responsibility, sovereignty, and human judgement. Bringing together scholars and practitioners, this volume moves beyond hype and alarmism to explore AI across three interconnected levels: global systems, organisational governance, and personal ethics. It addresses digital sovereignty, cybersecurity, sustainability, inclusion, healthcare, education, and accessibility, highlighting both the environmental and social costs of AI and its potential to advance innovation within the Sustainable Development Goals.

2.5.6 A Multipolar Approach to Early Christian Arabic: Vatican Arabic Ms 13 in the Linguistic Landscape of Early Islam

Author: Phillip W. Stokes

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0517

This volume offers the most comprehensive linguistic analysis to date of Vatican Arabic MS 13, a late 9th/early 10th-century Arabic Gospel manuscript. Combining meticulous quantitative study with wide-ranging comparative evidence, this book provides an in-depth examination of the manuscript's orthography, phonology, morphology, morpho-syntax, and syntax. Through extensive charts, tables, and multiple interpretive frameworks, the author illuminates how linguistic features pattern across every dimension relevant to accurate analysis.

Crucially, the study does not treat MS 13 in isolation. Its features are systematically compared with those of other Christian Arabic manuscripts, Quranic traditions, medieval Arabic registers, early poetry, and modern dialects. This contextualised approach situates the manuscript within the rich linguistic diversity of medieval Arabic and challenges long-standing assumptions about 'Middle Arabic' and 'Classical Arabic'. By demonstrating that many features of MS 13 align with broader scribal and linguistic practices of the period, the book makes a compelling case against the notion that scribes worked towards a single, unified register or variety. Rather, they drew creatively and pragmatically from a diverse repertoire of features and linguistic traditions, revealing a far more dynamic and multifaceted approach to written composition than previously recognised.

An outstanding and field-shaping contribution, this volume provides an essential model for future work on Christian Arabic, medieval Arabic varieties, and the history of Arabic more broadly.

2.5.7 Colour Matters: Exploring Chromatic Materialities in the Long Nineteenth Century (1798-1914)

Editor: Stefano Evangelista

Editor: Charlotte Ribeyrol

Editor: Matthew Winterbottom

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0501

Colour Matters provides a fresh investigation of colour in the long nineteenth century. Across fourteen richly researched essays, the book explores the materiality, politics, and sensory experience of colour—from synthetic dyes and chrome pigments to the role of colour in medicine, gender, empire, and identity.

2.5.8 The Sentencing of Jesus (Gzar-dina de-Yeshu): The 'Authentic' Jewish Protocols of the Trial of Jesus

Author: Gideon Bohak

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0497

By reconstructing an ancient polemical text that has previously been known only in a fragmentary manner, and by situating it both within its Late Antique context and in the context of previous scholarship, this book makes a significant contribution to the study of Judaism, and of Jewish-Christian relations, in Late Antiquity and the early Middle Ages.

2.5.9 Benjamin Franklin, Orthoepist and Phonetician: Vol. 1: Language, Literacy and Social Mobility in Franklin's World

Author: Gary D. German

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0470

This book offers a groundbreaking exploreation of Franklin's little-studied linguistic legacy – his *Reformed Mode of Spelling* (1768/1779).

2.5.10 Distributing Knowledge: Openness, Equity, and Higher Education Transformation

Author: Richard F. Heller

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0520

Inequity is deeply embedded in higher education: in who can access learning, whose knowledge is created and valued, who gets published, and who ultimately benefits from universities' work. Distributing Knowledge argues that the sector is falling short of its public mission—and that incremental reform is no longer enough.

2.5.11 Benjamin Franklin, Orthoepist and Phonetician: Vol. 2: Colonial American Voices and London Norms: Franklin's Quest for an Orthographic Reform

Author: Gary D. German

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0537

Benjamin Franklin has been hailed as an inventor, scientist, printer, author, philosopher, diplomat, philanthropist and political activist and, especially, a founding father of the United States, but few are aware he was also a phonetician. This volume offers a groundbreaking exploration of Franklin's little-studied linguistic legacy—his Reformed Mode of Spelling (1768/1779). In this short treatise, Franklin outlined a plan for a radical, phonetically-based modernization of the English spelling system that would simultaneously serve as a pronunciation guide for what he envisaged to be 'correct' English as well as a practical scheme allowing the unlettered and foreigners to learn to read and write 'within a week'. The social and sociolinguistic reasons for its inception as well as what that model entailed linguistically are the focus of this book.

2.5.12 From Debris to Sediment: Unearthing Imperial Geology

Editor: Felix Hasebrink

Editor: Petra Löffler

Author: Ulrike Gerhardt

Author: Henriette Gunkel

Author: Amelia Hine

Author: Alexandra Klemme

Author: Susanne Kriemann

Author: Lisa Rosendahl

Author: Christiane Schürkmann

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/2713

In geology, the term sediment refers to organic or mineral particles that were set in motion and transported to a new location by air, water, or ice. Today, new sediments are emerging that challenge traditional concepts of geological processes: the global spread of microplastics, the contamination of soil and water with toxins, infrastructural remainders of industrial manufacturing, or the material legacies of imperial and/or colonial resource extraction. From Debris to Sediment addresses the rising relevance of these residues. From the perspective of media studies, geography, sociology, environmental sciences, and artistic research, the contributions to this volume deal with key sites and issues related to the mounting layers of anthropogenic refuse and explore sediments as a geo-philosophical figure of thought. What media, politics, and ecologies are implicated in accumulating "future fossils"? And how do they envision the new material cycles emerging from these growing deposits?

2.6 April 2026

2.6.1 From the Margins: Migrant Academics' Narratives of Precarity

Editor: Ladan Rahbari

Editor: Olga Burlyuk

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0508

From the Margins: Migrant Academics' Narratives of Precarity is the much-anticipated second volume following *Migrant Academics' Narratives of Precarity and Resilience in Europe* published in 2023, and available at https://www.openbookpublishers.com/books/10.11647/obp.0331. This new collection deepens and expands the conversation on the lived experiences of migrant academics navigating global academia.

Maintaining the autoethnographic and narrative approach of the first volume, *From the Margins* brings together diverse voices that challenge the Eurocentric framing of academic mobility

by extending the focus beyond Europe to contexts such as the United States, Canada, Australia, Japan, South Africa, and the Middle East. Through deeply personal, creative, and reflexive narratives, the contributors delve deep into the notions of privilege, migration, and precarity, revealing how academic hierarchies and colonial legacies shape everyday experiences of belonging, vulnerability, and resilience.

Bridging scholarship and storytelling, this volume offers an intellectually rich and emotionally resonant exploration of academia's margins, inviting readers to rethink what knowledge, care, and solidarity mean within and beyond institutional borders. This volume appeals to scholars and students across migration, sociology, postcolonial, gender, race, and border studies, as well as to university leaders and diversity officers. Its interdisciplinary and creative format—including poetry and prose—makes it both accessible and engaging for academic and general audiences alike.

2.6.2 Vector Media

Author: Leonardo Impett

Author: Fabian Offert

Introduction by: Johanna Drucker

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/0986

Neural networks are designed to dissolve all media into the vector space—a universal space of commensurability. In Vector Media, Leonardo Impett and Fabian Offert parse theories of automatic vision to trace contemporary artificial intelligence's technical ideology of epistemic reduction, where sensory data is turned into abstracted forms of meaning. Under this regime, bias is not just a question of what is represented but of the logic of representation itself. Drawing on Phil Agre's notion of a critical technical practice, Vector Media reveals how artificial intelligence systems embed new epistemologies of media beneath the surface of their architectures.Analyzing the techniques underpinning large multimodal artificial intelligence models like DALL-E, Midjourney, Flux, or Stable Diffusion, Impett and Offert offer the concept of neural exchange value: the value cultural artifacts acquire not through meaning or context but through their capacity to function as vectors. In such a system, commensurability becomes a condition of existence: what matters is not what something is but that it can be embedded. Rather than focusing solely on datasets, Vector Media proposes a critical study of vector spaces—and the machine cultures they produce—as a necessary complement to prevailing approaches in AI critique.

2.6.3 Artificial Intelligence in Higher Education: A Phenomenological View

Editor: Sencer Yeralan

Author: Philip Aka

Author: Derek Baker

Author: Azra Branković

Author: Eka Gegeshidze

Author: Laura Ancona Lee

Author: Christos Michalakelis

Author: Mbulaheni Nthangeni

Author: Efthymia Staiou

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0525

Artificial intelligence is increasingly embedded in the everyday practices of higher education, shaping assessment, governance, labor, and institutional legitimacy. Rather than presenting a technical guide or policy checklist, this volume instead offers a reflective, multi-voiced examination of what AI means for higher education's purpose, identity, and future. Its phenomenological grounding shifts the focus from operational questions of implementation to deeper inquiries into how AI reshapes institutions, knowledge, and the academic self.

2.6.4 Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape: The "Natives" Look Far and Wide

Editor: Marisol Ramos

Editor: Manuel Valdés Pizzini

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0540.1.00

Before World War II, most anthropological research in Puerto Rico was led by US anthropologists. The most famous project, *The People of Puerto Rico,* was directed by American anthropologist Julian Steward and launched the career of renowned scholars such as Sidney Mintz and Eric Wolf. *Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape* aims to delineate the development of the post-WWII anthropological field in Puerto Rico by Puerto Rican anthropologists, the so-called "native" anthropologists. The contributors to *Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape* deploy the term "native" somewhat ironically, but they also

know that who they are affects their positionality vis-à-vis their research subjects. Thus, they retain the term to spark a conversation addressing the complicated feelings that such labels still evoke among non-mainstream anthropologists.

Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape purposely avoids making Puerto Rico and Puerto Ricans a problem to study and instead focuses on a wide variety of epistemological and methodological questions related to the study of Puerto Rico and Puerto Ricans by "native" anthropologists within local, regional, and global spheres. We posit that the Puerto Rican anthropological landscape transcends the confines of the island of Puerto Rico to encompass its connection and engagement with the larger world, and that it is not limited to the inhabitants of the island of Puerto Rico but embraces members of its diaspora, as well as other groups and ethnicities. On that note, this book seeks to reflect critically on how the academic field of anthropology (research and teaching) in Puerto Rico has evolved, post-WWII, in various engagements with the current debates of contemporary anthropology — theoretical, methodological, socio-cultural, political, and otherwise.

2.6.5 Harvesting the Sea in Southeastern Arabia: Volume 2: Comparative Lexicon of Fish and Other Marine Species

Author: Miranda J. Morris

Author: Erik Anonby

Author: Janet C.E. Watson

Editor: Erik Anonby

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0538

Along the shores of southeastern Arabia, traditional marine knowledge is fading as languages and ecosystems come under increasing pressure. This second volume of *Harvesting the Sea in Southeastern Arabia* brings together marine species terminology and associated knowledge in the five coastal Modern South Arabian languages (MSAL) and the Kumzari language of the Musandam Peninsula in eastern Arabia. The materials, collected by the authors in periods between the 1970s and the present, are a testament to communities' longstanding intimacy with the sea and their resilient livelihoods in the face of often difficult conditions.

Over 2000 marine species names are inventoried, featuring many bony fish and cartilaginous fish, but also including mammals, reptiles, invertebrates, and plants. Terms for fish at various life stages and vocabulary associated with marine species are also provided. The lists are organised in the format of a comparative lexicon, where individual species are compared across the six languages, and as an annotated alphabetical lexicon with a searchable companion file, presenting additional insights collected over the course of fieldwork.

Along with its relevance for communities where this knowledge is being lost as species die out and livelihoods change, this book is an essential resource for anyone interested in learning from the languages, cultures, and ecosystems of Arabia.

2.6.6 Social Constructions of Gender-Based Violence in African Countries

Editor: Tinuade Adekunbi Ojo

Editor: Tanusha Raniga

Editor: Samson Sambian Konlan

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891309

Based on rich, contextual analysis from South Africa, Zimbabwe, Kenya and Ethiopia, *Social Constructions of Gender-Based Violence in African Countries* offers an exploration of gender-based violence that moves beyond definition to examine the profound psychological social and economic impacts of GBV, framing it as a critical barrier to human rights and prosperous societies. The analysis is set against the backdrop of international frameworks such as the UN Sustainable Development Goals and Africa Agenda 2063, while critically assessing national policies and legislative milestones within the four focus countries.

A central theme is the critique of governmental failures and the essential role of non-state actors. The book highlights how civil society organisations, aid institutions and research bodies fill critical gaps in service delivery, particularly for the most vulnerable, and provide novel assessments and interventions. It gives specific attention to the exacerbated challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic, which revealed severe deficiencies in protection systems and pushed women into greater danger during lockdowns.

Ultimately, *Social Constructions of Gender-Based Violence in African Countries* is a call for proactive, transformative action. It argues for improved gender justice through increased female representation in leadership, financial empowerment for women and robust, evidence-based policies. It is an indispensable resource for policymakers, human service professionals and scholars across Africa and beyond, providing the insights needed to re-evaluate existing strategies and formulate effective, empowering responses to end gender-based violence.

2.6.7 Sonic Detection: Necessary Notes for Art and Performance

Author: Rebecca Collins

Author: Johanna Linsley

Contributions by: Naomi Pearce

Contributions by: Xavier de Sousa

Contributions by: Christina Beatty

Contributions by: Nii Obodai

Research by: Amaara Raheem

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0470.1.00

Sonic Detection is part sonic noir, part performance document, and part critical investigation of listening at the margins for readers interested in prospecting the boundaries of performance studies, sound studies, and interdisciplinary writing.

The book opens with a group of sonic detectives (exact number unknown) who investigate the mystery of an as-yet-unidentified event that leaves traces only in the acoustic atmosphere. This hybrid fiction propels the reader up and down the UK coast and offers overheard fragments from a faded seaside resort, a container shipping port, a former coal-mining town, and the Scottish headquarters for North Sea oil. A heterogeneous collection of texts follows, from creative-critical essays, performance scores, engagement with the archives of earlier sonic detectives (including poet/performance artist Fiona Templeton and the sound art collective Bow Gamelan Ensemble), to a series of dispatches from expert witnesses with their ears to the ground.

Sonic Detection is not so much a monograph as a polygraph, tongue-in-cheek associations with questionable forensic technologies firmly in place. The book emerges from a decade-long collaboration between artists Rebecca Collins and Johanna Linsley, who used eavesdropping as an expanded creative methodology. The project began as a series of hyper-local, community-based performance works in coastal locations in the UK (from Bournemouth to Aberdeen) and grew into an international, multi-disciplinary life work devoted to an ongoing, organized curiosity. Sonic detectives hold open a collective sonorous space. They are the embodiment of the phenomenophile, lingering longer in listening.

2.6.8 The American Archipelago: A New Edition of Oscar Handlin's Classic Anthology, 'This Was America'

Author: Oscar Handlin

Editor: Kenneth Weisbrode

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0495

The collection at hand, Handlin's classic anthology 'This Was America', first published in 1949, gathers Europeans' travel accounts and perspectives on America from the eighteenth to the twentieth century. Rather than presenting a single narrative, Handlin emphasizes variety:

contrasting impressions of liberty and inequality, restlessness and rootedness, optimism and critique by people arriving from diverse European backgrounds. His free translations and selective introductions guide readers subtly but leave interpretation open. Over time, these essays shift meaning depending on context—once read as a celebration of American life, they now invite more critical reflection. This new edition reimagines America not as a singular whole but as an "archipelago": a collection of diverse experiences, perceptions, and contradictions. The metaphor underscores the interplay between unity and multiplicity in American identity.

2.6.9 Pietro Giannone. Autobiography. The Tragedy of a Historian and the Inquisition: Translated with commentary by Thérèse Ridley

Translator: Thérèse Ridley

Contributions by: Thérèse Ridley

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0483

This edition, translated and annotated by Therese Ridley, not only renders the full autobiography accessible to English readers for the first time, but contextualizes it within modern Italian scholarship. Each chapter is enriched with appendices that include critical sources, commentary, and related correspondence, illuminating the people, events, and philosophical struggles that defined Giannone's world.

2.6.10 Beyond Popular Science

Author: David H. Silver

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0526

Beyond Popular Science is not a popular science book. It is not a textbook. It is not an academic monograph. Instead, it occupies a rare and deliberately unconventional space: a work for readers who enjoy scientific storytelling but are no longer satisfied with simplifications that smooth away the real substance of modern science.

2.6.11 Kayfabe Nation: Professional Wrestling, Donald Trump, and the New Cynicism

Author: Neal Hebert

Author: Jon Cogburn

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0563.1.00

What do a pudgy, orange autocrat, and pumped-up men in tights have in common? The connections, while profound, all rest on specific strategies employed by World Wrestling Entertainment during the early 2000s (known as WWE's "Attitude Era") when Donald Trump was centrally involved with the promotion of WWE. These are: (1) universally breaking *kayfabe,* the code of people in the industry not to reveal or admit fakery; (2) Vince McMahon (WWE's CEO at that time) playing a fictional version of himself as someone constantly humiliated in storylines; (3) the vicious affirmation of traditional gender roles through parables of male domination; and (4) telling stories that encourage viewers to ignore the actual material conditions of WWE "superstars" in favor of conspiratorial fictions involving powerful individual actors. In *Kayfabe Nation: Professional Wrestling, Donald Trump, and the New Cynicism,* Hebert and Cogburn present a trenchant analysis of Attitude Era WWE, showing the extent to which MAGA is just is a function, or symptom, of Trump's internalization of WWE's most objectionable tropes.

Neal Hebert and Jon Cogburn's goal is not to use WWE merely to understand Trumpism and the related autocratic turn in countries as diverse as El-Sisi's Egypt, Putin's Russia, Erdogan's Turkey, Modi's India, Bolsonaro's Brazil, Orbán's Hungary, Netanyahu's Israel, and of course Trump's own America. Beyond that, *Kayfabe Nation* is a defense of truth against the lie that culminates in the widespread adoption of self-defeating conspiracy theories among the constituency of the right, as well as against the idea, popular in corrupted center-left parties across the planet that political success comes down to adopting better rhetorical strategies, strategies that exist in part to cover over their abandonment of New Deal and socialist ideologies where the material conditions of their constituencies would actually improve.

2.7 March 2026

2.7.1 Works for Works, Book 2: "No Rights"

Author: Gavin Keeney

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0512.1.00

Works for Works, Book 2: "No Rights," privileges works-based agency (praxis) in literary-artistic scholarship. The principal focus of the Franciscan-inspired embrace of a "no rights" status for works of literary-artistic scholarship is toward freeing both author and works from forms of technocratic determinism and neo-utilitarianism associated with regimes of intellectual property rights law and platform cultures. Engaging, and then dispensing with, the concept of "the artistic exception," a holdover from modernist justifications for art in/for itself, *Works for Works* nonetheless restores the primacy of the work itself through disconnecting author and work toward a transfiguration of both author and work and the substantiation of a new ecosystem for radical works of artistic-critical inquiry.

Works for Works, Book 2: "No Rights," follows upon *Works for Works, Book 1: Useless Beauty* (2022), a structuralist-inspired survey and exposé of the immanentist paradox artist-scholars inhabit in the post-contemporary transition from modernist and post-modernist reflexivity to forms of cultural production that favor no singular raison d'être nor socio-cultural, socio-economic, or socio-political bias.

2.7.2 Red Lives: Our Years in the U.S. Communist Party (1950–2000), Vol. 1: Coming of Age in the Communist and Labor Movements

Editor: Jay Schaffner

Editor: Paul Friedman

Editor: Cindy Hawes

Editor: Geoffrey Jacques

Editor: Timothy Johnson

Editor: Carol Pittman

Editor: Donna Ristorucci

Editor: Daniel Rosenberg

Editor: Jackie Saindon

Foreword by: Robin D.G. Kelley

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0455.1.00

Red Lives: Our Years in the US Communist Party (1950–2000) is the first collection of historical analyses and reminiscences by members of the Communist Party USA (CPUSA) and the Communist youth movement in the US from the 1950s through the 1990s. The nearly fifty first-person testimonies bring to life a missing chapter in the history of US radicalism

and demonstrate the influence of the post–World War II generation of Communists on social justice movements.

Most histories of US Communism end in 1956 when *Red Lives* just begins, when McCarthyism was on its final legs, the Civil Rights Movement was sweeping the American South and the whole country, the student movement was taking its first breaths, and a new generation of young people were seeking out socialists, communists, and the Communist Party in order to craft a radical, anti-establishment politics. At a time when the launching of Sputnik, the Cuban Revolution, other revolutions sweeping Africa, and the example of the Vietnamese people fighting for their freedom and independence were inspiring the world, one-third of the world was also socialist, led by the Soviet Union and China. The time was propitious for a new generation in the US to also be seeking out, and joining, the CPUSA. This first volume of *Red Lives*, *Coming of Age in the Communist and Labor Movements,* brings the stories of that generation to the forefront of American history at a time when narratives of resistance are more needed than ever before.

2.7.3 Spaces for Action: A Repository of Tools and Methods for a Socially Situated Architectural Education

Editor: Guido Cimadomo

Editor: Ingrid C. Vargas Díaz

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0503

'Spaces for Action' provides a hands-on guide for teachers and students looking to make architectural learning more engaging, collaborative, and socially meaningful.

The book brings together over 80 creative tools that can be adapted to different classrooms, communities, and design challenges. The tools are grouped by teaching approaches—like cooperative teamwork, experiential learning, and transformative practices—and by the stages of the design process: identifying challenges, generating ideas, and putting them into action. Each entry gives a clear overview of what the tool is for, how it works, and what you need to make it happen. You'll also find tips on group sizes, resources, and possible collaborators, making it easy to bring these methods straight into practice.

2.7.4 Ottoman-Era Documents from the Cairo Genizah

Author: Jane Hathaway

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0502

This groundbreaking volume marks a rare and transformative contribution to studies of the Cairo Genizah, a vast trove of documents generated by Egypt's Jewish community between the 10th and 19th centuries. While the Cairo Genizah has long yielded extraordinary insights into Jewish history in the greater Mediterranean region, attention has focused overwhelmingly on documents from the 'classical' period (11th–13th centuries). Documents from the later period, when Egypt was ruled by the Mamluk Sultanate and the Ottoman Empire, remain woefully underexplored. This book helps to change that, presenting a meticulously curated collection of later Genizah documents that expand the boundaries of current scholarship.

2.7.5 Make/Unmake: Play at the Centre of Culture Change

Author: Anna Beresin

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0511

Anna Beresin's 'Make/Unmake' is an engaging and deeply original exploration of children's play as a powerful cultural force. Drawing on ethnographic research and vivid travel writing, the author journeys to the Midlands region of England to observe three remarkable play-based programs: the Maker{Futures} Mobile Makerspace, the Pitsmoor Adventure Playground, and the GLUE Collective. She captures the voices of playworkers, teachers, and artists and documents the ingenuity of children turning objects into tools of imagination and change.

2.7.6 Dutch Afro Becomings: Hybrid Being in Black Art and Culture

Author: Charl Landvreugd

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0537.1.00

In *Dutch Afro Becomings,* artist, curator, and researcher Charl Landvreugd argues that we do not yet have a language to understand Dutch Afro-ness, and that it is insufficient to rely on the discourses developed in African American, Black British, or Caribbean cultural theory alone. This critical monograph on continental European Black art and cultural history articulates the specificity of Dutch Afro-ness and the way that Blackness has been translated and (mis)understood across multiple decades of cultural policy, while also providing an incisive analysis of the Dutch state's aim to showcase "diversity" in a way that is comfortable to the white cultural class, without ever addressing issues of racism or race.

Simultaneously, Landvreugd traces how recent generations of artists are effectively constructing a new visual language to name their Dutch Afro-ness by deepening the way their being is shaped across multiple cultural identities and national histories. These time travelers and wanderers are the Wakaman: cultural workers that embrace their hybridity and multiplicity

and have defined, on their own terms and through their own words, their nativity within the Dutch art scene.

Dutch Afro Becomings is a key theoretical and art-historical work, as an introduction to both different international genealogies of Black arts and culture and to the different movements that shaped the specificity of Dutch Afro artists in particular.

2.7.7 Historicizing IQ Testing: Intelligence Assessments and their Role in Norwegian Society from the 1900s to the Present

Editor: Håkon Aamot Caspersen

Editor: Jon Røyne Kyllingstad

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0471

Intelligence testing has shaped modern society in profound ways, influencing education, psychology, law, and governance. This volume offers the first comprehensive study of the history of IQ testing in a Nordic country, shedding new light on its development, adaptation, and societal impact in Norway.

2.8 February 2026

2.8.1 Desire: Subject, Sexuation, and Love

Author: Ana María Munar

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0516.1.00

Have you ever wondered what makes you wake up in the morning? Why not just lay down, stay, and eventually disappear? What is the wanting, the energy, and the grace of liveliness? Desire is at the core of liveliness, and this book explains why it is so. Desire is much more than a mere appendix to love, sex, or our craving to have the latest fashion item. It is what allows the most personal and unique expression of each of us.

Desire: Subject, Sexuation, and Love is a work of gratitude to the Lacanian tradition and feminist philosophy. It creatively uses the story of "The Little Mermaid" by H.C. Andersen, as well as art and popular culture to explain the complex landscape of desire and its relation to love and sexuation. Much of the criticism of psychoanalysis from gender studies and poststructuralism is based on a superficial reading of Jacques Lacan, and Munar corrects this,

providing in the first half of the book a rigorous and clear analysis of Lacanian subjectification and sexuation, elucidating their relationship to the nature of desire and love, in order to modify overly simplistic and erroneous interpretations of his thinking on desire.

Desire is essayistic and poetic philosophy, drawing upon and playing with psychoanalysis, philosophy, literature, biography, poetry, and art. As the reader enters the second part of the book, the focus on Lacanian theory recedes, opening a space that is more paradoxical and multiple where Munar engages in creative form as an expression of critique, transforming our understandings of desire and love, which always elude us while also always being present.

2.8.2 Imagining What We Don't Know: Creative Theory and Critical Bodies

Author: Lisa Samuels

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0483.1.00

Bringing together perception, ecology, community, lingual value, and quantum life, *Imagining What We Don't Know: Creative Theory and Critical Bodies* presents twenty-four essays and theory poems that blend interpretive neologisms — wild dialectics, distributed centrality, membranism, deformance, bioautography, transplace, soft text, and more — with readings of visionary philosophers and the art and writing of Algeria, Australasia, the Caribbean, Oceania, the UK, and the US.

Committed to experimental ideation and relational ethics, *Imagining What We Don't Know* is for art and theory practitioners, philosophy rebels, creative writers, and anyone who relishes thinking about contemporary art, transnational and transdisciplinary life, and how we imagine with language. *Imagining What We Don't Know* presents a biblio-architecture of "blurprints" built with theories of the embodied mind that are elemental, entangled, and electrified by the political. This is creative theory, hovering with alterities of art and interpretation and imagining with critical attention.

2.8.3 Africa in Russian Imperial Culture: Race, Empire, and Representation (1850-1917)

Author: Anita Frison

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0504

This volume uncovers how Sub-Saharan Africa was imagined in Russian culture from 1850 to 1917. Drawing on travelogues, ethnographic studies, fiction, and museum collections, Anita

Frison reveals how Russia—though lacking formal colonies in Africa—nonetheless engaged deeply with Western colonial discourse.

2.8.4 From Erving to Goffman: A Work in Performance?

Author: Yves Winkin

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.e3d5966c

Yves Winkin's From Erving to Goffman, translated from the French, is an elegantly written and deeply informed account of the sociologist's life, by one of the world's leading Goffman scholars.

2.8.5 A Society of Meta-Organizations

Author: Héloïse Berkowitz

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0505

Our contemporary societies are made of meta-organizations — organizations composed of other organizations. These range from international bodies like the International Whaling Commission, to national industry or business associations like the crowdfunding association Finance Participative France, to local associations such as fisheries co-management committees in Catalunya. Meta-organizations have become a defining feature of how actors coordinate, govern and make collective decisions. But what exactly makes them distinct, and why do they matter — both in theory and in practice?

2.8.6 Neomania: How Our Obsession With Innovation is Failing Science, and How to Restore Trust

Author: Krist Vaesen

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0507

Drawing on metascience as well as the philosophy and sociology of science, Neomania offers a critical analysis of how this ethos has permeated the norms and institutions of modern science. The book traces its historical emergence, diagnoses its systemic consequences, and articulates a reform agenda centered on coordination, shared research programs, and epistemic integrity—an agenda that goes well beyond the principles of Open Science.

2.8.7 al-Dānī's al-Taysīr fī al-qirāʾāt al-sabᶜ: A Translation with Linguistic Commentary

Author: Marijn van Putten

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0475

Al-Taysīr fī al-Qirāʾāt al-Sabᶜ by the 11th century Andalusian scholar ʾAbū ᶜAmr al-Dānī is one of the most influential descriptions of the seven reading traditions of the Qurʾān. It is the work on which the later didactic poem by al-Šāṭibī was based, which still stands as the basis for the teaching of the reading traditions among Muslim specialists. This book makes the highly technical genre of the Qurʾānic reading traditions accessible through a rigorous translation of al-Dānī's work with extensive elucidating footnotes. Besides a full translation of the text, the book also includes an in-depth introduction, which lays out the history of the reading traditions, details of their transmission, the technical terminology of the Qirāʾāt genre, and summarises the linguistic principles of the reading traditions using modern linguistic terminology and illustrative tables.

2.8.8 Corporeal Aesth/ethics: The Body in Bracha L. Ettinger's Theory and Art

Author: Anna Kisiel

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0499.1.00

Can we think of an ethics that originates in corporeality, and not in codified or symbolic systems? In* Corporeal Aesth/ethics,* the body resurfaces as a central category of Bracha L. Ettinger's theory and art, as well as an interpretive key that allows us to assume ethical responsibility for an Other who is not abstract, or distant, or total. Ettinger's matrixial theory, a deeply feminist psycho-analytical system, ventures beyond the models of subjectivity based on separation and lack, and thus it helps us rethink togetherness and our own humanity.

Corporeal Aesth/ethics explores how we become subjects not through a series of cuts, but through an encounter with radical openness, modeled upon the intrauterine/pregnancy period. Even though the theorized encounter relies on caring, carrying, and sharing, it is far from pleasant and safe, as we might assume. Indeed, some of the knowledge communicated in this phase of subjectivity-becoming may turn out to be painful, even traumatic. It is this profoundly corporeal encounter, Kisiel contends, that makes it possible to conceive of the body as a site and source of ethics. Envisioned through the lens of the matrixial, a subject (never alone, always in severality) reaches new modes of intimacy and hospitality, occasioned by our universally shared, originary experience of becoming with-in the maternal body.

A psychoanalyst, theoretician, and feminist, Ettinger is also an artist. Sharing Ettinger's conviction that "painting and theory are not different aspects that attest to the same thing, but are rather differentiated levels of working-through," Kisiel maps the entanglements of the (feminine/motherly) body in both dimensions of Ettinger's work. In five chapters, this book delineates the project of Ettinger's corporeal aesth/ethics. It contextualizes the matrixial body, analyzes its humanizing potential, and proposes dialogues of Ettinger's work with feminism, theology, and Holocaust studies.

2.8.9 Sticky Films

Editor: Kerim Dogruel

Editor: Fadekemi Olawoye

Editor: Clara Podlesnigg

Author: Olja Alvir

Author: Marie Sophie Beckmann

Author: Fabienne Bieri

Author: Miriam De Rosa

Author: Silas Edwards

Author: Rodrigo Faustini dos Santos

Author: Fenja Holz

Author: Philipp Dominik Keidl

Author: Franziska Kohler

Author: Andrea Mariani

Author: Jurij Meden

Author: Emma Merkling

Author: Nils Meyn

Author: Amber Jamilla Musser

Author: Jamal Phoenix

Author: Alexandra Schneider

Author: Laura Teixeira

Author: Julia Willms

Author: Sigal Yona

https://doi.org/10.14619/2348

Stickiness is ambiguous. Sometimes it is a problem, sometimes a solution. It holds a strong affective charge between arousal, lust and disgust. If something is sticky, it promises relation while also threatening unwanted clinginess and the collapse of boundaries between self and other. This volume seeks out moments of stickiness in media cultures, thinking "film" beyond moving images as sediment, residue or layer that transforms, repairs, melts, and splices. Sticky Films explores stickiness in three parts: through sticky feelings, sticky modes of being and becoming, and the representations and material traces of stickiness in audiovisual media.

2.9 January 2026

2.9.1 Science in the Salon: Atoms and Animals in Madeleine de Scudéry's 'Conversations' (1680–92): An Essay and Translation

Author: Helena Taylor

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0465

Madeleine de Scudéry (1607–1701) was a celebrated seventeenth-century novelist and essayist, yet her engagement with natural philosophy and the sciences has been largely overlooked. This volume presents the first English translation of 'The Story of Two Chameleons' (1688) and situates it within Scudéry's broader scientific and philosophical writing. Beyond this seminal text, the book explores her reflections on atomism, natural history, and epistemology, revealing her critical engagement with cutting-edge theories of her time, including a challenge to the Cartesian 'animal-machine' hypothesis.

2.9.2 Urban Liquefaction: Rethinking the Relationship between Land and Sea

Editor: Cristián Simonetti

Editor: Michel Lussault

Editor: Tim Ingold

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0532.1.00

From classical times until today, cities have been conceived in the western imagination as ideally confined to the fixities of the land, a space defined in opposition to the fluxes of the

sea. Whereas solid land afforded a durable platform for the establishment of property and citizenship, the fluid sea allowed markets—isolated within the secure boundaries of cities—to be connected across the globe though navigation.

Urban Liquefaction: Rethinking the Relationship between Land and Sea attends to the concurrent tensions between solidity and fluidity, permanence and impermanence, and substance and change that remain at the core of the western intellectual tradition, often dividing what is perceived as social from what is perceived as natural in life. Sea level rise poses unprecedented threats to this oppositional relationship, forcing us to reconsider the tension between solidity and fluidity in the design of the built environment. Nearly ten percent of all major cities are likely to be impacted by sea level rise in the coming decades, compromising the necessary infrastructure on which urban life depends. In reality, urban landscapes have been continually in flux, which becomes dramatically visible to urban dwellers mostly in catastrophic events such as earthquakes, tsunamis, alluvions, sinkholes, and, above all, soil liquefaction.

Urban Liquefaction gathers contributions from scholars and practitioners working across continents and fields interested in urban life in (and after) the Anthropocene, including anthropology, archaeology, art, architecture, design, human geography, and science studies, to open up an inquiry into these categorical tensions and to speculate on alternative futures for the built environment.

2.9.3 The Case of California

Author: Laurence A. Rickels

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0577.1.00

Focusing on the changing image of the West Coast through such varied social and cultural artifacts as bodybuilding, group therapy, suicide cults, Marilyn Monroe, milk-carton images of missing children, orgies, Mickey Mouse, zombies, teenage slang, shock therapy, and surf music, *The Case of California* offers a dizzying psycho-history of the twentieth century as crystallized in the symbolic configuration and "case" of California, which case is articulated in relation to German modernism, National Socialism, and Freudian psychoanalysis. As Laurence Rickels writes, "on the personalizable level or label, California is a death cult; on the social, outward, happy-face level, it distributes pleasure via sadomasochism, the adolescent group, or friendship."

Ultimately, *The Case of California* excavates the places "California" occupies as concept or placeholder within Freudian psychoanalysis and such systems as the Frankfurt School, East Coast psychoanalysis, and deconstruction. To excavate the full range of "California," one must apply pressure to a series of adjacent (and often equally marginal or missing) concepts, including group and adolescent psychology, female sexuality, the haunting of music and of mass

media at large, the charge of child abuse, and a certain convergence of religious and hysterical conversion.

This publication was originally published by University of Minnesota Press in 1991, and is now being released as a new print and open-access edition as part of punctum's Special Collections initiative.

2.9.4 Passivisation in Semitic, Iranian, Armenian, and Beyond

Editor: Paul M. Noorlander

Editor: Hiwa Asadpour

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0516

This volume brings together research on passive voice constructions in low-resource languages of Western Asia, a region marked by extraordinary linguistic diversity as well as a long history of cultural suppression and marginalisation. The contributions showcase the passive voice in Semitic, Iranian, Armenian, Greek, and Turkic languages, many of which are endangered, understudied, or confined to diaspora communities and disappearing language islands. Education and cultural expression in these languages remained heavily restricted across parts of Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran, underscoring the urgent need for documentation and revitalisation.

2.9.5 Defund Culture: A Radical Proposal

Author: Gary Hall

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.67ab11w2

Defund Culture interrogates the structural inequalities embedded in Britain's cultural institutions, arguing that meaningful transformation requires not just expanding access, but redistributing resources away from elite structures toward more pluralistic, decolonial alternatives.

2.9.6 Heroines of Greek and Roman Myth: An Intermediate Latin Reader

Author: Maxwell Teitel Paule

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0496

This volume offers students a fresh approach to reading Latin through the lens of women's stories in classical myth. The stories, carefully adapted from ancient sources, progress in grammatical and stylistic difficulty, beginning with accessible prose and gradually building toward the complexity of authentic classical Latin. Drawing on Dickinson College's Latin Core Vocabulary, the book ensures that learners are practicing the most useful words, while less common terms are glossed in-line to promote fluid reading rather than constant translation.

2.10 December 2025

2.10.1 Reckoning with Everything

Editor: Benedikt Merkle

Editor: Bernhard Siegert

Author: Geoffrey C. Bowker

Author: Ranjodh Singh Dhaliwal

Author: Anna Echterhölter

Author: Eva-Maria Gillich

Author: Moritz Hiller

Author: Jeffrey West Kirkwood

Author: Susanna Lidström

Author: Jussi Parikka

Author: Christoph Rosol

Author: John S. Seberger

Author: Angelika Seppi

Author: Christina Vagt

Author: Adam Wickberg

https://doi.org/10.14619/2676

The transformation of the cultural technique of calculation into a computational environment for the whole planet Earth requires media studies to undergo fundamental changes that go beyond mere reflection on the transformation of global political and economic structures. The becoming environmental of computing confronts us with the fact that the map is the territory: map and territory, media and nature, the Symbolic and the Real, are not distinguished in any categorical way but rather temporarily stabilized results of recursive processes by which they differentiate themselves from each other and call each other into being.However, the cultural technique of calculation has not only become "environmental" since the ubiquity of computation turned cultural techniques into environing techniques. Computation must and has always had to "reckon with everything," with the materialities of the media that define the environmental conditions of computability, as well as with practices of extracting, storing and transferring data. This volume brings together contributions that seek to describe the environmentality of computation based on selected settings.

2.10.2 Computing Cultures: Knowledges and Practices (1940–1990)

Editor: Arianna Borrelli

Editor: Helena Durnová

Author: Troy Kaighin Astarte

Author: Nathalie Bredella

Author: Marie-José Durand-Richard

Author: Edgar Lejeune

Author: Jacqueline Léon

Author: Elisabetta Mori

Author: Mark Priestley

https://doi.org/10.14619/2737

Highlighting the diverse and fragmentary nature of the so-called "digital turn," this volume offers a glimpse into the landscape of different computing cultures which emerged side by side between the 1940s and the 1990s, at times sharing some features, yet remaining essentially independent from each other. Some of these cultures disappeared, some thrive until today, but understanding all through their knowledges and practices, interconnections and broader historical context, is essential to deal critically with the visions and dreams, fears and tensions characterizing digital practices in today's knowledge societies.

2.10.3 Banales Publizieren: Praktiken, Verfahren und Episteme des Selfpublishings

Editor: Elisa Linseisen

Editor: Dorothea Walzer

Author: Julia Bee

Author: Sarah-Mai Dang

Author: Gerko Egert

Author: Annette Gilbert

Author: Erin Rose Glass

Author: Timothy Laquintano

Author: Matthias Preuss

Author: Tom Schmidt

Author: Erika Thomalla

Author: Eva Weinmayr

https://doi.org/10.14619/2300

Praktiken, Verfahren und Episteme des Selfpublishings in Kunst, Literatur und Wissenschaft treten heute konkurrierend neben die institutionalisierte Publikationslandschaft. Dieser Band schlägt vor, die ‚Banalität' als wesentliches Merkmal des digitalen Selbstpublizierens zu begreifen. Ziel ist es, die Erweiterung und Überformung der institutionalisierten Verlagslandschaft durch plattformbasierte Publikationsmodelle zu verstehen und zu fragen, inwiefern diese Entwicklung (die eigenen) wissenschaftlichen Erkenntnismodelle und ihre konstitutiven Ein- und Ausschlussprinzipien aufs Spiel setzt. Es geht dabei um die Vermessung eines Feldes von buchförmigen und nicht-buchförmigen digitalen Selbstpublikationen auf Plattformen und im Print-on-Demand-Bereich, das die Grenzen zwischen professionellen Autor:innen und Lai:innen genauso zur Diskussion stellt wie die Unterscheidung von Literatur, Theorie, Kunst und Wissenschaft und ihrer Vermittlung.

2.10.4 "FOLLOW THE PERSON": Archival Encounters

Author: Ammiel Alcalay

Introduction by: Miriam Nichols

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0395.1.00

Poet, novelist, translator, scholar, and critical essayist extraordinaire, Ammiel Alcalay's intrepid work has always moved across geographic, chronological, political, and linguistic borders. *"FOLLOW THE PERSON": Archival Encounters* gathers a dizzying array of texts by Alcalay written over the past fifteen years, all of them having something to do with archival materials. In Alcalay's case, however, these archives range from more traditional, institutionally-held materials and personal collections to the use of his own experiences and memories as sources for redrawing cultural maps that have too long been divided along sectarian lines of one kind or another.

Moving from the Beats and the Black Arts Movement to the Middle East, *"FOLLOW THE PERSON"* recalibrates our sense of living history while offering new possibilities for encounters that have been relegated to oblivion or never even imagined. Culled from a variety of eclectic sources and contexts, encountering these essays together offers a completely different experience of Alcalay's essays, one that argues for a methodology based on minutely recorded events and historical contexts, and for necessary human and cultural encounters that provide models for a new, reinvigorated critical vocabulary.

As Miriam Nichols writes in her Introduction, "Follow the tenuous threads in this collection of writings and you may end up at the looted National Museum in Baghdad during the American invasion, or in the Hoover Institute at Stanford University where most Iraqi state archives wound up. You may find yourself at Bashcharshiya, the market in Sarajevo during the Bosnian war, or in Palestine, on May 14, 1948. Maybe, if you are keen, you will pick up the thread that leads to 17th-century colonial Massachusetts, or perhaps you will stay in New York, rummaging through garbage cans with Diane di Prima, looking for journals and letters tossed out by a lover." Whichever path you take, you will find multiple worlds, all rendered by Alcalay with light and compassion.

2.10.5 Broken: Illness and Disability in Antônio Francisco Lisboa, Camilo Castelo Branco, Clarice Lispector, Victor Willing, Paula Rego and Ana Palma

Author: Maria Manuel Lisboa

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0500

'Broken: Illness and Disability in Antônio Francisco Lisboa, Camilo Castelo Branco, Clarice Lispector, Victor Willing, Paula Rego and Ana Palma' traces the lives and works of six major artists and writers from Portugal, Brazil, and Britain through the lens of 'being broken'—in body, mind, or both. Spanning from the eighteenth century to the present, the volume explores how sociopolitical and somatic factors such as mental illness, psychological abuse, arthritis, genital mutilation, and multiple sclerosis shaped their creativity, while also reflecting broader national, social, sexual, and political pressures.

2.10.6 Digital Theory

Author: M. Beatrice Fazi

Author: Alexander R. Galloway

Author: Matthew Handelman

Author: Leif Weatherby

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/0849

Digital Theory argues that the digital is theoretical. It proposes a powerful new approach to the often overlooked conceptual side of the digital, starting with a minimal definition of the digital as a form of mediation using discrete units. Pushing the understanding of the digital beyond its interpretation as sheer consumer electronics and instead working with that conceptual definition, the three essays in this volume explore digitality's relation to thinking, signs, and difference, each bringing out distinctive new aspects of the digital's profound theoretical potential.

2.10.7 More with More: Investing in the Energy Transition: 2025 European Public Investment Outlook

Editor: Floriana Cerniglia

Editor: Francesco Saraceno

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0499

This outlook offers a timely and insightful exploration of Europe's energy transition, a process that lies at the heart of today's environmental, economic, and political debates. It examines the diverse commitments undertaken by European countries as they navigate the challenges of decarbonization and the shift to sustainable energy systems. By analyzing both the policy

frameworks and the concrete instruments adopted to reach ambitious climate and energy goals, the book sheds light on the strategies shaping the continent's future.

2.10.8 Solidarity in Contingency: Rorty's Constructive Project

Editor: Elin D. Huckerby

Editor: Marianne Janack

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0487

Richard Rorty (1931–2007), once dubbed 'the man who killed truth', is best known for challenging the idea that philosophy provides foundational knowledge. Yet beyond the controversy lies a vital, underexplored side of Rorty's work: his constructive vision for fostering democratic solidarity in a world shaped by contingency and uncertainty. This volume shifts focus from defending Rorty to applying his insights for today's fractured, post-truth culture.

3 African Minds

This page shows the latest publications (in descending order of publication date) from African Minds.

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Last updated: 2026-11-03 01:00:05

3.0.1 Tributes in Honour of Maria Lis Lange: Scholar, Administrator, Activist, Leader

Editor: Jonathan Jansen

Editor: André Keet

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891453

Through a critical engagement and treatment of the ideas, approaches, commitments and questions that defined Lis Lange's work, this Festschrift brings together colleagues, collaborators, friends and fellow thinkers in a collection that offers a rich portrait of one of South African higher education's most influential and uncompromising scholar-administrators.This book is a valuable resource for those interested in intellectually driven governance and leadership as forms of critical praxis and strategic institution-building.

3.1 July 2026

3.1.1 Rock-time (Vol. 4 in the FicSci Series)

Editor: Mehita Iqani

Editor: Wamuwi Mbao

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891422

What is science communication? This collection, the fourth in the series, continues to argue that it can be creative writing aimed at the heart, rather than information directed to the mind.

3.2 May 2026

3.2.1 Neoliberalism, Democratic Erosion and the Global Struggle for Social Justice

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Chris Tapscott

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891330

The global expansion of neoliberal capitalism and its contentious relationship with democracy remains one of the most pressing debates of our time. This book offers a comprehensive examination of how capitalism has adapted from merchant and industrial forms into the modern era of financialization which underpins the current globalising order. By tracing the evolution of the state, it explores the deliberate political decisions that have prioritised market efficiency over social welfare.The central thesis of this book is that neoliberalism is not an inevitable evolutionary endpoint of human development, but rather a crafted ideology designed to "tame" democracy through technocratic and judicial constraints. The authors argue that a fundamental tension exists between the market's "free play of forces" and the democratic principle of social entitlement. As the state shifts from an economic regulator to a market broker, democratic oversight is increasingly displaced by insulated, expert-driven authorities. This restructuring has not only fuelled global inequality but has also turned technology into a tool for digital coloniality, where transnational firms extract value through surveillance and algorithmic optimisation. "Techno-feudalism" epitomises how the contemporary trajectory of datafication serves corporate interests over democratic publics.Unlike literature that merely critiques, this book identifies emerging "geo-economic fragmentation" and the revival of socialdemocratic ideas as openings for democratic renewal. Ultimately, the book argues that the current hegemony is neither inevitable nor irreversible. By analysing the rise of right-wing populism and the growing disillusionment with the neoliberal narrative, the contributors highlight the urgent need to reassert democratic control over economic systems to address the existential threats of environmental collapse and social polarisation.

3.3 April 2026

3.3.1 Social Constructions of Gender-Based Violence in African Countries

Editor: Tinuade Adekunbi Ojo

Editor: Tanusha Raniga

Editor: Samson Sambian Konlan

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780639891309

Based on rich, contextual analysis from South Africa, Zimbabwe, Kenya and Ethiopia, *Social Constructions of Gender-Based Violence in African Countries* offers an exploration of gender-based violence that moves beyond definition to examine the profound psychological social and economic impacts of GBV, framing it as a critical barrier to human rights and prosperous societies. The analysis is set against the backdrop of international frameworks such as the UN Sustainable Development Goals and Africa Agenda 2063, while critically assessing national policies and legislative milestones within the four focus countries.

A central theme is the critique of governmental failures and the essential role of non-state actors. The book highlights how civil society organisations, aid institutions and research bodies fill critical gaps in service delivery, particularly for the most vulnerable, and provide novel assessments and interventions. It gives specific attention to the exacerbated challenges of the COVID-19 pandemic, which revealed severe deficiencies in protection systems and pushed women into greater danger during lockdowns.

Ultimately, *Social Constructions of Gender-Based Violence in African Countries* is a call for proactive, transformative action. It argues for improved gender justice through increased female representation in leadership, financial empowerment for women and robust, evidence-based policies. It is an indispensable resource for policymakers, human service professionals and scholars across Africa and beyond, providing the insights needed to re-evaluate existing strategies and formulate effective, empowering responses to end gender-based violence.

3.4 October 2025

3.4.1 Dismantling Gender Barriers in STEM: Perspectives from the Global South

Editor: Hannah Whitehead

Editor: Matilda Dipieri

Cape Town: African Minds, 2025

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781067253776

Education and science are foundational to international development, yet gender inequities in Science, Technology, Engineering, and Mathematics (STEM) persist globally. While these disparities are widespread, most research and discourse on gender in STEM originates from the Global North. This edited collection amplifies contributions from the Global South, presenting twelve case studies supported by Canada's International Development Research Centre (IDRC). The case studies are led by researchers across Africa and Latin America who investigate gender inequities in STEM within their local or regional contexts.

Organised around four interwoven themes, (1) building gender-responsive and equitable STEM institutions, (2) leveraging data to address gender disparities, (3) fostering leadership and mentorship for women in STEM, and (4) ensuring support across academic and career pathways,

the book offers a comprehensive view of the challenges and innovations shaping gender equity in STEM. Taken together, these chapters provide critical insights and recommendations to promote gender equity in STEM across the Global South and beyond.

3.5 August 2025

3.5.1 Sea-ice: Vol. 3 in the FicSci Series

Cape Town: African Minds, 2025

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781067253653

What is science communication? This collection proposes that it can be creative writing aimed at the heart, rather than information directed to the mind.

FicSci playfully subverts the term 'science fiction' to offer an experimental process that explores the limits of imagination in relation to scientific possibility (and vice versa). FicSci is an experiment in hybridised creative practice that induces new forms of knowledge-making between the hard sciences and the social world. This collection offers writing that emerged from an encounter bringing together creative writers with a sea ice scientist based in a chemical and materials engineering department.

The presented research invited contemplation of scientific aspects of the properties, formation and behaviour of sea ice, especially in the Southern Ocean. The creative writings that emerged offer new directions for thinking about the relation between creative expression and Antarctic science.

3.6 June 2025

3.6.1 Linking Education and the Local Economy: Intermediaries in a Furniture Ecosystem

Author: André Kraak

Cape Town: African Minds, 2025

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781067253714

Linking Education and the Local Economy examines the collapse of linkages between South Africa's post-school education and training system and the declining furniture industry. Using a case study approach, it explores reasons behind the erosion of the sector's competitiveness. The book shows how intermediaries – organisations or individuals bridging gaps between fi rms,

education providers and government – could revitalise the industry by fostering collaboration, knowledge exchange and innovation.

3.7 February 2025

3.7.1 Doctoral Education in Context: Perspectives from Africa

Editor: Jan Botha

Editor: Liezel Frick

Editor: Nompilo Tshuma

Cape Town: African Minds, 2025

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781067253530

Doctoral Education in Context: Perspectives from Africa shares lived experiences and insights of doctoral supervisors from 16 different countries in Africa. The book's originality lies also in the contributors' profiles as practicing, novice doctoral supervisors. All of them graduated from the Training Course for Supervisors offered by the Centre for Research on Evaluation, Science and Technology (CREST) at Stellenbosch University in South Africa, with the support of the German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD)/German Rectors' Conference (HRK) through the DIES Programme.

3.8 December 2024

3.8.1 Education Research in African Contexts: Traditions and New Beginnings for Knowledge and Impact

Editor: Paul Webb

Editor: Mathabo Khau

Editor: Proscovia Namubiru Ssentamu

Cape Town: African Minds, 2024

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781067253509

This compelling anthology illuminates the transformative role of education research in Africa, presenting a bricolage of studies by scholarship holders of the East and South African-German Centre of Excellence for Educational Research Methodologies and Management (CERM-ESA). Bridging insights from these two regions, the book examines the vital intersections between

education, society and culture, with a focus on fostering sustainable educational reform and empowering local communities.

At the heart of the book is a shared commitment to evolving higher education in Africa through collaborative, context-sensitive research. Anchored by the partnership of five universities across two continents, CERM-ESA's initiatives support capacity-building and innovation in African educational contexts, working directly with schools, communities and policymakers to address the unique challenges of the continent. With themes ranging from indigenous methodologies and climate change education to gender equity and academic resilience, the chapters showcase diverse and locally relevant approaches that inform and inspire change across educational sectors.

Targeted toward education researchers, policymakers and practitioners invested in African development, Education Research in African Contexts offers an in-depth exploration of educational methodologies that honour traditions while embracing progressive change. The book provides invaluable insights for educators and leaders seeking to support responsive, impactful education systems.

Through critical reflection and innovative research, the volume reimagines educational paradigms that respect African realities, encouraging readers to explore new possibilities for inclusive and transformative research.

3.9 October 2024

3.9.1 From Memory to Marble Vol 1: The Historical Frieze of the Voortrekker Monument, Part I: The Frieze

Author: Elizabeth Rankin

Author: Rolf Michael Schneider

Cape Town: African Minds, 2024

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502852

For the first time the 92-metre frieze of the Voortrekker Monument in Pretoria, one of the largest historical narratives in marble, has been made the subject of a book.

The pictorial narrative of the Boer pioneers who conquered South Africa's interior during the 'Great Trek' (1835-52) represents a crucial period of South Africa's past. Forming the concept of the frieze both reflected on and contributed to the country's socio-political debates in the 1930s and 1940s when it was made. The frieze is unique in that it provides rare evidence of the complex processes followed in creating a major monument.

Based on unpublished documents, drawings and models, these processes are unfolded step by step, from the earliest discussions of the purpose and content of the frieze through all the stages

of its design to its shipping to post-war Italy to be copied into marble and final installation in the Monument. The book examines how visual representation transforms historical memory in what it chooses to recount, and the forms in which it depicts this. It also investigates the active role the Monument played in the development of apartheid, and its place in post-apartheid heritage.

3.10 September 2024

3.10.1 State Power in Land Reform: Barriers to implementation in the Western and Northern Cape, South Africa, 1990–2006

Author: Thorvald Gran

Cape Town: African Minds, 2024

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502869

ANC land reform started on a good footing with the RDP, but has since moved to a policy of supporting entrepreneurial emerging middle-class black farmers rather than the immiserated rural subsistence farmers. This has shifted government funding and support towards the urban areas leaving rural areas destitute.

In State Power in Land Reform, the author relies on a robust theoretical frame, extensive policy analysis and empirical data to advocate for a new engagement with local communities through rejuvenated municipalities, that is, through strong local institutions.

State Power in Land Reform provides a valuable analytical account for both the historian and the archive.

3.10.2 Revisiting Africa's Flagship Universities: Local, National and International Dynamics

Author: James Ransom

Cape Town: African Minds, 2024

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502951

Revisiting Africa's Flagship Universities: National, International, and Local Dynamics offers a compelling exploration of Africa's large, public higher education institutions. The book delves into the evolving roles of these universities, examining how they navigate their responsibilities at national, international and local levels.

The book uncovers the tensions between global aspirations, national relevance and local realities. In doing so, this insightful work sheds light on the unique challenges and opportunities

faced by African flagship universities, revealing their potential as forces for local, national and international collaboration and development.

Revisiting Africa's Flagship Universities provides rigorous evidence on the relevance of higher education at the local and national level, and the interrelation between these and the

burgeoning international roles of universities. This book makes for important reading for university staff, policymakers, and anyone interested in the future of higher education in Africa.

3.11 August 2024

3.11.1 Night-sky: Vol. 2

Editor: Mehita Iqani

Editor: Wamuwi Mbao

Cape Town: African Minds, 2024

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502920

What is science communication? This collection proposes that it can be creative writing aimed at the heart, rather than information directed to the mind.

FicSci playfully subverts the term 'science fiction' to offer an experimental process that explores the limits of imagination in relation to scientific possibility (and vice versa). FicSci is an experiment in hybridized creative practice that induces new forms of knowledge-making between the hard sciences and the social world. This collection offers writing that emerged from an encounter that brought twelve creative writers together with an astronomer.

The presented science invited contemplation of scientific aspects of the night sky, in specific X-ray binary stars, extra-galactic sources, and magellanic clouds. The creative writings that emerged are attendant to the wider potentialities of scientific thought, and reveal how methodologies for storying the scientific encounter are creatively multi-form.

3.11.2 Rocklands: On Becoming the First Generation of Black Psychologists in Post-Apartheid South Africa

Author: Liezille Jean Jacobs

Cape Town: African Minds, 2024

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502890

This book makes a brave and erudite scholarly contribution to the field of psychology. Its method is unconventional but carefully considered. Those who have provided comments on the manuscript unanimously concur – this book is essential reading for students and academics, families and patriarchs in equal measure.

3.12 October 2023

3.12.1 African Science Granting Councils: Towards Sustainable Development in Africa

Author: Teboho Moja

Author: Samuel Kehinde Okunade

South Africa: African Minds, 2023

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502791

This book delves into the research-policy nexus as it relates to development in Africa. It does so by examining four country-cases – Botswana, Cote d'Ivoire, Kenya and Zambia – while referring to South Africa as a possible exemplar case.

3.13 September 2023

3.13.1 Collaboration in Development: A South African Heritage

Author: Godwin Khosa

South Africa: African Minds, 2023

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502821

South Africa is under-capitalising on its rich ways of doing business. One such way, the focus of this book, is collaboration.

The collaboration approach should be promoted to the same extent that the Japanese have entrenched and exported their 'small incremental improvement' Kaizen approach. There are many such underexplored indigenous ways of doing business in Africa. Where improvement is required in relation to development and organisational performance, the need is not so much building new capacities as discovering and implementing more strategic and effective utilisation of existing indigenous ones. And there is no need to cringe when African culture is used to inform science.

This book uses history, interviews and documentary evidence from South Africa to weave together a story, arguments and lessons about collaboration.

3.14 July 2023

3.14.1 Flow: FicSci 01

Editor: Mehita Iqani

Editor: Wamuwi Mbao

South Africa: African Minds, 2023

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502739

The practice and theory of science communication can take many forms. One of them, which this volume represents, explores what forms of knowledge might be constructed when creative writing encounters science.

Working outwards from a theoretical framework that sees the sciences as discourses constructed by human endeavour through forms of language and practices of authority, this collection offers writing that emerged from a scientific encounter. It explores the relationship between creativity and scientific experiment, between the languages deployed by scientists in their experiments and analyses and the languages forged by creatives in their ongoing efforts to understand the human condition.

FicSci 01 brought eleven creative writers together with a biomechanical engineer. The presented science invited creative enquiry into different aspects of flow, that physical property that is so central to research in fluid mechanics. This anthology collects the results of that encounter.

3.15 April 2023

3.15.1 Transformative Innovation in Times of Change: Lessons for Africa from COVID-19

Author: Erika Kraemer-Mbula

Author: Rebecca Hanlin

Author: Rob Byrne

Author: Chux Daniels

Author: Ann Kingiri

South Africa: African Minds, 2023

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502760

This book was produced in an environment of uncertainty and constantly changing narratives about COVID-19 and its effects. From a narrative of survival in 2020 to contain the spread of the virus with a central role of government leadership, evidence-informed decisions, solidarity and a scientific race to develop a vaccine taking the central stage; to a later narrative in 2021 focused on socio-economic recovery, building back better, managing vaccine inequalities and visions and proposals for post-COVID societies.

In 2022, we have seen a move to a narrative of post-pandemic (rather than post-COVID-19) and "learning to live with the virus" with societies in the global South learning to navigate the harsh economic realities by looking at opportunities emerging in the digital and regional spaces. The production of this book embeds some of these dominant narratives in different chapters, as they were developed over such unstable ground.

This experience has put a spotlight on the importance of innovative solutions, and the role of public sector, raising a new interest in governance systems and structures, and ways to strengthen governance overall. The pandemic has propelled countries across the world to innovate and develop more resilient systems and strategies that will enable us to gain the capacity to tackle complex challenges we face today and those that will come.

We hope this book helps us extract some valuable lessons from the COVID-19 pandemic. After all, learning from a crisis may well be our best way to prepare for the future.

3.16 January 2023

3.16.1 Digital Technology in Capacity Development: Enabling Learning and Supporting Change

Editor: Joanna Wild

Editor: Femi Nzegwu

Foreword by: Laura Czerniewicz

South Africa: African Minds, 2023

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502708

This book focuses on digital approaches to capacity development, reflecting the greater interest in how digital tools and platforms can be used for capacity development in the 'Global South'. While Covid-19 demonstrated some of the benefits of online learning, the widespread, often uncritical adoption of online tools driven by necessity has left many with an experience of 'emergency online learning'. This book aims to assist in the design of technology-enhanced

capacity development by sharing evidence of practices that are principled rather than rushed; inclusive rather than creating new digital divides.

3.16.2 Who Counts? Ghanaian Academic Publishing and Global Science

Author: David Mills

Author: Patricia Kingori

Author: Abigail Branford

Author: Samuel T. Chatio

Author: Natasha Robinson

Author: Paulina Tindana

South Africa: African Minds, 2023

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502647

Since the 1990s, global academic publishing has been transformed by digitisation, consolidation and the rise of the internet. The data produced by commercially owned citation indexes increasingly defines legitimate academic knowledge. Publication in prestigious 'high impact' journals can be traded for academic promotion, tenure and job-security. African researchers and publishers labour in the shadows of a global knowledge system dominated by 'Northern' journals and by global publishing conglomerates. This book goes beyond the numbers. It tells the story of how the Ghanaian academy is being transformed by this bibliometric economy. It offers a rich account of the voices and perspectives of Ghanaian academics and African journal publishers. How, where and when are Ghana's researchers disseminating their work, and what do these experiences reveal about an unequal global science system? Is there pressure to publish in 'reputable' international journals, what role do supervisors, collaborators and mentors play, and how do academics manage in conditions of scarcity? Putting the insights of more than 40 Ghanaian academics into dialogue with journal editors and publishers from across the continent, the book highlights creative responses, along with the emergence of new regional research ecosystems. This is an important Africa-centred analysis of Anglophone academic publishing on the continent and its relationship to global science.

3.17 December 2022

3.17.1 Reframing Africa? Reflections on Modernity and the Moving Image

Editor: Cynthia Kros

Editor: Reece Auguiste

Editor: Pervaiz Khan

South Africa: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502678

This book takes readers on a series of stimulating intellectual journeys from the late nineteenth century to the contemporary era to explore notions of modernity in the production and reception of the African moving image and of African archival practices. Ideas are presented from multiple historical and contemporary perspectives, while inviting new voices to participate in discussions about the future of the African moving image.

Reframing Africa?makes a plea for the recognition, preservation and repatriation of the African moving image archive, advancing ideas about how it speaks to contemporary Africans, possessed of the power to elucidate their lived experiences and to reorientate perceptions of the past, present and future. On the basis of this wide-ranging appreciation of the archive, the book charts a way forward for African-inflected film studies as well as other programmes in the humanities and social sciences.

Reframing Africa? will appeal to scholars, academics and practitioners across the continent and beyond.

3.18 November 2022

3.18.1 On Becoming a Scholar: What Every New Academic Needs to Know

Editor: Jonathan D Jansen

Editor: Daniel Visser

Cape Town: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502616

On Becoming a Scholar: What Every New Academic Needs to Know

Edited by Jonathan Jansen and Daniel Visser

The origins of On Becoming a Scholar lie in the realisation that there is a need for a vademecum, a handy compendium of ideas, plans and strategies for building a productive and fulfilling academic career to guide the host of prospective academics.

On Becoming a Scholar is geared to help relatively new scholars to construct personal futures and to find their way through the 21st century university. It is intended to be a map, and like any map it does not contain all the contours and details of the landscape, but rather seeks to reveal the important pathways and milestones in the journey to becoming an established academic.

Drawing on highly experienced academics and accomplished professors in their different fields, as well as promising younger academics already on their way, this book cover a concentrated resource of practical wisdom. The topics are broad and, cumulatively, they seek to answer the many questions that experienced mentors encounter every day in their work with new academics.

3.19 October 2022

3.19.1 (u)Mzantsi Classics: Dialogues in Decolonisation from Southern Africa

Editor: Samantha Masters

Editor: Imkhita Nzungu

Editor: Grant Parker

South Africa: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502302

Though Graeco-Roman antiquity ('classics') has often been considered the handmaid of colonialism, its various forms have nonetheless endured through many of the continent's decolonising transitions. Southern Africa is no exception. This book canvasses the variety of forms classics has taken in Zimbabwe, Mozambique and especially South Africa, and even the dynamics of transformation itself.

3.20 May 2022

3.20.1 Positioning Diversity in Kenyan Schools: Teaching in the Face of Inequality and Discrimination

Author: Malve von Möllendorff

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502333

Education is considered key for societies to achieve greater social cohesion and equality. Yet, schools, as the main providers of formal education, have increasingly come into question concerning their role in manifesting and perpetuating social categorisations, inequalities and discrimination instead of decreasing existing fragmentations and challenging power relations and hierarchies.

As a diverse society, Kenya is faced with power struggles and rivalries between different groups – for instance, along ethnic lines, often constructed deep in colonial history. This affects teaching and learning in school and the result is that Kenya is faced with vast disparities in terms of educational access and success – rendering some social groups marginalised and others favoured.

Positioning Diversity at Kenyan Schools explores the ways in which teachers in Kenyan primary and secondary schools experience and deal with social categorisations and diversity in terms of ethnicity, gender, wealth, culture, religion, etc. in their professional practice and in the current education system. Using critical pedagogy and diversity theory as a lens for positioning diversity in Kenyan schools, the questions that this book sets out to answer are: In what ways do the teachers' and schools' practices lead to transformation in terms of more social equality and less discrimination? In what ways do the practices manifest existing group categorisations, hierarchies and discrimination? How can schools and teaching practices in postcolonial Kenya become more inclusive and foster social cohesion and equality?

3.20.2 Out of Place: An Autoethnography of Postcolonial Citizenship

Author: Nuraan Davids

Foreword by: Jonathan D Jansen

Cape Town: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502364

Out of Place offers an in-depth exploration of Nuraan Davids' experience as a Muslim 'coloured' woman, traversing a post-apartheid space. It centres on and explores a number of themes, which include her challenges not only as a South African citizen, and within her faith community, but as an academic citizen at a historically white university. The book is her story, an autoethnography, her reparation.

By embarking on an auto-ethnography, she not only tries to change the way her story has been told by others, transforms her 'sense of what it means to live' (Bhabha, 1994). She is driven by a postcolonial appeal, which insists that if she seeks to imprint her own way of life into the discourses which pervade the world around her, then she can no longer allow herself to be spoken on behalf of or to be subjugated into the hegemonies of others.

The main argument of Out of Place is that Muslim, 'coloured' women are subjected to layers of scrutiny and prejudices, which have yet to be confronted. What we know about Muslim 'coloured' women has been shaped by preconceived notions of 'otherness', and attached to a meta-narrative of 'oppression and backwardness'. By centring and using her lived experiences, the author takes readers on a journey of what it is like to be seen in terms of race, gender and religion – not only within the public sphere of her professional identities, but within the private sphere of her faith community.

3.20.3 Low-Income Students, Human Development and Higher Education in South Africa: Opportunities, Obstacles and Outcomes

Author: Melanie Walker

Author: Monica McLean

Author: Mikateko Mathebula

Author: Patience Mukwambo

Cape Town: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502395

This book explores learning outcomes for low-income rural and township youth at five South African universities. The book is framed as a contribution to southern and Africa-centred scholarship, adapting Amartya Sen's capability approach and a framework of key concepts: capabilities, functionings, context, conversion factors, poverty and agency to investigate opportunities and obstacles to achieved student outcomes. This approach allows a reimagining of 'inclusive learning outcomes' to encompass the multi-dimensional value of a university education and a plurality of valued cognitive and non-cognitive outcomes for students from low-income backgrounds whose experiences are strongly shaped by hardship.

Based on capability theorising and student voices, the book proposes for policy and practice a set of contextual higher education capability domains and corresponding functionings orientated to more justice and more equality for each person to have the opportunities to be and to do what they have reason to value. The book concludes that sufficient material resources are necessary to get into university and flourish while there; the benefits of a university education should be rich and multi-dimensional so that they can result in functionings in all areas of life as well as work and future study; the inequalities and exclusion of the labour market and pathways to further study must be addressed by wider economic and social policies for 'inclusive learning outcomes' to be meaningful; and that universities ought to be doing more to enable black working-class students to participate and succeed.

Low-Income Students, Human Development and Higher Education in South Africa makes an original contribution to capabilitarian scholarship: conceptually in theorising a South-based multi-dimensional student well-being higher education matrix and a rich reconceptualisation of learning outcomes, as well as empirically by conducting rigorous, longitudinal in-depth mixed-methods research on students' lives and experiences in higher education in South Africa. The audience for the book includes higher education researchers, international capabilitarian scholars, practitioners and policy-makers.

3.21 March 2022

3.21.1 Open Learning as a Means of Advancing Social Justice: Cases in Post-School Education and Training in South Africa

Editor: Tabisa Mayisela

Editor: Shanali C. Govender

Editor: Cheryl Ann Hodgkinson-Williams

South Africa: African Minds, 2022

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502425

This volume investigates the uptake of 'open learning' in South African Technical Vocational Education and Training (TVET) colleges and higher education institutions. Comprised of 16 studies focused on activities at a range of colleges and universities across the country, these chapters aim to promote a better understanding of open learning practices across the Post-School Education and Training (PSET) sector, including issues such as: recognition of prior learning, access for students with disabilities, work integrated learning, professional development, novel student funding mechanisms, leadership for open educational practices, institutional culture, student support, blended and online learning, flexible learning, online assessment, open educational resource development models and funding, and micro-credentials.

This collection of peer-reviewed chapters contributes to understanding the ways in which South African PSET institutions and educators are interpreting 'open learning' as a means of advancing social justice. It includes a historical and contemporary understanding of the economic, cultural and political obstacles facing PSET, drawing on Nancy Fraser's theory of social justice as 'participatory parity' to better understand the ways in which 'open learning' may address systemic social injustices in order to allow South African students and educators to thrive.

This volume emerges from research conducted by the Cases on Open Learning (COOL) project, an initiative by the Department of Higher Education and Training in partnership with the Centre for Innovation in Learning and Teaching (CILT) at the University of Cape Town (UCT) in South Africa.

3.22 December 2021

3.22.1 Teaching and Learning for Change: Education and Sustainability in South Africa

Editor: Ingrid Schudel

Editor: Zintle Songqwaru

Editor: Sirkka Tshiningayamwe

Editor: Heila Lotz-Sisitka

Cape Town: African Minds, 2021

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502241

Like many national curricula around the world, South Africa's curriculum is rich in environment and sustainability content. Despite this, environmental teaching and learning can be challenging for educators. This comes at a time when Sustainable Development Goal 4 via Target 4.7 requires governments to integrate Education for Sustainable Development into national education systems.

Teaching and Learning for Change is an exploration of how teachers and teacher educators engage environment and sustainability content knowledge, methods, and assessment practices – an exposition of quality education processes in support of ecological and social justice and sustainability.

The chapters evolve from a ten-year research programme led out of the DSI/NRF SARChI Chair in Global Change and Social Learning Systems working with national partners in the Fundisa for Change programme and the UNESCO Sustainability Starts with Teachers programme. They show the integration of education for sustainable development in teacher professional development and curricula in schools in South Africa. They reveal how university-based researchers, teachers and teacher educators have made theoretically and contextually reasoned choices about their lives and their teaching in response to calls for a more sustainable world in which education must play a role.

Teaching and Learning for Change will be of interest to education policymakers in government, advisors and educators in educational and environmental departments, NGOs and other institutions. It will also be of interest to teacher educators, teachers and researchers in education more generally, and environment and sustainability education specifically.

3.23 August 2021

3.23.1 Democracy and the Discourse on Relevance Within the Academic Profession at Makerere University

Author: Andrea Kronstad Felde

Author: Tor Halvorsen

Author: Anja Myrtveit

Cape Town: African Minds, 2021

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502272

Democracy and the Discourse of Relevance is set against the backdrop of the spread of neoliberal ideas and reforms since the 1980s, accepting also that these ideas are rooted in a longer history. It focuses on how neoliberalism has worked to transform the university sector and the academic profession. In particular, it examines how understandings of, and control over, what constitutes relevant knowledge have changed.

Taken as a whole, these changes have sought to reorient universities and academics towards economic development in various ways. This includes the installation of strategies for how institutions and academics achieve recognition and status within the academy, the privatisation of educational services and the downgrading of the value of public higher education, as well as a steady shift away from the public funding for universities. Research universities are increasingly adopting a user- and market-oriented model, with an emphasis on meeting corporate demands, the privileging of short-term research, and a strong tendency to view utility, and the potential to sell intellectual property for profit, as primary criteria for determining the relevance of academic knowledge.

3.24 June 2021

3.24.1 Transformer l'excellence en recherche: Nouvelles idées des pays du Sud Global

Editor: Erika Kraemer-Mbula

Editor: Robert Tijssen

Editor: Matthew Wallace

Editor: Robert McLean

Cape Town: African Minds, 2021

https://doi.org/10.47622/9782954099477

La science contemporaine est soumise à de fortes pressions. Un mélange puissant d'attentes croissantes, de ressources limitées, de tensions entre la concurrence et la coopération, et le besoin d'un financement fondé sur des données probantes, créent un changement majeur dans la façon dont la science est menée et perçue. Au milieu de cette « tempête parfaite » se trouve l'attrait de « l'excellence de la recherche », un concept qui guide les décisions prises par les universités et les bailleurs de fonds, et définit les stratégies de recherche et les trajectoires de carrière des chercheurs.

Mais qu'est-ce qu'une science « excellente » ? Et comment la reconnaître ? Après des décennies d'enquêtes et de débats, il n'y a toujours pas de réponse satisfaisante. Posons-nous la mauvaise question ? La réalité est-elle plus complexe et « l'excellence scientifique » plus insaisissable que beaucoup ne veulent l'admettre ? Et comment l'excellence devrait-elle être définie dans

différentes régions du monde, surtout dans les pays à faible revenu du « Sud Global » où l'on attend de la science qu'elle contribue à résoudre les problèmes de développement urgents, malgré des ressources souvent limitées ? Beaucoup se demandent si le Sud Global importe, avec ou sans consentement, les outils imparfaits d'évaluation de la recherche provenant d'Amérique du Nord et d'Europe, qui ne sont pas adaptés.

Ce livre adopte une vision critique, abordant des questions conceptuelles et des problèmes pratiques qui surgissent inévitablement lorsque « l'excellence » est au centre des systèmes scientifiques. Issu du travail de renforcement des capacités du Science Granting Councils Initiative en Afrique subsaharienne, il s'adresse aux chercheurs, ainsi qu'aux gestionnaires et aux bailleurs de fonds de la recherche du monde entier. Confrontés à des problèmes épineux et à des vérités inconfortables, les chapitres contiennent des idées et des recommandations qui pointent vers de nouvelles solutions – à la fois pour le Sud Global et le Nord Global.

3.25 May 2021

3.25.1 The Politics of Housing in (Post-)Colonial Africa: Accommodating Workers & Urban Residents

Editor: Kirsten Rüther

Editor: Martina Barker-Ciganikova

Editor: Daniela Waldburger

Editor: Carl-Philipp Bodenstein

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2021

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110601183

Housing matters, no matter when or where. This volume of collected essays on housing in colonial and postcolonial Africa seeks to elaborate how and why housing is much more than an everyday practice. The politics of housing unfold in disparate dimensions of time, space and agency. Depending on context, they acquire diverse, often ambivalent, meanings. Housing can be a promise, an unfulfilled dream, a tool of self- and class-assertion, a negotiation process, or a means to achieve other ends. This volume analyzes housing in its multifacetedness, be it a lens to offer insights into complex processes that shape societies; be it a tool of empire to exercise control over private relations of inhabitants; or be it a means to create good, obedient and productive citizens. Contributions to this volume range from the field of history, to architecture and urban planning, African studies, linguistics, and literature. The individual case studies home in on specific aspects and dimensions of housing and seek to bring them into dialogue with each other. By doing so, the volume aims to add to the debate on studying urban practices and their significance for current social change.

3.26 January 2021

3.26.1 Refractions of the National, the Popular and the Global in African Cities

Editor: Simon Bekker

Editor: Sylvia Croese

Editor: Edgar Pieterse

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2021

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502159

Case studies of metropolitan cities in nine African countries from Egypt in the north to three in West and Central Africa, two in East Africa and three in Southern Africa make up the empirical foundation of this publication. The interrelated themes addressed in these chapters the national influence on urban development, the popular dynamics that shape urban development and the global currents on urban development make up its framework. All authors and editors are African, as is the publisher. The only exception is Göran Therborn whose recent book, Cities of Power, served as motivation for this volume. Accordingly, the issue common to all case studies is the often conflictual powers that are exercised by national, global and popular forces in the development of these African cities. Rather than locating the case studies in an exclusively African historical context, the focus is on the trajectories of the postcolonial city (with the important exception of Addis Ababa with a non-colonial history that has granted it a special place in African consciousness). These trajectories enable comparisons with those of postcolonial cities on other continents. This, in turn, highlights the fact that Africa today, the least urbanised continent on an increasingly urbanised globe is in the thick of processes of large-scale urban transformation, illustrated in diverse ways by the case studies that make up the foundation of this publication.

3.27 September 2020

3.27.1 Situating Open Data: Global Trends in Local Contexts

Editor: Danny Lämmerhirt

Editor: Ana Brandusescu

Editor: Natali a Domagala

Editor: Patrick Enaholo

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2020

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502128

Open data and its effects on society are always woven into infrastructural legacies, social relations, and the political economy. This raises questions about how our understanding and engagement with open data shifts when we focus on its situated use.

To shed a light on these questions, Situating Open Data provides several empirical accounts of open data practices, the local implementation of global initiatives, and the development of new open data ecosystems. Drawing on case studies in different countries and contexts, the chapters demonstrate the practices and actors involved in open government data initiatives unfolding within different socio-political settings.

The book proposes three recommendations for researchers, policy-makers and practitioners. First, beyond upskilling through data literacy programmes, open data initiatives should be specified through the kinds of data practices and effects they generate. Second, global visions of open data implementation require more studies of the resonances and tensions created in localised initiatives. And third, research into open data ecosystems requires more attention to the histories and legacies of information infrastructures and how these shape who benefits from open data flows.

As such, this volume departs from the framing of data as a resource to be deployed. Instead, it proposes a prism of different data practices in different contexts through which to study the social relations, capacities, infrastructural histories and power structures affecting open data initiatives. It is hoped that the contributions collected in Situating Open Data will spark critical reflection about the way open data is locally practiced and implemented. The contributions should be of interest to open data researchers, advocates, and those in or advising government administrations designing and rolling out effective open data initiatives.

3.27.2 From Memory to Marble Vol 2: The Historical Frieze of the Voortrekker Monument, Part II: The Scenes

Author: Elizabeth Rankin

Author: Rolf Michael Schneider

Cape Town: African Minds, 2020

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110668797

The Voortrekker Monumentality digital archive hosted by Stanford University Libraries is based on the eight-hundred-and-four illustrations from the two-volume book From Memory to Marble: The historical frieze of the Voortrekker Monument. It includes not only images of the monument and the frieze but also many related documents and artworks. The corpus aims to promote studies of controversial monuments, with a focus on visual interpretation.

For the first time the 92-metre frieze of the Voortrekker Monument in Pretoria, one of the largest historical narratives in marble, has been made the subject of a book.

The pictorial narrative of the Boer pioneers who conquered South Africa's interior during the 'Great Trek' (1835-52) represents a crucial period of South Africa's past. Forming the concept of the frieze both reflected on and contributed to the country's socio-political debates in the 1930s and 1940s when it was made. The frieze is unique in that it provides rare evidence of the complex processes followed in creating a major monument.

Based on unpublished documents, drawings and models, these processes are unfolded step by step, from the earliest discussions of the purpose and content of the frieze through all the stages of its design to its shipping to post-war Italy to be copied into marble and final installation in the Monument. The book examines how visual representation transforms historical memory in what it chooses to recount, and the forms in which it depicts this. It also investigates the active role the Monument played in the development of apartheid, and its place in post-apartheid heritage.

This second volume expands on the first, considering each of the 27 scenes in depth, providing new insights into not only the frieze, but also South Africa's history.

3.28 June 2020

3.28.1 The Artistry of Bheki Mseleku

Author: Andrew Lilley

Cape Town: African Minds, 2020

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331667

Bheki Mseleku is widely regarded as one of the most gifted, technically accomplished and emotionally expressive jazz musicians to have emerged from South Africa. His individualistic and eclectic sound draws on American, classical and township influences. He had no apparent formal music training and grew up in a poor village on the outskirts of Durban where, at the fairly late age of seventeen, he discovered that he had an innate ability to play. He has become a key inspiration for aspiring young South African jazz musicians and has left an infinite source of knowledge to draw on.

The Artistry of Bheki Mseleku is an in-depth study of the Mseleku's compositional works and improvisational style. The annotated transcriptions and analysis bring into focus the exquisite skill and artistry that ultimately caught the eye of some of the most celebrated international jazz musicians in the world.

"Despite being entirely self-taught, Mseleku was the most technically sophisticated of jazz musicians, though the abiding experience of hearing him play was one of an unjazzlike simplicity."

– John Fordham, The Guardian

3.29 March 2020

3.29.1 Reflections of South African Student Leaders: 1994 to 2017

Editor: Thierry Luescher

Editor: Denyse Webbstock

Editor: Ntokozo Bhengu

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2020

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502104

Reflections of South African Student Leaders 1994-2017 brings together the reflections of twelve former SRC leaders from across the landscape of South African universities. Reviews of the previous volume, 1981-2014 suggested that it contributed significantly to a better understanding of the stringent demands of visionary and transformative leadership required by university leaders in the fastchanging and increasingly complex public higher education sector.

This volume is based on comprehensive interviews with former student leaders, each of whom provided a personal account in their own words of their experience in the position of student leadership. The interviewees are from different backgrounds and of diverse political persuasions. The book is important for current and future leaders of higher education institutions as it provides insights into the thinking, aspirations, desires, fears and modus operandi of student leaders. Such insight can contribute to developing and implementing appropriate strategies for achieving meaningful and constructive engagement with current and future student leaders.

3.30 February 2020

3.30.1 From Memory to Marble Vol 1: The Historical Frieze of the Voortrekker Monument, Part I: The Frieze

Author: Elizabeth Rankin

Author: Rolf Michael Schneider

Cape Town: African Minds, 2020

https://doi.org/10.1515/9783110668780

The Voortrekker Monumentality digital archive hosted by Stanford University Libraries is based on the eight-hundred-and-four illustrations from the two-volume book From Memory to Marble: The historical frieze of the Voortrekker Monument. It includes not only images of the monument and the frieze but also many related documents and artworks. The corpus aims to promote studies of controversial monuments, with a focus on visual interpretation.

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This second volume expands on the first, considering each of the 27 scenes in depth, providing new insights into not only the frieze, but also South Africa's history.

3.31 January 2020

3.31.1 Transforming Research Excellence: New Ideas from the Global South

Editor: Erika Kraemer-Mbula

Editor: Robert Tijssen

Editor: Matthew Wallace

Editor: Robert McLean

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2020

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502067

Modern-day science is under great pressure. A potent mix of increasing expectations, limited resources, tensions between competition and cooperation, and the need for evidence-based funding is creating major change in how science is conducted and perceived. Amidst this 'perfect storm' is the allure of 'research excellence', a concept that drives decisions made by universities and funders, and defines scientists' research strategies and career trajectories. But what is 'excellent' science? And how to recognise it? After decades of inquiry and debate there is still no satisfactory answer. Are we asking the wrong question? Is reality more complex, and 'excellence in science' more elusive, than many are willing to admit? And how should excellence be defined in different parts of the world, particularly in lower-income countries of the 'Global South' where science is expected to contribute to pressing development issues,

despite often scarce resources? Many wonder whether the Global South is importing, with or without consenting, the flawed tools for research evaluation from North America and Europe that are not fit for purpose. This book takes a critical view of these issues, touching on conceptual issues and practical problems that inevitably emerge when 'excellence' is at the center of science systems. Emerging from the capacity-building work of the Science Granting Councils Initiative in sub-Saharan Africa, it speaks to scholars, as well as to managers and funders of research around the world. Confronting sticky problems and uncomfortable truths, the chapters contain insights and recommendations that point towards new solutions – both for the Global South and the Global North.

3.32 November 2019

3.32.1 Science Communication in South Africa: Reflections on Current Issues

Editor: Peter Weingart

Editor: Marina Joubert

Editor: Bankole Falade

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2019

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502036

Why do we need to communicate science? Is science, with its highly specialised language and its arcane methods, too distant to be understood by the public? Is it really possible for citizens to participate meaningfully in scientific research projects and debate? Should scientists be mandated to engage with the public to facilitate better understanding of science? How can they best communicate their special knowledge to be intelligible? These and a plethora of related questions are being raised by researchers and politicians alike as they have become convinced that science and society need to draw nearer to one another. Once the persuasion took hold that science should open up to the public and these questions were raised, it became clear that coming up with satisfactory answers would be a complex challenge. The inaccessibility of scientific language and methods, due to ever increasing specialisation, is at the base of its very success. Thus, translating specialised knowledge to become understandable, interesting and relevant to various publics creates particular perils. This is exacerbated by the ongoing disruption of the public discourse through the digitisation of communication platforms. For example, the availability of medical knowledge on the internet and the immense opportunities to inform oneself about health risks via social media are undermined by the manipulable nature of this technology that does not allow its users to distinguish between credible content and misinformation. In countries around the world, scientists, policy-makers and the public have high hopes for science communication: that it may elevate its populations educationally, that it may raise the level of sound decision-making for people in their daily lives, and that it may contribute to innovation and economic well-being. This collection of current reflections gives

an insight into the issues that have to be addressed by research to reach these noble goals, for South Africa and by South Africans in particular.

3.33 October 2019

3.33.1 Sharing Knowledge, Transforming Societies: The Norhed Programme 2013-2020

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Kristin Orgeret

Editor: Roy Krøvel

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2019

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928502005

In June 2016, the Norwegian Programme for Capacity Development in Higher Education and Research for Development (Norhed) hosted a conference on the theme of 'knowledge for development' in an attempt to shift the focus of the programme towards its academic content. This book follows up on that event. The conference highlighted the usefulness of presenting the value of Norhed's different projects to the world, showing how they improve knowledge and expand access to it through co-operation. A wish for more meta-knowledge was also expressed and this gives rise to the following questions: Is this way of co-operating contributing to the growth of independent post-colonial knowledge production in the South, based on analyses of local data and experiences in ways that are relevant to our shared future? Does the growth of academic independence, as well as greater equality, and the ability to develop theories different to those imposed by the better-off parts of the world, give rise to deeper understandings and better explanations? Does it, at least, spread the ability to translate existing methodologies in ways that add meaning to observations of local context and data, and thus enhance the relevance and influence of the academic profession locally and internationally? This book, in its varied contributions, does not provide definite answers to these questions but it does show that Norhed is a step in the right direction. Norhed is an attempt to fund collaboration within and between higher education institutions. We know that both the uniqueness of this programme, and ideas of how to better utilise the learning and experience emerging from it, call for more elaboration and broader dissemination before we can offer further guidance on how to do things better. This book is a first attempt.

3.33.2 Ubushakashatsi: mu Bumenyi Nyamuntu n'Imibanire y'Abantu

Editor: Evode Mukama

Editor: Laurent Nkusi

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2019

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331971

Research in developed countries is often considered as a means to pave the way towards sustainable development in different areas of the society including science and technology, the economy, governance and security. Researchers in developing countries rarely have the opportunity to use their indigenous languages to design, plan and conduct research. Nor do they communicate in their indigenous languages to share their insights and learnings from other parts of the world with colleagues or students. Utilising the languages that researchers, students and teachers, policymakers, the community, and others interested in research understand better can help to generate new knowledge embedded in local realities where sustainable development needs to take root. That is why this book is in Kinyarwanda. The authors hope that writing this book in Kinyarwanda will increase research capacity in the humanities and social sciences in Rwanda and in the region. And that it will increase interaction between all key stakeholders in the planning and conducting of research as well as in analysing, monitoring and evaluating the research process and its outputs.

3.34 May 2019

3.34.1 The State of Open Data: Histories and Horizons

Editor: Tim Davies

Editor: Mor Rubinstein

Editor: Fernando Perini

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2019

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331957

Its been ten years since open data first broke onto the global stage. Over the past decade, thousands of programmes and projects around the world have worked to open data and use it to address a myriad of social and economic challenges. Meanwhile, issues related to data rights and privacy have moved to the centre of public and political discourse. As the open data movement enters a new phase in its evolution, shifting to target real-world problems and embed open data thinking into other existing or emerging communities of practice, big questions still remain. How will open data initiatives respond to new concerns about privacy, inclusion, and artificial intelligence? And what can we learn from the last decade in order

to deliver impact where it is most needed? The State of Open Data brings together over 60 authors from around the world to address these questions and to take stock of the real progress made to date across sectors and around the world, uncovering the issues that will shape the future of open data in the years to come.

3.35 March 2019

3.35.1 African Markets and the Utu-buntu Business Model: A Perspective in Economic Informality in Nairobi

Author: Mary Njeri Kinyanjui

Cape Town: African Minds, 2019

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331780

The persistence of indigenous African markets in the context of a hostile or neglectful business and policy environment makes them worthy of analysis. An investigation of Afrocentric business ethics is long overdue. Attempting to understand the actions and efforts of informal traders and artisans from their own points of view, and analysing how they organise and get by, allows for viable approaches to be identified to integrate them into global urban models and cultures.

3.36 December 2018

3.36.1 Higher Education Pathways: South African Undergraduate Education and the Public Good

Editor: Paul Ashwin

Editor: Jennifer Case

Cape Town: African Minds, 2018

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331902

In what ways does access to undergraduate education have a transformative impact on people and societies? What conditions are required for this impact to occur? What are the pathways from an undergraduate education to the public good, including inclusive economic development?

These questions have particular resonance in the South African higher education context, which is attempting to tackle the challenges of widening access and improving completion rates in in a system in which the segregations of the apartheid years are still apparent.

Higher education is recognised in core legislation as having a distinctive and crucial role in building post-apartheid society. Undergraduate education is seen as central to addressing skills shortages in South Africa. It is also seen to yield significant social returns, including a consistent positive impact on societal institutions and the development of a range of capabilities that have public, as well as private, benefits.

This book offers comprehensive contemporary evidence that allows for a fresh engagement with these pressing issues.

3.37 November 2018

3.37.1 The Next Generation of Scientists in Africa

Author: Catherine Beaudry

Author: Johann Mouton

Author: Heidi Prozesky

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2018

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331933

Young scientists are a powerful resource for change and sustainable development, as they drive innovation and knowledge creation. However, comparable findings on young scientists in various countries, especially in Africa and developing regions, are generally sparse. Therefore, empirical knowledge on the state of early-career scientists is critical in order to address current challenges faced by those scientists in Africa. This book reports on the main findings of a three-and-a-half-year international project in order to assist its readers in better understanding the African research system in general, and more specifically its young scientists. The first part of the book provides background on the state of science in Africa, and bibliometric findings concerning Africa's scientific production and networks, for the period 2005 to 2015. The second part of the book combines the findings of a large-scale, quantitative survey and more than 200 qualitative interviews to provide a detailed profile of young scientists and the barriers they face in terms of five aspects of their careers: research output; funding; mobility; collaboration; and mentoring. In each case, field and gender differences are also taken into account. The last part of the book comprises conclusions and recommendations to relevant policy- and decision-makers on desirable changes to current research systems in Africa.

3.37.2 Research Universities in Africa

Author: Nico Cloete

Author: Ian Bunting

Author: Francois van Schalkwyk

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2018

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331872

From the early 2000s, a new discourse emerged, in Africa and the international donor community, that higher education was important for development in Africa. Within this zeitgeist of converging interests, a range of agencies agreed that a different, collaborative approach to linking higher education to development was necessary. This led to the establishment of the Higher Education Research and Advocacy Network in Africa (Herana) to concentrate on research and advocacy about the possible role and contribution of universities to development in Africa. This book is the final publication to emerge from the Herana project. The project has also published more than 100 articles, chapters, reports, manuals and datasets, and many presentations have been delivered to share insights gained from the work done by Herana. Given its prolific dissemination, it seems reasonable to ask whether this fourth and final publication will offer the reader anything new. This book is certainly different from previous publications in several respects. First, it is the only book to include an analysis of eight African universities based on the full 15 years of empirical data collected by the project. Second, previous books and reports were published mid-project. This book has benefited from an extended gestation period allowing the authors and contributors to reflect on the project without the distractions associated with managing and participating in a large-scale project. For the first time, some of those who have been involved in Herana since its inception have had the opportunity to at least make an attempt to see part of the wood for the trees. Different does not necessarily mean new. An emphasis on the newness of the data and perspectives presented in this book is important because it shows that it is more than a historical record of a donor-funded project. Rather, each chapter in this book brings, to a lesser or greater extent, something new to our understanding of universities, research and development in Africa.

3.38 October 2018

3.38.1 Anchored in Place: Rethinking the University and Development in South Africa

Editor: Leslie Bank

Editor: Nico Cloete

Editor: Francois van Schalkwyk

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2018

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331759

Tensions in South African universities have traditionally centred around equity (particularly access and affordability), historical legacies (such as apartheid and colonialism), and the shape and structure of the higher education system. What has not received sufficient attention, is the contribution of the university to place-based development.

This volume is the first in South Africa to engage seriously with the place-based developmental role of universities. In the international literature and policy there has been an increasing integration of the university with place-based development, especially in cities. This volume weighs in on the debate by drawing attention to the place-based roles and agency of South African universities in their local towns and cities. It acknowledges that universities were given specific development roles in regions, homelands and towns under apartheid, and comments on why sub-national, place-based development has not been a key theme in post-apartheid, higher education planning.

3.39 February 2018

3.39.1 Going to University: The Influence of Higher Education on the Lives of Young South Africans

Author: Jennifer Case

Author: Delia Marshall

Author: Sioux McKenna

Author: Disaapele Mogashana

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2018

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331698

Around the world, more young people than ever before are attending university. Student numbers in South Africa have doubled since democracy and for many families, higher education is a route to a better future for their children. But alongside the overwhelming demand for higher education, questions about its purposes have intensified. Deliberations about the curriculum, culture and costing of public higher education abound from student activists, academics, parents, civil society and policy-makers. We know, from macro research, that South African graduates generally have good employment prospects. But little is known at a detailed level about how young people actually make use of their university experiences to craft their life courses. And even less is known about what happens to those who drop out. This accessible book brings together the rich life stories of 73 young people, six years after they began their university studies. It traces how going to university influences not only

their employment options, but also nurtures the agency needed to chart their own way and to engage critically with the world around them. The book offers deep insights into the ways in which public higher education is both a private and public good, and it provides significant conclusions pertinent to anyone who works in and cares about universities.

3.40 December 2017

3.40.1 The Social Dynamics of Open Data

Editor: Francois van Schalkwyk

Editor: Stefaan Verhulst

Editor: Gustavo Magalhaes

Editor: Juan Pane

Editor: Johanna Walker

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331568

The Social Dynamics of Open Data is a collection of peer reviewed papers presented at the 2nd Open Data Research Symposium (ODRS) held in Madrid, Spain, on 5 October 2016. Research is critical to developing a more rigorous and fine-combed analysis not only of why open data is valuable, but how it is valuable and under what specific conditions. The objective of the Open Data Research Symposium and the subsequent collection of chapters published here is to build such a stronger evidence base. This base is essential to understanding what open datas impacts have been to date, and how positive impacts can be enabled and amplified. Consequently, common to the majority of chapters in this collection is the attempt by the authors to draw on existing scientific theories, and to apply them to open data to better explain the socially embedded dynamics that account for open datas successes and failures in contributing to a more equitable and just society.

3.40.2 Adoption and Impact of OER in the Global South

Editor: Cheryl Hodgkinson-Williams

Editor: Patricia Arinto

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331483

Education in the Global South faces several key interrelated challenges, for which Open Educational Resources (OER) are seen to be part of the solution. These challenges include: unequal access to education; variable quality of educational resources, teaching, and student performance; and increasing cost and concern about the sustainability of education. The Research on Open Educational Resources for Development (ROER4D) project seeks to build on and contribute to the body of research on how OER can help to improve access, enhance quality and reduce the cost of education in the Global South. This volume examines aspects of educator and student adoption of OER and engagement in Open Educational Practices (OEP) in secondary and tertiary education as well as teacher professional development in 21 countries in South America, Sub-Saharan Africa and South and Southeast Asia. The ROER4D studies and syntheses presented here aim to help inform Open Education advocacy, policy, practice and research in developing countries.

3.40.3 North-South Knowledge Networks: Towards Equitable Collaboration Between Academics, Donors and Universities

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Jorun Nossum

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331308

Since the 1990s, internationalisation has become key for institutions wishing to secure funding for higher education and research. For the academic community, this strategic shift has had many consequences. Priorities have changed and been influenced by new ways of thinking about universities, and of measuring their impact in relation to each other and to their social goals. Debates are ongoing and hotly contested.

3.41 November 2017

3.41.1 Open Data in Developing Economies: Toward Building an Evidence Base on What Works and How

Author: Stefaan Verhulst

Author: Andrew Young

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331599

Recent years have witnessed considerable speculation about the potential of open data to bring about wide-scale transformation. The bulk of existing evidence about the impact of open data, however, focuses on high-income countries. Much less is known about open data's role and value in low- and middle-income countries, and more generally about its possible contributions to economic and social development.

Open Data for Developing Economies features in-depth case studies on how open data is having an impact across the developing world-from an agriculture initiative in Colombia to data-driven healthcare projects in Uganda and South Africa to crisis response in Nepal. The analysis built on these case studies aims to create actionable intelligence regarding: (a) the conditions under which open data is most (and least) effective in development, presented in the form of a Periodic Table of Open Data; (b) strategies to maximize the positive contributions of open data to development; and (c) the means for limiting open data's harms on developing countries.

3.42 October 2017

3.42.1 Knowledge for Justice: Critical Perspectives from Southern African-Nordic Research Partnerships

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Hilde Ibsen

Editor: Henri-Count Evans

Editor: Sharon Penderis

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331636

With the adoption of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and the Paris Agreement, the purpose of development is being redefined in both social and environmental terms. Despite pushback from conservative forces, change is accelerating in many sectors. To drive this transformation in ways that bring about social, environmental and economic justice at a local, national, regional and global levels, new knowledge and strong cross-regional networks capable of foregrounding different realities, needs and agendas will be essential. In fact, the power of knowledge matters today in ways that humanity has probably never experienced before, placing an emphasis on the roles of research, academics and universities.

3.43 September 2017

3.43.1 The Future of Scholarly Publishing: Open Access and the Economics of Digitisation

Editor: Peter Weingart

Editor: Niels Taubert

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331537

The formal scientific communication system is currently undergoing significant change. This is due to four developments: the digitisation of formal science communication; the economisation of academic publishing as profit drives many academic publishers and other providers of information; an increase in the self-observation of science by means of publication, citation and utility-based indicators; and the medialisation of science as its observation by the mass media intensifies. Previously, these developments have only been dealt with individually in the literature and by science-policy actors. The Future of Scholarly Publishing documents the materials and results of an interdisciplinary working group commissioned by the Berlin-Brandenburg Academy of Sciences and Humanities (BBAW) to analyse the future of scholarly publishing and to make recommendations on how to respond to the challenges posed by these developments.As per the working groups intention, the focus was mainly on the sciences and humanities in Germany. However, in the course of the work it became clear that the issues discussed by the group are equally relevant for academic publishing in other countries. As such, this book will contribute to the transfer of ideas and perspectives, and allow for mutual learning about the current and future state of scientific publishing in different settings.

3.44 July 2017

3.44.1 La Jurisprudence Congolaise en Matière de Crimes de Droit International: Une Analyse des Décisions des Juridictions Militaires Congolaises en Application du Statut de Rome

Author: Jacques B Mbokani

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331421

En 2004, un tribunal de Mbandaka, dans la province congolaise de l'Equateur, a décidé que le statut de la Cour pénale internationale (CPI) répondait mieux que le code militaire congolais au cas qui lui était soumis. Cette décision a déclenché une avalanche d'autres décisions dans

lesquelles, au cours des dix dernières années, les juges militaires à travers le pays ont systématiquement et délibérément écarté le code pénal militaire congolais auquel ils ont préféré les dispositions du Statut de Rome. L'importante jurisprudence née de ce mouvement compte parmi les expériences les plus innovantes d'application du statut de la CPI aux poursuites nationales des crimes graves.

3.44.2 Organes de gestion des élections en Afrique de l'ouest: Une étude comparative de la contribution des commissions électorales au renforcement de la démocratie

Editor: Ismaila Fall

Editor: Mathias Hounkpe

Editor: Adele Jinadu

Editor: Pascal Kambale

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920489175

Ce rapport est une cartographie exhaustive des commissions électorales dans six pays de la région ouest africaine (Bénin, Cap-Vert, Ghana, Nigeria, Sénégal et Sierra-Léone) dont l'objectif est d'évaluer leur contribution au renforcement de la démocratie participative dans la région. Comme institutions de mise en oeuvre des règles du jeu électoral, les organes de gestion des élections (OGE) ont occupé au cours des deux dernières décennies le centre des discussions et de la pratique sur la question cruciale de la participation effective des citoyens aux affaires publiques de leur pays. Les modes de leur création et les règles de leur fonctionnement effectif n'ont cessé de préoccuper les protagonistes des compétitions électorales et d'occuper le centre des réformes politiques.

L'étude Organes de gestion des élections en Afrique de l'ouest répond donc à un besoin évident d'éclairage sur une institution qui occupe une place de plus en plus centrale dans les processus politiques en Afrique de l'Ouest. Basée sur une recherche documentaire approfondie et des entretiens détaillés menés dans chaque pays, l'étude propose une analyse comparative des OGE qui dégage les ressemblances et dissemblances dans leurs formes comme dans leurs fonctionnements tout en essayant de mettre en exergue les logiques qui fondent leurs succès et leurs limites.

3.44.3 Effectivité des Agences Nationales Anti-Corruption en Afrique de L'ouest: Bénin, Libéria, Niger, Nigéria, Sénégal, Sierra Leone

Editor: Open Society Initiative for West Africa

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331360

Avec plus de 100 milliards de dollars perdus chaque année, d'après certaines informations, à cause de la corruption et autres pratiques illicites, la lutte contre la corruption en Afrique fait face à d'énormes défis. Cependant, des lois et politiques aux niveaux continental, régional et national ont été promulguées et adoptées par les dirigeants africains. Au nombre de ces initiatives il y a la création d'agences spécialisées mandatées pour lutter contre la corruption au niveau national, ainsi que l'institution aux niveaux régional et continental des mécanismes pour assurer l'harmonisation des normes et l'adoption des meilleures pratiques dans la lutte contre la corruption.

Pourtant, compte tenu de la disparité entre l'apparente impunité dont jouissent les fonctionnaires et la rhétorique anti-corruption des gouvernements de la région, l'efficacité de ces organismes est considérée avec scepticisme.

Cette étude des agences anti-corruption à l'échelle continentale vise à évaluer leur pertinence et leur efficacité en examinant leur indépendance, leurs mandats, les ressources disponibles, l'appropriation nationale, les capacités en leur sein et leur positionnement stratégique.

Ces enquêtes comprennent des recommandations fondées sur des preuves appelant à des institutions plus fortes, plus pertinentes et efficaces qui sont directement alignées sur les cadres régionaux et continentaux de lutte contre la corruption, comme la Convention de l'Union africaine sur la prévention et la lutte contre la corruption, que les six pays étudiés dans ce rapport – Bénin, Libéria, Niger, Nigeria, Sénégal et Sierra Leone – ont tous ratifiée.

3.45 April 2017

3.45.1 Election Management Bodies in Southern Africa: Comparative Study of the Electoral Commissions Contribution to Electoral Processes

Editor: Open Society Initiative for Southern Africa (OSISA)

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928332176

Over the past two decades, Southern African countries have entrenched the use of elections as the only means and medium for electing governments and representative institutions in governance. Electoral Management Bodies (EMBs) are central to the delivery and quality

of elections. These institutions are mandated to manage most or all aspects of the electoral process. Informed by diverse factors – the design, mandate, extent of powers and even the number of institutions responsible for electoral matters vary in each country. This study is a collaborative effort between the Open Society Initiative for Southern Africa (OSISA), the Open Society Foundation's Africa Regional Office (AfRO) and the Electoral Commissions Forum of the Southern African Development Community (ECF-SADC). For each of the 12 countries, the research covered:

1. Comparative analysis of the legal frameworks the EMBs operate under and of the historical and political contexts they function within
2. Comparative study of the institutional nature of the EMBs
3. Assessment of the powers vested in the EMBs in the conduct and management of electoral processes and their role in the drafting of electoral laws, managing electoral operations, certifying and proclaiming electoral results, ensuring that electoral results are credible, and in resolving electoral conflicts
4. Comparative assessment of the independence of the EMBs with particular reference to funding and their relationships with the executive, political parties, parliament and the judiciary (electoral justice mechanisms)

Findings and recommendations from this pan-African initiative are expected to increase information and knowledge on the strengths, weaknesses and workings of EMBs in sub-Saharan Africa to facilitate peer learning among African election managers, as well as informing policy-makers, legislators, governments and civil society on a progressive reform agenda to strengthen inclusive electoral processes and democratic practice.

3.45.2 Effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies in Southern Africa: Angola, Botswana, DRC, Lesotho, Malawi, Mozambique, Namibia, South Africa, Swaziland, Zambia and Zimbabwe

Editor: Open Society Initiative for Southern Africa (OSISA)

Cape Town: African Minds, 2017

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928332213

With reportedly over USD100 billion lost annually through graft and illicit practices, combatting corruption in Africa has been challenging. However, laws and policies at the continental, regional and national levels have been promulgated and enacted by African leaders. These initiatives have included the establishment of anti-corruption agencies mandated to tackle graft at national level, as well as coordinate bodies at regional and continental levels to ensure the harmonisation of normative standards and the adoption of best practices in the fight against corruption.

Yet, given the disparity between the apparent impunity enjoyed by public servants and the anti-corruption rhetoric of governments in the region, the effectiveness of these agencies is viewed with scepticism. This continent-wide study of anti-corruption agencies aims to gauge their relevance and effectiveness by assessing their independence, mandate, available resources, national ownership, capacities and strategic positioning.

These surveys include evidence-based recommendations calling for stronger, more relevant and effective institutions that are directly aligned to regional and continental anti-corruption frameworks, such as the African Union Convention on Preventing and Combatting Corruption (AUCPCC), which the ten countries in this current report – Angola, Botswana, DRC, Lesotho, Malawi, Mozambique, Namibia, South Africa, Swaziland, Zambia and Zimbabwe – have all ratified.

3.46 October 2016

3.46.1 Cape Town Harmonies: Memory, Humour and Resilience

Author: Armelle Gaulier

Author: Denis-Constant Martin

Cape Town: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331506

"Cape Town's public cultures can only be fully appreciated through recognition of its deep and diverse soundscape. We have to listen to what has made and makes a city. The ear is an integral part of the 'research tools' one needs to get a sense of any city. We have to listen to the sounds that made and make the expansive 'mother city'. Various of its constituent parts sound different from each other… There is the sound of the singing men and their choirs ("teams" they are called) in preparation for the longstanding annual Malay choral competitions. The lyrics from the various repertoires they perform are hardly ever written down. There are texts of the hallowed 'Dutch songs' but these do not circulate easily and widely. Researchers dream of finding lyrics from decades ago, not to mention a few generations ago - back to the early 19th century. This work by Denis Constant Martin and Armelle Gaulier provides us with a very useful selection of these songs. More than that, it is a critical sociological reflection of the place of these songs and their performers in the context that have given rise to them and sustains their relevance. It is a necessary work and is a very important scholarly intervention about a rather neglected aspect of the history and present production of music in the city."

- Shamil Jeppie, Associate Professor in the Department of Historical Studies at the University of Cape Town

3.46.2 The Delusion of Knowledge Transfer: The Impact of Foreign Aid Experts on Policy-making in South Africa and Tanzania

Author: Susanne Koch

Author: Peter Weingart

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331391

With the rise of the 'knowledge for development' paradigm, expert advice has become a prime instrument of foreign aid. At the same time, it has been object of repeated criticism: the chronic failure of 'technical assistance' – a notion under which advice is commonly subsumed – has been documented in a host of studies. Nonetheless, international organisations continue to send advisors, promising to increase the 'effectiveness' of expert support if their technocratic recommendations are taken up. This book reveals fundamental problems of expert advice in the context of aid that concern issues of power and legitimacy rather than merely flaws of implementation. Based on empirical evidence from South Africa and Tanzania, the authors show that aid-related advisory processes are inevitably obstructed by colliding interests, political pressures and hierarchical relations that impede knowledge transfer and mutual learning. As a result, recipient governments find themselves caught in a perpetual cycle of dependency, continuously advised by experts who convey the shifting paradigms and agendas of their respective donor governments. For young democracies, the persistent presence of external actors is hazardous: ultimately, it poses a threat to the legitimacy of their governments if their policy-making becomes more responsive to foreign demands than to the preferences and needs of their citizens.

3.47 June 2016

3.47.1 Change Management in TVET Colleges: Lessons Learnt from the Field of Practice

Editor: André Kraak

Editor: Andrew Paterson

Editor: Kedibone Bok

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331339

The Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) college environment is marked by increasingly stark juxtapositions between what needs to be achieved in the post-school education sector and the increasing difficulty of current conditions. The 'triple challenge' of

poverty, inequality and unemployment weighs heavily on the social, political and economic fabric of the country and expectations are high that the TVET colleges can make a pivotal contribution to counter these challenges. Despite laudable increases in TVET enrolment, the education system needs to work harder to accommodate the weight of demand for post school further education and training (FET) band qualifications from young people not in education, employment or training. At the same time, it is vital to secure adequate quality in TVET programmes which depend so much on the competence and commitment of college lecturers. This collection offers a set of research papers that provide new analytic and empirical material on:

The political economy of TVET types in different countries which, by comparison, illuminate the South African case;

A periodisation of government interventions in the TVET sector over the last three decades;

The unsettled state and status of TVET lecturers in relation to their job requirements and conditions of service;

The halting evolution of collegial relationships between college lecturers towards higher collegiality;

Employer expectations of college graduates and how colleges are responding; and

An analysis of the outcomes of a college improvement intervention in Limpopo and the Eastern Cape.

This book will offer valuable information and insights for decision-makers as well as analysts of institutional change concerning links between education and economic growth, with particular regard to TVET graduates' employment rates.

3.48 May 2016

3.48.1 Election Management Bodies in West Africa: A Comparative Study of the Contribution of Electoral Commissions to the Strengthening of Democracy

Author: Ismaila Fall

Author: Mathias Hounkpe

Author: Adele Jinadu

Author: Pascal Kambale

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920489168

This report is an in-depth study of electoral commissions in six countries of West Africa Benin, Cape Verde, Ghana, Nigeria, Senegal and Sierra Leone assessing their contribution in strengthening political participation in the region. As institutions that apply the rules governing elections, electoral management bodies (EMBs) have occupied, over the last two decades, the heart of discussion and practice on the critical question of effective citizen participation in the public affairs of their countries. The way in which they are established and the effectiveness of their operations have continued to preoccupy those who advocate for competitive elections, while reforms to the EMBs have taken centre stage in more general political reforms. Election Management Bodies in West Africa thus responds to the evident need for more knowledge about an institution that occupies a more and more important place in the political process in West Africa. Based on documentary research and detailed interviews in each country, the study provides a comparative analysis which highlights the similarities and differences in the structure and operations of each body, and attempts to establish the reasons for their comparative successes and failures.

3.48.2 One World, Many Knowledges: Regional Experiences and Cross-regional Links in Higher Education

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Peter Vale

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780620557894

Various forms of academic co-operation criss-cross the modern university system in a bewildering number of ways, from the open exchange of ideas and knowledge, to the sharing of research results, and frank discussions about research challenges. Embedded in these scholarly networks is the question of whether a global template for the management of both higher education and national research organisations is necessary, and if so, must institutions slavishly follow the high-flown language of the global knowledge society or risk falling behind in the ubiquitous university ranking system? Or are there alternatives that can achieve a better, more ethically inclined, world? Basing their observations on their own experiences, an interesting mix of seasoned scholars and new voices from southern Africa and the Nordic region offer critical perspectives on issues of inter- and cross-regional academic co-operation. Several of the chapters also touch on the evolution of the higher education sector in the two regions. An absorbing and intelligent study, this book will be invaluable for anyone interested in the strategies scholars are using to adapt to the interconnectedness of the modern world. It offers fresh insights into how academics are attempting to protect the spaces in which they can freely and openly debate the challenges they face, while aiming to transform higher education, and foster scholarly collaboration. The Southern African-Nordic Centre (SANORD) is a partnership of higher education institutions from Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Sweden, Botswana, Namibia, Malawi, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe. SANORDs primary aim

is to promote multilateral research co-operation on matters of importance to the development of both regions. Our activities are based on the values of democracy, equity, and mutually beneficial academic engagement.

3.48.3 Castells in Africa: Universities and Development

Author: Johan Muller

Author: Nico Cloete

Author: Francois van Schalkwyk

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677923

Universities and Development collects the papers produced by Manuel Castells on his visits to South Africa, and publishes them in a single volume for the first time. The book also publishes a series of empirically-based papers which together display the multi-faceted and far-sighted scope of his theoretical framework, and its fecundity for fine-grained, detailed empirical investigations on universities and development in Africa. Castells, in his afterword to this book, always looking forward, assesses the role of the university in the wake of the upheavals to the global economic order. He decides the universities function not only remains, but is more important than ever. This book will serve as an introduction to the relevance of his work for higher education in Africa for postgraduate students, reflective practitioners and researchers.

3.48.4 Moçambique Como Lugar de Interrogação: A Modernidade em Elísio Macamo e Severino Ngoenha

Author: Paula Sophia Branco de Lima

Cape Town: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331278

Moçambique como lugar de interrogação: a modernidade em Elísio Macamo e Severino Ngoenha é uma tentativa de procurar respostas para algumas questões que se apresentam quando pensamos dentro do escopo da ciência moderna a partir das periferias globais. Como fazer ciência sociais ignorando a historicidade destas disciplinas e os sentidos que incorporaram desde o seu surgimento e ao longo do processo de exploração colonial? O livro não pretende negar a possibilidade de desenvolvermos ciência de forma crítica a partir dos nossos lugares de fala ou tampouco negar a importância desta produção em nossos contextos. Pelo contrário, nos desafia a refletir sobre caminhos para esse pensar crítico e assume que do nosso lugar de fala, é fulcral que comecemos por interrogar alguns pressuspostos. Por isso, o nosso lugar é

um excelente lugar para levantar velhos e novos questionamentos. O conceito de modernidade é exemplar para o tensionamento destas questões, porque traz à tona a dicotomia que historicamente separou colonizadores e colonizados, que é a dicotomia civilizado-selvagem, moderno-tradicional. Por detrás dele está a negociação da nossa igualdade. Refletí-lo, por isso, é uma forma de desconstruir roupagens que nunca nos couberam. O passeio através das obras de Elísio Macamo e Severino Ngoenha, autores de grande importância no pensamento social moçambicano, é uma forma de buscar algumas respostas para estas questões.

A perspicácia e fecundidade com as quais os autores se debruçam sobre a complexa relação que o continente africano estabelece com a modernidade é uma bela porta de entrada para refletirmos sobre o nosso lugar numa rede mais ampla de produção de conhecimento. Moçambique como lugar de interrogação: a modernidade em Elísio Macamo e Severino Ngoenha não é de forma alguma conclusivo, é uma busca. Mergulhar no pensamento destes autores é um convite para pensarmos nossos horizontes.

3.49 March 2016

3.49.1 Student Politics in Africa: Representation and Activism

Editor: Thierry Luescher

Editor: Manja Klemencic

Editor: James Otieno Jowi

Cape Town: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331223

Student Politics in Africa: Representation and Activism

By Thierry M Luescher, Manja Klemenčič & James Otieno Jowi

The second volume of the African Higher Education Dynamics Series brings together the research of an international network of higher education scholars with interest in higher education and student politics in Africa. Most authors are early career academics who teach and conduct research in universities across the continent and came together for a research project, and related workshops and a symposium on student representation in African higher education governance.

The book includes theoretical chapters on student organising, student activism and representation; chapters on historical and current developments in student politics in Anglophone and Francophone Africa, and in-depth case studies on student representation and activism in a cross-section of universities and countries.

The book provides a unique resource for academics, university leaders and student affairs professionals as well as student leaders and policy-makers in Africa and elsewhere.

3.49.2 Reflections of South African University Leaders: 1981 to 2014

Editor: Council on Higher Education

Cape Town: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331094

The inspiration for this collection arose in late 2013 in the Council on Higher Education's (CHE) Monitoring and Evaluation Directorate, the directorate responsible for conducting research on the higher education landscape and monitoring the state of the sector over time. They noted that conditions besetting universities had grown increasingly complex, both globally but more especially locally, and the question arose – how had this altered the challenges to university leadership over the period, say, between the new political dispensation ushered in in 1994 and the second decade of the new millennium? More particularly, how had leaders with a proven track record of visionary and strong leadership during this period faced these challenges? How did they see the main changes that needed dealing with? What challenges did these changes pose and how were they successfully overcome? What did they think, looking back, were the main constituents of successful leadership and management? What wisdom could be distilled for posterity? The Directorate decided to invite a range of vice-chancellors and senior academic leaders who had completed their terms of office to contribute to a project that set out to gather such reflections and compile them into a publication.

3.50 February 2016

3.50.1 Election Management Bodies in East Africa: A Comparative Study of the Contribution of Electoral Commissions to the Strengthening of Democracy

Author: Alexander Makulilo

Author: Eugène Ntaganda

Author: Francis Away

Author: Margaret Sekaggya

Author: Patrick Osodo

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677978

The management of elections is increasingly generating impassioned debate in these East African nations - Burundi, Kenya, Rwanda, Tanzania and Uganda. The bodies that manage and conduct elections are, therefore, coming under intense citizen and stakeholder scrutiny for the manner in which they are composed, how they organise and perform their mandates, and the outcomes they achieve. The effectiveness of electoral management bodies (EMBs) has largely been influenced by the impact of political violence on election management reforms in East Africa. Even in countries where EMBs are the products of reforms initiated in the aftermath of violent disputes over elections, they still face enormous challenges in dealing with electoral disputes and anticipating election-related crises. Although changes to constitutions and the laws in these countries have sought to make EMBs independent and, therefore, more inclined to deliver free, fair and credible elections, there are many issues that determine their impartiality and their ability to allow for the aggregation and free expression of the will of the people. These shortcomings negatively impact on democracy. This volume assembles case studies on the capacity of EMBs in these five East African countries to deliver democratic and transparent elections.

3.51 January 2016

3.51.1 The Civil Society Guide to Regional Economic Communities in Africa

Author: Morris Odhiambo

Author: Rudy Chitiga

Author: Solomon Ebobrah

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677961

Since 1963, when the African integration project was born, regional Economic Communities (RECs) have been an indispensable part of the continents deeper socioeconomic and political integration. More than half a century later, such regional institutions continue to evolve, keeping pace with an Africa that is transforming itself amid challenges and opportunities. RECs represent a huge potential to be the engines that drive the continents economic growth and development as well as being vehicles through which a sense of a continental community is fostered. It is critical therefore that citizens understand the multi-faceted and bureaucratic operations of regional institutions in order to use them to advance their collective interests.

3.51.2 Effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies in East Africa: Kenya, Tanzania and Uganda

Author: Open Society Initiative for Southern Africa (OSISA

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331148

With reportedly over USD50 billion lost annually through graft and illicit practices, combating corruption in Africa has been challenging. However, laws and policies at the continental, regional and national levels have been promulgated and enacted by African leaders. These initiatives have included the establishment of anti-corruption agencies mandated to tackle graft at national level, as well as coordinate bodies at regional and continental lev Yet, given the disparity between the apparent impunity enjoyed by public servants and the anti-corruption rhetoric of governments in the region, the effectiveness of these agencies is viewed with scepticism. This continent-wide study of anti-corruption agencies aims to gauge their relevance and effectiveness by assessing their independence, mandate, available resources, national ownership, capacities and strategic positioning. These surveys include evidence-based recommendations calling for stronger, more relevant and effective institutions that are directly aligned to regional and continental anti-corruption frameworks, such as the African Union Convention on Preventing and Combating Corruption (AUCPCC), which the three countries in this current report Kenya, Tanzania and Uganda have all ratified.els to ensure the harmonisation of normative standards and the adoption of best practices in the fight against corruption.

3.51.3 Citizenship Law in Africa: A Comparative Study (3rd edition)

Author: Bronwyn Manby

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331087

Few African countries provide for an explicit right to a nationality. Laws and practices governing citizenship effectively leave hundreds of thousands of people in Africa without a country. These stateless Africans can neither vote nor stand for office; they cannot enrol their children in school, travel freely, or own property; they cannot work for the government; they are exposed to human rights abuses. Statelessness exacerbates and underlies tensions in many regions of the continent. Citizenship Law in Africa, a comparative study by two programs of the Open Society Foundations, describes the often arbitrary, discriminatory, and contradictory citizenship laws that exist from state to state and recommends ways that African countries can bring their citizenship laws in line with international rights norms. The report covers topics such as citizenship by descent, citizenship by naturalisation, gender discrimination in citizenship law, dual citizenship, and the right to identity documents and passports. It is essential reading for policymakers, attorneys, and activists.

3.51.4 Doctoral Education in South Africa: Policy, Discourse and Data

Author: Nico Cloete

Author: Johann Mouton

Author: Charles Sheppard

Cape Town: African Minds, 2016

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331001

Worldwide, in Africa and in South Africa, the importance of the doctorate has increased disproportionately in relation to its share of the overall graduate output over the last decade. This heightened attention has not only been concerned with the traditional role of the PhD, namely the provision of a future supply of academics. Rather, it has focused on the increasingly important role that higher education – particularly high-level skills – is perceived to play in national development and the knowledge economy.

3.52 November 2015

3.52.1 Knowledge for a Sustainable World: A Southern African-Nordic contribution

Editor: Tor Halvorsen

Editor: Hilde Ibsen

Editor: Vyvienne M'kumbuzi

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2015

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331049

The search for answers to the issue of global sustainability has become increasingly urgent. In the context of higher education, many universities and academics are seeking new insights that can shift our dependence on ways of living that rely on the exploitation of so many and the degradation of so much of our planet. This is the vision that drives SANORD and many of the researchers and institutions within its network. Although much of the research is on a relatively small scale, the vision is steadily gaining momentum, forging dynamic collaborations and pathways to new knowledge.The contributors to this book cover a variety of subject areas and offer fresh insights about chronically under-researched parts of the world. Others document and critically reflect on innovative approaches to cross-continental teaching and research collaborations. This book will be of interest to anyone involved in the transformation of higher education or the practicalities of cross-continental and cross-disciplinary academic collaboration. The Southern African-Nordic Centre (SANORD) is a network of higher education

institutions from Denmark, Finland, Iceland, Norway, Sweden, Botswana, Namibia, Malawi, South Africa, Zambia and Zimbabwe. Universities in the southern African and Nordic regions that are not yet members are encouraged to join.

3.53 October 2015

3.53.1 Boundaries of the Educational Imagination

Author: Wayne Hugo

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2015

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781928331018

The educational imagination is the capacity to think critically beyond our located, daily experiences of education. It breaks away from the immediacy of personal understanding by placing education within wider, deeper and longer contexts. Boundaries of the Educational Imagination develops the educational imagination by answering six questions:

1. What happens when we expand continuously outwards from one school to all the schools of the world?
2. What happens if we go inside a school and explore how its material equipment has changed over the past 300 years?
3. What is the smallest educational unit in our brain and how does it allow an almost infinite expansion of knowledge?
4. What is the highest level of individual development we can teach students to aspire towards?
5. What role does education play in a world that is producing more and more complex knowledge increasingly quickly?
6. How do small knowledge elements combine to produce increasingly complex knowledge forms?

3.54 May 2015

3.54.1 Twenty Years of Transformation in Gauteng 1994 to 2014: An Independent Review

Editor: Felix Maringe

Editor: Martin Prew

Cape Town: African Minds, 2015

https://doi.org/10.47622/9780621429152

Twenty Years of Education Transformation in Gauteng 1994 to 2014: An Independent Review presents a collection of 15 important essays on different aspects of education in Gauteng since the advent of democracy in 1994. These essays talk to what a provincial education department does and how and why it does these things – whether it be about policy, resourcing or implementing projects. Each essay is written by one or more specialist in the relevant focus area.

The book is written to be accessible to the general reader as well as being informative and an essential resource for the specialist reader. It sheds light on aspects of how a provincial department operates and why and with what consequences certain decisions have been made in education over the last 20 turbulent years, both nationally and provincially.

There has been no attempt to fit the book's chapters into a particular ideological or educational paradigm, and as a result the reader will find differing views on various aspects of the Gauteng Department of Education's present and past. We leave the reader to decide to what extent the GDE has fulfilled its educational mandate over the last 20 years.

3.54.2 Leadership and Management: Case Studies in Training in Higher Education in Africa

Editor: Johann Mouton

Editor: Lauren Wildschut

Cape Town: African Minds, 2015

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677893

Leadership and Management: Case Studies in Training in Higher Education in Africa

By Johann Mouton and Lauren Wildschut (eds)

There has been a resurgence of interest in training programmes for higher education leaders and management (HELM) at African universities in recent times. Although there have been a few cases of evaluation studies of such programmes in Africa, a more systematic review of the lessons learnt through these programmes has not been done.

This book aims to document and reflect on the learnings from intervention programmes at three African higher education councils. It is clear that university leaders face many leadership and management challenges. This is the starting point of the book. More specific questions that are addressed include:

Have the challenges for leadership in higher education management been documented: Not only the shifts in education but the challenges and how leaders at universities have responded to them?

There has been an increase in the number of interventions but little evidence of lessons learnt. What lessons have we learnt from the three training programmes?

The book commences with an introduction that sets the historical context for this initiative. The remainder of the book is divided into three main parts:

Part One consists of two chapters: A review of African scholarship on university leadership and management and the history and landscape of HELM training in Africa.

Part Two presents the 'documentation and lessons learnt' from the three country initiatives.

Part Three consists of two chapters: the first describes in detail the monitoring and evaluation process that ran concurrently with the implementation of the country training programmes; the second reviews the uptake and impact of these programmes.

The following stakeholder groupings will find the book useful: HE councils (especially in Africa) and other bodies that are in the business of designing and implementing interventions; senior leadership and management at African universities; international donor agencies and other agencies; and evaluators and scholars in the field of higher education.

3.55 March 2015

3.55.1 Knowledge Production and Contradictory Functions in African Higher Education

Editor: Nico Cloete

Editor: Peter Maassen

Editor: Tracy Bailey

Cape Town: African Minds, 2015

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677855

Currently, Africa has more than half of the 20 fastest-growing economies in the world, which has contributed to what has been called the era of 'Africa Rising' or a 'New Africa'. In order to further strengthen socio-economic development, African universities need to improve their ability to produce and apply knowledge in effective and relevant ways. In OECD countries there are several public and private sites for knowledge production, but in Africa the university is the only knowledge institution, and hardly any knowledge is produced outside of the university.

However, the performance of African universities in knowledge production has not been impressive. It has generally been acknowledged by agencies such as the African Observatory for Science, Technology and Innovation and the World Bank, as well as leading development scholars, that African universities are lagging behind the rest of the world in their knowledge production function. There has been only weak empirical evidence on the actual performance of universities, with virtually no cross-institutional and cross-country comparative research on the factors that are responsible for the poor performance of universities in knowledge production across the continent.

The crossroads African universities are facing consist of, on the one hand, a familiar path of relative decoupling between the university and its nation's socio-economic development and, on the other hand, a path that requires far-reaching changes that could make it possible for the African university to connect much more productively to the main actors in emerging national (and in some cases regional) development and innovation networks. For the latter path to become accessible, these universities and their national authorities need research-rooted information.

3.56 December 2014

3.56.1 A Comprehensive Review of Methods for the Channel Allocation Problem

Author: Jayrani Cheenebash

Author: Harry Coomar Shumsher Rughooputh

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677534

The study of the channel allocation problem has received much attention during the last decade. Several techniques such as genetic algorithm, artificial neural network, simulated annealing, tabu search and others have been used. This book is devoted to compiling all the techniques that have been used to solve the channel allocation problem. Each of the methods is described fully in a manner that explains the essential parts of how the techniques are formulated and applied in solving the problem. This textbook will be helpful to students studying communications or researchers as it compiles all the techniques used since this problem was first solved.

3.57 October 2014

3.57.1 Higher Education in Portuguese Speaking African Countries

Author: Patrício Langa

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677039

This publication is the result of a baseline study of the state of the higher education systems in the five Portuguese speaking countries in Africa (PALOP): Angola, Cape Verde, Guinea-Bissau, Mozambique and Sao Tome and Principe. The project was undertaken by an African international expert in the field of higher education studies and was fully sponsored and supported by the Association for the Development of Education in Africa (ADEA). The report offers a historical overview of the development of higher education in PALOP from colonial times to the present. The main objective of this baseline study is to map the landscape and dynamics of change in the higher education systems of PALOP countries. It focuses on describing the latest developments of trends of expansion, financing, governance and policy reforms closely linked to the development of higher education systems in these countries. Furthermore, the study will facilitate an informed debate and the dissemination of knowledge on the role of higher education for development in Africa.

3.58 June 2014

3.58.1 Confronting Exclusion: 2013 Transformation Audit

Editor: Jan Hofmeyr

Cape Town: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677428

South Africa has made important political strides over the past two decades. It has created a framework of democratic legislative, executive and judicial institutions that mark a clear break from the apartheid past. In theory, they are inclusive and offer every citizen equal access to constitutionally protected rights. Their capacity to deliver, however, is coming under increasing pressure and, as this happens, citizen confidence in their efficacy is waning.

Much of the pressure, which ultimately may affect their legitimacy in the eyes of ordinary citizens, stems from the desperation and sense of economic exclusion experienced by those who find themselves at the wrong end of South Africa's grossly unequal society. If this decline in trust persists, the cohesive effects of the country's democratic institutions will diminish, and instability will become an increasingly common feature of political contestation.

3.58.2 Systemic School Improvement Interventions in South Africa: Some Practical Lessons from Development Practioners

Editor: Godwin Khosa

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677374

Looking at two smaller-scale systemic school improvement projects implemented in selected district circuits in the North West and Eastern Cape by partnerships between government, JET Education Services, and private sector organisations, this book captures and reflects on the experiences of the practitioners involved. The Systemic School Improvement Model developed by JET to address an identified range of interconnected challenges at district, school, classroom and household level, is made up of seven components. In reflecting on what worked and what did not in the implementation of these different components, the different chapters set out some of the practical lessons learnt, which could be used to improve the design and implementation of similar education improvement projects. Many of the lessons in this field that remain under-recorded to date relate to the step-by-step processes followed, the relationship dynamics encountered at different levels of the education system, and the local realities confronting schools and districts in South Africa's rural areas. Drawing on field data that is often not available to researchers, the book endeavours to address this gap and record these lessons. It is not intended to provide an academic review of the systemic school improvement projects. It is presented rather to offer other development practitioners working to improve the quality of education in South African schools, an understanding of some of the real practical and logistical challenges that arise and how these may be resolved to take further school improvement projects forward at a wider district, provincial and national scale.

3.58.3 Perspectives on Students Affairs

Editor: McGlory Speckman

Editor: Martin Mandew

Foreword by: Ahmed Bawa

Cape Town: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677442

The goal of Perspectives on Student Affairs in South Africa is to generate interest in student affairs in South Africa. The papers contained herein are based on best practice, local experience and well-researched international and local theories.

The papers in this book deal with matters pertaining to international and national trends in student affairs: academic development, access and retention, counselling, and material

support for students coming from disadvantaged backgrounds. They are linked to national and international developments, as described in the first two papers.

This publication will assist both young and experienced practitioners as they grow into their task of developing the students entrusted to them.

All contributors are South Africans with a great deal of experience in student affairs, and all are committed to the advancement of student affairs in South Africa. The editors are former heads of student affairs portfolios at two leading South African universities.

3.59 May 2014

3.59.1 Seeking Impact and Visibility: Scholarly Communication in Southern Africa

Author: Henry Trotter

Author: Catherine Kell

Author: Michelle Willmers

Author: Eve Gray

Author: Thomas King

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677510

African scholarly research is relatively invisible globally because even though research production on the continent is growing in absolute terms, it is falling in comparative terms. In addition, traditional metrics of visibility, such as the Impact Factor, fail to make legible all African scholarly production. Many African universities also do not take a strategic approach to scholarly communication to broaden the reach of their scholars'work. To address this challenge, the Scholarly Communication in Africa Programme (SCAP) was established to help raise the visibility of African scholarship by mapping current research and communication practices in Southern African universities and by recommending and piloting technical and administrative innovations based on open access dissemination principles. To do this, SCAP conducted extensive research in four faculties at the Universities of Botswana, Cape Town, Mauritius and Namibia.

3.59.2 Driving Change: The Story of the South Africa Norway Tertiary Education Development Programme

Editor: Trish Gibbon

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2014

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920677435

Driving Change tells a story that exemplifies a basic law of physics, known to all the application of a relatively small lever can shift weight, create movement and initiate change far in excess of its own size.

It tells a story about a particular instance of development co-operation, relatively modest in scope and aim that has nonetheless achieved remarkable things and has been held up as an exemplar of its kind.

It does not tell a story of flawless execution and perfectly achieved outcomes: it is instead a narrative that gives some insight into the structural and organisational arrangements, the institutional and individual commitments, and above all, the work, intelligence and passion of its participants, which made the South Africa Norway Tertiary Education Development (SANTED) Programme a noteworthy success.

3.60 November 2013

3.60.1 Trading Places: Accessing Land in African Cities

Editor: Mark Napier

Editor: Stephen Berrisford

Editor: Caroline Kihato

Editor: Rod McGaffin

Editor: Lauren Royston

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2013

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920489991

Trading Places is about urban land markets in African cities. It explores how local practice, land governance and markets interact to shape the ways that people at society's margins access land to build their livelihoods. The authors argue that the problem is not with markets per se, but in the unequal ways in which market access is structured. They make the case for more equal access to urban land markets, not only for ethical reasons, but because it makes economic sense for growing cities and towns. If we are to have any chance of understanding

and intervening in predominantly poor and very unequal African cities, we need to see land and markets differently. New migrants to the city and communities living in slums are as much a part of the real estate market as anyone else; they're just not registered or officially recognised. This book highlights the land practices of those living on the city's margins, and explores the nature and character of their participation in the urban land market. It details how the urban poor access, hold and trade land in the city, and how local practices shape the city, and reconfigures how we understand land markets in rapidly urbanising contexts. Rather than developing new policies which aim to supply land and housing formally but with little effect on the scale of the need, it advocates an alternative approach which recognises the local practices that already exist in land access and management. In this way, the agency of the poor is strengthened, and households and communities are better able to integrate into urban economies.

3.61 May 2013

3.61.1 The Origins of War in Mozambique: A History of Unity and Division

Author: Sayaka Funada-Classen

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2013

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920489977

The independence of Mozambique in 1975 and its decolonisation process attracted worldwide attention as a successful example of national unity. Yet, the armed conflict that broke out between the government and the guerrilla force in 1977 lasted for sixteen years and resulted in over a million deaths and several million refugees, placing this concept of national unity into doubt. For nearly twenty years, Sayaka Funada-Classen interviewed people in rural communities in Mozambique. By examining their testimonies, historical documents, previous studies, international and regional politics, and the changes that various interventions under colonialism brought to the traditional social structure, this book demonstrates that the seeds of division had already been planted while the liberation movement was seeking unity in the struggle years. Presenting a comprehensive history of contemporary Mozambique, this book is indispensable for Mozambican scholars. It promises to serve as a landmark study not only for historians and the scholars of African studies but also for those who give serious consideration to the problems of conflict and peace in the world.

3.61.2 Sounding the Cape: Music, Identity and Politics in South Africa

Author: Denis-Constant Martin

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2013

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920489823

For several centuries Cape Town has accommodated a great variety of musical genres which have usually been associated with specific population groups living in and around the city. Musical styles and genres produced in Cape Town have therefore been assigned an ìidentityî which is first and foremost social. This volume tries to question the relationship established between musical styles and genres, and social –in this case pseudo-racial –identities.

In Sounding the Cape, Denis-Constant Martin recomposes and examines through the theoretical prism of creolisation the history of music in Cape Town, deploying analytical tools borrowed from the most recent studies of identity configurations. He demonstrates that musical creation in the Mother City, and in South Africa, has always been nurtured by contacts, exchanges and innovations whatever the efforts made by racist powers to separate and divide people according to their origin. Musicians interviewed at the dawn of the 21st century confirm that mixture and blending characterise all Cape Town's musics. They also emphasise the importance of a rhythmic pattern particular to Cape Town, the ghoema beat, whose origins are obviously mixed. The study of music demonstrates that the history of Cape Town, and of South Africa as a whole, undeniably fostered creole societies. Yet, twenty years after the collapse of apartheid, these societies are still divided along lines that combine economic factors and 'racial'categorisations.

Martin concludes that, were music given a greater importance in educational and cultural policies, it could contribute to fighting these divisions and promote the notion of a nation that, in spite of the violence of racism and apartheid, has managed to invent a unique common culture.

3.62 August 2012

3.62.1 Public Broadcasting in Africa Series: Nigeria

Author: Akin Akingbulu

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920489007

This report on the broadcast media in Nigeria finds that liberalisation efforts in the broadcasting sector have only been partially achieved. More than a decade after military rule, the nation still has not managed to enact media legislation that is in line with continental standards, particularly the Declaration on Freedom of Expression in Africa. The report, part of an 11-country survey of broadcast media in Africa, strongly recommends the transformation of the two state broadcasters into a genuine public broadcaster as an independent legal entity with editorial independence and strong safeguards against any interference from the federal government, state governments and other interests.

3.62.2 Towards a People-Driven African Union: Current Obstacles and New Opportunities

Editor: AfriMAP

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920051839

This report is the first independent, substantive and public assessment of the progress of the African Union. Towards a People-Driven African Union: Current Obstacles and New Opportunities analyses the preparations of African Union member-states, the AU Commission and civil society organisations for the twice-yearly AU summits. The main finding is that despite some welcome new opportunities for participation, the African Union's vision of 'an Africa driven by its own citizens' remains largely unfulfilled. Detailed recommendations are offered to help deliver on this vision in future. Published by AFRODAD, AfriMAP and Oxfam, this report is endorsed by more than a dozen other organisations in Africa and elsewhere, and is based on interviews with more than 50 representatives of member-states, the AU Commission and civil society organisations in eleven African countries.

3.62.3 Public Broadcasting in Africa Series: Zimbabwe

Author: Sarah Chiumbu

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355265

This report is the result of research that started in 2008 with the aim of collecting, collating and writing up information about regulation, ownership, access, performance as well as prospects for public broadcasting reform in Africa. The Zimbabwe report is part of an 11-country survey of African broadcast media, evaluating compliance with the agreements, conventions, charters and declarations regarding media that have been developed at regional and continental levels in Africa.

3.62.4 Public Broadcasting in Africa Series: Uganda

Author: George Lugalambi

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355401

Uganda's broadcast media landscape has witnessed tremendous growth in recent years. While the public broadcaster remains the dominant national player - in terms of reach - in both radio and television, commercial broadcasters have introduced a substantial level of diversity in the

industry. Public broadcasting faces serious competition from the numerous private and independent broadcasters, especially in and around the capital Kampala and major urban centres. In fact, the private/commercial sector clearly dominates the industry in most respects, notably productivity and profitability. The public broadcaster, which enjoys wider geographical coverage, faces the challenge of trying to fulfill a broad mandate with little funding. This makes it difficult for UBC to compete with the more nimble operators in the commercial/private sector. Overall, there appears to be a healthy degree of pluralism and diversity in terms of ownership.

3.63 July 2012

3.63.1 Citizenship Law in Africa: A Comparative Study (2nd edition)

Author: Bronwyn Manby

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781936133291

Few African countries provide for an explicit right to a nationality. Laws and practices governing citizenship effectively leave hundreds of thousands of people in Africa without a country. These stateless Africans can neither vote nor stand for office; they cannot enrol their children in school, travel freely, or own property; they cannot work for the government; they are exposed to human rights abuses.

Statelessness exacerbates and underlies tensions in many regions of the continent.

Citizenship Law in Africa, a comparative study by two programs of the Open Society Foundations, describes the often arbitrary, discriminatory, and contradictory citizenship laws that exist from state to state and recommends ways that African countries can bring their citizenship laws in line with international rights norms.

The report covers topics such as citizenship by descent, citizenship by naturalisation, gender discrimination in citizenship law, dual citizenship, and the right to identity documents and passports.

It is essential reading for policymakers, attorneys, and activists.

This second edition includes updates on developments in Kenya, Libya, Namibia, South Africa, Sudan and Zimbabwe, as well as minor corrections to the tables and other additions throughout.

3.64 May 2012

3.64.1 Dick Fehnel: Lessons from Graver's School

Author: Richard Fehnel

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355043

Dick Fehnel worked as higher education consultant for World Bank, Ford Foundation and the Human Sciences Research Council. He held the positions of acting representative (1998–1999) and programme officer (1993–2000) for the Ford Foundation, Southern Africa, after which he semi-retired to Portland Oregon, and continued to travel and consult until his death in May 2006.

3.64.2 Hijab: Unveiling Queer Muslim Lives

Author: The Inner Circle

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355203

Hijab: Unveiling Queer Muslim Lives is the first known collection of South African Muslim stories relating to Islam and sexual diversity. This anthology shares real life stories of people that have struggled, or may still be struggling, to reconcile their spirituality and their sexuality. These are stories that illustrate the oneness of being and reflect on how some interpretations of the scriptures may alienate others. Although the collection focuses predominantly on Muslim stories, it is universal in its approach in dealing with spirituality rather than religion.

3.64.3 Beyond Memory: Recording the History, Moments and Memories of South African Music

Author: Sello Galane

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920299286

South Africa possesses one of the richest popular music traditions in the world – from marabi to mbaqanga, from boeremusiek to bubblegum, from kwela to kwaito. Yet the risk that future generations of South Africans will not know their musical roots is very real. Of all the recordings made here since the 1930s, thousands have been lost for ever, for the powers-that-be never deemed them worthy of preservation. And if one peruses the books that exist on

South African popular music, one still finds that their authors have on occasion jumped to conclusions that were not as foregone as they had assumed. Yet the fault lies not with them, rather in the fact that there has been precious little documentation in South Africa of who played what, or who recorded what, with whom, and when. This is true of all music-making in this country, though it is most striking in the musics of the black communities.

3.64.4 The University in Africa and Democratic Citizenship: Hothouse or Training Ground?

Author: Thierry Luescher-Mamashela

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355678

Whether and how higher education in Africa contributes to democratisation beyond producing the professionals that are necessary for developing and sustaining a modern political system, remains an unresolved question. This report, then, represents an attempt to address the question of whether there are university specific mechanisms or pathways by which higher education contributes to the development of democratic attitudes and behaviours among students, and how these mechanisms operate and relate to politics both on and off campus. The research contained in this report shows that the potential of a university to act as training ground for democratic citizenship is best realised by supporting students' exercise of democratic leadership on campus. This, in turn, develops and fosters democratic leadership in civil society. Thus, the university's response to student political activity, student representation in university governance and other aspects of extra-curricular student life needs to be examined for ways in which African universities can instil and support democratic values and practices. Encouraging and facilitating student leadership in various forms of on-campus political activity and in a range of student organisations emerges as one of the most promising ways in which African universities can act as training grounds for democratic citizenship. The project on which this report is based forms part of a larger study on Higher Education and Democracy in Africa, undertaken by the Higher Education Research and Advocacy Network in Africa (HERANA). HERANA is coordinated by the Centre for Higher Education Transformation in South Africa.

3.64.5 Reflections on Identity in Four African Cities

Editor: Simon Bekker

Editor: Anne Leilde

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781067253752

Identity has become the watchword of our times. In sub-Saharan Africa, this certainly appears to be true and for particular reasons. Africa is urbanising rapidly, cross-border migration streams are swelling and globalising influences sweep across the continent. Africa is also facing up to the challenge of nurturing emergent democracies in which citizens often feel torn between older traditional and newer national loyalties. Accordingly, collective identities are deeply coloured by recent urban as well as international experience and are squarely located within identity politics where reconciliation is required between state nation-building strategies and sub-national affiliations. They are also fundamentally shaped by the growing inequality and the poverty found on this continent. These themes are explored by an international set of scholars in two South African and two Francophone cities. The relative importance to urban residents of race, class and ethnicity but also of work, space and language are compared in these cities. This volume also includes a chapter investigating the emergence of a continental African identity. A recent report of the Office of the South African President claims that a strong national identity is emerging among its citizens, and that race and ethnicity are waning whilst a class identity is in the ascendance. The evidence and analyses within this volume serve to gauge the extent to which such claims ring true, in what everyone knows is a much more complex and shifting terrain of shared meanings than can ever be captured by such generalisations.

3.64.6 Linking Higher Education and Economic Development: Implications For Africa From Three Successful Systems

Author: Pundy Pillay

Cape Town: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355449

Finland, South Korea and the state of North Carolina in the United States are three systems that successfully have harnessed higher education in their economic development initiatives. Common to the success of the all these systems is, amongst others, the link between economic and education planning, quality public schooling, high tertiary participation rates with institutional differentiation, labour market demand, cooperation and networks, and consensus about the importance of higher education for development.

3.64.7 Higher Education Financing in East and Southern Africa

Editor: Pundy Pillay

Cape Town, South Africa: African Minds, 2012

https://doi.org/10.47622/9781920355333

This nine-country study of higher education financing in Africa includes three East African states (Kenya, Tanzania and Uganda), five countries in southern Africa (Botswana, Lesotho, Mozambique, Namibia and South Africa), and an Indian Ocean island state (Mauritius). Higher Education Financing in East and Southern Africa explores trends in financing policies, paying particular attention to the nature and extent of public sector funding of higher education, the growth of private financing (including both household financing and the growth of private higher education institutions) and the changing mix of financing instruments that these countries are developing in response to public sector financial constraints. This unique collection of African-country case studies draws attention to the remaining challenges around the financing of higher education in Africa, but also identifies good practices, lessons and common themes.

4 Mattering Press

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Last updated: 2026-11-03 01:00:12

4.0.1 Homo Textor: Weaving As (Technical) Mode of Existence

Editor: Ellen Harlizius-Klück

Editor: Annapurna Mamidipudi

Editor: Giovanni Fanfani

Editor: Alex McLean

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729425

Homo Textor aims to exemplify how weaving as a (technical) mode of existence provides concepts that help to rethink Homo faber and the way the Moderns talk about technology. It shows weaving as histomorphism, a generative process where intelligible forms grow out of the loom-weaver-threads system

4.0.2 Predictions: Volume 1: From speculative ethnography to apocalyptic testimony

Editor: Mél Hogan

Editor: Stefan Laser

Editor: Edward Ongweso Jr.

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729463

We make Predictions as a gesture of hope that goes against the current momentums that trouble us: planetary harm, war, AI hype, viruses, despair. The authors assembled in this series critically and creatively engage with what this uncanniness feels like, and how it helps us to redirect our engagement.

4.1 September 2025

4.1.1 Technoscientific Globalisation from Below

Editor: Mathieu Quet

Editor: Koichi Kameda

Editor: Jessica Pourraz

Editor: Yves-Marie Rault-Chodankar

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.28938/mw20-c7f3

Global South populations, firms and governments play a key role in redefining the relationship between sciences, technologies and markets on an international scale. Forces shaping the future of global technoscience emerge from unexpected places, prompting a reassessment of global power processes. This volume contains rich case studies studying technoscientific globalization 'from below' drawn from fieldwork in Asia, Latin America and Africa, examining the interplay between technology, power, and society at the global scale. The cases are grounded in postcolonial Science and Technology Studies and address a range of topics including pharmaceutical markets, scientific developments and digital practices. This approach illuminates the multiple creative ways in which subaltern players appropriate, divert, overturn or bypass prevailing views on technology and market construction.

4.2 November 2023

4.2.1 The Ethnographic Case

Editor: Emily Yates-Doerr

Editor: Christine Labuski

Manchester: Mattering Press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729340

In 26 gripping and provocative installations, the new and updated volume showcases research from influential feminist and decolonial scholars. Where anthropology has long sought to identify patterns in culture, this volume makes space for inquiry focused on particularities and advocates for an intellectual politics where that which seemingly doesn't fit is still allowed to matter.

4.3 May 2022

4.3.1 Democratic Situations

Editor: Andreas Birkbak

Editor: Irina Papazu

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729302

Democratic Situations places the making and doing of democratic politics at the centre of relational research. The book turns the well-known sites of contemporary Euro-American democracy – elections, bureaucracies, public debates and citizen participation – into fluctuating democratic situations where supposedly untouchable democratic ideals are contested and warped in practice. The empirical cases demonstrate that democracy cannot be reduced to theoretical schemes of conflict, institutions or deliberation. Instead, they offer an urgently needed renewal of our understanding of democratic politics at a time when conventional ideas increasingly fail to capture current events such as Brexit, Trump and Covid19.

4.4 April 2022

4.4.1 Concealing for Freedom: The Making of Encryption, Secure Messaging and Digital Liberties

Author: Ksenia Ermoshina

Author: Francesca Musiani

Foreword by: Laura DeNardis

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729227

Concealing for Freedom: The Making of Encryption, Secure Messaging and Digital Liberties sets out to explore one of the core battlegrounds of Internet governance: the encryption of

online communications. Current debates around encryption have fundamental implications for our individual liberties and collective presence on the Internet. Encryption of communications at scale and in increasingly usable ways has become a matter of public concern, especially since Edward Snowden's 2013 revelations. A new cryptographic imaginary is taking hold, which sees encryption as a necessary precondition for the formation of networked publics. At the same time, there have been major evolutions and accelerations in the field of secure communications, prompted in part by the cryptography community's renewed efforts to create next-generation secure messaging protocols and applications. The book explores developers' actions and their interactions with other stakeholders, for instance users, security trainers, standardising bodies, and funding organizations. It also examines their interactions with the technical artifacts they develop, in which a core common objective is to create tools that "conceal for freedom" even as how this objective is met differs according to technical architectures, the user publics being targeted and the tools' underlying values and business models.

4.5 November 2021

4.5.1 Engineering the Climate: Science, Politics and Visions of Control

Author: Julia Schubert

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729265

Notions of the impending climate crisis have pushed a set of highly contested techno-scientific measures onto policy agendas around the world. Suggestions to deliberately alter, to engineer, the Earth's climate have gained political currency in recent years not as a positive vision of techno-scientific innovation, but as a daunting measure of last resort. The controversial status of various so-called climate engineering proposals raises a simple, yet pressing question: How has it has come to this? And, more specifically, how did such contested measures earn their place on policy agendas, despite enormous scientific complexities and fierce political contestation?

4.6 October 2021

4.6.1 With Microbes

Editor: Charlotte Brives

Author: Matthäus Rest

Editor: Salla Sariola

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729180

Without microbes, no other forms of life would be possible. But what does it mean to be with microbes? With Microbes sets microbes and the multiple ways they exist around, in and on humans at center stage. In this book, 24 social scientists and artists attune to microbes and describe their complicated relationships with humans and other beings. The book shows the multiplicity of these relationships and their dynamism, through detailed ethnographies of the relationships between humans, animals, plants, and microbes. Ethnographic explorations with fermented foods, waste, faecal matter, immunity, antimicrobial resistance, phages, as well as indigenous and scientific understandings of microbes challenge ideas of them being simple entities: not just pathogenic foes, old friends or good fermentation minions, but so much more. By describing these complex, dynamic, and ever-changing entanglements between humans and microbes, the chapters raise crucial points about how microbes are 'known' and how social scientists can study microbes with ethnographic methods, more often than not in the absence of microscopes, models, and computations. Following these various entanglements, the book tells how these relations transform both humans and microbes in the process.

4.6.2 Environmental Alterities

Editor: Cristóbal Bonelli

Editor: Antonia Walford

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729142

In the context of accelerating environmental crises and exhausted intellectual paradigms, this book asks what comes after 'after nature'. Instead of demanding new models and approaches, it invites its readers to look to the endpoints and failures of what is already known, in order to generate alternative forms of ethical engagement with worlds both on this planet, and beyond it. Drawing together scholarship from across science and technology studies, philosophy, and anthropology and bringing it into conversation with rich ethnographic and empirical material, the book asks how we might potentialise the contradictions and oppositions of critical social scientific thinking in order to develop a mode of paradoxical engagement that is in constant movement between knowledge and its edges, practices and their limits, and which allows us to relate to that which is excessive to relations and relationality.

4.7 August 2021

4.7.1 Sensing In/Security: Sensors as Transnational Security Infrastructures

Editor: Nina Klimburg-Witjes

Editor: Nikolaus Poechhacker

Editor: Geoffrey C. Bowker

Foreword by: Lucy Suchman

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729111

Sensing In/Security: Sensors as Transnational Security Infrastructures investigates how sensors and sensing practices enact regimes of security and insecurity. It extends long-standing concerns with infrastructuring to emergent modes of surveillance and control by exploring how digitally networked sensors shape securitisation practices. Contributions in this volume examine how sensing devices gain political and epistemic relevance in various forms of in/security, from border control, regulation, and epidemiological tracking, to aerial surveillance and hacking. Instead of focusing on specific sensory devices and their consequences, this volume explores the complex and sometimes invisible political, cultural and ethical processes of infrastructuring in/security.

4.8 May 2021

4.8.1 Energy Worlds in Experiment

Editor: James Maguire

Editor: Laura Watts

Editor: Brit Ross Winthereik

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729098

Energy Worlds in Experiment is an experiment in writing about energy and an exploration of energy infrastructures as experiments. Twenty authors have written collaborative chapters that examine energy politics and practices, from electricity cables and energy monitors to swamps and estuaries.

4.9 August 2020

4.9.1 Boxes: A Field Guide

Editor: Susanne Bauer

Editor: Martina Schlünder

Editor: Maria Rentetzi

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.28938/9781912729012

A book full of boxes. A box in itself. An unboxing. This book explores boxes in their broadest sense and size. It invites us to step into the field, unravel how and why things are contained and how it might be otherwise. By turning the focus of Science and Technology Studies (STS) to boxing practices, this collation of essays examines boxes as world-making devices.

4.10 September 2018

4.10.1 Energy Babble

Author: Andy Boucher

Author: Bill Gaver

Author: Tobie Kerridge

Author: Mike Michael

Author: Katherine Moline

Author: Liliana Ovalle

Author: Matthew Plummer-Fernandez

Author: Alex Wilkie

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780995527720

This is the story of a set of computational devices called Energy Babbles. The product of a collaboration between designers and STS researchers, Energy Babbles are like automated talk radios obsessed with energy. Synthesised voices, punctuated by occasional jingles, recount

energy policy announcements, remarks about energy conservation made on social media, information about current energy demand and production, and comments entered by other Babble users.

Developed for members of UK community groups working to promote sustainable energy practices, the Energy Babbles were designed to reflect the complex situations they navigate, to provide information and encourage communication, and to help shed light on their engagements with energy policy and practice. This book tells the story of the Babbles from a mix of design and STS perspectives, suggesting how design may benefit from the perspectives of STS, and how STS may take an interventionist, design-led approach to the study of emerging technological issues.

4.11 July 2018

4.11.1 Ghost-Managed Medicine: Big Pharma's Invisible Hands

Author: Sergio Sismondo

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780995527775

Ghost-Managed Medicine by Sergio Sismondo explores a spectral side of medical knowledge, based in pharmaceutical industry tactics and practices.

4.11.2 An Anthropology of Common Ground: Awkward Encounters in Heritage Work

Author: Nathalia Brichet

Manchester: Mattering Press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780995527799

Paying attention to details and 'small stories' as that which make worlds (heritage projects as well as ethnography), the book proposes a kind of postcolonial scholarship. Rather than uncovering or building up one story about the Danish-Ghanaian past, the work insists on providing 'inconclusive' analyses, collaboratively generated in the course of the project work and in the process of writing ethnographically about it. The ambition is to nurture fieldwork as an opportunity for creating a common ground, on which to think about what heritage and ethnography could be. Common ground, then, is not only an ideal of the joint heritage project, but an expression of an anthropological ambition. In consequence, the book is an account of a particular ethnographic research project – the 'methods story' being about how post-colonial relations might be noticed and supported and about how empirical research is done as relations

between what is going on in the field and the way that the ethnographer chooses to tell the story of the field in the text.

4.11.3 Inventing the Social

Editor: Noortje Marres

Editor: Michael Guggenheim

Editor: Alex Wilkie

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780995527768

Inventing the Social, edited by Noortje Marres, Michael Guggenheim and Alex Wilkie, showcases recent efforts to develop new ways of knowing society that combine social research with creative practice. With contributions from leading figures in sociology, architecture, geography, design, anthropology, and digital media, the book provides practical and conceptual pointers on how to move beyond the customary distinctions between knowledge and art, and on how to connect the doing, researching and making of social life in potentially new ways.

Presenting concrete projects with a creative approach to researching social life as well as reflections on the wider contexts from which these projects emerge, this collection shows how collaboration across social science, digital media and the arts opens up timely alternatives to narrow, instrumentalist proposals that seek to engineer behaviour and to design community from scratch. To invent the social is to recognise that social life is always already creative in itself and to take this as a starting point for developing different ways of combining representation and intervention in social life.

4.12 January 2017

4.12.1 The Ethnographic Case

Editor: Emily Yates-Doerr

Editor: Christine Labuski

https://doi.org/10.28938/995527744

The Ethnographic Case challenges a widespread academic inclination to treat concepts as immutable mobiles. The contributions to this volume develop “ethnographic casing” as a technique of attending to heterogeneities in systems of thought. Medical cases. Legal cases. Briefcases. Detective cases. Some cases featured are violent, others compassionate; some set stereotypes in motion, others break them down. Connected more by difference than similarity,

the "cases" in this volume make a case for the virtue of relational science. This is a science that is not beholden to the masters' narratives, but which embraces the double-work of caring for detail, while caring for the practices through which one learns to care. In 26 gripping and provocative installations, the volume showcases research from numerous influential feminist and decolonial scholars. Where anthropology has long sought to identify patterns in culture, this volume makes space for inquiry focused on particularities and advocates for an intellectual politics where that which doesn't fit is still allowed to matter.

4.13 July 2016

4.13.1 On Curiosity: The Art of Market Seduction

Author: Frank Cochoy

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2016

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780995527706

What draws us towards a shop window display? What drives us to grab a special offer, to enter the privileged circle of premium newspaper subscribers, to peruse the pages of an enticing magazine? Without doubt, it is curiosity — that essential force of everyday action which invites us to break from our habits and to become transported beyond our very selves.

Curiosity (whether healthy or unhealthy) is one of the favourite tricks of market seduction. Capturing a public — attracting the attention of a reader, seducing a customer, meeting the expectations of a user, persuading a voter … — often requires the construction of a set of technical devices that can play upon people's inner motivations.

4.13.2 Imagining Classrooms: Stories of children, teaching, and ethnography

Author: Vicki Macknight

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2016

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780993144967

In this book we go to five Australian classrooms, bustling with nine- and ten-year-old children. In each classroom, imaginations are being done, not just in minds, but with bodies too, using materials and words, laughter and ideas. Each classroom is part of a different type of school: a Waldorf/Steiner school, an exclusive private school, a middle-class government school, a diverse catholic school, and a school for intellectually disabled 'special' children. And at these five schools, we see imagination being done — to represent, to transform, to empathise, to work with others, and to think.

The book's characters are children and teachers, with teachers working through the school day to give children the skills they will need to think, to think with and about others, and to be creative. What we notice are habits of imagining being instilled and these range from getting children to close their eyes and imagine accurate representations, through to getting them to imagine how others feel, to getting children to make new connections between thoughts and feelings. We wonder about the implications of these habits for good knowing and good doing.

At the same time, the book shines a critical lens onto the imaginative practices of ethnographers and participant-observers, to help us think about how we define, how we class, and how we analyse our data. Ethnographers, too, have habits of imagining, representing, empathising, and connecting, and noticing these habits can help us do them better. How are academic practices both material and imaginative? How might we make sure our work is both as accurate and as ethical as possible? Macknight argues that imagination is not just something hidden in minds — it is something we do. This, then, is a book about how to do imagination better for thinking, for making, and for living together.

4.13.3 Modes of Knowing: Resources from the Baroque

Editor: John Law

Editor: Evelyn Ruppert

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2016

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780993144981

How might we think differently? This book is an attempt to respond to this question. Its contributors are all interested in non-standard modes of knowing. They are all more or less uneasy with the restrictions or the agendas implied by academic modes of knowing, and they have chosen to do this by working with, through, or against one important Western alternative — that of the baroque.

4.13.4 Practising Comparison: Logics, Relations, Collaborations

Editor: Joe Deville

Editor: Michael Guggenheim

Editor: Zuzana Hrdličková

Manchester, UK: Mattering Press, 2016

https://doi.org/10.28938/9780993144943

This book compares things, objects, concepts, and ideas. It is also about the practical acts of doing comparison. Comparison is not something that exists in the world, but a particular kind of activity.

Agents of various kinds compare by placing things next to one another, by using software programs and other tools, and by simply looking in certain ways. Comparing like this is an everyday practice. But in the social sciences, comparing often becomes more burdensome, more complex, and more questions are asked of it.

How, then, do social scientists compare? What role do funders, their tools, and databases play in social scientific comparisons? Which sorts of objects do they choose to compare and how do they decide which comparisons are meaningful? Doing comparison in the social sciences, it emerges, is a practice weighed down by a history in which comparison was seen as problematic. As it plays out in the present, this history encounters a range of other agents also involved in doing comparison who may challenge the comparisons of social scientists themselves.

5 mediastudies.press

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5.0.1 Mobile Personalization: The History and Theory of Mobile Streaming Media

Author: Justin Grandinetti

Author: Charles Ecenbarger

https://doi.org/10.64629/pf8605cb.10dcf8f3

People were watching and listening on the move long before the iPhone's launch. The world of always-on streaming, accessible anywhere, has a pre-history: magic lanterns, drive-in theaters, and portable radios. In *Mobile Personalization*, Justin Grandinetti and Charlie Ecenbarger place Netflix, YouTube, Spotify, TikTok, and other corporate claimants in a lineage that includes the build-out of sprawling, invisible infrastructures—undersea cables, server farms, and adtech. These "architectures of mobility," together with their Silicon Valley underwriters, make seamless, algorithmic streams possible and profitable. The upshot is an evolving regime of mobile personalization, with entertainment for consumers and data-driven monetization for companies. *Mobile Personalization* recasts foundational ideas from Raymond Williams, including "flow" and "mobile privatization," to account for the algorithmic delivery of targeted video and audio to lucrative audiences. As this important new book argues, the mobile streamers have delivered convenience, but also audience fragmentation and behavioral capture.

5.1 July 2026

5.1.1 Communication Conduct in an Island Community

Author: Erving Goffman

Introduction by: Yves Winkin

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.baaa50ag

A republication of Erving Goffman's landmark 1953 dissertation, with a new introduction by Yves Winkin.

5.2 February 2026

5.2.1 From Erving to Goffman: A Work in Performance?

Author: Yves Winkin

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.e3d5966c

Yves Winkin's From Erving to Goffman, translated from the French, is an elegantly written and deeply informed account of the sociologist's life, by one of the world's leading Goffman scholars.

5.3 January 2026

5.3.1 Defund Culture: A Radical Proposal

Author: Gary Hall

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.67ab11w2

Defund Culture interrogates the structural inequalities embedded in Britain's cultural institutions, arguing that meaningful transformation requires not just expanding access, but redistributing resources away from elite structures toward more pluralistic, decolonial alternatives.

5.4 October 2025

5.4.1 From the Chilean Laboratory to World-Communication: Armand Mattelart's Intellectual Journey

Author: Mariano Zarowsky

Translator: William Quinn

Translator: Peter Simonson

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.08e7ds72

From the Chilean Laboratory to World-Communication follows Armand Mattelart's intellectual trajectory through Cold War geopolitics and the rise of critical communication studies in Latin America and Europe.

5.5 August 2025

5.5.1 Mapping Goffman's Invisible College

Author: Wendy Leeds-Hurwitz

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.64629/3f8575cb.dwb73w6d

Mapping Goffman's Invisible College offers new insight into how academic communities take shape and how ideas move through informal networks.

5.6 December 2024

5.6.1 Early Media Effects Theory & the Suggestion Doctrine: Selected Readings, 1895–1935

Editor: Patrick Parsons

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.f1e0489e

Early Media Effects Theory & the Suggestion Doctrine: Selected Readings, 1895–1935 consists of over 30 public domain works originally publishing from the late 19th century to the mid-1930s on the concept of "suggestion"

5.7 November 2023

5.7.1 Killer Fandom: Fan Studies and the Celebrity Serial Killer

Author: Judith May Fathallah

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.c2702120

Killer Fandom, in the first long-form treatment, examines serial killer fandom through the lens of textual poaching, affective community, subcultural capital, and play—with close readings of fan posts, comments, and mashups on Tumblr, TikTok, and YouTube.

5.8 July 2023

5.8.1 Franklin Ford Collection

Editor: Dominique Trudel

Editor: Juliette De Maeyer

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.80aee30a

The Franklin Ford Collection, curated and introduced by Dominique Trudel and Juliette De Maeyer, includes letters, leaflets, editorials, and treatises by the American journalist Franklin Ford (1849–1918).

5.9 January 2023

5.9.1 Creativity: Process and Personality

Author: Larry Gross

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.60b97b6f

Creativity: Process and Personality, a 1964 thesis published for the first time, features interviews on creativity with prominent psychologists, including B. F. Skinner, Herbert Simon, Abraham Maslow, David McClelland, Jerome Bruner, and Milton Rokeach.

5.10 December 2022

5.10.1 Communication Conduct in an Island Community

Author: Erving Goffman

Introduction by: Yves Winkin

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.baaa50af

Erving Goffman's 1953 dissertation, published here for the first time on the hundredth anniversary of his birth.

5.11 April 2022

5.11.1 What Was Artificial Intelligence?

Author: Sue Curry Jansen

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.0cc62523

Sue Curry Jansen's classic critique of AI rhetoric, republished open access with a new introduction by Jansen.

5.12 July 2021

5.12.1 Social Media & the Self: An Open Reader

Editor: Jefferson Pooley

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.1fc3f80a

A web-only reader on social media and the self, selected and ordered with university courses in mind. Each of its component works already carries an open access license, or—in the case of copyrighted items—links to a web version. With a preface and introduction by Jefferson Pooley.

5.13 November 2020

5.13.1 Liberty and the News

Author: Walter Lippmann

Introduction by: Sue Curry Jansen

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.32376/3f8575cb.2e69e142

Published a century ago as the young Walter Lippmann's fifth book, the slim volume merits a fresh read in our post-truth moment. Republished in this mediastudies.press edition with a new introduction by Sue Curry Jansen.

5.14 October 2020

5.14.1 Our Master's Voice: Advertising

Author: James Rorty

Introduction by: Jefferson Pooley

Bethlehem, PA: mediastudies.press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.21428/3f8575cb.dbba9917

"I was an ad-man once," James Rorty writes in this classic dissection of the advertising industry. A neglected masterpiece, the book is republished in this mediastudies.press edition with a new introduction by Jefferson Pooley.

6 meson press

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Author: Katia Schwerzmann

https://doi.org/10.14619/2423

Digitale Medien sind heute weniger Werkzeuge der Produktion als Systeme der Anpassung. Unter dem Begriff des Customizing bündeln sich Praktiken der Personalisierung, Konfiguration und kuratierten Auswahl, die Wahrnehmung, Handlung und Subjektivität grundlegend verändern. Was als individuelle Passung und Selbstermächtigung erscheint, geht mit neuen Formen der Vorstrukturierung, Normierung und algorithmischen Steuerung einher.Das Internationale Jahrbuch für Medienphilosophie und Medienästhetik nimmt Customizing als zentrale Kategorie gegenwärtiger Medienkulturen in den Blick. Die Beiträge untersuchen, wie sich ästhetische Erfahrung, epistemische Ordnung und soziale Öffentlichkeit unter Bedingungen datenbasierter und KI-gestützter Medien verschieben. Im Zentrum steht dabei die Ambivalenz zwischen Autonomie und Abhängigkeit, Sorge und Kontrolle, Singularisierung und dem Verlust gemeinsamer Horizonte. Der Band versteht Customizing nicht als bloßes technisches Feature, sondern als medienphilosophisches Problem von grundsätzlicher Tragweite.

6.1 July 2026

6.1.1 Distributed Productivities: Digital Transcreation and the New World Order of Cultural Production

Editor: Vinzenz Hediger

Editor: Matthias Krings

Editor: Bertram Lang

Editor: Cornelia Storz

Author: Tabitha Adler

Author: Añulika Agina

Author: Yonson Ahn

Author: Egbert Amoncio

Author: Sonia Campanini

Author: Casandra-Angela Chistinean

Author: Bakar Abdul-Rashid Jeduah

Author: Nico Nassenstein

Author: Izuu Nwankwọ

Author: Ute Röschenthaler

Author: Artemis Saleh

Author: Tom Simmert

Author: Solomon Waliaula

Author: Usaku Wammanda

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/0634

Digital distribution produces new global cultural flows from urban centers like Lagos, Mumbai or Seoul. But it also enables new forms of distributed production in which cultural entrepreneurs cooperate across continents and challenge and expand established notions of cultural and political space. In the "new world order of cultural production" (Fatima Bhutto) cultural specificity is no longer a matter of physical location, but of digital transcreation, the transport of meaning across multiple cultural contexts.The contributions to this volume trace such transports across Africa, Asia, and beyond.

6.2 June 2026

6.2.1 Digitale Gewalt: Politisierungen affektiver Öffentlichkeiten

Author: Julia Bee

Author: Jasmin Degeling

Author: Jennifer Eickelmann

Author: Katrin Köppert

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/2751

Digitale Gewalt, die sich in Form von Deepfakes, Doxing oder Voice Cloning gegen marginalisierte Gruppen richtet, ist politische Gewalt. Ihre gegenwärtige Konjunktur geht Hand in Hand mit der Proliferation rechter und faschistischer Politiken. Dieser Band untersucht Misogynie und Transfeindlichkeit, Rassismus und Faschismus unter digitalen Bedingungen und ordnet diese Gewaltformen mithilfe intersektionaler Theorien ein. Die Beiträge beleuchten die Regulierung und Politisierung Sozialer Medien, Rassismus in digitalen Erinnerungskulturen und kritische Politische Bildung. Durch diese Analysen interveniert der Band in Szenarien ungleich verteilter politischer Gewalt und zeigt auf, wie unerlässlich intersektionale Perspektiven der Gender Media Studies für eine zeitgemäße Analyse digitaler Medienkulturen sind.

6.3 May 2026

6.3.1 From Debris to Sediment: Unearthing Imperial Geology

Editor: Felix Hasebrink

Editor: Petra Löffler

Author: Ulrike Gerhardt

Author: Henriette Gunkel

Author: Amelia Hine

Author: Alexandra Klemme

Author: Susanne Kriemann

Author: Lisa Rosendahl

Author: Christiane Schürkmann

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/2713

In geology, the term sediment refers to organic or mineral particles that were set in motion and transported to a new location by air, water, or ice. Today, new sediments are emerging that challenge traditional concepts of geological processes: the global spread of microplastics, the contamination of soil and water with toxins, infrastructural remainders of industrial manufacturing, or the material legacies of imperial and/or colonial resource extraction. From Debris to Sediment addresses the rising relevance of these residues. From the perspective of media studies, geography, sociology, environmental sciences, and artistic research, the contributions to this volume deal with key sites and issues related to the mounting layers of anthropogenic refuse and explore sediments as a geo-philosophical figure of thought. What media, politics, and ecologies are implicated in accumulating "future fossils"? And how do they envision the new material cycles emerging from these growing deposits?

6.4 April 2026

6.4.1 Vector Media

Author: Leonardo Impett

Author: Fabian Offert

Introduction by: Johanna Drucker

Lüneburg: meson press, 2026

https://doi.org/10.14619/0986

Neural networks are designed to dissolve all media into the vector space—a universal space of commensurability. In Vector Media, Leonardo Impett and Fabian Offert parse theories of automatic vision to trace contemporary artificial intelligence's technical ideology of epistemic reduction, where sensory data is turned into abstracted forms of meaning. Under this regime, bias is not just a question of what is represented but of the logic of representation itself. Drawing on Phil Agre's notion of a critical technical practice, Vector Media reveals how artificial intelligence systems embed new epistemologies of media beneath the surface of their architectures.Analyzing the techniques underpinning large multimodal artificial intelligence models like DALL-E, Midjourney, Flux, or Stable Diffusion, Impett and Offert offer the concept of neural exchange value: the value cultural artifacts acquire not through meaning or context but through their capacity to function as vectors. In such a system, commensurability becomes a condition of existence: what matters is not what something is but that it can be embedded. Rather than focusing solely on datasets, Vector Media proposes a critical study of vector spaces—and the machine cultures they produce—as a necessary complement to prevailing approaches in AI critique.

6.5 February 2026

6.5.1 Sticky Films

Editor: Kerim Dogruel

Editor: Fadekemi Olawoye

Editor: Clara Podlesnigg

Author: Olja Alvir

Author: Marie Sophie Beckmann

Author: Fabienne Bieri

Author: Miriam De Rosa

Author: Silas Edwards

Author: Rodrigo Faustini dos Santos

Author: Fenja Holz

Author: Philipp Dominik Keidl

Author: Franziska Kohler

Author: Andrea Mariani

Author: Jurij Meden

Author: Emma Merkling

Author: Nils Meyn

Author: Amber Jamilla Musser

Author: Jamal Phoenix

Author: Alexandra Schneider

Author: Laura Teixeira

Author: Julia Willms

Author: Sigal Yona

https://doi.org/10.14619/2348

Stickiness is ambiguous. Sometimes it is a problem, sometimes a solution. It holds a strong affective charge between arousal, lust and disgust. If something is sticky, it promises relation while also threatening unwanted clinginess and the collapse of boundaries between self and other. This volume seeks out moments of stickiness in media cultures, thinking "film" beyond moving images as sediment, residue or layer that transforms, repairs, melts, and splices. Sticky Films explores stickiness in three parts: through sticky feelings, sticky modes of being and becoming, and the representations and material traces of stickiness in audiovisual media.

6.6 December 2025

6.6.1 Reckoning with Everything

Editor: Benedikt Merkle

Editor: Bernhard Siegert

Author: Geoffrey C. Bowker

Author: Ranjodh Singh Dhaliwal

Author: Anna Echterhölter

Author: Eva-Maria Gillich

Author: Moritz Hiller

Author: Jeffrey West Kirkwood

Author: Susanna Lidström

Author: Jussi Parikka

Author: Christoph Rosol

Author: John S. Seberger

Author: Angelika Seppi

Author: Christina Vagt

Author: Adam Wickberg

https://doi.org/10.14619/2676

The transformation of the cultural technique of calculation into a computational environment for the whole planet Earth requires media studies to undergo fundamental changes that go beyond mere reflection on the transformation of global political and economic structures. The becoming environmental of computing confronts us with the fact that the map is the territory: map and territory, media and nature, the Symbolic and the Real, are not distinguished in any categorical way but rather temporarily stabilized results of recursive processes by which they differentiate themselves from each other and call each other into being.However, the cultural technique of calculation has not only become "environmental" since the ubiquity of computation turned cultural techniques into environing techniques. Computation must and has always had to "reckon with everything," with the materialities of the media that define the environmental conditions of computability, as well as with practices of extracting, storing and transferring data. This volume brings together contributions that seek to describe the environmentality of computation based on selected settings.

6.6.2 Computing Cultures: Knowledges and Practices (1940–1990)

Editor: Arianna Borrelli

Editor: Helena Durnová

Author: Troy Kaighin Astarte

Author: Nathalie Bredella

Author: Marie-José Durand-Richard

Author: Edgar Lejeune

Author: Jacqueline Léon

Author: Elisabetta Mori

Author: Mark Priestley

https://doi.org/10.14619/2737

Highlighting the diverse and fragmentary nature of the so-called "digital turn," this volume offers a glimpse into the landscape of different computing cultures which emerged side by side between the 1940s and the 1990s, at times sharing some features, yet remaining essentially independent from each other. Some of these cultures disappeared, some thrive until today, but understanding all through their knowledges and practices, interconnections and broader historical context, is essential to deal critically with the visions and dreams, fears and tensions characterizing digital practices in today's knowledge societies.

6.6.3 Banales Publizieren: Praktiken, Verfahren und Episteme des Selfpublishings

Editor: Elisa Linseisen

Editor: Dorothea Walzer

Author: Julia Bee

Author: Sarah-Mai Dang

Author: Gerko Egert

Author: Annette Gilbert

Author: Erin Rose Glass

Author: Timothy Laquintano

Author: Matthias Preuss

Author: Tom Schmidt

Author: Erika Thomalla

Author: Eva Weinmayr

https://doi.org/10.14619/2300

Praktiken, Verfahren und Episteme des Selfpublishings in Kunst, Literatur und Wissenschaft treten heute konkurrierend neben die institutionalisierte Publikationslandschaft. Dieser Band schlägt vor, die ‚Banalität' als wesentliches Merkmal des digitalen Selbstpublizierens zu begreifen. Ziel ist es, die Erweiterung und Überformung der institutionalisierten Verlagslandschaft durch plattformbasierte Publikationsmodelle zu verstehen und zu fragen, inwiefern diese Entwicklung (die eigenen) wissenschaftlichen Erkenntnismodelle und ihre konstitutiven Ein- und Ausschlussprinzipien aufs Spiel setzt. Es geht dabei um die Vermessung eines Feldes von buchförmigen und nicht-buchförmigen digitalen Selbstpublikationen auf Plattformen und im Print-on-Demand-Bereich, das die Grenzen zwischen professionellen Autor:innen und Lai:innen genauso zur Diskussion stellt wie die Unterscheidung von Literatur, Theorie, Kunst und Wissenschaft und ihrer Vermittlung.

6.6.4 Digital Theory

Author: M. Beatrice Fazi

Author: Alexander R. Galloway

Author: Matthew Handelman

Author: Leif Weatherby

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/0849

Digital Theory argues that the digital is theoretical. It proposes a powerful new approach to the often overlooked conceptual side of the digital, starting with a minimal definition of the digital as a form of mediation using discrete units. Pushing the understanding of the digital beyond its interpretation as sheer consumer electronics and instead working with that conceptual definition, the three essays in this volume explore digitality's relation to thinking, signs, and difference, each bringing out distinctive new aspects of the digital's profound theoretical potential.

6.7 October 2025

6.7.1 Property: Colonial Histories and Messages to the Future

Author: Ulrike Bergermann

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/0689

To possess something is to lose something: Starting from this seemingly contradictory claim this essay invokes various registers to defamiliarize the ways in which property structures subjectivity, world relations and affects. Intertwined with colonialism, racism and sexism, concepts of property have found an echo in piracy and "postcolonial copyright." At the level of theory, a crossing out and a reversal of time are required to undo property-related violence and its mindsets. At the level of artistic practice new modes of appropriation become imaginable. And while the commons will not be restored, multiple modes of having and commoning are possible.

6.8 June 2025

6.8.1 Zonen: Für eine kritische Ökologie in den Geisteswissenschaften

Editor: Jörg Dünne

Editor: Eva Horn

Editor: Birgit Schneider

Author: Florian Auerochs

Author: Jeanne Etelain

Author: Mary Louise Pratt

Author: Robert Stockhammer

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/2614

Die Erde befindet sich in einem vom Menschen bewirkten, tiefgreifenden Veränderungsprozess. Um dieses dringliche Problem neu anzugehen, nehmen die Autor*innen dieses Bandes den Begriff der „Zone“ zum Ausgangspunkt für eine kritische Ökologie.

Das „Denken in Zonen“ hält der Makro-Perspektive des Planetarischen den Blick auf das Heterogene und Prozesshafte, auf die Übergänge, Grenzen und Singularitäten von Räumen entgegen. In den Vordergrund rücken damit die Handlungsmacht und Relationalität von Räumen, um die drastischen, ebenso materiellen wie epistemischen Veränderungen und Verschiebungen im Verhältnis des Menschen zur Erde im Anthropozän besser zu fassen.

Mit Aufsätzen von Florian Auerochs, Jeanne Etelain, Mary Louise Pratt und Robert Stockhammer versammelt dieser Band erstmals maßgebliche Zugänge zu Begriff und Ästhetik der Zone, die seine Tragweite als Instrument ökologischen Denkens in den Kulturwissenschaften aufzeigen.

6.8.2 Gefühle Vermessen: Zur Genealogie des Affective Computing

Author: Lisa Schreiber

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/2287

Seit Anfang der 2010er Jahre beschäftigt sich das Affective Computing mit der Entwicklung von digitalen Technologien zur automatischen Erfassung menschlicher Gefühle. Das sogenannte emotion detection operiert auf Grundlage des Facial Action Coding System (FACS),

einem Klassifikationssystem für Emotionen, das verspricht, Gefühle anhand der Bewegung der Gesichtsmuskeln zu entschlüsseln. Das FACS transportiert jedoch ein Gefühlsparadigma, das ungelöste Probleme aus der Vorgeschichte der Emotionsforschung bündelt. Gefühle Vermessen untersucht das Nachwirken dieser Probleme in der computergestützten Depressionsforschung und Autismustherapie, welche die Verfahren des Affective Computing anwenden. Im Zentrum steht die Frage, warum das Codierungssystem trotz dieser Ambivalenzen eine mächtige Produktivität entfaltet.

6.8.3 Children Reinventing Cinema: Snapshots from the Early 21st Century

Author: Alexandra Schneider

Author: Wanda Strauven

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/0887

Children today discover a new digital drawing tool, the camera-crayon, at a very young age. They appropriate devices such as compact cameras and mobile phones and make their own media artifacts in their play. Expanding on a media-archaeological approach to film history, this book maps children's playful and imaginative knowledge of contemporary media culture and explores their filmmaking practices that push the boundaries of forms and formats.

6.8.4 Platforms and the Moving Image

Editor: Jana Zündel

Editor: Philipp Dominik Keidl

Author: Sudipto Basu

Author: Anna Bell

Author: Amrita Biswas

Author: Colin Crawford

Author: Vinzenz Hediger

Author: Becky Holt

Author: Sneha Kumar

Author: Isadora Campregher Paiva

Author: Jake Pitre

Author: Clara Podlesnigg

Author: Alexandra Schneider

Foreword by: Marc Steinberg

Afterword by: Ishita Tiwary

Author: Sam Thompson

Author: Zeynep Tuna

Author: Haidee Wasson

Author: Yvonne Zimmermann

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/0733

Platforms and the Moving Image offers a multifaceted look at how digital platforms shape and are shaped by economic, cultural, and political forces. The collection examines the effects of gaming, social media, streaming and videosharing platforms on the production, circulation, and consumption of moving images. Through diverse methodologies—archival research, social media ethnography, and textual analysis—the essays investigate the global movements of film and video formats, the platformization of cultural industries, and the evolving nature of media consumption. The volume emphasizes the importance of considering digital labor, media infrastructures, and user practices in understanding platforms' role in contemporary society.

6.9 February 2025

6.9.1 The Making of Les Immatériaux

Author: Andreas Broeckmann

Lüneburg: meson press, 2025

https://doi.org/10.14619/2591

The exhibition Les Immatériaux was presented at the Centre Pompidou in Paris in 1985. Curated by the philosopher Jean-François Lyotard and design theoretician Thierry Chaput, it is widely regarded as a landmark in the history of postmodern philosophy, as well as for discourses around art, science and digital culture.

Broeckmann's book provides the first comprehensive account of the preparation of this epochal event. It shows how the exhibition resulted from multiple, collaborative and interdisciplinary trajectories in such diverse fields as contemporary art, architecture, science, and network media. Based on extensive archival research, The Making of Les Immatériaux offers detailed insights into the curatorial process. Throughout its ten chapters, the book highlights the different forms of cooperation among the people involved in the conception of the exhibition, including

Lyotard, Chaput, the team at the Centre de Création Industrielle, and their consultations with artists, theorists, and scientists.

Les Immatériaux marks a pivotal point in the history of exhibitions in the 20th century because it gave important impulses for the organisation, design and structure of interdisciplinary exhibitions. Broeckmann discusses the place of Les Immatériaux in the broader context of this history, examining the epistemology of exhibits, curatorial agency, and interdisciplinarity in research networks. The book takes up current questions about the relationship between materiality and immateriality, between subjectivity and thinghood, and shows how Les Immatériaux continues to offer a significant contribution to debates that over the last decades have become ever more urgent.

6.10 December 2024

6.10.1 Kritik des Neo-Extraktivismus in der Gegenwartskunst

Editor: Hauke Ohls

Editor: Birgit Mersmann

Author: Viktor Brim

Author: Linn Burchert

Author: Lena Geuer

Author: Liliana Gómez

Author: Ina Neddermeyer

Author: Veronica Peselmann

Author: Jorge Sanguino

Author: Lukas Schepers

Author: Irene Schütze

Author: Martin Siegler

Author: Franca Spengler

Author: Florian Telsnig

Author: Susanne Witzgall

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

Wie reflektieren Künstler*innen und Kollektive die globalen Herausforderungen der akzelerierenden Rohstoffausbeutung? Und welches Widerstandspotenzial entfalten diese

künstlerischen Praktiken gegen die Paradigmen des (Neo-)Extraktivismus? Die Beiträge in Kritik des Neo-Extraktivismus in der Gegenwartskunst analysieren die künstlerische Auseinandersetzung mit unterschiedlichen extraktivistischen Phänomenen aus kunstwissenschaftlichen, kuratorischen und künstlerischen Perspektiven. Eröffnet wird ein globaler Blickwinkel, der kritisch die Materialitäten und Infrastrukturen des (Neo-)Extraktivismus beleuchtet und um dekoloniale Perspektiven ergänzt.

6.10.2 Fragile Evidenz: Videodokumente illegaler Zurückweisungen an Europas Grenzen

Author: Anna Polze

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/2386

Pushbacks finden systematisch an den EU-Außengrenzen statt. Von offizieller Seite wird ihr Einsatz geheim gehalten oder geleugnet. Fragile Evidenz stellt die Frage, wie aus einem gescheiterten Fluchtversuch eine aussagekräftige Falldarstellung europäischer Grenzregime entstehen kann. Es begreift die Dokumentation illegaler Zurückweisungen als mediale Aushandlungen von Sichtbarkeit und Hörbarkeit, Aufmerksamkeit, öffentlicher Anerkennung und vor allem Evidenz.

Eine zehnminütige Videoinvestigation der Rechercheagentur Forensic Architecture erweist sich als Symptom für die Krisen politischen Auftretens in digitalen Medien. Sie wird detailliert als Montage von Smartphone-Dokumenten fliehender Personen und den Medien forensischer Verifikation aufgeschlüsselt. Im Zentrum steht die Spannung zwischen Fluchtauftritt und Evidenzprozess, das Wechselspiel von ästhetischen Strategien und rhetorischen Wirksamkeiten, von Situiertheit und Infrastrukturen. Fragile Evidenz ist eine analytische Reaktion auf die anwachsende Präsenz forensischer Medienpraktiken in digitalen Bildkulturen.

6.10.3 Was ist Medienästhetik? Internationales Jahrbuch für Medienphilosophie und Medienästhetik

Editor: Natascha Adamowsky

Editor: Judith Siegmund

Author: Emmanuel Alloa

Author: Martin Beck

Author: Dieter Mersch

Author: Beate Ochsner

Author: Bettina Papenburg

Author: Ulrike Ramming

Author: Jörg Sternagel

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/2409

Als Nachfolger des früheren Internationalen Jahrbuchs für Medienphilosophie beschäftigt sich das Internationale Jahrbuch für Medienphilosophie und Medienästhetik in der ersten Ausgabe nach dem Relaunch mit der wesentlichen Frage: Was ist Medienästhetik?

Diese Frage steht für eine doppelte Öffnung: Medienästhetik markiert eine Suchbewegung, die die philosophischen wie medienwissenschaftlichen Grundlagen erkundet, die in medienästhetischen Kontexten in Erscheinung treten können. Zugleich lädt sie ein zu einer historischen Kartographierung und begrifflichen Konturierung von Medienästhetik, einer Diskussion ihrer unterschiedlichen Modellierungen und der sich daraus ergebenden Optionen für Kritik.

Ziel ist es, den Begriff Medienästhetik offen zu halten und aus seiner Problematisierung immer wieder neue disziplinübergreifende Debatten anzustoßen. Das Jahrbuch bietet unterschiedlichen Projekten, Positionen und Fragestellungen Raum, die zueinander im Modus des Dissenses, der Überschneidung, der Assoziation, aber auch der inhaltlichen Weiterführung stehen können.

6.11 July 2024

6.11.1 Containment: Technologies of Holding, Filtering, Leaking

Editor: Marie-Luise Angerer

Editor: Ingrid Richardson

Editor: Hannah Schmedes

Editor: Zoë Sofoulis

Author: Daniela Agostinho

Author: Hélène Frichot

Author: Meredith Jones

Author: Chris Otter

Author: Paul Graham Raven

Author: Helen Runting

Author: Yolande Strengers

Author: Nanna Bonde Thylstrup

Author: Dinesh Wadiwel

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/2188

Containers are ubiquitous and inescapable. From handbags to houses, barrels to databases, captivating gameworlds to the "bag of stars" that Ursula Le Guin calls the universe, containers furnish infrastructures for living and action while extending our capacities for managing things across space and time. They not only give shape to our lifeworlds: they form and transform our bodies and being.

The chapters in Containment: Technologies of Holding, Filtering, Leaking traverse technologies, bodies, ontologies and imaginaries, reflecting on what different container technologies, containment strategies, and container metaphors tell us about ourselves and how we relate to our worlds. With common reference to Zoë Sofia's (2000) foundational essay on container technologies, contributors draw on media and cultural studies, social history, architecture, and postdualistic approaches in philosophy and social science to explore liminalities of containment both as and beyond holding.

6.12 May 2024

6.12.1 Elementare Ekstasen: Sondierungen der Technosphäre

Author: Léa Perraudin

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/2263

Elementare Ekstasen überschwemmen, erodieren und evaporieren die wohlsortierten Grenzziehungen zwischen Technik, Umwelt und Mensch. Als Neuverortung im Spannungsfeld medienökologischer, neomaterialistischer und technikfeministischer Theoriebildung werden hier all jene Widerständigkeiten und Un/Verfügbarkeiten sondiert, die von technokapitalistisch protegierten Operationen nicht zu tilgen sind. Was hieße es, die planetarische Implikation der Technosphäre aus Mikroperspektiven zu denken, mit ihren Überlappungen, Leerstellen, Fragmentierungen, Akkumulationen des Technischen zu schreiben? Entlang ihrer materiellen Prozessualität werden elementare Medien wie Regen, Minerale, Staub und Schaum zur Gegenwartsdiagnose. Angesichts der umfassenden Ökologisierungstendenzen und ihrer experimentellen Verarbeitung in Medienkunst und Interfacedesign verdichtet sich ein kritisches Begriffsinventar, das die makrologische Karriere des Technischen anders denkt.

6.12.2 Democratic Algorithms: Ethnography of a Public Recommender System

Author: Nikolaus Poechhacker

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

Can an algorithm be democratic? And how can we understand algorithms not only as technical, but also as social and political phenomena? Democratic Algorithms offers theoretically and empirically informed perspectives on how we can imagine and design algorithms for a democratic society, and what we even mean by that. Based on ethnographic fieldwork, the book illustrates how a recommender system was built in a public broadcaster, raising questions not only about organizational and technical implementation, but also about the possible compatibility of such an algorithmic system with democratic constitutions.

6.12.3 Tacit Cinematic Knowledge: Approaches and Practices

Editor: Rebecca Boguska

Editor: Guilherme da Silva Machado

Editor: Rebecca Puchta

Editor: Marin Reljić

Author: Larissa Fischer

Author: Veena Hariharan

Author: Vinzenz Hediger

Author: Andrea Mariani

Author: Bettina Paul

Author: Jelena Rakin

Author: Haritha R.

Author: Claire Salles

Author: Henning Schmidgen

Author: Felix M. Simon

Author: Felipe Soares

Author: Benoît Turquety

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/0238

Moving images are increasingly finding their way into laboratories, dentist offices, clinics, airports and gyms. In these places and institutions film and moving image technologies serve to advance knowledge, to show how things are done, to train, teach, educate, mobilize people, as well as to imagine complex social facts and visualize dynamic models and schemes through data visualizations, pattern recognition software, and in social graphs. But what these moving images do goes beyond instruction, illustration and visual education. This publication introduces the concept of tacit cinematic knowledge to designate a broad variety of epistemic environments in which knowledge is configured in and through cinematic practices, and in the interaction with moving images. The concept thus describes a challenge not only for film and media scholars, but also for social scientists, economists, data analysts and artists.

Covering areas of study beyond the cinema and non-theatrical films which have recently become a focus of inquiry, the contributions analyze the operations of tacit cinematic knowledge in objects ranging from political campaigns, medical and scientific devices, corporate communications, devices for the study of animal behavior and more.

6.13 April 2024

6.13.1 Neural Networks

Author: Ranjodh Singh Dhaliwal

Author: Théo Lepage-Richer

Author: Lucy Suchman

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/0832

Neural Networks proposes to reconstruct situated practices, social histories, mediating techniques, and ontological assumptions that inform the computational project of the same name. If so-called machine learning comprises a statistical approach to pattern extraction, then neural networks can be defined as a biologically inspired model that relies on probabilistically weighted neuron-like units to identify such patterns. Far from signaling the ultimate convergence of human and machine intelligence, however, neural networks highlight the technologization of neurophysiology that characterizes virtually all strands of neuroscientific and AI research of the past century. Taking this traffic as its starting point, this volume explores how cognition came to be constructed as essentially computational in nature, to the point of underwriting a technologized view of human biology, psychology, and sociability, and how countermovements provide resources for thinking otherwise.

6.14 February 2024

6.14.1 Serge Daney and Queer Cinephilia

Editor: Pierre Eugène

Editor: Kate Ince

Editor: Marc Siegel

Author: Claire Allouche

Author: Raymond Bellour

Author: Mélina Delmas

Author: Garin Dowd

Author: Chloé Galibert-Laîné

Author: Theresa Heath

Author: Andrea Inzerillo

Author: Hervé Joubert-Laurencin

Author: Philipp Dominik Keidl

Author: Simon Pageau

Author: Sylvie Pierre-Ulmann

Author: Bamchade Pourvali

Author: Patrice Rollet

Author: Marcos Uzal

Author: So Mayer

Author: Selina Robertson

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/0184

French critic Serge Daney was a central figure in film, television and media criticism of the second half of the twentieth century. He died of AIDS in 1992, just as the concept of queer cinema entered international film studies and just before the start of the digital era that has transformed film culture. This collection of new essays investigates the legacy of Daney's work alongside considerations of feminist, queer and digital cinephilia and contemporary practices of film curation.

6.14.2 Szenen kritischer Relationalität

Editor: Charlotte Bolwin

Editor: Jasmin Degeling

Editor: Gabriel Geffert

Editor: Martin Kallmeyer

Editor: Gereon Rahnfeld

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Author: Eva Krivanec

Author: Irina Raskin

Editor: Maximilian Rünker

Author: Julia Schade

Author: Martin Siegler

Author: Christiane Voss

Author: Max Walther

Author: Shirin Weigelt

Lüneburg: meson press, 2024

https://doi.org/10.14619/2225

Kritische Relationalität interveniert in Ordnungen des Denkens, die Kritik als Operation des Trennens und Auseinanderhaltens entworfen und damit die modernen Dualismen von Menschlichem und Nicht-Menschlichem, Subjekten und Objekten, Organischem und Technischem, Natur und Kultur geprägt haben. Ausgehend von multiplen, verschränkten Krisen suchen die Beiträge dieses Bandes konkrete Szenen auf, in denen das kritische Potenzial von Verbindungen und Verstrickungen anschaulich wird. Das Ausloten von Relationalität wird dabei zu einem

analytischen Modus, der für die Produktivität von Verbindungen sensibilisiert und zugleich ihre differenziellen Dimensionen anerkennt.

6.15 December 2023

6.15.1 Material Trajectories: Designing With Care?

Editor: Léa Perraudin

Editor: Clemens Winkler

Editor: Claudia Mareis

Editor: Matthias Held

Author: Sename Koffi Agbodjinou

Author: Viola S. Ahrensfeld

Author: Joanna Boehnert

Author: Jessica Bulling

Author: Michaela Büsse

Author: Emile De Visscher

Author: Roman Kirschner

Author: Manuel Kretzer

Author: Anupama Kundoo

Author: Martin Müller

Author: Fara Peluso

Author: Wolfgang Schäffner

Author: Lea Schmidt

Author: Maxie Schneider

Author: Emilia Tikka

Author: Ebba Fransén Waldhör

Author: Charlett Wenig

Author: Susanne Witzgall

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/2201

Material Trajectories: Designing With Care? turns towards material-driven design processes with the aim of relocating technoscientific trajectories. Concerned with new forms of caretaking, it combines positions from the extended fields of design research and humanities scholarship including practice-based approaches. The contributions explore current ecological conditions through multiple acts of making-with and seek to complicate questions of sustainability, livability, and cooperation. In reassessing the status quo in design and architecture as material practices, they provide outlines for a nuanced reading of these worldmaking processes and ask what different ways of designing with care and complicity might entail.

6.15.2 Deine Kamera ist eine App: Über Medienverflechtungen des Applizierens und Appropriierens

Editor: Elisa Linseisen

Editor: Alena Strohmaier

Author: Nicole Braida

Author: Anne Ganzert

Author: Angela Jouini

Author: Florian Krautkrämer

Author: Laura Katharina Mücke

Author: Simone Pfeifer

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

Der vorliegende Band untersucht systematisch das Verhältnis von digitalen Kameras und ihren softwaretechnischen Grundlagen, die wir unter „Apps“ zusammenfassen. Als konzeptuelles Framing in der Auseinandersetzung mit dieser medialen Verbindung aus Kamera/App wählen wir das ästhetische wie theoretische Spektrum aus Techniken des Appropriierens und Applizierens und damit verbundene Theorietraditionen der Filmwissenschaft sowie der Software, Platform und App Studies. Mit dem programmatischen Befund ‚Deine Kamera ist eine App‘ soll in vier dialogischen Textpaaren dem offenen Themenfeld zwischen Appropriation/Applikation und seiner zeitgenössischen Brisanz wie historischen Tiefe entlang übergreifender Konzepte wie Partizipation, Format und Widerstand nachgegangen werden. Dabei beleuchtet der Band die Verbindung von Ästhetik und Technik, Kunst und Software und wendet sich neben dem Film auch den sogenannten Medienkünsten, dokumentarischen Videoformaten, Selbstdokumentationen und dem Gaming zu.

6.15.3 Accidental Archivism: Shaping Cinema's Futures with Remnants of the Past

Editor: Stefanie Schulte Strathaus

Editor: Vinzenz Hediger

Author: Añulika Agina

Author: Hadi Alipanah

Author: Gaby Babić

Author: Lynhan Balatbat-Helbock

Author: Erika Balsom

Author: Marie Sophie Beckmann

Author: Mareike Bernien

Author: Amrita Biswas

Author: Sema Çakmak

Author: Sonia Campanini

Author: Erica Carter

Author: Özge Çelikaslan

Author: Filipa César

Author: Didi Cheeka

Author: Vaginal Davis

Author: Madhusree Dutta

Author: Tamer El Said

Author: Almudena Escobar López

Author: Mariia Glazunova

Author: Ulrich Gregor

Author: Olena Goncharuk

Author: Karola Gramann

Author: Veena Hariharan

Author: Mohammad Shawky Hassan

Author: Shai Heredia

Author: Tobias Hering

Author: Grazia Ingravalle

Author: Ritika Kaushik

Author: Philipp Dominik Keidl

Author: Julita Pratiwi

Author: Lisabona Rahman

Author: Ivanna Khitsinska

Author: Hieyoon Kim

Author: Laura Kloeckner

Author: Merle Kröger

Author: Asja Makarevic

Author: Nils Meyn

Author: Petna Ndaliko Katondolo

Author: Rebecca Ohene-Asah

Author: Volker Pantenburg

Author: Nikolaus Perneczky

Author: Francesco Pitassio

Author: Constanze Ruhm

Author: Heide Schlüpmann

Author: Alexandra Schneider

Author: Girish Shambu

Author: Marc Siegel

Author: Can Sungu

Author: Clarissa Thieme

Author: Mila Turajlić

Author: Ravi Vasudevan

Author: Simone Venturini

Author: Ala Younis

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/0535

In the digital media ecology, archives are changing. Artists, curators, critics and scholars assume the role of accidental archivists. They shape cinema's futures by salvaging precarious repositories and making them matter in new ways. In the process, the cinema's public, a democratic body seemingly scattered about platforms and niches in a post-pandemic world, re-emerges as a political force.

Accidental Archivism brings together programmatic statements and proposals to explore an artistic space between archiving and activism, a space where remnants of the past become the building blocks of new ways of making, showing, teaching and thinking cinema.

6.16 October 2023

6.16.1 Boundary Images

Author: Giselle Beiguelman

Author: Melody Devries

Author: Winnie Soon

Author: Magdalena Tyżlik-Carver

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/0597

How are images made, and how should we understand the capacities of digital images? This book investigates images as well as the technologies that host them. Its three chapters discuss the boundaries that images cross and blur between humans, machines, and nature and the ways in which images are political, material, and visual. Exploring these boundaries of images, this book places itself at the limits of the visual and beyond what can be seen, understanding these as starting points for the production of new and radically different ways of knowing about the world and its becomings.

6.17 September 2023

6.17.1 Frictions: Inquiries into Cybernetic Thinking and Its Attempts towards Mate[real]ization

Editor: Diego Gómez-Venegas

Author: Andrei Cretu

Author: Wolfgang Ernst

Author: Thomas Fischer

Author: Hans-Christian von Herrmann

Author: Stefan Höltgen

Author: Rolf F. Nohr

Author: Eva Schauerte

Author: Isabell Schrickel

Author: Sebastian Vehlken

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/2164

Frictions is a collective invitation to embrace the space of difference that both connects and separates techno-scientific discourses from their actual implementations—or even, from their non-implementations. Through a series of case studies focused on cybernetics, systems research, and some of their more contemporary inheritors, this book argues that such a middle space, the topology of frictions, offers significant insights to assess the historical and epistemological relevance of these interconnected fields. Characterized here as cybernetic thinking, this broad area of theoretical and applied projects would conceal, precisely within its frictions, the operational principles of our present.

6.18 August 2023

6.18.1 Mediale Teilhabe: Partizipation zwischen Anspruch und Inanspruchnahme

Editor: Beate Ochsner

Author: Erich Hörl

Author: Milan Stürmer

Author: Markus Spöhrer

Author: Robert Stock

Author: Isabell Otto

Author: Urs Stäheli

Author: Anne Ganzert

Author: Mathias Denecke

Author: Matthias Drusell

Author: Elke Bippus

Author: Christoph Brunner

Author: Roberto Nigro

Author: Michel Schreiber

Author: nate wessalowski

Author: Ruth Lang

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/2126

Gesellschaftliche, politische und wissenschaftliche Forderungen nach mehr Beteiligung, Zugang und Mitwirkung sind ebenso allgegenwärtig wie spannungsgeladen und durchzogen von Ambivalenzen. Mediale Teilhabe fragt nach den medialen Ermöglichungs- und Austauschprozessen, als deren Effekt Teilhabe/Nicht-Teilhabe entsteht. Entlang der Modalitäten Verschalten, Temporalisieren und Teilhabende Kritik entwickeln die Beiträge einen differenzierten Blick auf Teilhabe im Spannungsfeld von Anspruch und Inanspruchnahme.

6.18.2 Digital Energetics

Author: Zane Griffin Talley Cooper

Author: Jordan B. Kinder

Author: Cindy Kaiying Lin

Author: Anne Pasek

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/0580

Media and energy require joint theorization as they are bound together across contemporary informational and fossil regimes. Digital Energetics traces the contours of a media analytic of energy and an energy analytic of media across the cultural, environmental, and labor relations they subtend. Focusing specifically on digital operations, its authors analyze how data and energy have jointly modulated the character of data work and politics in a warming world.

6.19 July 2023

6.19.1 Algorithmic Authenticity: An Overview

Author: Anthony Glyn Burton

Author: Wendy Hui Kyong Chun

Author: Liliana Bounegru

Author: Melody Devries

Author: Amy Harris

Author: hannah holtzclaw

Author: Ioana B. Jucan

Author: Alexandra Juhasz

Author: D.W. Kamish

Author: Ganaele Langlois

Author: Jasmine Proctor

Author: Christine Tomlinson

Author: Roopa Vasudevan

Author: Esther Weltevrede

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/2102

What makes information feel true or compelling in our contemporary digital societies? This book brings together different disciplinary understandings of "authenticity" in order to find alternative ways to approach mis- and disinformation that go beyond contemporary fact-checking and its search for the "authentic" truth. Patterned under the algorithmic flows of digital capitalism, authenticity itself is subject to variation, iteration, and outside influence. Linking cross-disciplinary research on the history and practices of algorithmic authenticity points to

new research questions to understand the impact of algorithmic authenticity on social life and its role in contemporary information disorder.

6.20 June 2023

6.20.1 Post-Cinematic Bodies

Author: Shane Denson

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/0436

How is human embodiment transformed in an age of algorithms? How do post-cinematic media technologies such as AI, VR, and robotics target and re-shape our bodies? Post-Cinematic Bodies grapples with these questions by attending both to mundane devices—such as smartphones, networked exercise machines, and smart watches and other wearables equipped with heartrate sensors—as well as to new media artworks that rework such equipment to reveal to us the ways that our fleshly existences are increasingly up for grabs. Through an equally philosophical and interpretive analysis, the book aims to develop a new aesthetics of embodied experience that is attuned to a new age of predictive technology and metabolic capitalism.

6.21 March 2023

6.21.1 Counter-Dancing Digitality: On Commoning and Computation

Author: Shintaro Miyazaki

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/0481

Digitality is imposed upon us! To change this, we should not turn away from it, but look carefully into its transformative power and make operable alternatives such as counter-algorhythms and solidarity-oriented commoning. The aim is a world where profit and property no longer exist, but instead where a cooperative dance – between all the needs posed by our ecosystems, and all the needs of people – becomes practicable. This book is a critical media theory of future-building, modulated by a focus on the potentials of counter-dancing as providing ways to unfold fugitive practices.

6.22 February 2023

6.22.1 Preferable Futures

Editor: Irina Kaldrack

Editor: Rolf F. Nohr

https://doi.org/10.14619/0337

Preferable Futures delves into the question of possible, probable, and desirable futures amidst the pressures of climate change and digitalization. Through a diverse range of perspectives, the book explores ways to negotiate and create desirable futures using the concept of transformation design in theory and practice, economic business simulations, and recent humanistic theories. This thought-provoking read challenges us to imagine and (re)shape a future we cannot predict and find ways to make a difference right now.

6.22.2 Kritik postdigital

Editor: Laura Hille

Editor: Daniela Wentz

Lüneburg: meson press, 2023

https://doi.org/10.14619/0382

Die realpolitische Affirmation der Universalität des Digitalen geht mit einer regelrechten Abwehr der kritischen Reflexion seiner scheinbaren Axiome einher. Umso dringlicher ist es zu fragen: Was sind die Bedingungen und Möglichkeiten von Kritik am Digitalen und seiner Kulturen? Wie lässt sich die drängende Notwendigkeit politischer Haltung und kritischer Praxis mit einem wissenschaftlichen Einsatz verbinden, der die Eigengesetzlichkeiten des Digitalen ernst nimmt? Die Beiträge in Kritik postdigital begegnen diesen Herausforderungen aus sozial-, medienwissenschaftlicher und philosophischer Perspektive.

6.23 October 2022

6.23.1 Records of Disaster: Media Infrastructures and Climate Change

Editor: Jakob Claus

Editor: Petra Löffler

Author: Marie Sophie Beckmann

Author: Charlotte Bolwin

Author: Katrin Köppert

Author: Armin Linke

Author: Gabriele Schabacher

Author: Susan Schuppli

Author: Solveig Qu Suess

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/2089

Records of Disasters: Media Infrastructures and Climate Change explores how environmental disasters manifest and inscribe themselves in infrastructures. By turning to infrastructures, their logic and functioning, collapse and malfunction, the volume reveals their potential as fragile material witnesses to and of disasters. As climate change is unequally distributed across continuous dynamics and events, time scales and spatial registers, infrastructures can be understood as proxies or seismographs mediating different spatio-temporal layers that make these dynamics tangible. Disaster is made operational by negotiating what is defined as such, and under which geopolitical conditions. What connects melting glaciers and the knowledge from ice cores to the mapping of the ocean floor and the extraction of resources in the deep-sea? How can infrastructures be thought in time and "critical proximity", and how do they bear witness to colonial pasts and presents? The volume proposes an analytical perspective on infrastructures as multi-layered witnesses to climate change, bringing together scientific and artistic approaches, students and scholars from different disciplines.

6.24 September 2022

6.24.1 Guantánamo Frames

Author: Rebecca Boguska

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/2065

For the last twenty years, the Guantánamo Bay detention camp has not just been a military prison and security facility, but also a site of media production. Films, photographs, and documents have continued to emerge from the camp and become the focus of fierce legal and political battles, as well as intense moral anguish. This book looks at how the US Department of Defense has struggled, and often failed, to control the public perception of these media objects through complex, layered framing devices. It traces how small ruptures in the Department's framings have provided openings for critical interventions from various fields – ranging

from journalism and human rights law to the arts. Guantánamo Frames thus lays the groundwork for a critical reappraisal of the entanglement of media, violence, and the security state in a broader sense.

6.24.2 Nonconscious: On the Affective Synching of Mind and Machine

Author: Marie-Luise Angerer

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/2041

Growing numbers of nonhuman companions are creating affective synching between human and nonhuman agency. Unlike the unconscious of psychoanalysis, this book argues, the resulting nonconscious is no longer coupled to a subject grounded in language, instead acting as an affective link between technical, mental, and physical processes.

6.25 August 2022

6.25.1 Technopharmacology

Author: Joshua Neves

Author: Aleena Chia

Author: Susanna Paasonen

Author: Ravi Sundaram

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/029-0

Technopharmacology is a modest call to expand media theoretical inquiry by attending to the biological, neurological, and pharmacological dimensions of media and centers on emergent affinities between big data and big pharma.

6.26 June 2022

6.26.1 Fahrradutopien: Medien, Ästhetiken und Aktivismus

Author: Julia Bee

Author: Ulrike Bergermann

Author: Linda Keck

Author: Sarah Sander

Author: Herbert Schwaab

Author: Markus Stauff

Author: Franzi Wagner

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/1952

Das Fahrrad ist ein Medium sozialer Veränderung. Seine vielfältigen utopischen Potenziale ergeben sich nicht zuletzt aus seinen ebenso vielfältigen und häufig übersehenen medialen Qualitäten: Es vermittelt, es verbindet, es übersetzt; es modifiziert Wahrnehmung und Organisation von Raum und Zeit, von Körpern und von Sozialität. Umgekehrt kann auch das medienwissenschaftliche Denken fahrradmedial verändert werden. Das Fahrrad ist nicht nur Medium des sozialen und ökologischen Wandels: Radfahren eröffnet Perspektiven, verändert Räume, lässt neue Relationen entstehen und teilt Handlungsmacht neu auf.

Fahrradutopien denkt vom Fahrrad aus und ergänzt dabei bestehende Ansätze zur Mobilitätsforschung um medienkulturwissenschaftliche Perspektiven. Die Beiträge verbinden Medienwissenschaften und Forschungen zu Fahrradaktivismus mit der Liebe zum Radfahren. Fokussiert werden Fahrradfilme und -vlogs, Verkehr und Infrastrukturen, Virtuelle Realität und Fahrrad, Fahrradkollektive und Fahrradfeminismus.

6.27 April 2022

6.27.1 Foucault, digital

Author: Bernhard J. Dotzler

Author: Henning Schmidgen

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/1983

Mitte der 1960er Jahre hat Michel Foucault die Methode der „Diskursanalyse“ in die Geistes- und Sozialwissenschaften eingeführt. Besonders in der Archäologie des Wissens hat er dafür plädiert, die Geschichte des Wissens und der Wissenschaften zum Gegenstand diskursanalytischer Untersuchungen zu machen. Über ein halbes Jahrhundert später ist im Bereich der Informatik ein zunehmendes Interesse an der Diskursanalyse zu verzeichnen. In der Regel spielt Foucault dabei aber keine Rolle. Fern von jeder Archäologie setzen auch die Digital Humanities vermehrt auf die Analyse von historischen und gegenwärtigen Diskursen. Angesichts dieser Konjunkturen ist es an der Zeit, die Archäologie des Wissens neu zu lesen. Denn schon 1968 behauptete der französische Historiker Emmanuel Le Roy Ladurie „Der zukünftige Historiker wird Programmierer sein, oder er wird nicht sein.“ Ein Jahr später gibt Foucault mit seinem Buch auf eben diese Herausforderung eine ebenso informierte wie nuancierte Antwort. Diese Antwort ist in ihrer Aktualität und Relevanz erst noch zu entdecken.

6.28 March 2022

6.28.1 Uexküll's Surroundings: Umwelt Theory and Right-Wing Thought

Author: Gottfried Schnödl

Author: Florian Sprenger

Translator: Michael Thomas Taylor

Translator: Wayne Yung

Lüneburg: meson press, 2022

https://doi.org/10.14619/2010

With its diversity of possible Umwelten or environments for living things, Jakob von Uexküll's Umwelt theory has been hailed by many readers as the first step toward an innovative, pluralistic conception of nonhuman life. But what is generally ignored is its structural conservatism, its identitarian logic in which everything should remain in its place and nothing should mix, and its proximity to Nazi ideology and politics. By turning the spotlight on these neglected aspects, Uexküll's Surroundings opens up a new perspective on Uexküll's Umwelt theory.

6.29 December 2021

6.29.1 Who Owns the Images? The Paradox of Archives, between Commercialization, Free Circulation and Respect

Editor: Sylvie Lindeperg

Editor: Ania Szczepanska

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/0146

Digitization carries the utopian promise of archival access unlimited by constraints of space and time, and with it, of new forms of research and historiographies. In reality, digital image archives pose a complex set of technical, legal, ethical and methodological challenges, particularly for film and media studies and adjacent fields. In a series of studies and interviews with practitioners, scholars and theorists, this volume draws a detailed map of these challenges and offers perspectives for further research and creative practice.

6.30 October 2021

6.30.1 Uexkülls Umgebungen: Umweltlehre und rechtes Denken

Author: Gottfried Schnödl

Author: Florian Sprenger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/1921

Die Lehre Jakob von Uexkülls wird oft mit anerkennendem Blick auf die Vielfalt möglicher Umwelten und als erster Schritt zu einem anderen, pluralen Nachdenken über nichtmenschliche Lebensformen gelesen. Ihr struktureller Konservatismus, ihre identitäre Logik, nach welcher alles an seinem Platz bleiben und sich nichts vermischen soll, und ihre Nähe zum Nationalsozialismus bleiben dabei in aller Regel außen vor. Uexkülls Umgebungen stellt diese Fragen ins Zentrum und eröffnet damit einen neuen Blick auf Uexkülls Umweltlehre.

6.30.2 Media and Management

Author: Rutvica Andrijasevic

Author: Julie Yujie Chen

Author: Melissa Gregg

Author: Marc Steinberg

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/028-3

Management is enabled by media, just as media give life to management. Studying the management innovations learned through media uncovers the evolving relationship between workers and employers. With a view to history, Media and Management shows the interdependence of hardware, software, and human experience adjusting to algorithmically defined rhythms.

6.31 July 2021

6.31.1 Really Fake

Author: Alexandra Juhasz

Author: Ganaele Langlois

Author: Nishant Shah

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/154-9

With anchors in feminist theory, queer discourse, and digital politics, Really Fake rescues "fakeness" from the morass of "fake news" and rejuvenates "fake" as a material and tactical reality. This book treats fakeness as a media object itself: "Fakes" are things that travel and circulate through our bodies, sociality, and the technologies that envelop them. Punctuated with anecdotes, experiences, poetry, stories, and a strong feminist ethic and ethos of care, intimacy, and collectivity, Really Fake offers a series of entry points into reframing the debates of fakeness beyond polarized positions of performative outrage.

6.32 June 2021

6.32.1 Tactical Entanglements: AI Art, Creative Agency, and the Limits of Intellectual Property

Author: Martin Zeilinger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/1839

How do artistic experiments with artificial intelligence problematize human-centered notions of creative agency, authorship, and ownership? Offering a wide-ranging discussion of contemporary digital art practices, philosophical and technical considerations of AI, posthumanist thought, and emerging issues of intellectual property and the commons, this book is firmly positioned against the anthropomorphic spectacle of "creative AI." It proposes instead the concept of the posthumanist agential assemblage, and invites readers to consider what new

types of creative practice, what reconfigurations of the author function, and what critical interventions become possible when AI art provokes tactical entanglements between aesthetics, law, and capital.

6.32.2 Undoing Networks

Author: Tero Karppi

Author: Urs Stäheli

Author: Clara Wieghorst

Author: Lea P. Zierott

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/153-2

How do we think beyond the dominant images and imaginaries of connectivity? Undoing Networks enables a different connectivity: "digital detox" is a luxury for stressed urbanites wishing to lead a mindful life. Self-help books advocate "digital minimalism" to recover authentic experiences of the offline. Artists envision a world without the internet. Activists mobilize against the expansion of the 5G network.

If connectivity brought us virtual communities, information superhighways, and participatory culture, disconnection comes with privacy tools, Faraday shields, and figures of the shy. This book explores non-usage and the "right to disconnect" from work and from the excessive demands of digital capitalism.

6.33 May 2021

6.33.1 Touchscreen Archaeology: Tracing Histories of Hands-On Media Practices

Author: Wanda Strauven

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/1860

The touchscreen belongs to a century-long history of hands-on media practices and touchable art objects. This media-archaeological excavation examines the nature of our sensual involvement with media and invites the reader to think about the touchscreen beyond its technological implications. In six chapters, the book questions and historicizes both aspects of the touchscreen, considering "touch" as a media practice and "screen" as a touchable object.

6.34 March 2021

6.34.1 Earth and Beyond in Tumultuous Times: A Critical Atlas of the Anthropocene

Editor: Réka Patrícia Gál

Editor: Petra Löffler

Author: Jakob Claus

Author: Jörg Dünne

Author: Marie Heinrichs

Author: Hannah Schmedes

Author: Tomás J. Usón

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/1891

Earth and Beyond in Tumultuous Times offers a critical exploration of the Anthropocene concept. It addresses the urgent geopolitical and environmental questions raised by the new geological epoch. How are we to rethink landscapes, such as river deltas, oceans, or outer space? How can we create spaces for resistance and utopic dreaming? This volume confronts these questions by charting how space and place are constructed, deconstructed, and negotiated by humans and non-humans under conditions of globally entangled consumption, movement, and contamination. The essays in this volume are complemented by artistic interventions that offer a poetics for a harmed planet and the numerous worlds it contains.

Earth and Beyond in Tumultuous Times is part of the series Future Ecologies dedicated to rethink the multiple ecologies that flourish and struggle on Earth and beyond.

6.34.2 Aesthetic Experience of Metabolic Processes

Author: Desiree Förster

Lüneburg: meson press, 2021

https://doi.org/10.14619/1808

Simultaneously speculative and inspired by everyday experiences, this volume develops an aesthetics of metabolism that offers a new perspective on the human-environment relation, one that is processual, relational, and not dependent on conscious thought. In art installations, design prototypes, and research-creation projects that utilize air, light, or temperature to impact subjective experience the author finds aesthetic milieus that shift our awareness to the

role of different sense modalities in aesthetic experience. Metabolic and atmospheric processes allow for an aesthetics besides and beyond the usually dominant visual sense.

Aesthetic Experience of Metabolic Processes is part of the series Future Ecologies dedicated to rethink the multiple ecologies that flourish and struggle on Earth and beyond.

6.35 December 2020

6.35.1 Pandemic Media: Preliminary Notes Toward an Inventory

Editor: Philipp Dominik Keidl

Editor: Laliv Melamed

Editor: Vinzenz Hediger

Editor: Antonio Somaini

Author: Ada Ackerman

Author: Neta Alexander

Author: Meredith A. Bak

Author: Marie-Aude Baronian

Author: Ulrike Bergermann

Author: Amrita Biswas

Author: Teresa Castro

Author: Didi Cheeka

Author: Michelle Cho

Author: Shane Denson

Author: Guilherme da Silva Machado

Author: Marijke de Valck

Author: Kerim Dogruel

Author: Stefanie Duguay

Author: Kester Dyer

Author: Christoph Engemann

Author: Karin Fleck

Author: Bishnupriya Ghosh

Author: Sophia Gräfe

Author: Malte Hagener

Author: Florian Hoof

Author: Marek Jancovic

Author: Alice Leroy

Author: Juan Llamas-Rodriguez

Author: John Mowitt

Author: Joshua Neves

Author: Alexandra Schneider

Author: Benjamín Schultz-Figueroa

Author: Diego Semerene

Author: Felix M. Simon

Author: Marc Steinberg

Author: Wanda Strauven

Author: Jaap Verheul

Author: Abby S. Waysdorf

Author: Rebecca Williams

Author: Leonie Zilch

Author: Yvonne Zimmermann

Lüneburg: meson press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.14619/0085

With its unprecedented scale and consequences the COVID-19 pandemic has generated a variety of new configurations of media. Responding to demands for information, synchronization, regulation, and containment, these "pandemic media" reorder social interactions, spaces, and temporalities, thus contributing to a reconfiguration of media technologies and the cultures and polities with which they are entangled. Highlighting media's adaptability, malleability, and scalability under the conditions of a pandemic, the contributions to this volume track and analyze how media emerge, operate, and change in response to the global crisis and provide elements toward an understanding of the post-pandemic world to come.

6.35.2 Ein Medium namens McLuhan: 37 Befragungen eines Klassikers

Editor: Peter Bexte

Editor: Martina Leeker

Author: Arie Altena

Author: Marie-Luise Angerer

Author: Benjamin Beil

Author: Klaus Benesch

Author: Peter Bexte

Author: Richard Cavell

Author: Jan Distelmeyer

Author: Bernhard J. Dotzler

Author: Wolfgang Ernst

Author: Petra Gehring

Author: Olga Goriunova

Author: Baruch Gottlieb

Author: Wolfgang Hagen

Author: Orit Halpern

Author: Karin Harrasser

Author: Jens Hauser

Author: Stefan Heidenreich

Author: Ute Holl

Author: Derrick de Kerckhove

Author: Martina Leeker

Author: Petra Löffler

Author: Shannon Mattern

Author: Dieter Mersch

Author: Stefan Münker

Author: Benjamin Peters

Author: John Durham Peters

Author: Claus Pias

Author: Markus Rautzenberg

Author: Stefan Rieger

Author: Katja Rothe

Author: Kerstin Schmidt

Author: Jens Schröter

Author: Erhard Schüttpelz

Author: Florian Sprenger

Author: Fred Turner

Author: Christina Vagt

Author: Hartmut Winkler

Lüneburg: meson press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.14619/1778

„If you don‘t like my arguments, I‘ve got some more.“ (Marshall McLuhan) Wie aber steht es um den Klassiker der Medienwissenschaften im 21. Jahrhundert? Diese Frage diskutieren 37 zeitgenössische Medienwissenschaftler_innen. Ihre Antworten stehen in einem reizvollen Kontrast zu Interviews, die 2007 entstanden und jetzt online zugänglich gemacht worden sind. Viele der ursprünglich Befragten sind erneut beteiligt, neue Stimmen kamen hinzu. Dabei zeigt sich im Vergleich: Die Medienwissenschaften sind diverser geworden, und manche Zukunftserwartung wurde drastisch revidiert.

6.35.3 High Definition: Medienphilosophisches Image Processing

Author: Elisa Linseisen

Lüneburg: meson press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.14619/1747

Dieses Buch zoomt in informationsreiche und pixeldichte Welten in HD. Digitalbildliche Hochauflösung ist hier ein Potenzial, das es ermöglicht, mit und an Bildern Wirklichkeit zu erforschen und zu befragen. Dokumentarfilme, Videokunstarbeiten, Galaxiefotografien, Blockbuster, Pressebilder und Netflix-Serien bestellen diese visuelle Kultur in HD und zeigen auf, dass Bilder und Wirklichkeit nicht in fixierten Rahmen sitzen, sondern im Prozess werden.

HD heißt Image Processing. Lässt man sich darauf ein, entfaltet sich das Angebot, mit HD zu denken und sich vom Denken der Bildprozesse mitreißen zu lassen.

6.36 November 2020

6.36.1 Affective Transformations: Politics – Algorithms – Media

Editor: Bernd Bösel

Editor: Serjoscha Wiemer

Author: Marie-Luise Angerer

Author: Pierre Cassou-Noguès

Author: Jean Clam

Author: Mathias Fuchs

Author: Gabriele Gramelsberger

Author: Irina Kaldrack

Author: Dawid Kasprowicz

Author: Oliver Leistert

Author: Michaela Ott

Author: Markus Rautzenberg

Author: Andrew Ross

Author: Paul Stenner

Lüneburg: meson press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.14619/1655

The Affective Turn has lost its former innocence and euphoria. Affect Studies and its adjacent disciplines have now to prove that they can cope with the return of the affective real that technology, economy, and politics entail.

Two seemingly contradictory developments serve as starting points for this volume. First, technological innovations such as affective computing, mood tracking, sentiment analysis, and social robotics all share a focus on the recognition and modulation of human affectivity. Affect gets measured, calculated, controlled. Secondly, recent developments in politics, social media usage, and right-wing journalism have contributed to a conspicuous rise of hate speech, cybermobbing, public shaming, "felt truths," and resentful populisms. In a very specific way, politics as well as power have become affective.

Affect gets mobilized, fomented, unleashed. When the ways we deal with our affectivity get unsettled in such a dramatic fashion, we have to rethink our ethical, aesthetical, political as well as legal regimes of affect organization.

6.37 August 2020

6.37.1 Action at a Distance

Author: John Durham Peters

Author: Florian Sprenger

Author: Christina Vagt

Lüneburg: meson press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.14619/152-5

The mediality of transmission and the materiality of communication result today more than ever in "acting at a distance" – an action whose agency lies in a medium. This book provides an overview into this crucial phenomenon, thereby introducing urgent questions of human interaction, the binding and breaking of time and space, and the entanglement of the material and the immaterial. Three vivid inquiries deal with histories and theories of mediality and materiality.

6.38 February 2020

6.38.1 Format Matters: Standards, Practices, and Politics in Media Cultures

Editor: Marek Jancovic

Editor: Axel Volmar

Editor: Alexandra Schneider

Author: Erika Balsom

Author: Oliver Fahle

Author: Florian Hoof

Author: Elisa Linseisen

Author: Ramon Lobato

Author: Roland Meyer

Author: Kalani Michell

Author: Antonio Somaini

Author: Markus Stauff

Author: Wanda Strauven

Author: Julian Thomas

Lüneburg: meson press, 2020

https://doi.org/10.14619/1556

From TIFF files to TED talks, from book sizes to blues stations—the term "format" circulates in a staggering array of contexts and applies to entirely dissimilar objects and practices. How can such a pliable notion meaningfully function as an instrument of classification in so many industries and scientific communities? Comprising a wide range of case studies on the standards, practices, and politics of formats from scholars of photography, film, radio, television, and the Internet, Format Matters charts the many ways in which formats shape and are shaped by past and present media cultures. This volume represents the first sustained collaborative effort to advance the emerging field of format studies.

6.39 December 2019

6.39.1 Medium, Format, Configuration: The Displacements of Film

Author: Benoît Turquety

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/0047

In contrast with media constructed as vast, ontologically homogeneous, non-localized systems, formats show material networks of interoperability and exclusions, inscribed in local specificities, and involving precise conditions for the circulation of images and sounds. Formats, institutionalized as standards, frame the "technical networks" defined by Gilbert Simondon, that unfold technical objects into economically and politically structured webs that cover the world. Media are always formatted and, as such, do not flow: they are displaced.

6.40 November 2019

6.40.1 Organize

Author: Timon Beyes

Author: Lisa Conrad

Author: Reinhold Martin

Afterword by: Geert Lovink

Afterword by: Ned Rossiter

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1518

Digital media technologies re-pose the question of organization—and thus of power and domination, control and surveillance, disruption and emancipation. This book interrogates organization as effect and condition of media. How can we understand the recursive relationship between media and organization? How can we think, explore, critique—and perhaps alter—the organizational bodies and scripts that shape contemporary life?

6.41 September 2019

6.41.1 Tracks from the Crypt

Author: John Mowitt

Introduction by: Rebecca Boguska

Introduction by: Vinzenz Hediger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/0030

David Bowie's 2015 Blackstar has been understood by critics and fans alike to have a certain valedictory status. For them, perhaps for us, it is a 39-minute and 13-second farewell. A long goodbye. My angle is different. By situating the Bowie/Renck collaboration on "Lazarus" in the context of a meditation on the question once posed by Georg Stanitzek, "Was ist Kommunikation?" I consider the CD and the video as experiments in re-configuration. More specifically, by thinking about the distinctly cinematic iteration of the question of communication (citing here Captain's "what we have here is … failure to communicate" from Cool Hand Luke) I propose that mediated communication embodies the Ich/Es modality of dialogue disparaged by Martin Buber. What this invites us to consider is whether "Lazarus" in particular isn't

the generation of an audiovisual tombeau from which or out of which communication strains are to be heard. Is it "saying" farewell? Is it "saying" anything? By drawing on Jacques Derrida's appropriation of the crypt in the work of Abraham and Torok, I propose that "Lazarus" manages (and the feat is neither small nor insignificant) to communicate nothing. In effect, "Lazarus" is the very sound, not of a failure to communicate, but of a "speaking" emptied of what protects it from mediation. Here, Bowie's gnomic persona assumes a political valence not typically ascribed to it.

6.41.2 Beyond the Flow: Scholarly Publications During and After the Digital

Author: Niels-Oliver Walkowski

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1600

In the wake of the so-called digital revolution numerous attempts have been made to rethink and redesign what scholarly publications can or should be. Beyond the Flow examines the technologies as well as narratives driving this unfolding transformation. By unpacking the confusion, heterogeneity and uncertainty that is surrounding scholarly publishing today the book asks for how a sustainable post-digital publishing ecology can be imagined.

6.42 August 2019

6.42.1 Archives

Author: Andrew Lison

Author: Marcell Mars

Author: Tomislav Medak

Author: Rick Prelinger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1501

Archives have become a nexus in the wake of the digital turn. This book sets out to show how expanded archival practices can challenge contemporary conceptions and inform the redistribution of power and resources. Calling for the necessity to reimagine the potentials of archives in practice, the three contributions ask: Can archives fulfill their paradoxical potential as utopian sites in which the analog and the digital, the past and future, and remembrance and forgetting commingle?

6.43 April 2019

6.43.1 Remain

Author: Ioana B. Jucan

Author: Jussi Parikka

Author: Rebecca Schneider

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1495

In a world undergoing constant media-driven change, the infrastructures, materialities, and temporalities of remains have become urgent. This book engages with the remains and remainders of media cultures through the lens both of theater and performance studies and of media archaeology. By taking "remain" as a verb, noun, state, and process of becoming, the authors explore the epistemological, social, and political implications.

6.44 January 2019

6.44.1 Markets

Author: Armin Beverungen

Author: Philip Mirowski

Author: Edward Nik-Khah

Author: Jens Schröter

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1471

Markets abound in media—but a media theory of markets is still emerging. Anthropology offers media archaeologies of markets, and the sociology of markets and finance unravels how contemporary financial markets have witnessed a media technological arms race. Building on such work, this volume brings together key thinkers of economic studies with German media theory, describes the central role of the media specificity of markets in new detail and inflects them in three distinct ways. Nik-Khah and Mirowski show how the denigration of human cognition and the concomitant faith in computation prevalent in contemporary market-design practices rely on neoliberal conceptions of information in markets. Schröter confronts the asymmetries and abstractions that characterize money as a medium and explores the absence of money in media. Beverungen situates these inflections and gathers further elements for

a politically and historically attuned media theory of markets concerned with contemporary phenomena such as high-frequency trading and cryptocurrencies.

6.44.2 Communication

Author: Paula Bialski

Author: Finn Brunton

Author: Mercedes Bunz

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1464

Contemporary communication puts us not only in conversation with one another but also with our machinery. Machine communication—to communicate not just via but also with machines—is therefore the focus of this volume. Diving into digital communications history, Finn Brunton brings to the fore the alienness of computational communication by looking at network timekeeping, automated trolling, and early attempts at communication with extraterrestrial life. Picking up this fascination with inhuman communication, Mercedes Bunz then performs a close reading of interaction design and interfaces to show how technology addresses humans (as very young children). Finally, Paula Bialski shares her findings from a field study of software development, analyzing the communicative forms that occur when code is written by separate people. Today, communication unfolds merely between two or more conscious entities but often includes an invisible third party. Inspired by this drastic shift, this volume uncovers new meanings of what it means "to communicate."

6.44.3 Machine

Author: Thomas Patrick Pringle

Author: Gertrud Koch

Author: Bernard Stiegler

Lüneburg: meson press, 2019

https://doi.org/10.14619/1488

In contrast with media constructed as vast, ontologically homogeneous, non-localized systems, formats show material networks of interoperability and exclusions, inscribed in local specificities, and involving precise conditions for the circulation of images and sounds. Formats, institutionalized as standards, frame the "technical networks" defined by Gilbert Simondon, that unfold technical objects into economically and politically structured webs that cover the world. Media are always formatted and, as such, do not flow: they are displaced.

6.45 November 2018

6.45.1 Ferocious Logics: Unmaking the Algorithm

Author: Luke Munn

Lüneburg: meson press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.14619/1402

Contemporary power manifests in the algorithmic. And yet this power seems incomprehensible: understood as code, it becomes apolitical; understood as a totality, it becomes overwhelming. This book takes an alternate approach, using it to unravel the operations of Uber and Palantir, Airbnb and Amazon Alexa. Moving off the whiteboard and into the world, the algorithmic must negotiate with frictions—the 'merely' technical routines of distributing data and running tasks coming together into broader social forces that shape subjectivities, steer bodies, and calibrate relationships. Driven by the imperatives of capital, the algorithmic exhausts subjects and spaces, a double move seeking to both exhaustively apprehend them and exhaust away their productivities. But these on-the-ground encounters also reveal that force is never guaranteed. The irreducibility of the world renders logic inadequate and control gives way to contingency.

6.45.2 Pattern Discrimination

Author: Clemens Apprich

Author: Florian Cramer

Author: Wendy Hui Kyong Chun

Author: Hito Steyerl

Lüneburg: meson press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.14619/1457

Algorithmic identity politics reinstate old forms of social segregation—in a digital world, identity politics is pattern discrimination. It is by recognizing patterns in input data that Artificial Intelligence algorithms create bias and practice racial exclusions thereby inscribing power relations into media. How can we filter information out of data without reinserting racist, sexist, and classist beliefs?

6.46 April 2018

6.46.1 Non-Knowledge and Digital Cultures

Editor: Andreas Bernard

Editor: Matthias Koch

Editor: Martina Leeker

Author: Timon Beyes

Author: Paula Bialski

Author: Alexandre Monnin

Author: Jeannie Moser

Author: Claus Pias

Author: Christoph Wulf

Lüneburg: meson press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.14619/1259

Making available massive amounts of data that are generated, distributed, and modeled, digital media provide us with the possibility of abundant information and knowledge. This possibility has been attracting various scenarios in which technology either eliminates non-knowledge or plants it deep within contemporary cultures through the universal power and opacity of algorithms. This volume comprises contributions from media studies, literary studies, sociology, ethnography, anthropology, and philosophy to discuss non-knowledge as an important concept for understanding contemporary digital cultures.

6.46.2 Ökologien der Erde: Zur Wissensgeschichte und Aktualität der Gaia-Hypothese

Author: Alexander Friedrich

Author: Petra Löffler

Author: Niklas Schrape

Author: Florian Sprenger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.14619/1204

Ökologien der Erde bestimmen die Gegenwart. Dabei gewinnt die in den 1970er Jahren von James Lovelock gemeinsam mit Lynn Margulis entwickelte Gaia-Theorie heute neue Erklärungskraft. Wenn Gaia bei Bruno Latour sogar zum allgemeinen Modell der Welterklärung im 21. Jahrhundert wird, gilt es, nach der Plausibilität zu fragen, die die Rede von Gaia aktuell entwickelt. Die vier Beiträge des Bandes geben hierauf eine Antwort, indem sie die metaphorologischen und begriffshistorischen Linien der Gaia-Theorie nachzeichnen und ihren Bezug auf zeitgenössische Computersimulationen in den Blick nehmen. So wird der gegenwärtige Ort des Wiederauflebens Gaias deutlich – und damit die Verschränkung von kybernetischen und organizistischen Ökologien mit der Annahme einer Programmierbarkeit von Umgebungen.

6.46.3 Unterwachen und Schlafen: Anthropophile Medien nach dem Interface

Editor: Michael Andreas

Editor: Dawid Kasprowicz

Editor: Stefan Rieger

Author: Suzana Alpsancar

Author: Kevin Liggieri

Author: Anna Tuschling

Lüneburg: meson press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.14619/1358

Anthropophile Medien durchdringen zunehmend unsere lebensweltliche Realität, sei es im Ambient Assisted Living, als Pflegeassistenzsysteme, in den Arbeitsszenarien einer Industrie 4.0, als behagliche Interfaces des Affective Computing oder als Lifetracker der Quantified-Self-Bewegung. Verbunden ist damit der Einzug menschlicher Befindlichkeiten, Werte und sozialer Routinen in das Design medialer Agencies. Über 40 Jahre nach dem Erscheinen von Michel Foucaults “Surveiller et punir” gerät damit auch dessen Kritikbegriff ins Wanken. An die Stelle von “Überwachen und Strafen” tritt “Unterwachen und Schlafen”. Unterwachen und Schlafen stellt nicht das theoretische Programm einer vollautomatisierten Lebenswelt in Aussicht, sondern das Konstrukt einer nunmehr medialen Umsetzung anthropologischer Grundelemente wie Autonomie, Freiheit oder Vertrauen.

6.47 January 2018

6.47.1 Von Open Access zu Open Science: Zum Wandel digitaler Kulturen der wissenschaftlichen Kommunikation

Author: Christian Heise

Lüneburg: meson press, 2018

https://doi.org/10.14619/1303

Mit der Digitalisierung geht der Ruf nach freiem Zugang zu wissenschaftlichen Forschungsergebnissen und einer Öffnung des Forschungsprozesses einher. Open Access und Open Science sind die Leitbegriffe dieses Transformationsprozesses, der von den einen euphorisch begrüßt und von den anderen heftig abgelehnt wird. Auf der Grundlage einer quantitativen Erhebung und eines reflexiven Experiments gibt das Buch Einblick in die aktuellen Debatten über die Chancen aber auch Hindernisse der Öffnung der Wissenschaften.

6.48 November 2017

6.48.1 Interventions in Digital Cultures: Technology, the Political, Methods

Editor: Howard Caygill

Editor: Martina Leeker

Editor: Tobias Schulze

Author: Ulrike Bergermann

Author: Wendy Hui Kyong Chun

Author: Alexander R. Galloway

Author: Kat Jungnickel

Author: Steve Kurtz

Author: Fred Turner

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/1105

How to intervene? Interventions are in vogue in digital cultures as forms of critique or political actions into public spheres. By engaging in social, political, and economic contexts, interventions attempt to interrupt and change situations—often with artistic means. This volume maps methods of interventions under the specific conditions of the digital. How are interventions shaped by these conditions? And how can they contribute to altering them? In essays and interviews, this book interrogates modes of intervening in and through art, infrastructures, techno-ecological environments, bio-technology, and political protests to highlight their potentials as well as their ambivalences.

6.49 October 2017

6.49.1 Medien verstehen: Marshall McLuhans Understanding Media

Editor: Till A. Heilmann

Editor: Jens Schröter

Author: Jana Mangold

Author: Florian Sprenger

Author: Gabriele Schabacher

Author: Petra Löffler

Author: Martina Leeker

Author: Marie-Luise Angerer

Author: Rainer Leschke

Author: Lorenz Engell

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/1150

Medien in ihrer historischen und technischen Vielfalt zu verstehen, das war das Versprechen, das Marshall McLuhan vor über fünfzig Jahren mit Understanding Media gegeben hatte. Unsere digital veränderte Gegenwart erfordert, das Buch heute erneut zu lesen und vor dem Hintergrund aktueller technischer Entwicklungen zu hinterfragen. Gegenstand des Sammelbandes sind u. a. McLuhans Idee von Medien als „Umwelten“, seine eigenwillige Sprache und Argumentation sowie seine Annahme der technischen Verfasstheit von Wahrnehmung.

6.49.2 Interferences and Events: On Epistemic Shifts in Physics through Computer Simulations

Editor: Anne Dippel

Editor: Martin Warnke

Author: Arianna Borrelli

Author: Hans De Raedt

Author: Wolfgang Hagen

Author: Lukas Mairhofer

Author: Mira Maiwöger

Author: Kristel Michielsen

Author: Frank Pasemann

Author: Hans-Jörg Rheinberger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/022

Computer simulations are omnipresent media in today's knowledge production. For scientific endeavors such as the detection of gravitational waves and the exploration of subatomic worlds, simulations are essential; however, the epistemic status of computer simulations is rather controversial as they are neither just theory nor just experiment. Therefore, computer simulations have challenged well-established insights and common scientific practices as well as our very understanding of knowledge. This volume contributes to the ongoing discussion on the epistemic position of computer simulations in a variety of physical disciplines, such as quantum optics, quantum mechanics, and computational physics. Originating from an interdisciplinary event, it shows that accounts of contemporary physics can constructively interfere with media theory, philosophy, and the history of science.

6.50 August 2017

6.50.1 Profile: Interdisziplinäre Beiträge

Editor: Martin Degeling

Editor: Julius Othmer

Editor: Andreas Weich

Editor: Bianca Westermann

Author: Bettina Berendt

Author: Andreas Bernard

Author: Katja Grashöfer

Author: Irina Kaldrack

Author: Nikolaus Lehner

Author: Martin Schmitt

Author: Fabian Pittroff

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/021

Profile haben Konjunktur. Seit der Verbreitung von Social Networking Sites sind sie alltäglicher Ort der Selbstdarstellung. Doch die Praktiken und Techniken der Profilierung sind keineswegs neu. Schon lange beschreiben Profile potentielle StraftäterInnen. Nun bestimmen sie auch die potentielle Kreditwürdigkeit.

Im Spannungsfeld zwischen Profil und Profilierung nehmen die Beiträge aus Medienwissenschaft, Soziologie, Geschichtswissenschaft und Informatik die vielschichtigen Dimensionen dieses zentralen Phänomens der digitalen Medienkultur in den Blick: Wie verändern sich Bedeutung und Bewertung des Profil-Begriffs? Wie stehen Profile in Zusammenhang mit Subjektivierung und Machtkonstellationen? Welche Wechselwirkungen zwischen Profilen und Privatheit sind gegenwärtig relevant?

6.51 May 2017

6.51.1 Affektökologie: Intensive Milieus und zufällige Begegnungen

Author: Marie-Luise Angerer

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/019

Das Denken des Humanen wird in besonderer Weise von den medientechnologischen Verschiebungen des 20. Jahrhunderts berührt. Affekt wird hier zu einem neuen Schwellenbegriff, der den Körper medientechnisch und politisch auf neue Weise anschlussfähig macht. In einer relationalen Neu-Organisation verdichtet sich das organische und technische Leben auf neue, intensive Weise zu einer Ökologie des Affektiven.

6.51.2 Ecology of Affect: Intensive Milieus and Contingent Encounters

Author: Marie-Luise Angerer

Translator: Gerrit Jackson

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/020

The way we conceive the human today is particularly affected by the shifts in media technology during the 20th century. Affect emerges as the new liminal concept that renders the body compatible in novel ways with the technology and politics of media. By ways of a relational reorganization the organic end technological life is condensed in a new, intense way to an ecology of affects.

6.52 January 2017

6.52.1 Symptoms of the Planetary Condition: A Critical Vocabulary

Editor: Mercedes Bunz

Editor: Birgit Mara Kaiser

Editor: Kathrin Thiele

Author: Kiene Brillenburg Wurth

Author: Rosemarie Buikema

Author: Kári Driscoll

Author: Yvonne Förster

Author: Annemie Halsema

Author: Leonard Lawlor

Author: Jacques Lezra

Author: Sam McAuliffe

Author: Timothy O'Leary

Author: Bettina Papenburg

Author: Esther Peeren

Author: Asja Szafraniec

Author: Melanie Sehgal

Author: Sybrandt van Keulen

Author: Veronica Vasterling

Author: Jennifer A. Wagner-Lawlor

Lüneburg: meson press, 2017

https://doi.org/10.14619/018

This book explores the future of critique in view of our planetary condition. How are we to intervene in contemporary constellations of finance capitalism, climate change and neoliberalism? Think we must! To get to the symptoms, the book's 38 terms ranging from affect and affirmation to world and work provide the reader with a critical toolbox to be continued. Negativity, judgment and opposition as modes of critique have run out of steam. Critique as an attitude and a manner of enquiry has not.

6.53 July 2016

6.53.1 Trick 17: Mediengeschichten zwischen Zauberkunst und Wissenschaft

Author: Sebastian Vehlken

Author: Katja Müller-Helle

Author: Jan Müggenburg

Author: Florian Sprenger

Lüneburg: meson press, 2016

https://doi.org/10.14619/017

Der Zauber der Medien speist sich aus ihrem Geheimnis: Den Usern von heute sind Laptop, Smartphone oder Tablet eine Blackbox, die ihre Sinne im Bann hält und die Techniktricks im Inneren hinter einer opaken Oberfläche verbirgt. Doch solche Verzauberung ist nicht neu. Umihr auf die Spur zu kommen, nähert sich dieses Buch der Mediengeschichte der Zauberei an der Schwelle zwischen magischem Moment und Ent-Täuschung. Nicht seltenfolgt einer geradezu übernatürlich wirkenden Zaubervorführung die wissenschaftliche Erklärung und Offenlegung ihrer Tricks. Ein solcher Akt der Entzauberung mag zwar magische Momente als faulen Zauber demaskieren. Er rückt dafür jedoch die Technologien der Täuschung ins Rampenlicht: Erst die Ausnutzung physikalischer Gesetze, das Konstruieren mechanischer Zauberapparate und das Spiel mit der Wahrnehmung der Zuschauer machen deren ‚Verzauberung' möglich. Sie erlaubt, die Frage nach Wissen, dem medialen Zugriff auf unsere Sinne und dem sinnlichen Zugriff auf unsere Welt erneut zu stellen.

6.54 October 2015

6.54.1 Citizen Lobby: From Capacity to Influence

Author: Leif Thomas Olsen

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/010

The Internet holds endless opportunities for exchange and dialogue and the promise of developing a better democratic model. Day-to-day politics are largely driven by economic lobbies in the interest of what Habermas calls their „generalised particularism," the threat to take jobs and tax revenues elsewhere. Citizens' influence over politicians is twofold: they are asked for their input in elections, referenda, online consultations and surveys, and citizens can initiate issues where they see political action needed. Yet these "participative forces," including NGOs,

street rallies and charities, regularly fail to reach the ears of elected politicians as effectively as those of well-funded corporate lobbies. Also, this type of voluntary engagement often falls short of presenting the kind of reasoned challenges to the incumbents—by the electorate—that Habermas' communicative action aimed at. A more powerful model would therefore organise the efforts of the electorate in a way that both generates those reasoned arguments, which, as Habermas quite correctly pointed out differ from mere opinions, and delivers them to the elected politicians in a manner they can neither refuse nor ignore. This is what the Citizen Lobby intends to do.

6.55 September 2015

6.55.1 There is no Software, there are just Services

Editor: Irina Kaldrack

Editor: Martina Leeker

Author: Seth Erickson

Author: Anders Fagerjord

Author: Christopher Kelty

Author: Andrew Lison

Author: Liam Magee

Author: Christoph Neubert

Author: Jussi Parikka

Author: Ned Rossiter

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/008

Is software dead? Services like Google, Dropbox, Adobe Creative Cloud, or Social Media apps are all-pervasive in our digital media landscape. This marks the (re)emergence of the service paradigm that challenges traditional business and license models as well as modes of media creation and use. The short essays in this edited collection discuss how services shift the notion of software, the cultural technique of programming, conditions of labor as well as the ecology and politics of data and how they influence dispositifs of knowledge.

Contributors: Ned Rossiter, Jussi Parikka, Christoph Neubert, Liam Magee, Andrew Lison, Christopher M. Kelty, Anders Fagerjord, and Seth Erickson.

6.56 July 2015

6.56.1 Library Life: Werkstätten kulturwissenschaftlichen Forschens

Author: Friedolin Krentel

Author: Katja Barthel

Author: Sebastian Brand

Author: Alexander Friedrich

Author: Anna Rebecca Hoffmann

Author: Laura Meneghello

Author: Jennifer Ch. Müller

Author: Christian Wilke

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/006

Wie und wo entsteht kulturwissenschaftliches Wissen? Im Kopf? In der Bibliothek? Am Schreibtisch? Inspiriert von den Laborstudien der Science & Technology Studies ging das Autor*innen-Kollektiv des vorliegenden Buchs diesen Fragen nach. Aufgesucht wurden die persönlichen Schreiborte von Kulturwissenschaftler*innen verschiedener Disziplinen. In ihren Beiträgen eröffnen die Autor*innen vielfältige Perspektiven auf bislang kaum erforschte Praktiken kulturwissenschaftlicher Wissensproduktion. Hierdurch wird ein komplexes Zusammenspiel technisch-materieller, praktischer, medialer, sozialer, institutioneller, ökonomischer, politischer und ideeller Dimensionen in den Werkstätten kulturwissenschaftlichen Forschens freigelegt. Die Ergebnisse der interdisziplinär angelegten und kollaborativ erarbeiteten Studien liefern überraschende Einsichten und eröffnen weiterführende Forschungsfragen: ein Plädoyer für eine reflexive, kollaborativ-interdisziplinäre Wissenschaftspraxis.

6.56.2 Introduction to a Future Way of Thought: On Marx and Heidegger

Author: Kostas Axelos

Editor: Stuart Elden

Translator: Kenneth Mills

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/009

"Technologists only change the world in various ways in generalized indifference; the point is to think the world and interpret the changes in its unfathomability, to perceive and experience the difference binding being to the nothing." Anticipating the age of planetary technology Kostas Axelos, a Greek-French philosopher, approaches the technological question in this book, first published in 1966, by connecting the thought of Karl Marx and Martin Heidegger. Marx famously declared that philosophers had only interpreted the world, but the point was to change it. Heidegger on his part stressed that our modern malaise was due to the forgetting of being, for which he thought technological questions were central. Following from his study of Marx as a thinker of technology, and foreseeing debates about globalization, Axelos recognizes that technology now determines the world. Providing an introduction to some of his major themes, including the play of the world, Axelos asks if planetary technology requires a new, a future way of thought which in itself is planetary.

6.56.3 Alleys of Your Mind: Augmented Intelligence and Its Traumas

Editor: Matteo Pasquinelli

Author: Benjamin H. Bratton

Author: Orit Halpern

Author: Adrian Lahoud

Author: Jon Lindblom

Author: Catherine Malabou

Author: Reza Negarestani

Author: Luciana Parisi

Author: Matteo Pasquinelli

Author: Ana Teixeira Pinto

Author: Michael Wheeler

Author: Charles T. Wolfe

Author: Ben Woodard

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/014

What does thinking mean in the age of Artificial Intelligence? How is big-scale computation transforming the way our brains function? This collection discusses these pressing questions by looking beyond instrumental rationality. Exploring recent developments as well as examples from the history of cybernetics, the book uncovers the positive role played by errors and

traumas in the construction of our contemporary technological minds. With texts by Benjamin Bratton, Orit Halpern, Adrian Lahoud, Jon Lindblom, Catherine Malabou, Reza Negarestani, Luciana Parisi, Matteo Pasquinelli, Ana Teixeira Pinto, Michael Wheeler, Charles Wolfe, and Ben Woodard.

6.56.4 Life and Technology: An Inquiry Into and Beyond Simondon

Author: Jean-Hugues Barthélémy

Translator: Barnaby Norman

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/015

The philosophy of Gilbert Simondon has reinvigorated contemporary thinking about biological and technological beings. In this book, Jean-Hugues Barthélémy takes up Simondon's thought and shows how life and technology are connected by a transversal theme: individuation. In the first essay, Barthélémy delivers a contemporary interpretation of Simondon's concept of ontogenesis against the backdrop of biology and cybernetics. In the second essay, he extends his reflections to propose a non-anthropological understanding of technology, and so sets up a confrontation with the work of Martin Heidegger.

6.56.5 Digital Activism in Asia Reader

Editor: Nishant Shah

Editor: Puthiya Purayil Sneha

Editor: Sumandro Chattapadhyay

Author: Denisse Albornoz

Author: Esra'a Al Shafei

Author: Maesy Angelina

Author: Htaike Htaike Aung

Author: Anat Ben-David

Author: Nandini Chami

Author: Tracey Cheng

Author: Armand Hurault

Author: Rachael Jolley

Author: Youngmi Kim

Author: Merlyna Lim

Author: Sarah McKeever

Author: Subhashish Panigrahi

Author: Prabhas Pokharel

Author: Puthiya Purayil Sneha

Author: Padmini Ray Murray

Author: Urvashi Sarkar

Author: Shobha S V

Author: YiPing Zona Tsou

Author: Hu Yong

Author: Huma Yusuf

Author: Weiyu Zhang

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/013

The digital turn might as well be marked as an Asian turn. From flash-mobs in Taiwan to feminist mobilisations in India, from hybrid media strategies of Syrian activists to cultural protests in Thailand, we see the emergence of political acts that transform the citizen from being a beneficiary of change to becoming an agent of change. In co-shaping these changes, what the digital shall be used for, and what its consequences will be, are both up for speculation and negotiation. Digital Activism in Asia marks a particular shift where these questions are no longer being refracted through the ICT4D logic, or the West's attempts to save Asia from itself, but shaped by multiplicity, unevenness, and urgencies of digital sites and users in Asia. This reader crowd-sources critical tools, concepts, analyses, and annotations, self-identified by a network of change makers in Asia as important in their own practices within their own contexts.

6.56.6 The Political Structure of UK Broadcasting 1949–1999

Author: David Elstein

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/011

In 1999 David Elstein delivered a lecture series examining the evolvement of UK Broadcasting policy from 1949 to 1999. His sharp analysis is a valuable contribution to the post-war development of the British broadcasting system and unfolds many topical issues in current media policy debates.

6.56.7 Diversity of Play

Editor: Mathias Fuchs

Author: Astrid Ensslin

Author: Tanya Krzywinska

Author: Karen Palmer

Author: Markus Rautzenberg

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/012

The early days when digital games were new, harmless, and a niche are long gone. Today's games can simulate battlefields, predict disaster, and crash markets. We are faced with a diversity of play and the ubiquity of games, making them not only a popular medium, but the leading medium of our contemporary society. Based on the keynote lectures held at DiGRA2015, "Diversity of Play" provides a critical view on the current stage of digital games from a theoretic, artistic, and practical perspective by pointing towards the uncanny, the power of "unnatural" narratives, and the exceptions and uncertainties of digital ludic environments. With an interview with Karen Palmer and essays by Astrid Ensslin, Mathias Fuchs, Tanya Krzywinska, and Markus Rautzenberg.

6.57 June 2015

6.57.1 The Cyborg: A Treatise on the Artificial Man

Author: Antonio Caronia

Translator: Robert Booth

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/007

Born on the pages of science fiction comics in the 1920s and 30s, the cyborg lives in popular imagination. As hero of the cyberpunk epic, in its brief but intense history, the cyborg has followed and anticipated the rapport and conflict between man and machine.

In the post-fordist era of digital networked media the cyborg unfolds itself in the dissemination of multiple bodies: on the Internet, in the shift of individual identity, in the new collective aggregation connected by software. It bridges virtuality and concreteness, possibility and necessity. The cyborg thus becomes a field of social conflict, one of the new figures in which the bio-political perspective is embodied.

6.57.2 30 Years After Les Immatériaux: Art, Science and Theory

Editor: Andreas Broeckmann

Editor: Yuk Hui

Author: Jean-Louis Boissier

Author: Daniel Birnbaum

Author: Thierry Dufrêne

Author: Francesca Gallo

Author: Charlie Gere

Author: Antony Hudek

Author: Jean-François Lyotard

Author: Robin Mackay

Author: Anne Elisabeth Sejten

Author: Bernard Stiegler

Author: Sven-Olov Wallenstein

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/002

In 1985, the French philosopher Jean-François Lyotard curated a groundbreaking exhibition called Les Immatériaux at the Centre Pompidou in Paris. The exhibition showed how telecommunication technologies were beginning to impact every aspect of life. At the same time, it was a material demonstration of what Lyotard called the post-modern condition. This book features a previously unpublished report by Jean-François Lyotard on the conception of Les Immatériaux and its relation to postmodernity. Reviewing the historical significance of the exhibition, his text is accompanied by twelve contemporary meditations. The philosophers, art historians, and artists analyse this important moment in the history of media and theory, and reflect on the new material conditions brought about by digital technologies in the last 30 years.

6.57.3 Die verschiedenen Modi der Existenz

Author: Étienne Souriau

Translator: Thomas Wäckerle

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/003

„Wäre die Philosophie auch nur eine Stunde der Mühe wert, wenn sie uns nicht für das Leben rüstete?“ Gezielten Schrittes entwirft der französische Philosoph Étienne Souriau in diesem dicht gedrängten Buch eine Grammatik der Existenz. Im Fokus steht nicht nur ihre Theorie, sondern auch die tatsächliche Ausübung der „Kunst des Existierens“. Wie Gilles Deleuze und William James vertritt Souriau dabei die These eines existenziellen Pluralismus: Es gibt Phänomene, Dinge, das Virtuelle, fiktionale Wesen – die Existenz ist polyphon. Souriaus radikale Herangehensweise hat auch Bruno Latour und Isabelle Stengers entscheidend beeinflusst. In ihrer ausführlichen Einleitung zu Souriaus Text von 1943 und dem ebenfalls zum ersten Mal in deutscher Sprache veröffentlichten Vortrag „Über den Modus der Existenz des zu vollbringenden Werks“ (1956) zeigt sich eindrucksvoll die Aktualität seines Denkens.

6.57.4 Politik der Mikroentscheidungen: Edward Snowden, Netzneutralität und die Architekturen des Internets

Author: Florian Sprenger

Foreword by: Christopher Kelty

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/004

Ob beim Aufrufen einer Webseite, beim Versenden einer E-Mail oder beim Hochfrequenzhandel an der Börse: Auf ihrem Weg durch die Weiten digitaler Netze durchqueren Bits zahlreiche Knoten, an denen eine Reihe von Mikroentscheidungen getroffen werden. Diese Entscheidungen betreffen den besten Pfad zum Ziel, die Verarbeitungsgeschwindigkeit oder die Priorität zwischen den ankommenden Paketen.

In ihrer vielschichtigen Gestalt bilden solche Mikroentscheidungen eine bislang nur marginal beachtete Dimension von Kontrolle und Überwachung im 21. Jahrhundert. Sie sind sowohl die kleinste Einheit als auch die technische Voraussetzung einer gegenwärtigen Politik digitaler Netzwerke – und des Widerstands gegen sie. Die aktuellen Debatten um Netzneutralität und Edward Snowdens Enthüllung der NSA-Überwachung bilden dabei lediglich die Spitze des Eisbergs. Auf dem Spiel steht nicht weniger als die Zukunft des Internets, wie wir es kennen.

6.57.5 The Politics of Micro-Decisions: Edward Snowden, Net Neutrality, and the Architectures of the Internet

Author: Florian Sprenger

Foreword by: Christopher Kelty

Translator: Valentine A. Pakis

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/005

Be it in the case of opening a website, sending an email, or high-frequency trading, bits and bytes of information have to cross numerous nodes at which micro-decisions are made. These decisions concern the most efficient path through the network, the processing speed, or the priority of incoming data packets.

Despite their multifaceted nature, micro-decisions are a dimension of control and surveillance in the twenty-first century that has received little critical attention. They represent the smallest unit and the technical precondition of a contemporary network politics – and of our potential opposition to it. The current debates regarding net neutrality and Edward Snowden's revelation of NSA surveillance are only the tip of the iceberg. What is at stake is nothing less than the future of the Internet as we know it.

6.58 January 2015

6.58.1 In Catastrophic Times: Resisting the Coming Barbarism

Author: Isabelle Stengers

Lüneburg: meson press, 2015

https://doi.org/10.14619/016

There has been an epochal shift: the possibility of a global climate crisis is now upon us. Pollution, the poison of pesticides, the exhaustion of natural resources, falling water tables, growing social inequalities – these are all problems that can no longer be treated separately. The effects of global warming have a cumulative impact, and it is not a matter of a crisis that will "pass" before everything goes back to "normal."

Our governments are totally incapable of dealing with the situation. Economic warfare obliges them to stick to the goal of irresponsible, even criminal, economic growth, whatever the cost. It is no surprise that people were so struck by the catastrophe in New Orleans. The response of the authorities – to abandon the poor whilst the rich were able to take shelter – is a symbol of the coming barbarism.

6.59 June 2014

6.59.1 Rethinking Gamification

Editor: Mathias Fuchs

Editor: Sonia Fizek

Editor: Paolo Ruffino

Editor: Niklas Schrape

Author: Sebastian Deterding

Author: Daphne Dragona

Author: Gabriele Ferri

Author: Sonia Fizek

Author: Maxwell Foxman

Author: Scott Nicholson

Author: Thibault Philippette

Author: Fabrizio Augusto Poltronieri

Author: Felix Raczkowski

Author: Joost Raessens

Author: Paolo Ruffino

Author: Niklas Schrape

Author: Matthew Tiessen

Lüneburg: meson press, 2014

https://doi.org/10.14619/001

Gamification marks a major change to everyday life. It describes the permeation of economic, political, and social contexts by game-elements such as awards, rule structures, and interfaces that are inspired by video games. Sometimes the term is reduced to the implementation of points, badges, and leaderboards as incentives and motivations to be productive. Sometimes it is envisioned as a universal remedy to deeply transform society toward more humane and playful ends. Despite its use by corporations to manage brand communities and personnel, however, gamification is more than just a marketing buzzword. States are beginning to use it as a new tool for governing populations more effectively. It promises to fix what is wrong with reality by making every single one of us fitter, happier, and healthier. Indeed, it seems like all of society is up for being transformed into one massive game.

The contributions in this book offer a candid assessment of the gamification hype. They trace back the historical roots of the phenomenon and explore novel design practices and methods. They critically discuss its social implications and even present artistic tactics for resistance. It is time to rethink gamification!

7 Open Book Publishers

This page shows the latest publications (in descending order of publication date) from Open Book Publishers.

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Last updated: 2026-11-03 01:00:19

7.0.1 Who Will Speak the Truth? Buenaventura de Salinas y Córdova's Activist 'Memorial', Peru, 1630

Author: Buenaventura de Salinas y Córdova

Translator: Stephanie Merrim

Editor: Stephanie Merrim

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0532

'Who Will Speak the Truth?' brings to light the powerful seventeenth-century voice of the Peruvian Franciscan Buenaventura de Salinas y Córdova, whose 'Memorial on the Histories of the New World, Peru' (1630) stands as one of the earliest and most forceful creole denunciations of colonial injustices against Andean Indigenous peoples. Framed by the apocalyptic imagery of the opening of the Seventh Seal in the Book of Revelation, Salinas's Memorial is both exposé and call to action, articulating a passionate plea for justice and reform within the Spanish Empire.

7.0.2 Microscopic Life in Early-Twentieth- and Twenty-First-Century Literature and Performance

Editor: Liliane Campos

Editor: Sarah Bouttier

Editor: François-Joseph Lapointe

Editor: Sarah Montin

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0509

This volume provides a groundbreaking interdisciplinary collection exploring how literature and performance engage with life at microscopic scales. Responding to an era dominated by planetary thinking, the volume turns attention to the invisible biological dimensions that shape our imagination of life, community, and ecology. Drawing from North American and European case studies, the volume's essays and creative works examine how fiction, poetry, theatre, dance, installation art and museum practices render microbial and cellular processes perceptible, to enable new ethical and political relationships across species and scales.

7.0.3 Hydrology for Sustainability

Author: Stephanie Kampf

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0551

Hydrology for Sustainability is an accessible textbook introducing the movement of water through Earth's interconnected systems.

7.1 September 2026

7.1.1 Nicaragua Azul: Natural History of Nicaragua's Subaquatic Ecological Heritage

Author: Fabio Buitrago

Author: Peltier Barahona

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0547

This volume invites readers beneath the surface of a country shaped by two oceans, vast lakes, volcanic lagoons, rivers and estuaries.

7.1.2 Embedded Pedagogies: Digital Humanities Teaching and the Infrastructure of Change

Author: Brandon Walsh

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0544

This volume offers a timely and incisive exploration of teaching in an era of institutional instability and political pressure.

7.1.3 Bioethics in Apocalyptic Times

Author: Henk ten Have

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0548

This book confronts one of the defining challenges of our age: how to think and act ethically in a world increasingly shaped by crisis, uncertainty, and a pervasive sense of vulnerability.

7.1.4 Music and Dances from Central Nepal: The Works of Subi Shah: Volume 1

Editor: Anna Marie Stirr

Editor: Mason Brown

Editor: Hikmat Khadka

Editor: Lochan Rijal

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0246

Music and Dances from Central Nepal is the first English translation of Shah's works. This collection includes three published works— Madal, "Pangdure (Maruni) Folk Dances", and Glimpses of Nepali Folk Songs—and three unpublished manuscripts— Introduction to Nepali Tunes, Sorati, and Basic Theory of Folk Dance.

7.2 August 2026

7.2.1 Trespassing: The Subversive Travel of Indonesian Women in Literature and Performance

Author: Jennifer Goodlander

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0542

This volume explores how Indonesian women writers and artists challenge the boundaries of home, nation, and identity through acts of movement, both real and imagined.

7.2.2 The Doctrine of One: Personal Encounters with Film, Art and Music

Author: Michael Beckerman

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0510

This volume is a bold and original meditation on how we interpret art, music, and culture—and what it means to listen, see, and feel differently from others. Drawing on Czech history and aesthetics, the book moves from filmmaker Hugo Haas's coded tributes to his murdered brother, to the haunting ex libris designs of Josef Váchal, to the deeply personal resonances of Schubert's chamber music, Dvořák's cello concerto, and Gideon Klein's tragic Terezín Trio. Across these vivid case studies, the author asks whether meaning in art can ever be shared—or whether it always belongs to the individual observer.

7.2.3 The Diaries of Anthony Hewitson, Provincial Journalist, Volume 2: 1891–1912

Editor: Andrew Hobbs

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0270

Journalist Anthony Hewitson (1836-1912) worked in one of the largest sectors of the periodical press, provincial newspapers. His diaries, written between 1865 and 1912, reveal the people, processes and networks involved in the creation of Victorian newspapers.

7.2.4 Orienting Public Policy: Ethicists in Democratic Public Reasoning

Author: Frans W.A. Brom

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0541

In an era of increasing polarization, the book calls for a renewed understanding of ethics as a reflective public practice. It offers guidance for philosophers, policymakers, and advisors seeking to sustain a democratic ethos grounded in equality, dignity, and the rule of law.

7.2.5 Bourdieu and Literature

Author: John R.W. Speller

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0522

This study explores the impact of literature on Bourdieu's intellectual itinerary, and how his literary understanding intersected with his sociological theory and thinking about cultural policy. This is the first full-length study of Bourdieu's work on literature in English, and it provides an invaluable resource for students and scholars of literary studies, cultural theory and sociology.

7.2.6 Applied Psychology in Context: Stories and Lessons from Palestinian Villages

Author: Caesar Hakim

Author: Hamish J McLeod

Author: Mohammad Alkhatib

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0546

This book is an innovative, practice-oriented resource that reframes how psychology is applied in complex, real-world settings.

7.3 July 2026

7.3.1 The Khan's Pifferi: Reading about the Musics of Asia in Late Fifteenth-Century Italy

Author: Tim Shephard

Author: Chenxi Xiao

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0531

This volume explores what Italian readers of the 1480s and 1490s could learn about Asian music through the expanding medium of print.

7.3.2 The Philosophy of Julia Wedgwood: Imperfect Antithesis

Author: Alison Stone

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0543

Combining philosophical analysis with innovative digital methods for recovering lost texts, this study restores Wedgwood as a major nineteenth-century philosopher and offers a compelling new lens on moral and historical experience.

7.3.3 Rethinking Social Justice: Theory and Action in an Age of Transition

Author: Michael Karlberg

Author: Derik Smith

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0536

This book offers a compelling and original rethinking of social justice at a moment of global uncertainty and transformation. Tracing the emergence and evolution of modern social justice discourse, it addresses two fundamental questions: what ends should we aspire toward, and what means are most effective in pursuing them? Moving beyond familiar critiques of injustice, the authors identify a shared, though often implicit, horizon that diverse traditions of thought all orient toward: contributive justice. This positive vision of social justice centers on the creation of social conditions that enable every individual and group to develop their capacities to contribute meaningfully to collective flourishing.

7.3.4 Verbal Multi-Word Expressions in Corpus Languages: Data, Methodology, and Analysis

Editor: Victoria Beatrix Fendel

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0478

This volume brings together a diverse, interdisciplinary cohort of scholars to shed new light on verbal multi-word expressions in corpus languages such as Greek, Latin, and Egyptian.

7.3.5 Teaching Dido: Critical Perspectives on Aeneid 4

Editor: Ingo Gildenhard

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0540

A companion to *Virgil, Aeneid 4, with Study Questions, Vocabulary, and Commentary* (OBP 2026), *Teaching Dido* includes five essays that explore aspects of Virgil's poetry in a student-friendly way. They range from issues in poetics (verse design, allusion) to key themes ('historiographical Dido', religion, pietās). Six reprinted scholarly articles follow, allowing students and their teachers to engage directly with some of the research that informs the essays and the commentary and to broaden their appreciation of Dido, the Aeneid, Virgil, and the wider historical context. Topics covered include the ethics of hospitality, the interface of intertextuality and psychology in the construction of character, Carthage and Rome as imperial powers, racecraft in Aeneid 4, Virgil's authorial self-fashioning and negotiation of the Augustan new normal, the myth of Troy in Rome's cultural imaginary, and Dido's place within Virgil's philosophy of history.

7.4 June 2026

7.4.1 Virgil, Aeneid 4, with Study Questions, Vocabulary, and Commentary

Aeneid 4, with Study Questions, Vocabulary, and Commentary" width="300"/>

Author: Ingo Gildenhard

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0527

Poetry that has fascinated readers since antiquity is here presented in an innovative, student-friendly edition, with study questions, vocabulary, commentary and visual material designed to facilitate engagement with Virgil's text.

7.4.2 After the Before Times: Teachers' Experiences of Pandemic Pedagogy

Author: Sarah E. Barrett

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0529

After the Before Times documents how teachers experienced those early months of COVID-19 pandemic pedagogy—and what their stories reveal about the nature of teaching and learning

7.5 May 2026

7.5.1 The Politics of Open Infrastructures: Power, Governance, and Justice in Digital Knowledge Practices

Editor: Katja Mayer

Editor: Astrid Mager

Editor: Renée Ridgway

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0528

This volume examines how openness is designed, governed, contested and lived in contemporary digital knowledge infrastructures. From open source software and internet standards, to citizen science platforms, public sector data systems and alternative computing practices, the book shows that infrastructures are never neutral technical backbones.

7.5.2 The Unbearable Light(ness) of AI: Bright Promises and Hidden Shadows of Artificial Intelligence

Editor: Giuliano Pozza

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0530

This volume examines one of the defining tensions of our era: how to harness the transformative power of artificial intelligence while preserving responsibility, sovereignty, and human judgement. Bringing together scholars and practitioners, this volume moves beyond hype and alarmism to explore AI across three interconnected levels: global systems, organisational governance, and personal ethics. It addresses digital sovereignty, cybersecurity, sustainability, inclusion, healthcare, education, and accessibility, highlighting both the environmental and social costs of AI and its potential to advance innovation within the Sustainable Development Goals.

7.5.3 A Multipolar Approach to Early Christian Arabic: Vatican Arabic Ms 13 in the Linguistic Landscape of Early Islam

Author: Phillip W. Stokes

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0517

This volume offers the most comprehensive linguistic analysis to date of Vatican Arabic MS 13, a late 9th/early 10th-century Arabic Gospel manuscript. Combining meticulous quantitative study with wide-ranging comparative evidence, this book provides an in-depth examination of the manuscript's orthography, phonology, morphology, morpho-syntax, and syntax. Through extensive charts, tables, and multiple interpretive frameworks, the author illuminates how linguistic features pattern across every dimension relevant to accurate analysis.

Crucially, the study does not treat MS 13 in isolation. Its features are systematically compared with those of other Christian Arabic manuscripts, Quranic traditions, medieval Arabic registers, early poetry, and modern dialects. This contextualised approach situates the manuscript within the rich linguistic diversity of medieval Arabic and challenges long-standing assumptions about 'Middle Arabic' and 'Classical Arabic'. By demonstrating that many features of MS 13 align with broader scribal and linguistic practices of the period, the book makes a compelling case against the notion that scribes worked towards a single, unified register or variety. Rather, they drew creatively and pragmatically from a diverse repertoire of features and linguistic traditions, revealing a far more dynamic and multifaceted approach to written composition than previously recognised.

An outstanding and field-shaping contribution, this volume provides an essential model for future work on Christian Arabic, medieval Arabic varieties, and the history of Arabic more broadly.

7.5.4 Colour Matters: Exploring Chromatic Materialities in the Long Nineteenth Century (1798-1914)

Editor: Stefano Evangelista

Editor: Charlotte Ribeyrol

Editor: Matthew Winterbottom

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0501

Colour Matters provides a fresh investigation of colour in the long nineteenth century. Across fourteen richly researched essays, the book explores the materiality, politics, and sensory experience of colour—from synthetic dyes and chrome pigments to the role of colour in medicine, gender, empire, and identity.

7.5.5 The Sentencing of Jesus (Gzar-dina de-Yeshu): The 'Authentic' Jewish Protocols of the Trial of Jesus

Author: Gideon Bohak

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0497

By reconstructing an ancient polemical text that has previously been known only in a fragmentary manner, and by situating it both within its Late Antique context and in the context of previous scholarship, this book makes a significant contribution to the study of Judaism, and of Jewish-Christian relations, in Late Antiquity and the early Middle Ages.

7.5.6 Benjamin Franklin, Orthoepist and Phonetician: Vol. 1: Language, Literacy and Social Mobility in Franklin's World

Author: Gary D. German

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0470

This book offers a groundbreaking exploreation of Franklin's little-studied linguistic legacy – his *Reformed Mode of Spelling* (1768/1779).

7.5.7 Distributing Knowledge: Openness, Equity, and Higher Education Transformation

Author: Richard F. Heller

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0520

Inequity is deeply embedded in higher education: in who can access learning, whose knowledge is created and valued, who gets published, and who ultimately benefits from universities' work. Distributing Knowledge argues that the sector is falling short of its public mission—and that incremental reform is no longer enough.

7.5.8 Benjamin Franklin, Orthoepist and Phonetician: Vol. 2: Colonial American Voices and London Norms: Franklin's Quest for an Orthographic Reform

Author: Gary D. German

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0537

Benjamin Franklin has been hailed as an inventor, scientist, printer, author, philosopher, diplomat, philanthropist and political activist and, especially, a founding father of the United States, but few are aware he was also a phonetician. This volume offers a groundbreaking exploration of Franklin's little-studied linguistic legacy—his Reformed Mode of Spelling (1768/1779). In this short treatise, Franklin outlined a plan for a radical, phonetically-based modernization of the English spelling system that would simultaneously serve as a pronunciation guide for what he envisaged to be 'correct' English as well as a practical scheme allowing the unlettered and foreigners to learn to read and write 'within a week'. The social and sociolinguistic reasons for its inception as well as what that model entailed linguistically are the focus of this book.

7.6 April 2026

7.6.1 From the Margins: Migrant Academics' Narratives of Precarity

Editor: Ladan Rahbari

Editor: Olga Burlyuk

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0508

From the Margins: Migrant Academics' Narratives of Precarity is the much-anticipated second volume following *Migrant Academics' Narratives of Precarity and Resilience in Europe* published in 2023, and available at https://www.openbookpublishers.com/books/10.11647/obp.0331. This new collection deepens and expands the conversation on the lived experiences of migrant academics navigating global academia.

Maintaining the autoethnographic and narrative approach of the first volume, *From the Margins* brings together diverse voices that challenge the Eurocentric framing of academic mobility by extending the focus beyond Europe to contexts such as the United States, Canada, Australia, Japan, South Africa, and the Middle East. Through deeply personal, creative, and reflexive narratives, the contributors delve deep into the notions of privilege, migration, and precarity, revealing how academic hierarchies and colonial legacies shape everyday experiences of belonging, vulnerability, and resilience.

Bridging scholarship and storytelling, this volume offers an intellectually rich and emotionally resonant exploration of academia's margins, inviting readers to rethink what knowledge, care, and solidarity mean within and beyond institutional borders. This volume appeals to scholars and students across migration, sociology, postcolonial, gender, race, and border studies, as well as to university leaders and diversity officers. Its interdisciplinary and creative format—including poetry and prose—makes it both accessible and engaging for academic and general audiences alike.

7.6.2 Artificial Intelligence in Higher Education: A Phenomenological View

Editor: Sencer Yeralan

Author: Philip Aka

Author: Derek Baker

Author: Azra Branković

Author: Eka Gegeshidze

Author: Laura Ancona Lee

Author: Christos Michalakelis

Author: Mbulaheni Nthangeni

Author: Efthymia Staiou

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0525

Artificial intelligence is increasingly embedded in the everyday practices of higher education, shaping assessment, governance, labor, and institutional legitimacy. Rather than presenting a technical guide or policy checklist, this volume instead offers a reflective, multi-voiced examination of what AI means for higher education's purpose, identity, and future. Its phenomenological grounding shifts the focus from operational questions of implementation to deeper inquiries into how AI reshapes institutions, knowledge, and the academic self.

7.6.3 Harvesting the Sea in Southeastern Arabia: Volume 2: Comparative Lexicon of Fish and Other Marine Species

Author: Miranda J. Morris

Author: Erik Anonby

Author: Janet C.E. Watson

Editor: Erik Anonby

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0538

Along the shores of southeastern Arabia, traditional marine knowledge is fading as languages and ecosystems come under increasing pressure. This second volume of *Harvesting the Sea in Southeastern Arabia* brings together marine species terminology and associated knowledge in the five coastal Modern South Arabian languages (MSAL) and the Kumzari language of the Musandam Peninsula in eastern Arabia. The materials, collected by the authors in periods between the 1970s and the present, are a testament to communities' longstanding intimacy with the sea and their resilient livelihoods in the face of often difficult conditions.

Over 2000 marine species names are inventoried, featuring many bony fish and cartilaginous fish, but also including mammals, reptiles, invertebrates, and plants. Terms for fish at various life stages and vocabulary associated with marine species are also provided. The lists are organised in the format of a comparative lexicon, where individual species are compared across the six languages, and as an annotated alphabetical lexicon with a searchable companion file, presenting additional insights collected over the course of fieldwork.

Along with its relevance for communities where this knowledge is being lost as species die out and livelihoods change, this book is an essential resource for anyone interested in learning from the languages, cultures, and ecosystems of Arabia.

7.6.4 The American Archipelago: A New Edition of Oscar Handlin's Classic Anthology, 'This Was America'

Author: Oscar Handlin

Editor: Kenneth Weisbrode

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0495

The collection at hand, Handlin's classic anthology 'This Was America', first published in 1949, gathers Europeans' travel accounts and perspectives on America from the eighteenth to the twentieth century. Rather than presenting a single narrative, Handlin emphasizes variety: contrasting impressions of liberty and inequality, restlessness and rootedness, optimism and critique by people arriving from diverse European backgrounds. His free translations and selective introductions guide readers subtly but leave interpretation open. Over time, these essays shift meaning depending on context—once read as a celebration of American life, they now invite more critical reflection. This new edition reimagines America not as a singular whole but as an "archipelago": a collection of diverse experiences, perceptions, and contradictions. The metaphor underscores the interplay between unity and multiplicity in American identity.

7.6.5 Pietro Giannone. Autobiography. The Tragedy of a Historian and the Inquisition: Translated with commentary by Thérèse Ridley

Translator: Thérèse Ridley

Contributions by: Thérèse Ridley

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0483

This edition, translated and annotated by Therese Ridley, not only renders the full autobiography accessible to English readers for the first time, but contextualizes it within modern Italian scholarship. Each chapter is enriched with appendices that include critical sources, commentary, and related correspondence, illuminating the people, events, and philosophical struggles that defined Giannone's world.

7.6.6 Beyond Popular Science

Author: David H. Silver

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0526

Beyond Popular Science is not a popular science book. It is not a textbook. It is not an academic monograph. Instead, it occupies a rare and deliberately unconventional space: a work for readers who enjoy scientific storytelling but are no longer satisfied with simplifications that smooth away the real substance of modern science.

7.7 March 2026

7.7.1 Spaces for Action: A Repository of Tools and Methods for a Socially Situated Architectural Education

Editor: Guido Cimadomo

Editor: Ingrid C. Vargas Díaz

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0503

'Spaces for Action' provides a hands-on guide for teachers and students looking to make architectural learning more engaging, collaborative, and socially meaningful.

The book brings together over 80 creative tools that can be adapted to different classrooms, communities, and design challenges. The tools are grouped by teaching approaches—like cooperative teamwork, experiential learning, and transformative practices—and by the stages of the design process: identifying challenges, generating ideas, and putting them into action. Each entry gives a clear overview of what the tool is for, how it works, and what you need to make it happen. You'll also find tips on group sizes, resources, and possible collaborators, making it easy to bring these methods straight into practice.

7.7.2 Ottoman-Era Documents from the Cairo Genizah

Author: Jane Hathaway

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0502

This groundbreaking volume marks a rare and transformative contribution to studies of the Cairo Genizah, a vast trove of documents generated by Egypt's Jewish community between the 10th and 19th centuries. While the Cairo Genizah has long yielded extraordinary insights into Jewish history in the greater Mediterranean region, attention has focused overwhelmingly on documents from the 'classical' period (11th–13th centuries). Documents from the later period, when Egypt was ruled by the Mamluk Sultanate and the Ottoman Empire, remain woefully underexplored. This book helps to change that, presenting a meticulously curated collection of later Genizah documents that expand the boundaries of current scholarship.

7.7.3 Make/Unmake: Play at the Centre of Culture Change

Author: Anna Beresin

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0511

Anna Beresin's 'Make/Unmake' is an engaging and deeply original exploration of children's play as a powerful cultural force. Drawing on ethnographic research and vivid travel writing, the author journeys to the Midlands region of England to observe three remarkable play-based programs: the Maker{Futures} Mobile Makerspace, the Pitsmoor Adventure Playground, and the GLUE Collective. She captures the voices of playworkers, teachers, and artists and documents the ingenuity of children turning objects into tools of imagination and change.

7.7.4 Historicizing IQ Testing: Intelligence Assessments and their Role in Norwegian Society from the 1900s to the Present

Editor: Håkon Aamot Caspersen

Editor: Jon Røyne Kyllingstad

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0471

Intelligence testing has shaped modern society in profound ways, influencing education, psychology, law, and governance. This volume offers the first comprehensive study of the history of IQ testing in a Nordic country, shedding new light on its development, adaptation, and societal impact in Norway.

7.8 February 2026

7.8.1 Africa in Russian Imperial Culture: Race, Empire, and Representation (1850-1917)

Author: Anita Frison

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0504

This volume uncovers how Sub-Saharan Africa was imagined in Russian culture from 1850 to 1917. Drawing on travelogues, ethnographic studies, fiction, and museum collections, Anita Frison reveals how Russia—though lacking formal colonies in Africa—nonetheless engaged deeply with Western colonial discourse.

7.8.2 A Society of Meta-Organizations

Author: Héloïse Berkowitz

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0505

Our contemporary societies are made of meta-organizations — organizations composed of other organizations. These range from international bodies like the International Whaling Commission, to national industry or business associations like the crowdfunding association Finance Participative France, to local associations such as fisheries co-management committees in Catalunya. Meta-organizations have become a defining feature of how actors coordinate, govern and make collective decisions. But what exactly makes them distinct, and why do they matter — both in theory and in practice?

7.8.3 Neomania: How Our Obsession With Innovation is Failing Science, and How to Restore Trust

Author: Krist Vaesen

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0507

Drawing on metascience as well as the philosophy and sociology of science, Neomania offers a critical analysis of how this ethos has permeated the norms and institutions of modern science. The book traces its historical emergence, diagnoses its systemic consequences, and

articulates a reform agenda centered on coordination, shared research programs, and epistemic integrity—an agenda that goes well beyond the principles of Open Science.

7.8.4 al-Dānī's al-Taysīr fī al-qirāʾāt al-sabᶜ: A Translation with Linguistic Commentary

Author: Marijn van Putten

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0475

Al-Taysīr fī al-Qirāʾāt al-Sabᶜ by the 11th century Andalusian scholar ʾAbū ᶜAmr al-Dānī is one of the most influential descriptions of the seven reading traditions of the Qurʾān. It is the work on which the later didactic poem by al-Šāṭibī was based, which still stands as the basis for the teaching of the reading traditions among Muslim specialists. This book makes the highly technical genre of the Qurʾānic reading traditions accessible through a rigorous translation of al-Dānī's work with extensive elucidating footnotes. Besides a full translation of the text, the book also includes an in-depth introduction, which lays out the history of the reading traditions, details of their transmission, the technical terminology of the Qirāʾāt genre, and summarises the linguistic principles of the reading traditions using modern linguistic terminology and illustrative tables.

7.9 January 2026

7.9.1 Science in the Salon: Atoms and Animals in Madeleine de Scudéry's 'Conversations' (1680–92): An Essay and Translation

Author: Helena Taylor

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0465

Madeleine de Scudéry (1607–1701) was a celebrated seventeenth-century novelist and essayist, yet her engagement with natural philosophy and the sciences has been largely overlooked. This volume presents the first English translation of 'The Story of Two Chameleons' (1688) and situates it within Scudéry's broader scientific and philosophical writing. Beyond this seminal text, the book explores her reflections on atomism, natural history, and epistemology, revealing her critical engagement with cutting-edge theories of her time, including a challenge to the Cartesian 'animal-machine' hypothesis.

7.9.2 Passivisation in Semitic, Iranian, Armenian, and Beyond

Editor: Paul M. Noorlander

Editor: Hiwa Asadpour

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0516

This volume brings together research on passive voice constructions in low-resource languages of Western Asia, a region marked by extraordinary linguistic diversity as well as a long history of cultural suppression and marginalisation. The contributions showcase the passive voice in Semitic, Iranian, Armenian, Greek, and Turkic languages, many of which are endangered, understudied, or confined to diaspora communities and disappearing language islands. Education and cultural expression in these languages remained heavily restricted across parts of Turkey, Syria, Iraq, and Iran, underscoring the urgent need for documentation and revitalisation.

7.9.3 Heroines of Greek and Roman Myth: An Intermediate Latin Reader

Author: Maxwell Teitel Paule

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2026

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0496

This volume offers students a fresh approach to reading Latin through the lens of women's stories in classical myth. The stories, carefully adapted from ancient sources, progress in grammatical and stylistic difficulty, beginning with accessible prose and gradually building toward the complexity of authentic classical Latin. Drawing on Dickinson College's Latin Core Vocabulary, the book ensures that learners are practicing the most useful words, while less common terms are glossed in-line to promote fluid reading rather than constant translation.

7.10 December 2025

7.10.1 Broken: Illness and Disability in Antônio Francisco Lisboa, Camilo Castelo Branco, Clarice Lispector, Victor Willing, Paula Rego and Ana Palma

Author: Maria Manuel Lisboa

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0500

'Broken: Illness and Disability in Antônio Francisco Lisboa, Camilo Castelo Branco, Clarice Lispector, Victor Willing, Paula Rego and Ana Palma' traces the lives and works of six major artists and writers from Portugal, Brazil, and Britain through the lens of 'being broken'—in body, mind, or both. Spanning from the eighteenth century to the present, the volume explores how sociopolitical and somatic factors such as mental illness, psychological abuse, arthritis, genital mutilation, and multiple sclerosis shaped their creativity, while also reflecting broader national, social, sexual, and political pressures.

7.10.2 More with More: Investing in the Energy Transition: 2025 European Public Investment Outlook

Editor: Floriana Cerniglia

Editor: Francesco Saraceno

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0499

This outlook offers a timely and insightful exploration of Europe's energy transition, a process that lies at the heart of today's environmental, economic, and political debates. It examines the diverse commitments undertaken by European countries as they navigate the challenges of decarbonization and the shift to sustainable energy systems. By analyzing both the policy frameworks and the concrete instruments adopted to reach ambitious climate and energy goals, the book sheds light on the strategies shaping the continent's future.

7.10.3 Solidarity in Contingency: Rorty's Constructive Project

Editor: Elin D. Huckerby

Editor: Marianne Janack

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0487

Richard Rorty (1931–2007), once dubbed 'the man who killed truth', is best known for challenging the idea that philosophy provides foundational knowledge. Yet beyond the controversy lies a vital, underexplored side of Rorty's work: his constructive vision for fostering democratic solidarity in a world shaped by contingency and uncertainty. This volume shifts focus from defending Rorty to applying his insights for today's fractured, post-truth culture.

7.11 November 2025

7.11.1 Education 2.0: Chronicles of Technological and Cultural Change in Egypt

Editor: Linda Herrera

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0489

Education 2.0 offers a compelling portrait of Egypt's bold attempt to overhaul its public education system amid sweeping political and technological transformation. Drawing on extensive oral history interviews, this book traces the launch and rollout of the 'New Education System' initiated by the Ministry of Education in 2018, designed to modernize curriculum, pedagogy, and assessment in the digital age and change the 'culture of learning'. The volume moves fluidly from macro-level state planning to the lived experiences of teachers and students, exploring the promises and pitfalls of top-down reform.

7.11.2 A Place of Dreams: Desire, Deception and a Wartime Coming of Age

Author: Alison Twells

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0461

This book is a compelling blend of mystery, history, and creative non-fiction, that brings to life the wartime story of Norah Hodgkinson (1925-2009), a working-class schoolgirl, later clerical worker, and a prolific diarist. The book opens with a sailor's letter of thanks for a pair of socks that Norah had knitted for the Royal Navy Comforts Fund in 1940 a gift that led to an exciting romance with the sailor's dashing airman brother. But as the author pieces together Norah's diary entries and the sailor's letters, questions emerge about the men's identities and intentions. 'A Place of Dreams' uncovers a dark tale of male rivalry and wartime anonymity, and a young woman's appetite for life and love amidst unexpected dangers.

7.11.3 Joyce's Choices: New Textual Parallels in James Joyce's 'Dubliners', 'A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man', and 'Ulysses'

Author: R. H. Winnick

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0429

This major new study of the textual parallels that permeate James Joyce's three most widely read works—-'Dubliners', 'A Portrait of the Artist as a Young Man', and 'Ulysses'—-documents and discusses some eight hundred instances, just over seven hundred of them in 'Ulysses' alone, of previously unrecognized, unidentified, or misidentified echoes, most of them verbatim, of antecedent texts ranging from major and minor works of English, Irish, Italian, French and other literatures to the poems, plays, popular songs, hymns, comic operas, triple-deckers, dime novels, penny dreadfuls, and print advertisements of his own day.

7.11.4 A Portrait of Samuel Hartlib: In Search of Universal Betterment

Author: Charles Webster

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0486

The 2013 digitization of the vast Hartlib Papers archive highlighted the pressing need for a comprehensive modern study of Samuel Hartlib (1600–1662), a central figure in seventeenth-century intellectual life. Though educated in Eastern Europe, Hartlib spent his adult life in London, where he became a prolific correspondent and chronicler. His Ephemerides, spanning 1634 to 1660, and his extensive correspondence with leading thinkers across Britain and Protestant Europe offer an unparalleled window into the era's religious, political, and scientific ferment.

7.11.5 The Intertwined World of the Oral and Written Transmission of Sacred Traditions in the Middle East

Editor: Alba Fedeli

Editor: Geoffrey Khan

Editor: Johan Lundberg

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0498

In the medieval Middle East, the scriptures of Christianity, Judaism and Islam were transmitted in written and oral form. The means of written transmission and the textualisation of the oral reading of these scriptures exhibit many parallels, which reflect cultural contact and convergence across the various religious communities. This volume is the outcome of a project, funded jointly by the Deutsche Forschungsgemeinschaft and the Arts and Humanities Research Council, that aimed to bring together strands of research related to various aspects

of the transmission of these sacred texts in order to reach a deeper understanding of the intertwined world of the three major religions of the Middle East at their formative periods of development during the early Islamic centuries.

7.11.6 Allocation, Distribution, and Policy: Notes, Problems, and Solutions in Microeconomics

Author: Samuel Bowles

Author: Weikai Chen

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0466

This work provides a problem-based and policy oriented approach to teaching microeconomics, development, labor, environment, public economics and topics in business, management and public policy to upper level undergraduates, masters and doctoral students.

7.12 October 2025

7.12.1 Xouth, The Ape: A Tale of Manners

Author: Iakovos Pitsipios

Translator: Neo G. Christodoulides

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0493

'Xouth, the Ape', published in 1848 by Iakovos Pitsipios is a pioneering and satirical Greek novel that deftly blends humour, cultural critique, and biting social commentary. The novel is set in the aftermath of the Greek War of Independence. The story follows a young Greek man, desperate to present himself as a European aristocrat, who finds himself entangled with Xouth—an ape who is, in fact, a German travel writer transformed as punishment for his vanity and prejudices.

7.12.2 Performance Research Methods: Interdisciplinary Methods for Theatre, Dance and Performance Studies

Editor: Liesbeth Groot Nibbelink

Editor: Laura Karreman

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0469

'Performance Research Methods' is the first comprehensive guide to contemporary methodologies in performance studies, offering a clear and structured overview of the tools currently shaping research in theatre, dance, and performance. While many volumes focus on individual methods, this book uniquely surveys a range of approaches, presenting their historical background, analytical potential, practical application, and interdisciplinary relevance.

7.12.3 Hylo Narrans: Echoes of Material Marronage

Author: Kevin Toksöz Fairbairn

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0476

This book explores the acoustic agency of brass as a vital medium through which histories of extraction, resistance, and collective creativity resonate. Blending metalwork, experimental instrument-building, and philosophical inquiry, the book listens closely to brass not just as material, but as storyteller—what the author calls hylo narrans, echoing Sylvia Wynter's invocation of homo narrans. Grounded in their practice spanning artisanal craftsmanship and industrial labor, the author examines how materials respond, resist, and reshape meaning within the workshop, the concert hall, and the broader social fabric. By introducing chimeracords—hybrid sound objects forged from factory detritus—and their affordance for sonic experimentation, Hylo Narrans challenges Western narratives of purity, utility, and control, inviting readers to consider alternative storylines posed by materials-in-flight.

7.12.4 Grammar of Etulo: A Niger-Congo (Idomoid) Language

Author: Chikelu I. Ezenwafor-Afuecheta

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0467

This work provides the first detailed linguistic description of the grammar of Etulo, a language spoken in Nigeria by a minority group in Benue and Taraba states. This description establishes

Etulo as a tone language characterised by a predominant SVO word order, non-inflectional morphology, prominent aspectual values, obligatory complement verbs and verb serialization, among other features. This grammar also serves as a foundation for further description of the Etulo grammar and for the development of pedagogical materials needed in Etulo language teaching.

7.12.5 :

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Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0480

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7.12.6 A Grammar of Jordanian Arabic

Author: Bruno Herin

Author: Enam Al-Wer

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0410

The present grammar is based on empirical data collected over more than three decades. It investigates the phonology and morphosyntax of Jordanian Arabic, with a focus on the traditional sedentary varieties of Central and Northern Jordan, locally known as Balgawi and Horani.

7.13 September 2025

7.13.1 Sensing Violence: Reading with the Marquis de Sade

Author: Will McMorran

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0488

What does reading fictional violence do to us as readers? To find out, this provocative and original book turns to the works of an author synonymous with sexual violence: the Marquis de Sade. Drawing on psychology, cognitive literary studies, and empirical research, it argues that reading is a fundamentally embodied act – and one that implicates us far more than we might like to think in fictional depictions of violence.

7.13.2 Representation Theory: A Categorical Approach

Author: Jan E. Grabowski

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0492

This volume offers a fresh and modern introduction to one of abstract algebra's key topics. Guiding readers through the transition between structure theory and representation theory, this textbook explores how algebraic objects like groups and rings act as symmetries of other structures. Using the accessible yet powerful language of category theory, the book reimagines standard approaches to topics such as modules and algebras in a way that unlocks modern treatments of more advanced topics such as quiver representations and even representations of Hopf algebras and categories.

7.13.3 Questions on the Posterior Analytics (Second Redaction)

Editor: Iacopo Costa

Editor: Gustavo Fernández Walker

Editor: Ana María Mora-Márquez

Translator: John Longeway

Translator: Matthew Wennemann

Author: Simon of Faversham

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0468

The commentary edited here, together with the accompanying translation, offers new insight into Simon of Faversham's philosophy—a fascinating chapter in the history of late medieval thought. It also deepens our understanding of the philosophical discussions on demonstration and related topics that took place during the early period of Europe's university history, and of the ways in which these discussions drew on earlier philosophical developments in non-European traditions, notably the Islamic philosophical tradition.

7.13.4 Careful Village and Other 'Khashag' from Tibet: The Amdo Comedies of Menla Jyab

Author: Menla Jyab

Translator: Timothy Thurston

Translator: Tsering Samdrup

Editor: Timothy Thurston

Editor: Tsering Samdrup

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0452

This volume offers a unique glimpse into the world of khashag, a vibrant genre of Tibetan spoken comic dialogues from the area Tibetans call Amdo, with the first ever publication of 11 annotated translations of scripts by its leading performer, Menla Jyab. Emerging in the 1980s during a period of cultural revival in Tibetan communities, khashag fused traditional Tibetan expression with influences from Han Chinese xiangsheng (crosstalk), evolving into a medium of sharp societal critique and joyous entertainment. Menla Jyab, a pioneering performer, used his platform in radio, television, to craft comedies described as 'having meaning in every line'.

7.13.5 Models in Political Economy: Collective Choice, Voting, Elections, Bargaining, and Rebellion

Author: Martin J. Osborne

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0490

This volume explores topics that lie at the core of political economy: collective choice, voting, elections, bargaining, and rebellion. It presents the main formal models used to study the

behavior of individuals and groups in political contexts, from choosing public policies and participating as voters and candidates in elections, to staging revolutions. Complete mathematical proofs are provided, to clarify the assumptions and deepen understanding.

7.13.6 Interprofessional Approach to Refugee Health: A Practical Guide for Interdisciplinary Health and Social Care Teams

Editor: Emer McGowan

Editor: Djenana Jalovcic

Editor: Sarah Quinn

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0479

As global displacement reaches unprecedented levels, health and social care professionals increasingly find themselves supporting people with refugee experience whose health and well-being needs are complex, urgent, and often unmet. This timely and practical book provides essential guidance for professionals—particularly those new to working in this context—on how to deliver compassionate, culturally responsive, and effective care to forcibly displaced individuals and communities.

7.14 August 2025

7.14.1 'Casina' by Plautus: An Annotated Latin Text, with a Prose Translation

Translator: Catherine Tracy

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0482

This edition features the complete Latin text of the play, richly annotated with grammatical and vocabulary notes to support comprehension. A clear prose translation accompanies the original, offering accessible insight into the humor and intrigue of the play. The introduction provides historical and cultural context, situating the farce within ancient Athenian and Roman comedic traditions.

7.14.2 Jerome's Sources in His Translation of the Hebrew Bible

Author: Paul Rodrigue

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0474

At the close of the fourth century CE, Jerome of Stridon—renowned Latin scholar, theologian, and priest—undertook the monumental task of translating the Hebrew-Aramaic Bible into Latin. The result of this effort, now known as the Vulgate, has long been regarded as a foundational text of Western Christianity. In this volume, Paul Rodrigue investigates the sources that Jerome may have drawn upon in the process of translation.

7.14.3 City of Capital and Labour: The Making and Transformation of Industrial Manchester

Author: Tom Saunders

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0459

This compelling book explores the evolution of industrial Manchester, offering a fresh perspective on its built environment through the lens of architecture, archaeology, and social history. Richly illustrated and designed for both academic and general audiences, it sheds new light on Manchester's transformation during the Industrial Revolution, highlighting how the city's physical form shaped and was shaped by its socio-economic and cultural dynamics.

7.14.4 Sounding the Bookshelf 1501: Music in a Year of Italian Printed Books

Author: Tim Shephard

Author: Oliver Doyle

Author: Ciara O'Flaherty

Author: Annabelle Page

Author: Laura Ştefănescu

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0473

This volume explores how everyday texts in Renaissance Italy engaged with music, sound, and hearing. Of the 358 known editions printed in 1501, only a few contained formal music notation or specialist theory. Yet a surprising wealth of musical knowledge emerges from religious texts,

classical commentaries, lifestyle guides, poetry, and more. These sources—rarely penned by professional musicians—reflect the broader cultural presence of music in early 16th-century life, touching on themes like music's moral influence, its role in education, and its scientific understanding.

7.15 July 2025

7.15.1 Characters in Film and Other Media: Theory, Analysis, Interpretation

Author: Jens Eder

Translator: Jens Eder

Translator: Stephen Lowry

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0283

Characters are central to the creation and experience of films and other media. Their cultural significance is profound, but they also raise a wide range of questions. This book provides a comprehensive theory that guides the analysis and interpretation of characters across four dimensions: as represented beings with physical, psychological, and social characteristics; as artefacts with aesthetic structures; as meaningful symbols; and as symptoms of socio-cultural origins and effects. Integrating insights from film, media, and literary studies as well as philosophy, psychology and sociology, the book offers a broad range of approaches for understanding characters and the emotional responses they evoke.

7.15.2 The Economics of Cultural Loss: Harm and Resilience in North American Indigenous Communities

Author: Mukesh Eswaran

Foreword by: Ronald L. Trosper

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0477

Why do North American Indigenous Peoples face such grave conditions in health, poverty, and mortality—including alarmingly high rates of suicide, alcoholism, and drug abuse? In this groundbreaking book, Mukesh Eswaran confronts these urgent questions through the lens of economics, focusing deeply on an underexplored aspect: the erosion of Indigenous culture. While empirical studies have shed some light on Indigenous struggles, Eswaran argues

that mainstream economic theory fails to grasp the unique realities of Indigenous communities. His work introduces innovative models that incorporate cultural and communal values—particularly the sacredness of land and the importance of extended family and communal life—as foundational components of Indigenous well-being.

7.15.3 'Wisdom and Greatness in one Place': The Alexandrian Trader Moses ben Judah and his Circle

Author: Dotan Arad

Author: Esther-Miriam Wagner

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0352

The manuscript collections of the Bodleian Library contain a corpus of dozens of documents from the archive of Moses ben Judah. A leader of the Jewish community in Alexandria, he was also a prominent businessman and in contact with individuals from Cairo to Sicily. This collection of documents at the Bodleian likely did not emerge from the Cairo Genizah, but from another depository, and appears to have been buried at some point.

7.15.4 Reading: Performance and Materiality in Hebrew and Aramaic Traditions

Editor: Hector M. Patmore

Editor: Hindy Najman

Editor: Stefan Schorch

Editor: Jeroen Verrijssen

Editor: Hanneke van der Schoor

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0457

This volume contains the proceedings the 'Reading: Performance and Materiality in Hebrew and Aramaic Traditions' colloquium, hosted at the University of Oxford in 2023, and jointly sponsored by the Oriel Centre for the Study of the Bible and the European Research Council project, 'TEXTEVOLVE.' The aim of the colloquium was to investigate Jewish approaches to the reading of texts, with a focus on reading practices that were applied to Hebrew and Aramaic texts in antiquity and the early Middle Ages.

7.15.5 Surveillance and Control of Dengue Vectors in the United States and Territories

Author: Roberto Barrera

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0472

'Surveillance and Control of Dengue Vectors in the United States and Territories' offers a comprehensive exploration of the challenges and strategies involved in managing dengue vectors, particularly Aedes mosquitoes, in the US and its territories. With over 13 million dengue cases reported in the Americas in 2024 alone, this timely book synthesizes critical information on vector species, transmission cycles, and effective surveillance and control methods.

7.15.6 Stories of Hope: Reimagining Education

Editor: Sandra Abegglen

Editor: Tom Burns

Editor: Richard F. Heller

Editor: Rajan Madhok

Editor: Fabian Neuhaus

Editor: John Sandars

Editor: Sandra Sinfield

Editor: Upasana Gitanjali Singh

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0462

Bringing together a diverse range of educators and practitioners, this collection showcases real-world innovations that challenge the status quo and offer glimpses of a more humane and inspiring educational future. From rethinking systems and curriculum design to fostering imaginative collaboration and exploring the role of technology, the book highlights practical, hopeful interventions that are already making a difference.

7.16 June 2025

7.16.1 When Katherine Brewed, a Play: Telling the Story of the Peasants' Revolt and Today's New Radical Theatre

Contributions by: Mark O'Brien

Author: John Cresswell

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0456

In the sweltering heat of 1381, England's feudal foundations trembled as the Peasants' Revolt erupted—a rebellion that would forever echo through history. Triggered by an oppressive poll tax but fuelled by deeper injustices, this uprising saw land workers, artisans, and commoners rise to challenge the authority of landowners, church, and crown. 'When Katherine Brewed' brings this momentous event to life on stage, blending historical fidelity with a bold, radical perspective.

7.16.2 'Thou Shalt Not Stand Idly By': Jews of Conscience on Palestine

Editor: Susan Landau

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0481

This volume is a timely and powerful collection of Jewish dissent against Zionism and the impact of Israeli statehood on the indigenous Palestinian population. Bridging history, politics, theology, and conflict studies, this book traces a moral and intellectual tradition of resistance from within the global Jewish community—one rooted in values of justice, equality, and compassion. From early twentieth-century critics like Ahad Ha'am and Hannah Arendt to contemporary scholars, rabbis, journalists, and activists, the voices gathered here challenge the dominant narratives that conflate Judaism with Zionism.

7.16.3 Gender-Based Violence in Arts and Culture: Perspectives on Education and Work

Editor: Marie Buscatto

Editor: Sari Karttunen

Editor: Mathilde Provansal

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0436

This book offers a groundbreaking exploration of the pervasive issue of gender-based violence (GBV) within the realms of art and cultural production. This collection of essays delves into both the overt and subtle forms of GBV. It spans sexual harassment, assault, and the everyday sexism ingrained in creative workplaces and art schools, in both professional and private dimensions. The book covers a wide array of artistic sectors—opera, visual arts, music, and theatre—across diverse global contexts, from Europe to Asia and North America.

7.16.4 Uncovering European Private Law: A Student Handbook

Editor: Marija Bartl

Editor: Laura Burgers

Editor: Chantal Mak

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0448

Aimed at bridging a crucial gap in legal education, Uncovering European Private Law provides a comprehensive introduction to the evolving field of European private law. This innovative handbook addresses the interplay of national, European, and transnational rules governing relationships between private actors, including individuals and businesses. Designed with students in mind, this volume not only covers foundational concepts but also explores cutting-edge developments in areas such as contract, tort, property, and company law.

7.16.5 Housing, Heritage and Urbanisation in the Middle East and North Africa

Editor: Lilia Makhloufi

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0460

This book explores the interconnection between housing, heritage and urbanisation. Bringing together architects, archaeologists, urban sociologists, urban designers, urban planners and landscape architects, this multi-authored and interdisciplinary volume presents diverse case studies from the Middle East and North Africa, shedding light on the past, present and future of residential spaces.

7.17 May 2025

7.17.1 Oral Poetry

Author: Ruth Finnegan

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0428

This book offers a comprehensive introduction to the vast field of 'oral poetry,' encompassing everything from American folksongs, contemporary pop songs, and Inuit lyrics, to the heroic epics of Homer, biblical psalms, and epic traditions in Asia and the Pacific. Taking a broad comparative approach, it explores oral poetry across Africa, Asia, Oceania, Europe, and the Americas. Drawing on global research, Ruth Finnegan, the author of the seminal Oral Literature in Africa, sheds light on key debates such as the nature of oral tradition, the relationship between poetry and society, the differences between oral and written forms, and the role of poets in predominantly non-literate contexts.

7.17.2 Qur'an Translations in the Eastern Bloc and Beyond

Editor: Elvira Kulieva

Editor: Johanna Pink

Editor: Mykhaylo Yakubovych

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0444

This book offers the first comprehensive exploration of Qur'an translations across the diverse landscapes of the former Eastern Bloc, from Uzbekistan to the German Democratic Republic. With a focus on how Islamic texts have been shaped by state policies, ideological shifts, and religious identities, it traces connections between these regions and the wider world, including Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and China. This volume draws on perspectives from both Sunni and Shia traditions, as well as contributions by non-Muslim scholars. Through archival research and close textual analysis, the contributors demonstrate how translations of the Qur'an have served not only as religious texts but also as reflections of profound transformations in national and religious identities in communist and post-communist societies.

7.17.3 Bioethics: A Coursebook

Author: COMPOST Collective

Author: Daan Kenis

Author: Mayli Mertens

Author: Franlu Vulliermet

Author: Varsha Aravind Paleri

Author: Yanni Ratajczyk

Author: Emma Moormann

Author: Christina Stadlbauer

Author: Bartaku Vandeput

Author: Nele Buyst

Author: Lisanne Meinen

Author: Kristien Hens

Author: Ina Devos

Author: Ilya Gordon Villafuerte

Author: Joke Struyf

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0449

This coursebook offers an expansive exploration of bioethics, an interdisciplinary field examining ethical, social, and legal dilemmas in medicine, life sciences, and beyond. It challenges conventional boundaries, embracing Van Rensselaer Potter's vision of bioethics as a global, holistic ethics of life—integrating human health, environmental considerations, and transdisciplinary insights.

7.17.4 A Field Guide to Cross-Cultural Research on Childhood Learning: Theoretical, Methodological, Practical, and Ethical Considerations for an Interdisciplinary Field

Editor: Sheina Lew-Levy

Editor: Stephen Asatsa

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0440

This volume addresses the critical gaps in developmental research on childhood learning by advocating for a more inclusive and cross-cultural approach. Recent studies highlight a concerning over-reliance on data from post-industrialized western countries, raising questions about the broader applicability of findings. This book seeks to provide a comprehensive solution, bridging the gap between theory and practice.

7.17.5 Imagery of Hate Online

Editor: Matthias J. Becker

Editor: Marcus Scheiber

Editor: Uffa Jensen

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0447

This edited volume explores the evolving role of visual and multimodal expressions in spreading hate ideologies within digital communication. In digital spaces, hate speech is increasingly conveyed through memes, images, and videos, blending textual and pictorial elements to perpetuate harmful stereotypes and other exclusionary narratives. While historical perspectives on hate imagery are well-documented, this collection emphasises the pressing need for contemporary analysis of visual and multimodal communication in digital environments.

7.18 April 2025

7.18.1 Improvising Otherwise: A Decolonial Feminist Approach to Improvisation in Early Modern English Culture

Author: Fatima Lahham

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0451

This volume redefines how we approach early music and cultural histories, intertwining feminist, decolonial, and creative perspectives. Fatima Lahham delves into the improvisational practices of early modern England, situating them within a rich tapestry of musical sources, theological texts, travel narratives, and natural histories. Inspired by Sara Ahmed's notion of the "feminist ear," the book amplifies voices and histories often unheard, re-examining the cultural interplay between England and the Ottoman Empire in the seventeenth century.

7.18.2 Coral Conservation: Global Evidence for the Effects of Actions

Author: Ann Thornton

Author: William H. Morgan

Author: Eleanor K. Bladon

Author: Rebecca K. Smith

Author: William J. Sutherland

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0453

Coral Conservation: Global evidence for the effects of actions provides an essential resource for anyone dedicated to conserving or restoring corals. This comprehensive synthesis of global scientific evidence examines the effectiveness of conservation and restoration actions targeting stony, soft and cold-water coral species inhabiting a diverse range of marine habitats in tropical, temperate and arctic waters from shallow coasts to the deep sea.

7.18.3 Women Writers in the Romantic Age

Author: John Claiborne Isbell

Translator: John Claiborne Isbell

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0458

This groundbreaking book offers a comprehensive review of six hundred and fifty women writers from over fifty national traditions, spanning Europe and the Americas during the transformative years of 1776 to 1848. Framed by revolutionary upheavals, the book explores how women writers shaped and reflected Romanticism's global currents. It fills a critical scholarly gap, connecting disparate traditions and uncovering voices often overlooked in male-dominated literary histories.

7.18.4 Tragedy and the Witness: Shakespeare and Beyond

Author: Fred Parker

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0435

As he dies, Hamlet pleads with Horatio to 'report me aright … tell my story'. This book deals with the task of bearing witness to anguish, atrocity, and madness, as these are staged in the tragic theatre. Focusing on the relationship between the protagonist and the onlooker or witness, it explores how the tragic figure, often and understandably viewed as alien or culpable or profoundly strange, struggles to be understood. Centred on Shakespeare, its wide-ranging approach also introduces works by (among others) the Greeks, Racine, Ibsen, Pirandello, Kafka, Beckett, and Kane.

7.18.5 Active Speech: Critical Perspectives on Teresa Deevy

Editor: Úna Kealy

Editor: Kate McCarthy

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0432

'Active Speech' is a groundbreaking collection of scholarly essays and practitioner interviews focused on the work of Irish playwright Teresa Deevy. Acts of recovery in the 1980s and 1990s challenged Deevy's exclusion from the literary canon, reclaiming her contributions as significant to Irish drama and theatre. The recent resurgence of scholarship and productions evidences that, as a deafened woman and Irish playwright, Deevy's creative power continues to disrupt and tilt the canon of Irish drama, theatre, and performance.

7.18.6 Humans, Dogs and Other Beings: Myths, Stories, and History in the Land of Genghis Khan

Author: Baasanjav Terbish

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0450

Step into the windswept steppes of Mongolia and explore a world where humans and animals have coexisted for centuries in a delicate, profound dance. This groundbreaking book examines the complex relationships between the Mongols and four animals—dogs, marmots, cats, and

camels—shedding light on a nomadic culture that is deeply intertwined with its natural environment. Drawing from rich ethnographic accounts, historical records, and personal memoir, the author, of Mongol origin, offers a vivid narrative that intertwines cultural insights with intimate reflections.

7.19 March 2025

7.19.1 Ancient Greek II: A 21st-Century Approach

Author: Philip S. Peek

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0441

In this elementary textbook, Philip S. Peek draws on his twenty-five years of teaching experience to present the ancient Greek language in an imaginative and accessible way that promotes creativity, deep learning, and diversity.

7.19.2 Color, Healthcare and Bioethics

Author: Henk ten Have

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0443

This book explores the profound, yet often overlooked, role of color in healthcare and bioethics, arguing that color is far more than a visual or aesthetic element—it actively shapes human experience, perception, and ethical reasoning.

7.19.3 Music, Religion and Politics at Worcester Cathedral, 680-1950

Author: Richard Newsholme

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0437

This book provides a comprehensive history of music and liturgy at Worcester Cathedral, from its foundation in the seventh century to the mid-20th century. The author delves into how political shifts, public opinion, and national trends have influenced changes in the cathedral's practices over time, while also highlighting the distinct local dynamics at play.

7.19.4 Interconnected Traditions: Semitic Languages, Literatures, Cultures—A Festschrift for Geoffrey Khan: Volume 2: The Medieval World, Judaeo-Arabic, and Neo-Aramaic

Editor: Aaron D. Hornkohl

Editor: Nadia Vidro

Editor: Janet C.E. Watson

Editor: Eleanor Coghill

Editor: Magdalen M. Connolly

Editor: Benjamin M. Outhwaite

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0464

Geoffrey Khan's pioneering scholarship has transformed the study of Semitic languages, literatures, and cultures, leaving an indelible mark on fields ranging from Biblical Hebrew and Aramaic dialectology to medieval manuscript traditions and linguistic typology. This Festschrift, celebrating a distinguished career that culminated in his tenure (2012–2025) as Regius Professor of Hebrew in the Faculty of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies at the University of Cambridge, brings together contributions from a vast and representative array of scholars—retired, established, and up and coming—whose work has been influenced by his vast intellectual legacy.

7.19.5 Interconnected Traditions: Semitic Languages, Literatures, Cultures—A Festschrift for Geoffrey Khan: Volume 1: Hebrew and the Wider Semitic World

Editor: Aaron D. Hornkohl

Editor: Nadia Vidro

Editor: Janet C.E. Watson

Editor: Eleanor Coghill

Editor: Magdalen M. Connolly

Editor: Benjamin M. Outhwaite

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0463

Geoffrey Khan's pioneering scholarship has transformed the study of Semitic languages, literatures, and cultures, leaving an indelible mark on fields ranging from Biblical Hebrew and Aramaic dialectology to medieval manuscript traditions and linguistic typology. This Festschrift, celebrating a distinguished career that culminated in his tenure (2012–2025) as Regius Professor of Hebrew in the Faculty of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies at the University of Cambridge, brings together contributions from a vast and representative array of scholars—retired, established, and up and coming—whose work has been influenced by his vast intellectual legacy.

7.19.6 Feeling Colour: Chromatic Embodiment in Film Culture, 1950s–1960s

Author: Bregt Lameris

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0380

The shift back from quasi monochrome to coloured motion picture during the 1950s and 1960s famously provided moviegoers the dazzling opportunity to more fully engage their senses, all the while opening new modes of affective possibilities for filmmakers. Set against the intersection of media studies, emotion theory, biology, and digital humanities, Feeling Colour: Chromatic Embodiment in Film Culture (1950s-1960s) delves into the role colour played in the oft-fraught relationship between cinema and its audiences. This transnational analysis of an extensive range of midcentury cinematography examines the multilayered effects which extend beyond the silver screen, offering a high-level theoretical elaboration and in-depth historical exploration of both experimental and mainstream movies.

7.19.7 Troubled People, Troubled World: Psychotherapy, Ethics and Society

Author: Michael Briant

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0416

Therapists endeavour to be non-judgemental and, indeed, are no more qualified to pass judgement on others than anyone else; do they nevertheless learn anything about ethics from their disciplined listening?

The same question was asked after the war about the persecution of the Jews and other minorities, and it's a very live issue again, faced as we are by movements like ISIS, or Putinism in Russia, that cause great suffering in the name of religious or moral regeneration - a bewildering paradox that David Astor, former editor of The Observer called 'the scourge'.

Can psychotherapy throw any light on it, or contribute any ideas as to how we might contain, if not prevent, the barbarism it sanctions? Can it offer any insights into a different, more inclusive kind of ethics, and if so, can we glean any guidance from it as to how we might further it?

These are the questions the author explores, drawing on psychoanalytic thinking on these issues for over a century and illustrated by his work with individuals over four decades.

7.20 February 2025

7.20.1 Bacterial Genomes: Trees and Networks

Author: Aswin Sai Narain Seshasayee

Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2025

https://doi.org/10.11647/OBP.0446

In Bacterial Genomes, the evolutionary and regulatory processes that shape bacterial life are brought to life. This textbook offers a conceptual exploration of how bacterial genomes are organized, how they evolve, and how their genetic information is interpreted through intricate molecular networks. Drawing on both cutting-edge research and the historical milestones that shaped microbiology, it illuminates how bacteria navigate the intersection of genetic adaptation and ecological resilience.

8 punctum books

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Last updated: 2026-11-03 01:00:22

8.0.1 Walls: Multidimensional Essays

Author: M.H. Bowker

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0523.1.00

M.H. Bowker's *Walls* is a contemplative essay that is sometimes playful and sometimes grave. At first blush, its subject matter would appear simple. *Walls* considers (1) the psychic meaning of walls and (2) the meaning of psychic walls. It turns out that these two subjects are intimately and interestingly related, such that meditating on one turns out to be fruitful in terms of our understanding of the other.

In a series of short, varied chapters *Walls* moves between the psychoanalytic consulting room and the border crossing, the philosophical treatise and the nursery rhyme. Bowker treats walls literally and metaphorically, from the "wall" between nature and civilization, to Franz Kafka's musings on the Great Wall of China, then to the walling off of a person's interior world. There is even a place for Humpty Dumpty. What emerges is a sustained meditation on interiority itself: How walls constitute the inside and outside of a self, how the barriers we raise in the psyche mirror and are mirrored by the walls we raise in the world.

In each of its short chapters, *Walls* has been written with an intention of inclusivity. That is, no advanced prior knowledge or specialized jargon is necessary for the reader to appreciate what may be found herein. This of course implies that, very often, the reader and the author find themselves beginning from first principles, which is always far more difficult than people seem to believe.

8.0.2 2×6

Author: Nick Montfort

Author: Serge Bouchardon

Author: Carlos Léon

Author: Natalia Fedorova

Author: Andrew Campana

Author: Aleksandra Małecka

Author: Piotr Marecki

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0580.1.00

2×6 consists of short "stanzories"—stanzas that are also stories, each one relating an encounter between two people. Appearing in English, French, Spanish, Russian, Japanese, and Polish, the stanzories are generated by a similar underlying process, even as they do not neatly correspond to one another the way a translation typically does to a source text. These sixfold verses are generated by six short computer programs, the code of which is also presented in full. These simple programs can endlessly churn out combinatorial lines that challenge readers to determine to whom "she" and "he," and "him" and "her," refer, as well as which is the more powerful signifier, which the underdog. As John Cayley writes, "Gender is the chief generative obstacle here—making more than two times six—distributed across the natural grammars of these micro-dramas, with their psychosocial, vocational, and hierarchical narrative vectors."

This title is a second edition of a book originally published by Les Figues Press, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.0.3 Zen for Record

Author: Ken Friedman

Contributions by: Craig Dworkin

Contributions by: Hanna B. Hölling

Contributions by: Robin McGinley

Contributions by: Christof Migone

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0588.1.00

Zen for Record gathers five essays around Ken Friedman's 1966 Fluxus event score instructing the production of "a phonograph record with no sound on it." Originating as a found object, the work has migrated across six decades and multiple incarnations, from an unrealized concept to the LP edition that occasions this volume.

These essays accompany Friedman's account of the Fluxus origins of the work, but they approach the silent record from radically different angles. Craig Dworkin situates *Zen for Record* within a broader aesthetics of negation and conceptual art's engagement with the zero-degree of content. Christof Migone spirals through the paradoxes of inscribing nothing and the impossibility of a truly soundless playback. Robin McGinley traces a remarkable counterhistory of the silent record as pop artifact, from 1950s jukebox novelties to Vulfpeck's album *Sleepify*. Finally, Hanna B. Hölling reads the work through sonic materialism, preservation theory, and the politics of silencing, asking what it means for a concept to survive the obsolescence of its successive carriers.

Touching on Fluxus event scores and Cagean silence, the political economy of streaming platforms, and the conservation of time-based media, these essays stage a sustained interdisciplinary meditation on silence as material, medium, commodity, and philosophical provocation.

8.0.4 Janky Materiality: Artifice & Interface

Author: J †Johnson

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0522.1.00

Janky materiality works by not working. It is the spirit in the machine, the ghost in language, the provisional operation. It is a musicological poetics run through a patchwork apparatus.

Janky Materiality: Artifice & Interface is a transdisciplinary performative critical investigation of analog-digital interface and materiality, language-oriented poetry and digital language art, experimental electronic music and modular synths, and the technology of film, album, and book.

Janky Materiality explores blurry intersections and cracked interfaces between page, screen and speaker, analog and digital practice. With reference to avant-garde poetics, digital language art, experimental electronic music and modular synths, chance operations and oracular knowing, Johnson thinks about the ways digital material practice extends the post-structural field, as page-based practices are (further) destabilized by computer-based experiments. Language itself is a janky technology that works (at least temporarily) through its own failures, so that digital mediation serves to further break and rewire language operations. Meanwhile, the book also explores sonification and the study of waveforms: hybrid audio-visual objects that can be materially sculpted and analyzed.

Ultimately, *Janky Materiality* presents a theory of becoming-digital, where interface is a matter of thinking and acting between and among embodied and conceptual, analog and digital realms, whether we are thinking about a technology like language, audiovisual phenomena, or a tool at hand.

8.1 September 2026

8.1.1 A Refuge for Jae-in Doe and Other Fugues

Author: Seo-Young Chu

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0554.1.00

A Refuge for Jae-in Doe and Other Fugues is the lyric memoir of Korean American survivor Seo-Young (Jennie) Chu. It is also a meta-memoir, one that is aware of its makeshift nature, poses questions about the genre(s) it inhabits, and self-consciously reflects on what it means to write autobiographically. Throughout the book, Chu experiments with the first-person singular "I," tracing the polyphonies always implicit in the memoirist's first-person singular voice. Writing polyphonically allows Chu to explore the plurality within her "I," the uncanny homes she has found in dissociation, the appeal of other-than-first-person pronouns as sites of autobiographical consciousness, as well as the literal and figurative fugue states—from spells of incantatory writing to oneiric re-namings of the self—in which Chu finds refuge from intergenerational distress and rape trauma.

Moving from one fugue state to another, Chu explores a wide range of topics relevant to her meta-autobiography, including the nature of time, the history of the sonnet, code-switching, suicidal ideation, the model minority myth, late-stage capitalism, institutional violence, rape culture, standardized tests, the Korean Demilitarized Zone, what it means to read a book, and what it means to be a self.

8.1.2 Selected Essays, 2019–2023

Author: Peter Valente

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0521.1.00

"There are floods that destroy entire contents of a library or publishing house; libraries and museums bombed during wartime; authors themselves demanding certain works or letters be burned at their death; those who attempt at their own risk to save what they can of a manuscript; manuscripts left in taxis and never to be found again; there are distracted

painters who paint over an artwork not realizing what they are doing; finally, there are those works that never came to fruition for one reason or another, never to be known. We are given the misfires, the aborted works, the destroyed works, the mishandled works; the book is a catalogue of brutality, desperation, anger, shame and failure. It is like the negative of a photo, not the bright image we expect; it is the lack seething behind our feeling of abundance; it is a catalogue of the unfinished, the unknown, the unknowable. The effect of all the statements is quite devastating, and it reads like a kind of book of the dead. But it is also a magical book where the dead will live again in its pages."

So writes translator and cultural critic Peter Valente, in an essay about Henri LeFebvre's *The Missing Pieces*, a catalogue of lost and never realized artworks. *Selected Essays, 2019-2023* collects Valente's thinking and writings about books, films, poetry, digital art, dance, music, and other cultural objects that were important to him during the last decade. The essays cover a wide array of topics, from an examination of the new styles of music and dance in the UK to Gavin Douglas's 16th-century translation of the *Aeneid,* from Bernadette Mayer's *Memory* to John Ruskin's work, from an in-depth analysis of John Wieners's "A Poem for Painters" to an exploration of Maya Deren's experimental filmmaking. In these essays, Valente explores books by contemporary experimental poets such as Will Alexander and Adeena Karasick as well as prose writers such as Cookie Mueller and David Wojnarowicz. Valente's essays are not limited nor bound by current fashions in the poetry or prose worlds. His readings remain, as can be seen in his previous collection, *Essays on the Peripheries,* open-ended and adventurous.

8.1.3 Labyrinths: New and Selected Writings

Author: M. Munro

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0572.1.00

"Why are penetrating questions so much harder to formulate than penetrating answers?" critic Louis Bury asks. Why, indeed. It's a great question, and also the throughline of *Labyrinths: New and Selected Writings*. In this collection, Munro formulates penetrating questions (punctums) again and again, and with style and economy. The stories that follow are never reduced to examples, illustrating one theory or another, but answer these questions in the most fitting way possible: by giving them an additional fillip, enriching each. This is the kind of twist only literature (and the humanities) can provide.

Labyrinths is Munro's seventh book and continues his tradition of gnomic-styled writings that have been described as "intellectual origami," "koan-like," "flower-like," and "rooted in sweetness," with lines of inquiry that "auto-deconstruct, bridges crumbling as the author crosses them." The current volume gathers into a fragrant florilegium the best of earlier writings with newer pieces that bring together in artfully whimsical fashion Aristotle, Gilles Deleuze, G.W.F. Hegel, Giorgio Agamben, Graham Harman, Fred Moten, the *Mahābhārata*, Marcel

Proust, Andrea Long Chu, aesthetics, parables, kōans, autotheory, Franz Kafka, Ovid, Rey Chow, bell hooks, Lauren Berlant, Baruch Spinoza, and more.

8.2 August 2026

8.2.1 African Pastoral: Versions of Virgil's Eclogues

Eclogues" width="300"/>

Author: Richard Whitaker

Illustrator: William Kentridge

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0574.1.00

African Pastoral: Versions of Virgil's Eclogues presents a fresh and unexpected version of the ten pastoral poems that comprise the *Eclogues* of Virgil (70–19 BCE). Although these poems focus on the lives of shepherds and goatherds, Virgil makes their seemingly circumscribed existence a mirror of the wider world, a world that is both his and ours. The *Eclogues* deal with subjects that remain vital in the twenty-first century: erotic passion of many varieties, transformation and metamorphosis, the torments of unhappy love, and the nature and power of poetry (represented by different kinds of pastoral song). With striking originality, Virgil also allowed contemporary power politics to erupt into the world of his herders and small-scale farmers, as they face confiscation of their grazing lands and fields.

South African classicist and translator Richard Whitaker has produced eminently fluent and creative versions of Virgil's *Eclogues*. He reimagines the poems in an African landscape and evokes the troubled history of land dispossession in southern Africa, introducing local equivalents for much of Virgil's Mediterranean flora and fauna and making frequent use of words drawn from indigenous languages that have enriched his country's variety of English.

African Pastoral includes stunning images by South African artist William Kentridge, which interact with the versions of Virgilian pastoral in multiple ways, complementing and illuminating the poems, as well as raising points of contrast and difference between ancient and modern contexts.

8.2.2 Unvoicing Migraine: A Study of the Failing Voice

Author: Mariske Broeckmeyer

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0536.1.00

These writings spring from an observation: When migraine arises, the voice fails. It does so on many levels, ranging from a vocal-technical disintegration to migraine-specific symptoms like dysarthria and aphasia, up to the muteness forced upon the sufferer by stigmatization. As a migraine-suffering singer, Mariske Broeckmeyer witnesses and experiences these alterations. Frequently, routinely, and almost faithfully, she retreats to the blackened bedroom when migraine manifests. Lying in silence, she notices how little of her vocal instrument remains intact and how distorted our relations become under these circumstances. Migraine mutes—it occupies the body and leaves muscles, lungs, larynx, and tongue under its command. In the attempt to describe these sufferings, Broeckmeyer has indeed stammered and fallen silent, unable to name the pain. But could it be that this failure holds some sort of potential? What might vocal failure reveal about the nature of the voice?

To these questions, *Unvoicing Migraine* lends an ear. Shuttling between theoretical findings and artistic practice, the book turns to concepts provided by voice theory, disability studies, and queer theory to engage in an artistic research that studies the devocalizing impact of migraine. The book also attempts to redefine the artistic practice of a singer, the author, when her vocal apparatus falters: it questions the singer's relation to the stage and challenges the boundaries of performance. These aspects of vocality were not merely approached through an autotheoretical discourse, but through the creation of music and sound art that capture the failing voice and amplify it. Ultimately, *Unvoicing Migraine* looks at what lies *beyond* migraine, and makes note of its consequences and residues: stains the acid left on the carpet that transform into a woolly eye whose gaze morphs into a mouth that raves in a language we cannot always understand, but which Broeckmeyer transforms into migraine opera.

8.2.3 My 1980s Gayboy Playlist

Author: Arved Ashby

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0535.1.00

In this remarkably intimate book, *My 1980s Gayboy Playlist,* award-winning music writer Arved Ashby muses over pieces that impacted his sexual and musical awakenings as a troubled gay adolescent—pieces by Tchaikovsky, Chopin, Beethoven, Anton Bruckner, Alban Berg, Prince, Kurt Cobain, and Tom Petty.

Ashby shares memories both intimate and far-ranging, but *My 1980s Gayboy Playlist* is not a memoir. Instead of trying to amplify an outwardly uneventful life, the author reengages with and renegotiates eight still-simmering touchpoints—some old musical flames, a few abusive relationships among them. Ashby focuses on desire as it spilled messily across different avenues of expression, seeking connections between erotic experience and musical passion.

For Ashby, as a high school student in a small, rural Midwestern town in the early 1980s, choosing Alban Berg records over Van Halen counted as a perversion. When he recognized

Tchaikovsky's melodic fixations and Prince's and Chopin's musical fires, he better understood his own kinks. As an inadequate piano student and a shy virgin on tricyclic psych meds, his lack of physical success taught him the limitations of the body but also showed the capaciousness of queer failure.

It was music that showed him how queerness insists on misappropriation, mishearing, and reading against the grain. Musicality, like sexual expression, amounts to a kind of role-playing—involving penetration and violation of identity as well as validations of the self. The author's queer musical loves have shown him the vital beauty of muck, unreason, and noise, and as an imaginative writer, Ashby offers the liquid self-reflexivity of Proust and the auto-theory provocations of Maggie Nelson, Paul Preciado, and McKenzie Wark. His prose is poetic and playful, and now and again chaotic. He outs himself in and through his work, with humor and radical intimacy.

My 1980s Gayboy Playlist ultimately illuminates what queer theorist Leo Bersani called the gayboy's inelegant "apprenticeship in desiring." Ashby's closest partners growing up were fantasy, seclusion, and music-dependency, and he found his awkward bliss at the start of the era that witnessed AIDS and the rise of the Moral Majority. In Ashby's early exurban environment, gayness was a thing feared, because unseen and unfathomed, but his musical intimacies made his personal closet endurable. They also helped him to survive his mis-education, to overcome failures of expression, and to craft a sexual awakening into something more rich and more strange.

8.2.4 Jorge Luis Borges: At Play with Mental Models of the World

Author: Luis O. Arata

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0542.1.00

Jorge Luis Borges: At Play with Mental Models of the World explores mind-world relations through the creative writings and reflections of the iconic Argentine author, along with insights from corresponding findings in the field of cognitive studies. A selection of representative works—stories, poems, and essays—illuminates features of the constructive imagination that Borges sets in motion to personally blend mind and world, a venture to which he dedicated his life to the very end. This book is for readers from a broad range of backgrounds, interested in the interactive workings of mind and world through fiction, the imagination, and embodied cognition.

Over the years, Borges playfully created and tinkered with models of the self, time, fiction, reality, history, solitude, and reciprocity, among other cognitive objects. Arata focuses on a selection of representative works of Borges to examine how he modeled and then remodeled, over time, his perceptions of the world and his presence in it. Of particular importance was the onset of blindness halfway through his literary life, which led him to playfully remodel

certain aspects of his early views of experiencing the world. There was also his surprising partnership with María Kodama toward the end of his life, when he went from prizing solitude to experiencing a sense of reciprocity hardly felt before. Arata concludes this exploration with a view of Borges's burial headstone that is in stark contrast to his youthful idea that his death would happen in Buenos Aires, with his vanishing engraved in cold marble. Instead, Borges chose to pass away in Geneva, and was buried next to an earthy, rough headstone engraved simply with what could be seen as his playful final story.

Ultimately, Arata's book asks, to what extent does the mind shape our perception of the world? Through his work, Borges provides us with a personal, passionate example of how fiction and reality blend to create a multiplicity of striking meanings and his writings trace the poignant human quality of a life devoted to conjuring meaning through the interactions of narrative models that emerge from weaving dreams, memories, observations, reflections, and choices.

8.3 July 2026

8.3.1 Malleus Daemonum: The Hammer of Demons

Author: Alessandro Albertino

Translator: Andrew G. Traver

Introduction by: W. Thomas Branton

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0565.1.00

The *Malleus Daemonum* provides an exciting introduction into the religious world of early modern Italy. It consists of a series of personal exorcisms which the Italian Observant Franciscan Alessandro Albertino composed and which he claims have proven themselves by experience. It bears witness to the end of a period in which priests could freely compose their own exorcisms as a regular part of their pastoral functions.

Albertino's exorcisms faithfully follow the Passion narrative in the four Gospels designed both to parallel and to empower the Vulgate text. His strategy is to employ the words and instruments used against Christ by his detractors against the demons occupying the possessed individual in order to expel them. Those words and weapons which were once used to torment, harass, and crucify Christ thus become spiritual weapons which the exorcist may use to treat their patient. Albertino introduces each exorcism with an epigram based on Classical mythology followed by litanies, invocations, and prayers, and he also includes a general exorcism to expel demons from specific parts of the body, along with general blessings and prayers to drive out all sorcery and diabolical intervention from particular articles of clothing.

This edition comprises a comprehensive historical and theological introduction, a Latin edition, and the first-ever English translation of *The Hammer of Demons.* The translation, research, and commentary unveil a long-buried gem of the seventeenth century, offering readers an alluring narrative about the evolving face of the ancient convention of exorcism. More than just a book, this introduction, edition, and translation are an essential contribution to the understanding of the intersection of exorcism, history, and religion in early modern Italy.

8.3.2 The Specter of AIDS

Author: Néstor Perlongher

Translator: Jorge Sánchez Cruz

Afterword by: Gabriel Giorgi

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0548.1.00

The Specter of AIDS is a transdisciplinary text originally written in 1980s Brasil in a time of pandemic emergency. It situates how HIV/AIDS reconfigured intimacy, sexuality, and power while also providing a minoritarian theory of desire lived by dissident sexualities in 1980s Latin America.

Perlongher's paper exposes a new barometer of life undergirded by medico-scientific reason, religious ideology, and morality — in other words, a re-actualization and intensification of normative reason. In nuanced prose combined with wit, rigorous scholarship, political alertness, and poetics, Perlongher delineates how HIV/AIDS serves as a blueprint for how viral threats shed light on the inequitable unevenness of this world.

Written in Portuguese in 1987 and then published in Spanish in 1988, this translation offers an un/timely reading for the 21st century as it shows how new contaminants threaten national public health's paradigms of gendered and racialized structures: their borders, bodies, and good comportment.

8.3.3 Autotheory and Its Others

Editor: Becky McLaughlin

Editor: Eric Daffron

Editor: Maria Gil Ulldemolins

Editor: Kris Pint

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0530.1.00

Ever since Maggie Nelson's *Argonauts* gave the word fresh currency a decade ago, autotheory has infiltrated scholarly, literary, and artistic practices. *Autotheory and Its Others* contributes to this nascent metacritical conversation. An inclusive discourse, autotheory embraces its uncanny double, allotheory, and, thus, this collection invites to the table a host of uncanny others: psychoanalysis, queer theory, and crip theory as well as art writing, postcriticism, and autofiction, among other genres and discourses.

Bringing together four editors and thirteen contributors from both sides of the Atlantic, this collection of critical and creative-critical essays grapples with what it means to couple the personal with the theoretical. The volume's chapters feature geographical settings as far-flung as New Zealand, Iran, and Mississippi and its wide-ranging topics include anecdotal theory and *dialogia–theoria,* the bodymind and illness, artificial intelligence and experimentation, accident and fantasy, collages and fragments, unlearning and autopractices, unknowing and the unconscious, uncertainty and art writing, narcissus and trauma, kudzu and pedagogy, memory and legend, autofabulation and religion, and lo-fi critique and academia. Ultimately, *Autotheory and Its Others* showcases this emergent genre's diversity while also charting its multivalent future directions.

8.4 June 2026

8.4.1 Dotawo: A Journal of Nubian Studies 9: Nubian Homescapes

Editor: Anna Lucille Boozer

Editor: Anne M. Jennings

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0578.1.00

Dotawo: A Journal of Nubian Studies offers a platform in which the old meets the new, in which archaeological, papyrological, and philological research into Meroitic, Old Nubian, Coptic, Greek, and Arabic sources confront current investigations in modern anthropology and ethnography, Nilo-Saharan linguistics, and the critical and theoretical approaches of postcolonial and African studies. Dotawo gives a common home to the past, present, and future of one of the richest areas of research in African studies. It offers a crossroads where papyrus can meet the internet, scribes meet critical thinkers, and the promises of growing nations meet the accomplishments of older kingdoms.

The ninth issue of *Dotawo* takes a long-term perspective on Nubian houses and households to explore the distinctive material, visual, and phenomenological worlds of Nubian homescapes. A "homescape" is an array of features related to the home. It is the socially constructed space of human activity, understood as having spatial, conceptual, and emotional boundaries and

delimitations. Contributors to this volume embrace the dichotomy of homescapes, demonstrating how Nubians adapt their homescapes over time and space even while adhering to a core identity. The cross-disciplinary contributions to this volume include sociological, anthropological, archaeological, and linguistic approaches to the topic, as well as photographic essays, artwork, and fiction.

8.4.2 Inner Conflicts

Author: Sana Sheikh

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0464.1.00

What should I do? What is the right thing to do? What do I do when I don't know what to do?

The difficulty in answering these questions does not come from a lack of knowledge but a deeper problem that requires us to look inward (and outward).

Inner Conflicts is meant to be read in times of upheaval. It traverses jagged terrain, giving voice to the unspoken doubts and contradictions that underlie our dearly held projects. Drawing from psychoanalytic theory, five chapters unpack, process, and – like psychoanalysis – free associate to the fundamental tensions in our lives that refuse resolution. Neither a simple critique nor defense, *Inner Conflicts* contends that only through acknowledging all parts of the argument within us can we fully attend to the urgencies and particularities of ethical and political life.

8.4.3 Echo Otherwise: A Poetics of Sound and Loss in Ancient and Contemporary Poetry

Author: Jocelyn Saidenberg

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0493.1.00

At the heart of this book is a story about reading, about reading and pedagogy, about pedagogy's readers, about readers who listen, listening while reading, about poems and their sonic materials, about the demands that poetic sounds make on writers and readers, about seduction, about echoes and repetition, about the resounding qualities of poetic matter. How might the inarticulate (or inarticulable) communicate in the sounds of poetry? And how might poetry teach us to attend to what is beyond language or even beyond figuration? Reading for the excluded or absent, that which remains after erasure, might be said to be a hermeneutical

commandment. But how might we "read" for the faint echoes of words, the shared, phonic resonances that remain and continue to sound afterwards?

In *Echo Otherwise,* framed as a series of slow, recursive readerly meditations, Saidenberg sets about attending to these questions by bringing together two writers, Lucretius and Ferdinand de Saussure, whose selected works surprisingly disclose a set of interconnected and overlapping concerns with how sound works and in what sounds and resounds in the universe of poems and atoms, and they are also attentive to what sound tells us about poems and atoms. In addition to her readings of Lucretius and de Saussure on sound in the company of other readers — as reading, for Saidenberg, is a collective affair — there are garden walks in Little Sparta with Robert Glück and sustained engagements with m. nourbeSe philip's* Zong!,* several works by Saidiya Hartman, and the global pandemic. Ultimately, * Echo Otherwise* attests to the richness of the encounters that transpire in the process of reading and its transformative effects, encouraging forms of relation that would be receptive to and solicitous of unexpected otherness.

8.4.4 The Phonemes

Author: Frances Richard

Introduction by: Ronaldo V. Wilson

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0579.1.00

In *The Phonemes*, Frances Richard investigates perceptually distinct units of experience, such as sounds, energy surges, and scraps of national and natural history, to create episodes of disruption and dissolution. Organized into sequences that move from seismic notation and wave-form typography to lyric encounters with meteors, snakes, glaciers, and the domestic sublime, the poems break language into its smallest expressive particles and reassemble them at the threshold where sense tips into noise.

Richard's formal vocabulary is at once scientific and devotional: geological terms collide with fragments of political speech, advertising copy, lullaby, and prayer, while visual scores of nested parentheses, dashes, and radical signs interrupt the page like oscillograph readings of an unstable signal. What emerges is a poetics of phonemic attention, an insistence that a syllable, weather event, or fault line all can carry a full emotional charge and that the task of the poem is to hold open the instant in which raw perception has not yet hardened into meaning.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.5 May 2026

8.5.1 War Machine

Author: Richard A. Carter

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0564.1.00

War Machine is a speculative sounding of the myriad entanglements of technology, ecology, discourse, politics, and conflict shaping the contemporary environment. Taking the tools of geopolitical competition and control as its formal and conceptual basis—wargame simulations, artificial intelligence, weaponised drones, territorial enclosure, and extractivist economics—*War Machine* presents a series of digitally simulated conflicts over the most ecologically vulnerable areas of the Earth, using the data gathered to generate hybrid visual poems that stand in for the multitude of political, conceptual, and economic battles that are presently raging across the face of a profoundly endangered planet.

A hybrid work of generative criticism and poetry,* War Machine* depicts the intensive complexities of the present moment through conducting an experimental textual performance, attempting to enfold and perform, rather than simply describe, challenging conjunctions of competing discourses and activities. The resulting stream of outputs and interpretive potentials preclude the ascendency of any "definitive" critical narrative, refusing any straightforward integration with existing canons of worldly diagnosis, but also illustrating opportunities for resistant play and critical-creative possibility within the uncertainty.

The consciously unconventional gesture at the heart of *War Machine* is in attempt at modelling an adventurous, forward-facing approach, in both thought and practice, that refuses inaction when dealing with otherwise devastating scenarios. It is an approach that acknowledges head-on myriad worldly harms, seemingly insurmountable, while still contributing to the aesthetic, affective, and conceptual foundations from which alternative modes of knowing, being, and meaning are developed and justified.

8.5.2 Lifetimes: A Theory of Timescales and Life Forms

Editor: Helge Jordheim

Editor: Sine Halkjelsvik Bjordal

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0484.1.00

At the beginning of the twenty-first century, many of our most well-known and dependable forms of keeping, managing, and representing time are losing their grasp on the real. Clocks

cannot measure how societies speed up, or come to a standstill during crisis, modern historiography is unable to come up with meaningful narratives about mankind as the sixth extinction event, and calendars are insufficient as tools for societal and political change. *Lifetimes: A Theory of Timescales and Life Forms* presents an alternative framework for studying lives and times, and the relationships between them.

Building on post-war theories of history, as well as several historical sub-disciplines, such as cultural history, history of science, and medical history, *Lifetimes* integrates approaches from anthropology, game studies, cultural studies, literary studies, critical heritage studies, science & technology studies, and critical time studies. Times are understood as always existing in plural, as embodied and emergent—in things, in assemblages of things, and in the relations between things. Among them are the lives of humans, but also the lives of viruses, plants, animals, rocks, computers, nations, concepts, policies, technologies, infrastructures, etc.

Lifetimes explores theoretical foundations while at the same time developing them through case studies in individual chapters. The result is a bottom-up theory of temporal multiplicity, conceptually and theoretically open enough to be productive across various academic disciplines. Rather than discussing how different disciplines relate to time, the authors in this edited collection present a theoretically sustained, empirically diverse range of cases, in which times in plural become politically and historically salient. Out of these case studies a new theory emerges: a theory of lifetimes.

8.6 April 2026

8.6.1 Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape: The "Natives" Look Far and Wide

Editor: Marisol Ramos

Editor: Manuel Valdés Pizzini

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0540.1.00

Before World War II, most anthropological research in Puerto Rico was led by US anthropologists. The most famous project, *The People of Puerto Rico,* was directed by American anthropologist Julian Steward and launched the career of renowned scholars such as Sidney Mintz and Eric Wolf. *Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape* aims to delineate the development of the post-WWII anthropological field in Puerto Rico by Puerto Rican anthropologists, the so-called "native" anthropologists. The contributors to *Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape* deploy the term "native" somewhat ironically, but they also know that who they are affects their positionality vis-à-vis their research subjects. Thus, they

retain the term to spark a conversation addressing the complicated feelings that such labels still evoke among non-mainstream anthropologists.

Gazing at the Puerto Rican Anthropological Landscape purposely avoids making Puerto Rico and Puerto Ricans a problem to study and instead focuses on a wide variety of epistemological and methodological questions related to the study of Puerto Rico and Puerto Ricans by "native" anthropologists within local, regional, and global spheres. We posit that the Puerto Rican anthropological landscape transcends the confines of the island of Puerto Rico to encompass its connection and engagement with the larger world, and that it is not limited to the inhabitants of the island of Puerto Rico but embraces members of its diaspora, as well as other groups and ethnicities. On that note, this book seeks to reflect critically on how the academic field of anthropology (research and teaching) in Puerto Rico has evolved, post-WWII, in various engagements with the current debates of contemporary anthropology — theoretical, methodological, socio-cultural, political, and otherwise.

8.6.2 Sonic Detection: Necessary Notes for Art and Performance

Author: Rebecca Collins

Author: Johanna Linsley

Contributions by: Naomi Pearce

Contributions by: Xavier de Sousa

Contributions by: Christina Beatty

Contributions by: Nii Obodai

Research by: Amaara Raheem

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0470.1.00

Sonic Detection is part sonic noir, part performance document, and part critical investigation of listening at the margins for readers interested in prospecting the boundaries of performance studies, sound studies, and interdisciplinary writing.

The book opens with a group of sonic detectives (exact number unknown) who investigate the mystery of an as-yet-unidentified event that leaves traces only in the acoustic atmosphere. This hybrid fiction propels the reader up and down the UK coast and offers overheard fragments from a faded seaside resort, a container shipping port, a former coal-mining town, and the Scottish headquarters for North Sea oil. A heterogeneous collection of texts follows, from creative-critical essays, performance scores, engagement with the archives of earlier sonic detectives (including poet/performance artist Fiona Templeton and the sound art collective Bow

Gamelan Ensemble), to a series of dispatches from expert witnesses with their ears to the ground.

Sonic Detection is not so much a monograph as a polygraph, tongue-in-cheek associations with questionable forensic technologies firmly in place. The book emerges from a decade-long collaboration between artists Rebecca Collins and Johanna Linsley, who used eavesdropping as an expanded creative methodology. The project began as a series of hyper-local, community-based performance works in coastal locations in the UK (from Bournemouth to Aberdeen) and grew into an international, multi-disciplinary life work devoted to an ongoing, organized curiosity. Sonic detectives hold open a collective sonorous space. They are the embodiment of the phenomenophile, lingering longer in listening.

8.6.3 Kayfabe Nation: Professional Wrestling, Donald Trump, and the New Cynicism

Author: Neal Hebert

Author: Jon Cogburn

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0563.1.00

What do a pudgy, orange autocrat, and pumped-up men in tights have in common? The connections, while profound, all rest on specific strategies employed by World Wrestling Entertainment during the early 2000s (known as WWE's "Attitude Era") when Donald Trump was centrally involved with the promotion of WWE. These are: (1) universally breaking *kayfabe,* the code of people in the industry not to reveal or admit fakery; (2) Vince McMahon (WWE's CEO at that time) playing a fictional version of himself as someone constantly humiliated in storylines; (3) the vicious affirmation of traditional gender roles through parables of male domination; and (4) telling stories that encourage viewers to ignore the actual material conditions of WWE "superstars" in favor of conspiratorial fictions involving powerful individual actors. In *Kayfabe Nation: Professional Wrestling, Donald Trump, and the New Cynicism,* Hebert and Cogburn present a trenchant analysis of Attitude Era WWE, showing the extent to which MAGA is just is a function, or symptom, of Trump's internalization of WWE's most objectionable tropes.

Neal Hebert and Jon Cogburn's goal is not to use WWE merely to understand Trumpism and the related autocratic turn in countries as diverse as El-Sisi's Egypt, Putin's Russia, Erdogan's Turkey, Modi's India, Bolsonaro's Brazil, Orbán's Hungary, Netanyahu's Israel, and of course Trump's own America. Beyond that, *Kayfabe Nation* is a defense of truth against the lie that culminates in the widespread adoption of self-defeating conspiracy theories among the constituency of the right, as well as against the idea, popular in corrupted center-left parties across the planet that political success comes down to adopting better rhetorical strategies,

strategies that exist in part to cover over their abandonment of New Deal and socialist ideologies where the material conditions of their constituencies would actually improve.

8.7 March 2026

8.7.1 Works for Works, Book 2: "No Rights"

Author: Gavin Keeney

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0512.1.00

Works for Works, Book 2: "No Rights," privileges works-based agency (praxis) in literary-artistic scholarship. The principal focus of the Franciscan-inspired embrace of a "no rights" status for works of literary-artistic scholarship is toward freeing both author and works from forms of technocratic determinism and neo-utilitarianism associated with regimes of intellectual property rights law and platform cultures. Engaging, and then dispensing with, the concept of "the artistic exception," a holdover from modernist justifications for art in/for itself, *Works for Works* nonetheless restores the primacy of the work itself through disconnecting author and work toward a transfiguration of both author and work and the substantiation of a new ecosystem for radical works of artistic-critical inquiry.

Works for Works, Book 2: "No Rights," follows upon *Works for Works, Book 1: Useless Beauty* (2022), a structuralist-inspired survey and exposé of the immanentist paradox artist-scholars inhabit in the post-contemporary transition from modernist and post-modernist reflexivity to forms of cultural production that favor no singular raison d'être nor socio-cultural, socio-economic, or socio-political bias.

8.7.2 Red Lives: Our Years in the U.S. Communist Party (1950–2000), Vol. 1: Coming of Age in the Communist and Labor Movements

Editor: Jay Schaffner

Editor: Paul Friedman

Editor: Cindy Hawes

Editor: Geoffrey Jacques

Editor: Timothy Johnson

Editor: Carol Pittman

Editor: Donna Ristorucci

Editor: Daniel Rosenberg

Editor: Jackie Saindon

Foreword by: Robin D.G. Kelley

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0455.1.00

Red Lives: Our Years in the US Communist Party (1950–2000) is the first collection of historical analyses and reminiscences by members of the Communist Party USA (CPUSA) and the Communist youth movement in the US from the 1950s through the 1990s. The nearly fifty first-person testimonies bring to life a missing chapter in the history of US radicalism and demonstrate the influence of the post–World War II generation of Communists on social justice movements.

Most histories of US Communism end in 1956 when *Red Lives* just begins, when McCarthyism was on its final legs, the Civil Rights Movement was sweeping the American South and the whole country, the student movement was taking its first breaths, and a new generation of young people were seeking out socialists, communists, and the Communist Party in order to craft a radical, anti-establishment politics. At a time when the launching of Sputnik, the Cuban Revolution, other revolutions sweeping Africa, and the example of the Vietnamese people fighting for their freedom and independence were inspiring the world, one-third of the world was also socialist, led by the Soviet Union and China. The time was propitious for a new generation in the US to also be seeking out, and joining, the CPUSA. This first volume of *Red Lives*, *Coming of Age in the Communist and Labor Movements,* brings the stories of that generation to the forefront of American history at a time when narratives of resistance are more needed than ever before.

8.7.3 Dutch Afro Becomings: Hybrid Being in Black Art and Culture

Author: Charl Landvreugd

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0537.1.00

In *Dutch Afro Becomings,* artist, curator, and researcher Charl Landvreugd argues that we do not yet have a language to understand Dutch Afro-ness, and that it is insufficient to rely on the discourses developed in African American, Black British, or Caribbean cultural theory alone. This critical monograph on continental European Black art and cultural history articulates the specificity of Dutch Afro-ness and the way that Blackness has been translated

and (mis)understood across multiple decades of cultural policy, while also providing an incisive analysis of the Dutch state's aim to showcase "diversity" in a way that is comfortable to the white cultural class, without ever addressing issues of racism or race.

Simultaneously, Landvreugd traces how recent generations of artists are effectively constructing a new visual language to name their Dutch Afro-ness by deepening the way their being is shaped across multiple cultural identities and national histories. These time travelers and wanderers are the Wakaman: cultural workers that embrace their hybridity and multiplicity and have defined, on their own terms and through their own words, their nativity within the Dutch art scene.

Dutch Afro Becomings is a key theoretical and art-historical work, as an introduction to both different international genealogies of Black arts and culture and to the different movements that shaped the specificity of Dutch Afro artists in particular.

8.8 February 2026

8.8.1 Desire: Subject, Sexuation, and Love

Author: Ana María Munar

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0516.1.00

Have you ever wondered what makes you wake up in the morning? Why not just lay down, stay, and eventually disappear? What is the wanting, the energy, and the grace of liveliness? Desire is at the core of liveliness, and this book explains why it is so. Desire is much more than a mere appendix to love, sex, or our craving to have the latest fashion item. It is what allows the most personal and unique expression of each of us.

Desire: Subject, Sexuation, and Love is a work of gratitude to the Lacanian tradition and feminist philosophy. It creatively uses the story of "The Little Mermaid" by H.C. Andersen, as well as art and popular culture to explain the complex landscape of desire and its relation to love and sexuation. Much of the criticism of psychoanalysis from gender studies and poststructuralism is based on a superficial reading of Jacques Lacan, and Munar corrects this, providing in the first half of the book a rigorous and clear analysis of Lacanian subjectification and sexuation, elucidating their relationship to the nature of desire and love, in order to modify overly simplistic and erroneous interpretations of his thinking on desire.

Desire is essayistic and poetic philosophy, drawing upon and playing with psychoanalysis, philosophy, literature, biography, poetry, and art. As the reader enters the second part of the book, the focus on Lacanian theory recedes, opening a space that is more paradoxical and multiple where Munar engages in creative form as an expression of critique, transforming our understandings of desire and love, which always elude us while also always being present.

8.8.2 Imagining What We Don't Know: Creative Theory and Critical Bodies

Author: Lisa Samuels

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0483.1.00

Bringing together perception, ecology, community, lingual value, and quantum life, *Imagining What We Don't Know: Creative Theory and Critical Bodies* presents twenty-four essays and theory poems that blend interpretive neologisms — wild dialectics, distributed centrality, membranism, deformance, bioautography, transplace, soft text, and more — with readings of visionary philosophers and the art and writing of Algeria, Australasia, the Caribbean, Oceania, the UK, and the US.

Committed to experimental ideation and relational ethics, *Imagining What We Don't Know* is for art and theory practitioners, philosophy rebels, creative writers, and anyone who relishes thinking about contemporary art, transnational and transdisciplinary life, and how we imagine with language. *Imagining What We Don't Know* presents a biblio-architecture of "blurprints" built with theories of the embodied mind that are elemental, entangled, and electrified by the political. This is creative theory, hovering with alterities of art and interpretation and imagining with critical attention.

8.8.3 Corporeal Aesth/ethics: The Body in Bracha L. Ettinger's Theory and Art

Author: Anna Kisiel

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0499.1.00

Can we think of an ethics that originates in corporeality, and not in codified or symbolic systems? In* Corporeal Aesth/ethics,* the body resurfaces as a central category of Bracha L. Ettinger's theory and art, as well as an interpretive key that allows us to assume ethical responsibility for an Other who is not abstract, or distant, or total. Ettinger's matrixial theory, a deeply feminist psycho-analytical system, ventures beyond the models of subjectivity based on separation and lack, and thus it helps us rethink togetherness and our own humanity.

Corporeal Aesth/ethics explores how we become subjects not through a series of cuts, but through an encounter with radical openness, modeled upon the intrauterine/pregnancy period. Even though the theorized encounter relies on caring, carrying, and sharing, it is far from pleasant and safe, as we might assume. Indeed, some of the knowledge communicated in this phase of subjectivity-becoming may turn out to be painful, even traumatic. It is this profoundly corporeal encounter, Kisiel contends, that makes it possible to conceive of the body as a site and source of ethics. Envisioned through the lens of the matrixial, a subject

(never alone, always in severality) reaches new modes of intimacy and hospitality, occasioned by our universally shared, originary experience of becoming with-in the maternal body.

A psychoanalyst, theoretician, and feminist, Ettinger is also an artist. Sharing Ettinger's conviction that "painting and theory are not different aspects that attest to the same thing, but are rather differentiated levels of working-through," Kisiel maps the entanglements of the (feminine/motherly) body in both dimensions of Ettinger's work. In five chapters, this book delineates the project of Ettinger's corporeal aesth/ethics. It contextualizes the matrixial body, analyzes its humanizing potential, and proposes dialogues of Ettinger's work with feminism, theology, and Holocaust studies.

8.9 January 2026

8.9.1 Urban Liquefaction: Rethinking the Relationship between Land and Sea

Editor: Cristián Simonetti

Editor: Michel Lussault

Editor: Tim Ingold

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0532.1.00

From classical times until today, cities have been conceived in the western imagination as ideally confined to the fixities of the land, a space defined in opposition to the fluxes of the sea. Whereas solid land afforded a durable platform for the establishment of property and citizenship, the fluid sea allowed markets—isolated within the secure boundaries of cities—to be connected across the globe though navigation.

Urban Liquefaction: Rethinking the Relationship between Land and Sea attends to the concurrent tensions between solidity and fluidity, permanence and impermanence, and substance and change that remain at the core of the western intellectual tradition, often dividing what is perceived as social from what is perceived as natural in life. Sea level rise poses unprecedented threats to this oppositional relationship, forcing us to reconsider the tension between solidity and fluidity in the design of the built environment. Nearly ten percent of all major cities are likely to be impacted by sea level rise in the coming decades, compromising the necessary infrastructure on which urban life depends. In reality, urban landscapes have been continually in flux, which becomes dramatically visible to urban dwellers mostly in catastrophic events such as earthquakes, tsunamis, alluvions, sinkholes, and, above all, soil liquefaction.

Urban Liquefaction gathers contributions from scholars and practitioners working across continents and fields interested in urban life in (and after) the Anthropocene, including anthropology, archaeology, art, architecture, design, human geography, and science studies, to open up

an inquiry into these categorical tensions and to speculate on alternative futures for the built environment.

8.9.2 The Case of California

Author: Laurence A. Rickels

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2026

https://doi.org/10.53288/0577.1.00

Focusing on the changing image of the West Coast through such varied social and cultural artifacts as bodybuilding, group therapy, suicide cults, Marilyn Monroe, milk-carton images of missing children, orgies, Mickey Mouse, zombies, teenage slang, shock therapy, and surf music, *The Case of California* offers a dizzying psycho-history of the twentieth century as crystallized in the symbolic configuration and "case" of California, which case is articulated in relation to German modernism, National Socialism, and Freudian psychoanalysis. As Laurence Rickels writes, "on the personalizable level or label, California is a death cult; on the social, outward, happy-face level, it distributes pleasure via sadomasochism, the adolescent group, or friendship."

Ultimately, *The Case of California* excavates the places "California" occupies as concept or placeholder within Freudian psychoanalysis and such systems as the Frankfurt School, East Coast psychoanalysis, and deconstruction. To excavate the full range of "California," one must apply pressure to a series of adjacent (and often equally marginal or missing) concepts, including group and adolescent psychology, female sexuality, the haunting of music and of mass media at large, the charge of child abuse, and a certain convergence of religious and hysterical conversion.

This publication was originally published by University of Minnesota Press in 1991, and is now being released as a new print and open-access edition as part of punctum's Special Collections initiative.

8.10 December 2025

8.10.1 "FOLLOW THE PERSON": Archival Encounters

Author: Ammiel Alcalay

Introduction by: Miriam Nichols

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0395.1.00

Poet, novelist, translator, scholar, and critical essayist extraordinaire, Ammiel Alcalay's intrepid work has always moved across geographic, chronological, political, and linguistic borders. *"FOLLOW THE PERSON": Archival Encounters* gathers a dizzying array of texts by Alcalay written over the past fifteen years, all of them having something to do with archival materials. In Alcalay's case, however, these archives range from more traditional, institutionally-held materials and personal collections to the use of his own experiences and memories as sources for redrawing cultural maps that have too long been divided along sectarian lines of one kind or another.

Moving from the Beats and the Black Arts Movement to the Middle East, *"FOLLOW THE PERSON"* recalibrates our sense of living history while offering new possibilities for encounters that have been relegated to oblivion or never even imagined. Culled from a variety of eclectic sources and contexts, encountering these essays together offers a completely different experience of Alcalay's essays, one that argues for a methodology based on minutely recorded events and historical contexts, and for necessary human and cultural encounters that provide models for a new, reinvigorated critical vocabulary.

As Miriam Nichols writes in her Introduction, "Follow the tenuous threads in this collection of writings and you may end up at the looted National Museum in Baghdad during the American invasion, or in the Hoover Institute at Stanford University where most Iraqi state archives wound up. You may find yourself at Bashcharshiya, the market in Sarajevo during the Bosnian war, or in Palestine, on May 14, 1948. Maybe, if you are keen, you will pick up the thread that leads to 17th-century colonial Massachusetts, or perhaps you will stay in New York, rummaging through garbage cans with Diane di Prima, looking for journals and letters tossed out by a lover." Whichever path you take, you will find multiple worlds, all rendered by Alcalay with light and compassion.

8.11 November 2025

8.11.1 Voix de Glace / Voice of Ice

Author: Alta Ifland

Introduction by: John Taylor

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0589.1.00

Voix de Glace/Voice of Ice is a series of prose poems about the estranged self living outside of one's native land and away from one's native tongue. Romanian poet Alta Ifland writes first

in French, then translates her work into English, before returning to the original French for further revisions, a process of linguistic reconciliation as much as translation.

Published in a bilingual, French–English edition, Ifland repeatedly turns to remembered images of her unnamed homeland to animate her unfamiliar home, creating, what poet Gary Young calls "a brilliant collection of prose poems document[ing] the quest for a coherent self, an authentic identity born out of the chaos of language and history." He continues, "Ifland's poems trace a radical process of de-creation—dismemberment of the body, dissolution of the ego, abandonment of the self—and the reinvention of a new identity, purified by the acid of tears. This new creation—tentative and rarified, 'a child's body of light'—earns a tenuous existence, but it proves to be enough to withstand the omnipresent threat of oblivion."

Voix de Glace/Voice of Ice won the 2008 Prix Louis Guillaume du Poème en Prose/Louis Guillaume Prize for Prose Poetry.

This title is a second revised and expanded edition with a new introduction by John Taylor, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.11.2 Perceptron

Author: James E. Dobson

Author: Rena J. Mosteirin

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0408.1.00

Perceptron is a work of experimental poetry and a critical biographical reading of Frank Rosenblatt (1928–1971) and his 1957 invention, the Perceptron. The Perceptron was the first widely publicized and used machine learning device and the origin of much contemporary neural network technology. Rosenblatt was a psychologist, a computer engineer, a musician, an amateur astronomer, a sailor, and a poet. The Perceptron was born from an interdisciplinary mix of ideas and was so far ahead of its time that it was widely misunderstood by other scientists and the public.

This mechanical invention, imagined as an alternative to general purpose digital computers, and its algorithmic implementation as a simulation of the device was deeply rooted in mid-twentieth-century neuroscience and psychological theories of behavior. Introduced to the world by one newspaper under the headline "Shades of Frankenstein!" in 1958, following a public demonstration in Maryland sponsored by the US Navy, the Perceptron was a radical new approach to designing computer systems. What made it different was its design as a simplified model of animal vision systems. The Perceptron could perform pattern recognition and matching from a collection of simple visual objects. It was innovative and impressive, but it was also constantly oversold by its financial supporters, the press, and by its inventor.

Perceptron traces, contextualizes, and celebrates the ideas that would become embedded in this early thinking machine and that animated the excitement and promise that would eventually turn to frustration and failure during Rosenblatt's tragically short lifetime.

8.12 October 2025

8.12.1 The Negated Institution: Report from a Psychiatric Hospital

Editor: Franco Basaglia

Translator: John Foot

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0513.1.00

The Negated Institution: Report from a Psychiatric Hospital was first published in 1968 in Italian and caused an immediate sensation. It was an instant bestseller and was translated into numerous languages, but never into English. Edited by the Venetian psychiatrist Franco Basaglia, the book is a collection of writings, interviews, and debates which tell the story of the transformation of the Psychiatric Hospital in Gorizia, on the northeast border of Italy, into an open and "negated" institution. This story of an historically unique process of de-institutionalization—with the elimination of walls and barriers, the humanization of the hospital, the introduction of debates and meetings, the unlocking of wards, and the questioning of the very basis of all psychiatric hospitals—struck a nerve with the student and worker movements of 1968. It also gave a voice to the patients themselves, telling their stories of violence but also of liberation.

The Negated Institution was highly sensitive to the contradictions of this project of opening up and negation, and called for the abolition of the entire system of psychiatric asylums, as well as new ways of understanding and contextualising mental illness and mental health. It led to debates in many countries within and outside of psychiatry and played a part in the 1978 "Basaglia law," which eventually closed down the entire psychiatric hospital system in Italy—the first example of such total closure in the world, which endures to our contemporary moment.

This is the first translation into English of this seminal text. The translator, John Foot, is an expert in the life and work of Franco Basaglia and has added notes and a critical introduction.

8.12.2 Ontohackers: Radical Movement Philosophy in the Age of Extinctions and Algorithms, Part III: Metahistories of Movement: Philosophies in Becoming

Author: Jaym*/Jaime del Val

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0545.1.00

Ontohackers redefines what movement, worlds, and bodies are through the sense of proprioception reconceptualized as formless fluctuation field, a movement matrix that is itself also thought, and which underlies all life forms and fields, including the inorganic. Our worlds are made of endless such entangled fields n-folding in neverending variation or enferance. The current planetary crisis has emerged due to an accidental evolutionary alignment, narrowing, and impoverishment of that matrix's indeterminacy, that appeared gradually and eventually with bipedalism, and which created an imbalance between the larger proprioceptive field and its brain, and made the atrophied body extend itself technically in geometric fields gradually covering the planet, along with its fears, with disastrous consequences that are unleashing an unprecedented type of mass extinction and species suicide.

The reply to this crisis – which is urgently due if we are to reduce even slightly the collapse coming over the next decades – is in recovering a lost sensorimotor plasticity which is also cognitive, affective, and relational plasticity, through developing movement technes for cultivating Body Intelligence (BI), reversing and taking elsewhere the failed evolution culminating in AI, stepping down from humanist supremacist pedestals, undoing our dependency upon unsustainable killing machines of sedentary consumerism that impoverish experience, stopping the reproduction of a species that has become plague (by reversing heteronormative reproductive dogmas till we reach preagricultural population levels), and recovering the joys of moving with the world, in symbiotic mutation, towards unprecedented evolutionary variations: this is our cosmic responsibility for all life on Earth.

The book's structure expresses Enferance Theory with regard to how processes of becoming have a triple movement: an incipiency unfolding the field (Part I), a condensation-expansion where the field acquires full consistency (Part II), and a resonance or memory of the field relating to other fields (Part III).

Part III provides a critical history of (movement) philosophies, exposing the rise of the mechanistic vision as dominant anomaly emerging from a variety of other older proposals which have continued to exist in the background, returning more strongly since the 19th century, while exposing the limitations of recent attempts to free movement from the metaphysical tradition, which the book associates to the rise of human supremacism and its associated mass extinction cycle. The book proposes that movement is the core hidden motif of philosophy and diagnoses philosophies following a metaphilosophical and metaformative methodology that considers the perceptual–kinetic frames and biases underlying them. It is both a sketch for future expansion

and an appendix to the previous two volumes, which grounds Radical Movement Philosophy in a critical revision of the literature, exposing the differences, while undoing some errors, and rescuing philosophies like that of many Presocratics from the misreading stemming from Aristotle. Hereby a shift from *philosophia* to *philokinesia* is proposed, toward a thinking of the body in motion, reversing philosophy from a tool of human supremacism to an undoing of it and a regeneration of movement diversification – and with it life – in the Biosphere.

8.12.3 Crossings: Migrant Knowledges, Migrant Forms

Editor: Natalya Din-Kariuki

Editor: Subha Mukherji

Editor: Rowan Williams

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0417.1.00

Crossings: Migrant Knowledges, Migrant Forms brings together activists, artists, scholars, and migrants with diverse histories to explore what the experience of migration does with, and to, knowledge, and how its own ways of knowing find expressive form. As the volume's authors think about physical and imaginative crossings, and the traversals and transactions of knowledge they entail, the book itself crosses and complicates disciplinary and formal boundaries and the barriers between critical and creative intervention. Crucially, it brings together voices and forms emerging out of the experience of dislocation with responses to the encounters it generates.

The volume's discussions begin in the early modern world, and move freely across periods to dwell on the urgent experience of migrancy in our own times, while also responding to an urgent need to connect the local with the global experience of migrant knowledge and migrant aesthetics. *Crossings* stakes the claim that creative art, backed by humanities-based thinking, can meet the imaginative and ethical demands that the unknowable reality of mass displacement places on us, in a way that governments, institutions, and public discourse have calamitously failed to do. But aesthetic practice itself needs to be re-positioned if it is to rise to these political and human challenges, negotiating the points of friction between its own predilections and the matter of migration.

Crossings offers "migrant forms" – art about migration, objects from migrant life shaped into artifacts, and migrant self-expressions – as the means of this imaginative re-orientation, and a tool for activating a radical alternative to economic models of social benefit. *Crossings* takes its place in an emergent ecology of migrant forms, both speaking to and participating in that ecology.

8.13 September 2025

8.13.1 Imaginary Death

Author: Mariko Nagai

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0531.1.00

A man dies. He dies because he must—because without his death, there is no story, and, in the end, no history itself.

So begins Mariko Nagai's* Imaginary Death,* a creative nonfiction book that examines how the author's grandfather, an ordinary man born in a small village in the early 20th century, is unmade and remade into a perfect Japanese Imperial Soldier by the era he was born into. In the kaleidoscope composed of archival documents, letters, journals, research, interviews, and photographs,* Imaginary Death* traces the life of a man who fought and died for the empire, whose death, obscured by lack of documentation, must be composited of many possible ways men could die in Papua New Guinea. Only forty out of four thousand men from the regimental unit survived by the end of the repatriation in 1946: his was one small death out of many.

In the tradition of James Agee and Walker Evans's seminal work on the Great Depression *Let Us Now Praise Famous Men, Imaginary Death* is a work that is part meditation, part history, and part fragments of memory that tell a story of a Japanese soldier's life and death during World War II. Ultimately, *Imaginary Death* is a textual landscape of imagination, fact, history, and dreams all intersecting to create a psychological terrain that is not limited in the same way as history or nonfiction books, but is rather a new imaginative cartography, no less real than history itself.

8.13.2 The Mediterranean Question

Author: Iain Chambers

Author: Marta Cariello

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0539.1.00

Whose Mediterranean are we talking about? What languages are most appropriate to its reception and understanding? With two-thirds of the Mediterranean constituted by the histories and cultures of its African and Asian shorelines and hinterlands, and its principal spoken language being Arabic – in all its variants and dialects – then the Mediterranean clearly exceeds the Western frame of explanation. Without pretending to speak for or in the name of these ignored and repressed dimensions,* The Mediterranean Question* explores the resulting gaps

of a Mediterranean reduced to a European and Western mirror by listening and attending to some of those other histories, cultures, and lives.

How to puncture prevalent European understandings of the Mediterranean? The colonizing impulse inscribed in Western historiography cannot be undone simply by adding previously repressed and unacknowledged histories. Instead, a re-examination of the premises and procedures that produced such exclusions leads to a valuable change in coordinates. An order of knowledge that creates subaltern objects of study to reconfirm European centrality and subjectivity is interrogated. Insisting on a politics of registration and listening, further critical incentives drawn from the trans-local dissemination of literature, music, cinema, and the visual arts can be deployed to query existing representations.

In this more ragged and open series of maps, there lies no complete picture but rather a challenge to the violence of existing explanations. Insisting that present-day knowledge is sustained in asymmetrical relations of power,* The Mediterranean Question* promotes a reconfiguration of historical archives and cultural ties, casting a critical light on the deeper histories that have made the Mediterranean, Europe, and Western modernity. Proposing a series of intersecting analyses that underline the colonial constitution of the present and its mobile and creolized formation, Chambers and Cariello seek to establish new coordinates for thinking and practicing the possibilities of another Mediterranean.

8.14 August 2025

8.14.1 The Ants

Author: Sawako Nakayasu

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0552.1.00

The Ants is a study not of, but through, ants. In a dashing sequence of prose pieces, Sawako Nakayasu takes the human to the level of the ant, and the ant to the level of the human. Prima facie, *The Ants* is a catalogue of insect observations and observations of insects. But the exposé of insect life humbles and disrupts the myopia that is human life, where experience is seen in its most raw and animal form and human "nouveau-ambitious" and "free-thinking" lifestyles become estranged, uncovered, and humbled. Found in dumpling soups and remembered in childhood vignettes, these ants trail through what Nakayasu describes as the "industry of survival," exploring interfaces of love, ambition, and strategy. The danger is not in sentiment, but rather, in a gash, a wall, an argument, an intention. Is it more lonely to be crushed into the core of a non-mechanical pencil, to be isolated in the safety of home, or to "find" "it" "all" at the very very last moment? *The Ants* is the distance, the break, and the tenuous wilderness between exoskeleton and endoskeleton, and Nakayasu puts her finger on it, and it, and it.

This title is a new and expanded edition released as part of punctum's Special Collections project, inclduing seventeen additonal bilingual English–Japanese poems from the chapbook *Insect Country E: Bilingual Insects.*

8.14.2 The Poet as Experiencer: Wallace Stevens and Nonhuman Intelligence

Author: Adam Staley Groves

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0296.1.00

In *The Poet as Experiencer: Wallace Stevens and Nonhuman Intelligence,* Adam Staley Groves approaches Stevens, not merely as poet–thinker but rather as experiencer and theorist of what is today called "the phenomenon" (UFOs). Challenging both Stevens scholarship and our broader understanding of poetic consciousness, the book presents a radical appraisal of Stevens's oeuvre as an extended, coded testimony of contact with nonhuman intelligence. Drawing from journals, uncollected poems, and landmark works such as *Harmonium* and* The Necessary Angel,* Groves argues that Stevens's poetic evolution mirrors the psychological and spiritual trajectory of an experiencer grappling with anomalous phenomena long before cognitive frameworks for such were culturally available.

From moths and owls to missing time and the ethics of the imagination, Groves reads Stevens's work as a sustained effort to reckon with anomalous phenomena whose language has not yet come. Through careful textual analysis and historical correlation, Groves positions the poet within a lineage that includes Coleridge, Baudelaire, Kierkegaard, and Nietzsche, who are recast not only as theorists of the imagination but as precursors to a modern metaphysical crisis now resurfacing through the contemporary discourse on UFOs and UAPs (Unidentified Anomalous Phenomena). Integrating rigorous literary scholarship with insights from ufology, psychology, and metaphysical philosophy, Groves investigates Stevens's use of abstraction, the ethics of poetic imagination, and the emergence of the "true subject" as a form of ontological rupture. In doing so, the book bridges the hermetic with the historical, and the poetic with the paranormal.

8.15 July 2025

8.15.1 Historiographies of Game Studies: What It Has Been, What It Could Be

Editor: Alisha Karabinus

Editor: Carly A. Kocurek

Editor: Cody Mejeur

Editor: Emma Vossen

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0441.1.00

Historiographies of Game Studies offers a first-of-its-kind reflection on how game studies as an academic field has been shaped and sustained. Today, game studies is a thriving field with many dedicated national and international conferences, journals, professional societies, and a strong presence at conferences in disciplines like computer science, communication, media studies, theater, visual arts, popular culture, and others. But, when did game studies start? And what (and who) is at the core or center of game studies? Fields are defined as much by what they are not as by what they are, and their borderlands can be hotly contested spaces.

In this anthology, scholars from across the field consider how the boundaries of game studies have been established, codified, contested, and protected, raising critical questions about who and what gets left out of the field. Over more than two dozen chapters and interviews with leading figures, including Espen Aarseth, Kishonna Gray, Henry Jenkins, Lisa Nakamura, Kentaro Matsumoto, Ken McAllister, and Janet Murray, the contributors offer a dazzling array of insightful provocations that address the formation, propagation, and cultivation of game studies, interrogating not only the field's pasts but its potential futures and asking us to think deliberately about how academic fields are collectively built.

8.15.2 Barge Life: On Jean Vigo's "L'Atalante"

Author: Florian Deroo

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0480.1.00

Waves washing up against the hull, a bed and a small stove, the deck hatch sealed shut — the vessel is the ultimate dwelling.

How to live together in cramped quarters? How to create a microcosm against hostile surroundings? In *Barge Life,* Florian Deroo tackles these questions by looking at a mythical classic of French cinema: Jean Vigo's 1934 film *L'Atalante.* A work brimming with the energies of surrealism and anarchism, *L'Atalante* follows a young couple, two shipmates, and a clowder of cats who dwell in the belly of a river barge. Deroo offers a wide-ranging essay on the film, revealing how it lovingly delineates a small group that withdraws from the rhythms of modern life to establish a different kind of existence elsewhere. In *L'Atalante*'s most riveting moments, the river barge becomes a vehicle for a powerful fantasy: a supple and mobile collective life, lived in sensuous interdependence.

Combining film criticism, philosophy, and biography, Deroo's *Barge Life* reconsiders an important forerunner to the French New Wave and the early death of its director. Drawing readers into the intimately cramped living spaces of *L'Atalante,* Deroo explores the allure of retreating into a self-sufficient shelter, along with its intractable problems.

8.16 June 2025

8.16.1 Hand Book: A Manual on Performance, Process, and the Labor of Laundry

Author: Lizzie Olesker

Author: Lynne Sachs

Contributions by: Andrea Estepa

Foreword by: Silvia Federici

Contributions by: Tera Hunter

Contributions by: Jasmine Holloway

Contributions by: Amanda Katz

Contributions by: Mahoma Lopez

Contributions by: Rosanna Rodriguez

Contributions by: Margarita Lopez

Contributions by: Luo Xiaoyuan

Contributions by: Emily Rubin

Contributions by: Veraalba Santa

Contributions by: Stephen Vitiello

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0490.1.00

Hand Book: A Manual on Performance, Process, and the Labor of Laundry is a collection of writings and images from a performance and film set within a neighborhood laundromat, a microcosm of service work within our urban reality. With a focus on the people who are paid to wash and fold, *Hand Book* explores the convergence of dirt, stains, money, identity, and desire. Informed by both theory and history, filmmaker-poet Lynne Sachs and playwright Lizzie Olesker construct a model for making a site-specific work incorporating both live performance and film. From conversations with workers in laundromats around New York City,

they develop a play that magnifies forms of manual labor that often go unrecognized. The core of *Hand Book* is Sachs and Olesker's hybrid play-script which grew out of documentary material they collected in New York City over several years. Within this theatrical construct, the actors themselves navigate the dynamic between their laundry worker characters and who they are in their own lives. Images also engage with text to create an evocative graphic experience. Turning a page becomes an interactive, quasi-cinematic encounter, calling to mind the intimacy of touching other people's clothes, almost like a second skin, the textural care for things kept close to the body.

Hand Book includes essays, interviews, memoirs, and poetry that look at the relationship between art and social engagement. Observation, historical research, and fiction intersect, creating a patchwork of "what is" with a speculative, imagined "what was." Historian and author Tera Hunter speaks to the importance of The Washing Society, a group of 3,000 Black women laundry workers who organized in Atlanta in 1881 for better pay and working conditions. Feminist historian Silvia Federici engages in a conversation about the meaning of reproductive labor and its relationship to laundry. Two leaders of a grassroots organization share their experience of immigration and activism. A dancer creates a gestural map of her choreography. An actor deconstructs the charged significance of her Civil War-era costume.

Ultimately,* Hand Book: A Manual on Performance, Process, and the Labor of Laundry* presents an illuminating dialogue between the documentary arts, feminism, film, immigration, labor history, and theater. Throughout, a playwright and filmmaker contemplate how art-making can alter our understanding of the social structures of city life.

8.16.2 Executive Orders

Author: Organism for Poetic Research

Editor: Rachael Guynn Wilson

Editor: Andrew Michael Gorin

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0519.1.00

After the election of Donald Trump in 2016, a group of poets, artists, and activists conceived of a project wherein they could respond to the sudden and seemingly relentless barrage of Trump's dystopian executive orders with a series of their own orders. The project, titled "Executive Orders," was envisioned as a collaborative, freeform, "emergency" prose poem that would generate real-time responses to current events and the emerging American political landscape. The result was a poetic catalog of *the people's* executive orders—orders that are at turns serious, absurd, satirical, philosophical, critical, utopian, and so on.

Executive Orders began as one community's effort to cope with and respond to the tidal wave of reactionary policies enacted or proclaimed during the years of Trump's first administration.

As an index of historical happenings that charts events in rough chronological order (including the Muslim-country travel ban, Black Lives Matter protests, the Brett Kavanaugh hearings, the youth climate march, the January 6th riot at the US Capitol, and many other events), it stands as a documentary record of this historical period from the perspective of artists, writers, leftists, progressives, and other contributors, many of them anonymous. *Executive Orders* is also an experiment in crowdsourced collaborative making that tells a story about the ways we can—and *can't*—come together to form a collective that *could* have a voice in political deliberations.

8.17 May 2025

8.17.1 Ontohackers: Radical Movement Philosophy in the Age of Extinctions and Algorithms, Part II: R/evolution Technologies

Author: Jaym*/Jaime del Val

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0544.1.00

Ontohackers redefines what movement, worlds, and bodies are through the sense of proprioception reconceptualized as formless fluctuation field, a movement matrix that is itself also thought, and which underlies all life forms and fields, including the inorganic. Our worlds are made of endless such entangled fields *n*-folding in neverending variation or enferance. The current planetary crisis has emerged due to an accidental evolutionary alignment, narrowing, and impoverishment of that matrix's indeterminacy, that appeared gradually and eventually with bipedalism, and which created an imbalance between the larger proprioceptive field and its brain, and made the atrophied body extend itself technically in geometric fields gradually covering the planet, along with its fears, with disastrous consequences that are unleashing an unprecedented type of mass extinction and species suicide.

The reply to this crisis—which is urgently due if we are to reduce even slightly the collapse coming up over the next decades—is in recovering a lost sensorimotor plasticity which is also cognitive, affective, and relational plasticity, through developing movement technes for cultivating Body Intelligence (BI), reversing and taking elsewhere the failed evolution culminating in AI, stepping down from humanist supremacist pedestals, undoing our dependency upon unsustainable killing machines of sedentary consumerism that impoverish experience, stopping the reproduction of a species that has become plague (by reversing heteronormative reproductive dogmas till we reach preagricultural population levels), and recovering the joys of moving with the world, in symbiotic mutation, towards unprecedented evolutionary variations: this is our cosmic responsibility for all life on Earth.

The book's structure expresses Enferance Theory with regard to how processes of becoming have a triple movement: an incipiency unfolding the field (Part I), a condensation-expansion

where the field acquires full consistency (Part II), and a resonance or memory of the field relating to other fields (Part III).

Part II, subtitled *R/evolution Technologies,* includes Books 4, 5, and 6 and is by far the longest volume, elaborating in depth the book's proposals in a triple movement. It first exposes the technologies of variation in nature (Book 4), followed by the technologies of reduction in the Algoricene (Book 5), and finally the possibilities for overcoming the reductive fold (Book 6). Book 4 proposes a swarming chaosmology as theory of orgiastic evolution, culminating in the concept of *metabiosis:* life as indeterminate, symbiotic mutation. Book 5 diagnoses the regimes that have formatted movement and presents the theory of the Algoricene, or Age of Extinctions and Algorithms. It exposes a *kinetic ontology, genealogy,* and *dynamics of power.* An interlude discusses post-, trans-, and metahumanism, and a second part of the book unfolds a radical critique of the Planetary Holocaust. Book 6 unfolds metaformance aesthetics and metahuman politics, including the theory of metaformativity, the ontohacking pragmatics, and a choral Dionysian ontology, where the author also discusses at length hir own techniques and art projects, involving a radical challenge to human supremacism to face the extinction challenge now threatening all life on Earth, toward an Earth liberation and regeneration.

8.17.2 The Singing Detainee and the Librarian with One Book: Essays on Exile

Author: Michael Beltran

Foreword by: Larissa Mae Suarez

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0529.1.00

In late 2019, journalist Michael Beltran found himself in the city of Utrecht, the Netherlands, deep in conversation with Filipino revolutionary leaders Jose Maria Sison and Julie de Lima. What was planned to be a feature article ended up as a collection of observations on what it means to live in exile. Sison and de Lima are maligned by governments and revered by activists worldwide, all while spending most of their time tucked away in a small Dutch neighborhood. What Beltran realized was that it was impossible to speak of their exile without understanding the history and community surrounding it.

The Singing Detainee and the Librarian with One Book shares lesser known tales about two of the most well-known revolutionary exiles and their comrades. It speaks of a community and history behind the ordeal, weaving it into the Filipino diaspora. Sison passed away in December 2022, making this book a record of one of the last and arguably lengthiest interviews he ever gave. The essays track the couple's prolonged stay as refugees, how the Philippine liberation movement found a home in Europe, and how migrants and activists alike gravitated toward each other while adrift from their homeland. "Exile," Beltran says, "is imprisonment by displacement […] when people are condemned to leave their lands dressed in invisible chains."

8.17.3 The Social Properties of Concrete

Editor: Eli Elinoff

Editor: Kali Rubaii

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0405.1.00

Concrete is a ubiquitous part of our world. It composes our dwellings and shapes our infrastructures. It unites and divides urban space and is used to wage both war and peace. Concrete is simultaneously an indicator of freedom and development and is an essential part of the carceral apparatus. *The Social Properties of Concrete* begins from the premise that concrete is as richly social as it is densely material. Just as concrete's materiality permeates our everyday life, our political projects, social practices, religious concepts, environmental transformations, and ethical questions suffuse concrete structures.

Like concrete itself,* The Social Properties of Concrete* is an aggregate: it draws together essays by social scientists, historians, architects, artists, and urban planners who each blend social theory, material science, and empirical analysis to explore the ways in which social life is embedded within concrete and to inquire about how concrete shapes social life. Across forty globally situated chapters, these essays open new conversations around our relationships with anthropogenic stone and serve as a teachable introduction to the social and political lives of materials. By taking this approach, this volume develops a conceptual language and methodological approach that should inform new understandings of material politics and our built environment.

The social properties of concrete are neither metaphors nor are they simple reflections of the social. Instead, they are modes of materially enacting social, economic, and political life itself.

8.18 April 2025

8.18.1 A Cyborg's Father: Misreading Donna Haraway

Author: Dave Brennan

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0525.1.00

When his daughter was diagnosed with type 1 diabetes as an infant and became dependent on technology to stay alive, Dave Brennan set off in search of a vision: what does it mean to live as a cyborg? And how might he best help his daughter navigate the relationship between machine and flesh?

Beginning with a line plucked from Donna Haraway's "A Cyborg Manifesto" —"Their fathers, after all, are inessential"—*A Cyborg's Father* blends memoiristic poetic fragments with lyric essays that look toward music and literature by women artists who have embraced the technological as a metaphorical or literal means of investigating and owning their experience as women. Traversing the intersecting paths of feminism, chronic illness, disability studies, transhumanism, interdependence, and more, this is the tale of a father whose greatest hope is to be rendered inessential.

8.19 March 2025

8.19.1 One Thing Follows Another: Experiments in Dance, Art, and Life through the Lens of Simone Forti and Yvonne Rainer

Author: Sarah Rosenthal

Author: Valerie Witte

Afterword by: Ralph Lemon

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0486.1.00

In the 1950s, Yvonne Rainer, Simone Forti, and a handful of other young artists based in New York's Greenwich Village set out to challenge the practices and principles of professionalized dance. Inspired by the groundbreaking work of choreographers Anna Halprin, Robert Dunn, and Merce Cunningham, as well as composer John Cage, they were determined to change what dance is and can be. In *One Thing Follows Another,* a boundary-crossing collection of ten experimental-poetic essays, poets Valerie Witte and Sarah Rosenthal explore the work of dancer-choreographers Rainer and Forti, both at various inflection points throughout their careers and in this particular moment.

Through a combination of chance operations and intentional artistic choices that push the authors to unexpected places—including the zoo, the dance studio, the street corner—and via innovative forms and techniques, such as collage, erasure, and their own artistic inventions, they deconstruct the essay form to examine what they as poets, each with their own highly charged relationships to dance, can contribute to the conversation about these pivotal figures in postmodern performance art.

8.19.2 Mourning the Ends: Collaborative Writing and Performance

Author: Maria Shantelle Alexies Ambayec

Author: Kristof van Baarle

Author: Peter Burke

Author: Renata Gaspar

Author: Sozita Goudouna

Author: Nilüfer Ovalıoğlu Gros

Author: Adham Hafez

Author: Jan-Tage Kühling

Author: Eero Laine

Author: Sarah Lucie

Author: Juliana Martins Rodrigues de Moraes

Author: Evan Moritz

Author: Malin Palani

Author: Rumen Rachev

Author: Aneta Stojnić

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0506.1.00

Mourning the Ends: Collaborative Writing and Performance is an opening, a beginning, an attempt to rethink how we can be, think, and work together. This book, authored by a multitude, explores new methodologies of collaborative scholarship for the arts and humanities within the context of the various ecological, medical, military, and epistemic ends facing the world.

The authors of* Mourning the Ends* performed an experimental methodology as the book was researched, written, and revised by fifteen individuals situated across the globe. The writing emerged in part from a shared sense of mourning through the global pandemic and ongoing ecological catastrophes, yet the questions and arguments that are raised are immediately relevant as the rolling crises of our contemporary moment play out and further develop. The volume challenges a number of key areas in performance studies as well as foundational expectations and assumptions of the arts and humanities more broadly—namely, that writing and scholarship should be solitary endeavors. The authors write back against the model of thinking

and studying that centers the singular genius, especially against the backdrop of enduring and apparent end times.

Mourning the Ends is in some ways a rehearsal for another future, a speculative engagement with performance, ecology, and academic affiliation beyond institutional bounds—a methodology for shared mourning, performance, and thinking.

8.19.3 The Art of Compilation: Manuscripts and Networks in the Early Medieval Latin West

Editor: Anna Dorofeeva

Editor: Michael J. Kelly

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0494.1.00

The Art of Compilation: Manuscripts and Networks in the Early Medieval Latin West interrogates the medieval manuscript book as a dynamic, constantly changing object entangled in intellectual and cultural networks, constructed and deconstructed by different people, and transmuting in form and meaning over time. Medieval manuscripts are not static, permanently bound, and delimited, but rather serve as evidence for the layered relationships between texts and their material supports, and when we realize that, we gain a clearer view of medieval manuscript culture as driven by the agency and intellectual exchange of the people behind it. This volume of essays investigates early medieval Western European manuscript culture as a field of entangled objects, focusing on the connections between knowledge selection, material representation, and scribal agency.

The complex road of compiling selected texts into manuscripts (*compilatio*) in the early Middle Ages is still not well understood, yet it is the key to the historical context surrounding medieval manuscript culture. The practice of knowledge selection consisted of three key stages: the intellectual selection of the textual content of manuscript collections; the pragmatic action of arranging the textual content in a draft form by authors or editors; and the material representation and aesthetic exposition of texts in manuscripts. These stages were part of a linear development, but also exercised reciprocal influence upon one another. By tracing this process in surviving manuscript collections, we can better understand in what practical ways knowledge was encoded and how these often innovative and experimental practices contributed to the emergence and consolidation of intellectual and scribal traditions. This has important implications for how we understand education, reform, and the exercise of power in the early Middle Ages.

8.20 February 2025

8.20.1 Winter Light: On Late Life's Radiance

Author: Douglas J. Penick

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0533.1.00

In the contemporary West, the elderly are regarded as somehow "other," no longer who they used to be, no longer full members of the worlds they once inhabited. Being old is seen as a medical management issue. But old age is not a defective version of what preceded it; it is—like childhood, adolescence, and middle age—its own time of life with its own challenges and gifts. It is an unexpected experience and largely unknown terrain. *Winter Light: On Late Life's Radiance* is an exploration of old age as a time when sudden and uncontrollable losses reveal and clarify patterns of existence formerly obscured. In this context, Penick tells of the lives of artists, musicians, and others who, in old age, changed radically through visionary modes of experience that otherwise would not have been possible.

Near the end of their lives, Titian, Michelangelo, Beethoven, Rabindranath Tagore, Jean Rhys, Andrea Palladio, Paul Cézanne, Leoš Janáček, Igor Stravinsky, and others found unforeseen paths and articulated subtleties and beauties never before encountered. Their visions are now woven into our culture and the stories of their lives are signposts for us. As Thoreau once said: "Not 'til we are lost… not 'til we have lost the world, do we begin to find ourselves and realize where we are and the infinite extent of our relations."

In five essays, concerned respectively with body, connection, pattern, loss, and vision, *Winter Light* explores irretrievable losses and dawning possibilities. Penick gives voice to aspects of the inner life that in old age unfold with unanticipated depth, breadth, strangeness, and light.

8.20.2 The Fight for Black Liberation: Breaking the Political Strings in the Trump Era

Author: William T. Hoston

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0496.1.00

The first presidency of Donald J. Trump further unveiled the calamity of white America's determination to maintain societal order during a period of landmark racial upheaval. From the restrictive voting measures led by Republicans and conservatives following the 2020 election, to the death of George P. Floyd Jr. and the subsequent Black Lives Matter protests in the summer of 2020, to the January 6, 2021 insurrection, each racial marker continues to show the

endurance and even strengthening of white America's racist traditions alongside its avowed and always unfulfilled commitments to equality for all.

The Fight for Black Liberation: Breaking the Political Strings in the Trump Era presents a political critique of the state of Black America in the Trump era, especially when so many Democratic presidents (including Clinton, Obama and Biden) have done so little for Black Americans even while relying on their votes. The book argues that amid continued structural, institutional, and systemic barriers, Black people in America must establish political independence and demand a Black political agenda to chart a path toward a Black Liberation movement. What has hindered the process of reaching a Black Liberation movement has been the assimilationist loyalty of Black Americans to the false constructs of partisanship and ideology, and this book encourages Black eligible voters, of whatever party or other affiliation, to abstain from the two-party system and become an independent voting bloc only willing to give the Black vote to a chosen party in a free partisan market that best represents Black interests. Otherwise, the Black electorate remain frozen in a two-party system that has been built to serve white interests only, even when claiming otherwise, and no amount of assimilation will make a difference.

8.21 January 2025

8.21.1 The Before and the After: Critical Asynchrony Now

Editor: Sean Gurd

Editor: Mario Telò

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0446.1.00

Between 2020 and 2021, in the depths of the Covid-19 pandemic, the thirteen authors included in *The Before and the After: Critical Asynchrony Now* turned to reflections on the late work of Jacques Derrida in an attempt to think through the temporal disjunctions imposed by the global emergency. They found themselves thinking through ideas and philosophical tropes that had been in vogue more than twenty years earlier—as though a deep theoretical nostalgia could somehow rescue them from the moment that beset them.

As a belated turn to Derrida's late work, *The Before and the After* provides a series of visions of what we might become, in our engagements with the past—both the contemporary and ancient past—in our occupation of every fractured "now." This book is a document of a moment now largely (hopefully) behind us and an attempt to imagine what remains to come.

8.21.2 Requiem

Author: Teresa Carmody

Introduction by: David L. Ulin

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2025

https://doi.org/10.53288/0561.1.00

Requiem by Teresa Carmody is a "folk opera, a lament for the unexamined life," writes editor and author David Ulin in his Introduction. In this short collection of fiction, a lonely man plainchants for the waitress he once stalked, a sonless father serenades a fatherless son, and a bereft family gathers to bury a parent, providing an aching chorus of what is left. Carmody uses Biblical language to pierce the callous and bruised souls of these lost, and sometimes found, small-town Michiganders. In her raw spare stories, novelist, essayist, and poet Carol Muske-Dukes writes that Carmody creates in her raw, spare stories, "a voice out of the backyard burning bush, a Midwest scriptural mist: frank, fierce and fidgety, and most emphatically her own."

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.22 December 2024

8.22.1 Cycle of Dreams

Author: Eric Weiskott

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0524.1.00

An experimental hybrid work, *Cycle of Dreams* pairs translation and original poetry. The translations, or adaptations, are of William Langland's strange and wild fourteenth-century dream vision,* Piers Plowman,* a politically radical English and Latin poem written in the wake of plague and divided into a prologue and twenty *passūs* or steps. Eric Weiskott transposes the action from London and Worcestershire to New England and Long Island. The translations refashion and modernize *Piers Plowman* by disarticulating its continuous shape and rearticulating it as a collection of lyrics. The translation appears on the left and original poetry on the right in each page opening, so that the fourteenth and twenty-first centuries speak to one another as in a dream.

Like *Piers Plowman* itself in manuscript culture, *Cycle of Dreams* attracts paratexts. Images illustrate the absent presence of Langland's authorship. A series of glosses or marginal notes grounds the poems in critical theory, etymologies, lyric reminiscences, and statistics reflecting the desperation of our economic moment. An "oneirography" or dreamed bibliography names

some of the scholarship that supports study of *Piers Plowman* today and some other sources for Langlandian fever dreams.

Langland can address us today, not in the voice of a bygone author whose "context" must be arduously rearticulated in the laboratories of scholarly endeavor, but one whose utopian vision is in its broad outlines no less urgent in 2024 than it was in 1381, when English rebels used Langland's title figure as a rallying cry for insurrection. *Cycle of Dreams* unearths "buried dreams / of a future adequate to the present tense."

8.23 November 2024

8.23.1 Heavy Processing

Author: T.L. Cowan

Author: Jas Rault

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0364.1.00

What happens when we take the joke of "lesbian processing" seriously as a research method? *Heavy Processing* does just this, by tracing the multi-directional genealogies and vast affinities of processing-heavy methods as innovations in information technologies (such as operating systems, central processing units, network designs). Part methods handbook, manifesto, and survival guide, this book opens up the fields of information studies, data studies, digital media studies, and digital humanities to critical digital methods, information technologies, and infrastructures: trans- feminist and queer (TFQ) cultural protocols and ways of working.

Cowan and Rault offer heavy processing as a maximalist research method, consistent with a long and proud lesbian-leaning TFQ tradition of making a mountain out of a molehill. *Heavy Processing* draws together activist, artistic, and scholarly work that is both about and not about digital materials to critically reorient digital research methods calibrated for accountability, relationship-building, and trust as measures of scholarly rigor. A raging romp of a methods manual, Cowan and Rault offer an alternative to mass digitization in the form of TFQ processing for analog and born digital materials. They write for students, faculty, and researchers, as well as for information, cultural heritage, and tech-sector professionals; for anyone interested in digital media and feminist, queer, and transcultural studies; and for anyone who has ever been studied.

8.23.2 Burning Diagrams in Anthropology: An Inverse Museum

Author: Tristan Partridge

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0468.1.00

Burning Diagrams in Anthropology examines the use of diagrams in anthropology to reimagine how we think about, and challenge, intellectual histories. Highlighting the impossibility of escaping what different disciplines and institutions deem to be "past," the author combines critical analysis of selected diagrams with an expansive, exploratory reimmersion in their aesthetic, ethical, and political potential.

Diagrams persist. Yet while other visual components of scholarly work—especially photography, cartography, and film—have been subject to significant critical scrutiny, diagrams have received far less reflexive attention. Reversing this trend, Partridge presents a collection of 52 diagrams, covering a period of 150 years, to create an "inverse museum"—a space where the collection matters less than reactions to it. While the images are drawn from sociocultural anthropology, they are discussed in dialogue with approaches from philosophy, postcolonial studies, architecture, aesthetics, posthumanism, and critical art theory.

Dissecting the notion of The Canon in order to confront academic complicity in hierarchical and racialized relations of inequality, the figurative burning of the title refers to how we might prepare the ground for scholarly work that meets the immediate, collective needs of an Earth in crisis—not least, by refusing adherence to disciplinary normalcy. By refusing this adherence, Partridge reaffirms knowledge creation in general, and anthropology in particular, as deeply ethical, creative, and relational processes.

8.23.3 Oblation: Essays, Parables, Paradoxes

Author: M.H. Bowker

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0520.1.00

Elements of this book, *Oblation: Essays, Parables, Paradoxes,* defy reason. They do so for good reason. Much of what we do, much of what we think, is oblation: sacrifice, offering, to something or someone. The root of "oblation" is "to draw near" or "to dwell in." It refers to what is brought unto the altar, literal or proverbial—the profoundest oblation being what binds us together, our very souls, our dearest loves, indistinguishable from ourselves, our Isaacs on our Mount Moriahs.

The natures of our oblations characterize our relationships to objects great and small, e.g., Lords and loved ones, groups and masses of signifiers. Oblative transactions promise meaning,

yet we are full of uncertainty. What is it that cries out for oblation? How do we hear its voice? Are we, in fact, called, or do we, on the contrary, offer every bit *gratuit*? Why, as Albert Camus famously remarked, do "the stage sets collapse" as we offer ourselves to life's routine?

In *Oblation,* M.H. Bowker considers these questions in a series of essays touching upon figures such as Franz Kafka, Edgar Allan Poe, Baron van Münchhausen, and Jacques Lacan, unraveling themes of loss, hatred, and the Munchausen syndrome by proxy. Interspersed with brief parables and paradoxes, Bowker's essays push us to wonder who or what we are offering ourselves and others to—and how we get away with this.

8.24 October 2024

8.24.1 Redacted: Writing in the Negative Space of the State

Editor: Lisa Min

Editor: Franck Billé

Editor: Charlene Makley

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0466.1.00

When it comes to the political, acts of redaction, erasure, and blacking out sit in awkward tension with the myth of transparent governance, borderless access, and frictionless communication. But should there be more than this brute juxtaposition of truth and secrecy?

Redacted: Writing in the Negative Space of the State brings together essays, poems, artwork, and memes—a bricolage of media that conveys the experience of living in state-inflected worlds in flux. Critically and poetically engaging with redaction in politically charged contexts (from the United States and Denmark to Russia, China, and North Korea), the volume closely examines and turns loose this disquieting mark of state power, aiming to trouble the liberal imaginaries that configure the political as a left-right spectrum, as populism and nationalism versus global and transnational cosmopolitanism, as east versus west, authoritarianism versus democracy, good versus evil, or the state versus the people—age-old coordinates that no longer make sense. Because we know from the upheavals of the past decade that these relations are being reconfigured in novel, recursive, and unrecognizable ways, the consequences of which are perplexing and ever evolving.

This book takes up redaction as a vital form in this new political reality. Contributors both critically engage with statist redaction practices and also explore its alluring and ambivalent forms, as experimental practices that open up new dialogic possibilities in navigating and conveying the stakes of political encounters.

8.24.2 The Ruins of Solitude: Maternity at the Limits of Academic Discourse

Author: Lette Bragg

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0473.1.00

What happens when love unravels one's knowledge structures? In *The Ruins of Solitude*, after the birth of a child, Bragg embraces the event of love and examines the resulting disintegration of her supposed authorial subjectivity. Against the pressure to produce and organize knowledge—the pressure of writing a dissertation, for example—Bragg contemplates the poetic modes of thinking and ethics that emerge from her experience of reading continental philosophy while caring for her infant child. Dwelling on what she would have once excluded from her intellectual work—her maternity, the mole on her chest, her palm against another body, her exhaustion at the work of deconstruction—Bragg details a shift in her orientation and method that leads to creative theoretical thought, allowing her to illuminate and interrogate what she names "solitude," a condition of academic discourse that limits our critical-liberatory projects of transformation.

Ultimately, *The Ruins of Solitude* lets go of authority and mastery, and engages in a poetic and fractured writing style that lets in the relationality of thought. Bragg offers a philosophy of bodies beyond solitude and an intimacy of love and writing that fractures solitude, bringing forward the possibility of selfhood and authorship uncontained by the isolationist, tangible time of the present. Bragg's book also unravels familiar narratives of childcare, considering the parallels between poststructuralist theory and the embodied materiality of relation.

8.24.3 100 Chinese Silences

Author: Timothy Yu

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0549.1.00

There are one hundred kinds of Chinese silence: the silence of unknown grandfathers; the silence of borrowed Buddha and rebranded Confucius; the silence of alluring stereotypes and exotic reticence. These poems make those silences heard. Writing back to an "orientalist" tradition that has defined modern American poetry, these 100 Chinese silences unmask the imagined Asias of American literature, revealing the spectral Asian presence that haunts our most eloquent lyrics and self-satisfied wisdom. Rewriting poets from Ezra Pound and Marianne Moore to Gary Snyder and Billy Collins, this book is a sharply critical and wickedly humorous travesty of the modern canon, excavating the Asian (American) bones buried in our poetic language.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.25 September 2024

8.25.1 The Dream-Slaves

Author: Darieck Scott

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0399.1.00

To fight the gods—you must first become a slave.

Our universe is dead. All that's left are memories. But the powers indigenous to the new world are fighting back.

Alexander, a handsome immigrant fleeing trouble in his poor native land, doesn't even have a claim to his own name in the magic-rich city of Norio, where they call him Aleixo. But his name may be the least of what the sorcerers of Norio take from him, when a seemingly random invitation to cater-waiter at a party of the wealthy and famous sweeps Aleixo up into a maelstrom of imperial politics and a millennia-long war between humans and gods. The empire of Norio rules the world because of its monopoly on magical high-tech devices called dream-slaves—and now the head of imperial intelligence has proof that Aleixo isn't human at all, but a dream-slave assassin, smuggled into Norio by the empire's enemies.

Rescued by a cabal of sorcerers from a foiled attempt to kill him by a renegade sorcerer, Salvador, and his mysterious other-human ally Ydris, Aleixo finds his identity and humanity stripped from him in harrowing psychedelic adventures that transform his memories and bind him to a history of conflict, activating fabulous abilities he never dreamed he had. The world Aleixo lives in isn't what he's always believed it was: the forces that rule his destiny are not just economic class, race, gender, sexuality, body, nationality—they are much more sinister, and much more powerful. The greatest powers have secretly colonized his planet, and made its history strangely similar to our own. Aleixo discovers he may be the last line of defense against the dystopian present and future of Earth. He leads the struggle for emancipation as he grapples with who and what he is: is he human, or just a dream?

8.25.2 boy says: (a book with no ending)

Author: Néstor Ponce

Translator: Max Ubelaker Andrade

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0528.1.00

Where does your voice come from? The one you speak with, or the one you read with? What does it sound like when you read, silently, to yourself? There are the first influences, or at least the ones that first come to mind. But you quickly admit that there are others as well. The voices that emerged from different styles, tones, and patterns in books, stories, poems. From songs and television programs, family members and teachers. There are the voices that you don't remember as voices, the words you don't remember reading. This voice, this combination of symbols describing a translated book of poetry, for example, might be acknowledged as the very latest influence in your life.

After leaving Argentina in exile during the dictatorship of the military junta (1976-1983), Néstor Ponce found his way to France, where he now lives. He has written that throughout his life, reading has connected him to a shifting, unstable set of voices—a community of readers and writers that crisscrosses borders of all kinds, unafraid of conflict and contradiction. *boy says (a book with no ending)* opens to that community with poems that are at once the words of one poet and the traces of an infinite number of poets, some of whom are explicitly named in the titles of the poems.

This bilingual English-Spanish edition is an open library that is also a private one, made public. As you read, it might be difficult not to ask questions about Nazim Hikmet, Alejandra Pizarnik, Dina Posada, Eugenio Montale, Anna Greki, or Édouard Glissant. And it will be impossible to answer those questions without finding their books, opening them, and hearing your voice shaped by their and Ponce's words.

8.25.3 The Diary of Anna Comnena, or The Very Political Adventures of a Transgender Byzantine Princess in African Elevators

Author: Tis Kaoru Zamler-Carhart

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0467.1.00

In *The Diary of Anna Comnena, or The Very Political Adventures of a Transgender Byzantine Princess in African Elevators,* Zamler-Carhart impersonates the 12th-century Byzantine princess and historian Anna Comnena as she comes out as trans and tries to write her father's imperial biography, *The Alexiad,* while in exile in contemporary West Africa.

Outside the Empire, categories become fluid and elevators stop on strange floors. Prose slips into graphic poetry, medieval Christianity into mystical Sahelian Islam, Byzantine chronicles into erotic gore anime. Anna's first-person diary careens down a series of sinister African elevators and intersectional magic spaces. She is an outcast of the Empire but also a product of it, exploring the dynamics of contemporary African textile production, vernacular theater, animal husbandry, jihad, urban design, television, and coin metallurgy from the perspective of a 12th-century trans Byzantine engineer.

The Diary of Anna Comnena initially adopts the same Empire-centric perspective as the historical* Alexiad,* but the dystopian confrontation with African reality forces Anna to reflect on what it means for her to be specifically in Africa, and not just in a generic outside space. Together with the author's previous work,* The Diary of Anna Comnena* forms a gelatinous ongoing treatise where seriousness is an emerging property, and the distinction between speculative fiction, design theory, and political philosophy is probably just matter of scale.

8.26 August 2024

8.26.1 Taunting the Useful

Author: Loumille Métros

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0449.1.00

In an epoch driven by hyper-consumption and marvelously destructive futility, and in the context of a hegemonic utilitarianism where one goes to university to work rather than to "develop a meaningful philosophy of life," the concept of the useful is perhaps one most in need of interrogation. *Taunting the Useful* seeks to unsettle notions of usefulness and uselessness, not merely by deconstructing these terms, but by sidetracking them. It doesn't reverse things by saying that what is useless is useful. Rather, taunting is teasing, heckling, tickling, scratching the useful.

By elaborating a notion of the "virtual useless," *Taunting the Useful* seeks to tease the dimensions of wonder, use, and play, through modalities, contingencies, and potentialities of the useless-useful. An experimental book, it (un)does what it tells, and is as much an object taunting and taunted as it is a description of taunting the useful. Includes bonus chapters!

8.26.2 Voices from Nubia: Critical Essays on Contemporary Nubian Literature from Egypt

Editor: Amal Mazhar

Editor: Faten I. Morsy

Editor: Mona M. Radwan

Foreword by: Rasheed El-Enany

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0476.1.00

The Nubians, the largest ethnic community in Egypt, saw their ancestral homelands disappear beneath the waters of the Nile from the dawn of the 20th century through to 1964. The massive displacement of this population has been the subject of numerous literary works by Nubian writers who seek to save their heritage from oblivion and to preserve their Nubian collective memory. Despite the renewal of socio-political interest in Nubia in post-2011 Egypt, the authors of *Voices from Nubia*, all non-Nubian Egyptians, claim that art in general and literature in particular remain the domain in which the problematics of what has been called the Nubian Question can be primarily vocalized. Only through a thorough reading and analysis of the literary output of Egyptian Nubians can the complexities of Nubia, its people, and culture can find full expression.

The rich literary heritage of contemporary Nubian literature allows for a multiplicity of critiques that makes possible a reading of this literature that crosses the borderlines between literature, history, geography, politics, gender, and ethnicity. The diversity of themes and tropes in *Voices from Nubia* reflects a hallmark of Nubian literary output which is generally marked by a common feeling of solidarity around the Nubian cause. The array of critical studies included in the volume's eight chapters covers a multiplicity of approaches: cultural, postcolonial, ecofeminist, and critical race theory.

Voices from Nubia constitutes an attempt to go beyond the dichotomy between the activist Nubian writer who views the Nubian Question as a human rights issue and Arab-Egyptian nationalists who consider the discussion of Nubians as a distinct ethnic group or minority a threat to societal cohesion and national security. The editors conclude the book with interviews with three Egyptian Nubian writers belonging to different generations and expressing different positions with regards to the Nubian Question. It is thus hoped that this book will introduce the English-speaking reader to the rich tradition of contemporary Nubian literature from Egypt, written in Arabic. On the other hand, the book also forces the Egyptian-Arab reader to question some of the most cherished assumptions and ingrained ideas about the nature of culture, history, and identity. As such, *Voices from Nubia* has far-reaching implications for how we think about the diverse nature of our societies and nations.

8.27 July 2024

8.27.1 Atlas of Petromodernity

Author: Alexander Klose

Author: Benjamin Steininger

Translator: Ayça Türkoğlu

Foreword by: Stephanie LeMenager

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0514.1.00

The *Atlas of Petromodernity* is many things in one: historical and geographical non-fiction, cultural theory essay, and picture book. In forty-four short essays, inspired by an equal amount of pictorial findings, Klose and Steininger develop a technical, geographical, political, and speculative panorama of the declining era of petroleum modernity.

The authors stroll through Baku, Rotterdam, and Louisiana, into Manchuria and through the Vienna Basin. They read Bertolt Brecht, technical manuals, and petroculture theory, and they listen to Neil Young. They go to the moon, through refineries and over highways emptied by the COVID-19 pandemic. They confront petrochemistry with petromelancholy, catalysis with catharsis, cosmos with cosmetics. The *Atlas of Petromodernity* tackles the contradictory ambivalences of a substance that has been vital for our epoch, and whose roles and meanings need to be understood in order to be able to leave this epoch behind.

8.28 June 2024

8.28.1 Wilhelm Reich versus the Flying Saucers: An American Tragedy

Author: James Reich

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0452.1.00

The convenient myth of Wilhelm Reich is that he "lost his mind" in the early 1950s, if not before, and that the last seven years of his life and work—the orgone and radiation experiments, the cloudbuster, and flying saucer intrigues—present an embarrassment. Even the counterculture that embraced Reich, not least William S. Burroughs, Norman Mailer, and filmmaker Dušan Makavejev, tended to distort his theory. The psychosis attached to Reich by his detractors was the culmination of decades of scapegoating by psychoanalysts, Nazis, communists, and conservatives. But Reich's environmental and Cold War preoccupations and his slow-burning fascination with UFO phenomena were not signs of a madness incipient since his break with Sigmund Freud. They anticipated and reflected much in the American psyche.

Defining the presence of a "cinematic self" in the misunderstood analyst once considered an heir to Freud, *Wilhelm Reich versus the Flying Saucers* rejects orthodox portrayals of Reich's final years as merely pathological. Combining original analysis and evidence from the Wilhelm Reich Archive, James Reich uncovers the fatal moments in the psychologist's uncanny identification with the "spaceman," and the myth of a scientist lost to his own grandiosity and paranoia. Taking seriously the influence of *The Day the Earth Stood Still*, *Bad Day at Black Rock*, and other pop cultural narratives on Reich, this "psychoanalytic detective story" concerns existential traps, conscious and unconscious collaborations and betrayals by disciples,

and unidentified flying object-relations. Reich's is an atomic-age passion narrative. Vitally, Reich's story could be ours. The author is not related to his subject.

8.28.2 The Presence of Absence: Meditations on the Unsayable in Writing

Author: Katina L. Rogers

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0478.1.00

The Presence of Absence: Meditations on the Unsayable in Writing is about writers navigating the unspeakable through image, sound, and structure. Each chapter focuses on a specific text, exploring the ways that four writers look to visual and auditory materials and metaphors as passageways to understanding and expressing the ineffable qualities of relationships, identity, and grief. Through gorgeously slow and close readings, Rogers explores absence and excess, fragmentation and translation, and—above all—the push and pull between presence and absence, with absence carrying as much significance as presence (and sometimes more).

The Presence of Absence crosses languages and disciplines, working in French and English across poetry, photography, history, and literary theory. Through investigations of *Nox* by Anne Carson, *Quelque chose noir* by Jacques Roubaud, *Wayward Lives, Beautiful Experiments* by Saidiya Hartman, and* Le livre des questions* by Edmond Jabès, Rogers explores various truths—about loss but also about knowledge, beauty, even higher education—that are difficult to articulate and yet resonate deeply with lived experience.

8.28.3 A Story of Witchery

Author: Jennifer Calkins

Illustrator: Thor Harris

Introduction by: Amy Gerstler

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0517.1.00

Fantasy, fear, and freedom all play a part in *A Story of Witchery*, a book-length narrative poem by Jennifer Calkins, and newly illustrated by Thor Harris. Here we meet Emily, our "small and weedy" protagonist, an orphan complicit (perhaps) in her own abandonment who is caught up, as poet Amy Gerstler writes in her Introduction, in a story "entwined with science facts and twisted clinical fictions." In language rolling and tripping with spare precision, Calkins makes a modern pilgrim's progress into the imagination and the dark world of medicine. Rich and haunting images create a seemingly familiar environment which, like the internal landscape of the protagonist, dissolves only to reform, until finally resolving into a healed whole.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.29 May 2024

8.29.1 Speaking with the Dead: An Ethnography of Extrahuman Experience

Author: Matt Tomlinson

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0465.1.00

If you tried speaking with a dead person and they gave you a clear response, how would you react? Mediums develop their minds and bodies to communicate messages from the deceased to their living loved ones, and in* Speaking with the Dead,* anthropologist Matt Tomlinson describes his experiences training as a medium with a Spiritualist congregation in Canberra, Australia. The book is written in a first-person narrative style that brings "extrahuman" relationships to life, showing what it is like to learn and practice mediumship: the strategic suspension of skepticism; the wobbly first attempts; the embarrassing failures; and the moments, both unsettling and enthralling, when someone tells you that yes indeed, you've just described her grandfather who died in 1978.

Speaking with the Dead brims with stories of talented mediums and Tomlinson is not interested in proving or disproving mediumship, preferring instead to illustrate how mediums bring their practices to life. In contrast to the popular image of mediums as shameless frauds, Tomlinson describes earnest and committed seekers from a wide range of backgrounds who often struggle to understand their own experiences. Their profits are therapeutic rather than financial. And they worry about endings as much as anyone else: the passing of physical lives, the closure of beloved churches. *Speaking with the Dead* is ultimately a book about the lively side of death, grounded in Spiritualists' conviction that life is eternal and your social network extends to the astral plane. It is a close examination of how mediumship works culturally, which is to say, how mediums and audiences work together to create senses of transcendent connection.

8.29.2 Ontohackers: Radical Movement Philosophy in the Age of Extinctions and Algorithms, Part I: Radical Movement Philosophy and the Body Intelligence R/evolution

Author: Jaym*/Jaime del Val

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0402.1.00

Ontohackers redefines what movement, worlds, and bodies are through the sense of proprioception reconceptualized as formless fluctuation field, a movement matrix that is itself also thought, and which underlies all life forms and fields including the inorganic. Our worlds are made of endless such entangled fields *n*-folding in neverending variation or enferance. The current planetary crisis has emerged due to an accidental evolutionary alignment, narrowing, and impoverishment of that matrix's indeterminacy, that appeared gradually and eventually with bipedalism, and which created an imbalance between the larger proprioceptive field and its brain, and made the atrophied body extend itself technically in geometric fields gradually covering the planet, along with its fears, with disastrous consequences that are unleashing an unprecedented type of mass extinction and species suicide.

For del Val, the reply to this crisis – which is urgently due if we are to reduce even slightly the collapse coming up over the next decades – is in recovering a lost sensorimotor plasticity which is also cognitive, affective, and relational plasticity, through developing movement technes for cultivating Body Intelligence (BI), reversing and taking elsewhere the failed evolution culminating in AI, stepping away from humanist-supremacist pedestals, undoing our dependency upon unsustainable killing machines of sedentary consumerism that impoverish experience, stopping the reproduction of a species that has become a plague (by reversing heteronormative reproductive dogmas until we reach pre-agricultural population levels), and recovering the joys of moving with the world, in symbiotic mutation, towards unprecedented evolutionary variations: this is our cosmic responsibility for all life on Earth.

The book's structure expresses Enferance Theory with regard to how processes of becoming have a triple movement: an incipiency unfolding the field (Part I), a condensation-expansion where the field acquires full consistency (Part II), and a resonance or memory of the field relating to other fields (Part III).

Part I includes Books 1 to 3 out of seven books total. The preface sets the context of the book: the extinction crisis. Book 1 provides an introduction to the entire field of the book and reflects on the book's structure and process. Book 2 is a full treatise on proprioception, developing the theory of Body Intelligence and addressing core issues of cognition, perception, communication, and an ontological redefinition of the body as proprioceptive swarm. Book 3 develops all core concepts of Radical Movement Philosophy, unfolding in several sections, first introducing fluctation, field, and swarm theory, secondly the core concepts of *clinaos* (indeterminacy), *metabody* (consistency), and *intraduction* (variation), all coming together in the concept of *enferance*. Finally, another triad further unfolds the previous triad as *rhythm* (affect), *orientation* (desire), and *contact* (sex), closing with an orgiastic cosmo-ontology that opens the way to Part II.

8.29.3 On the Trail of the Morning Star: Psychosis as Self-Discovery

Author: Dorothea Buck

Editor: Susanne Antonetta

Translator: Eva Lipton

Foreword by: Hans Krieger

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0462.1.00

In 1936, at age nineteen, Dorothea Buck followed the trail of a star along the mudflats of her North Sea home, Wangerooge Island in Germany. Hospitalized at a Christian institution called Bethel, she was sterilized under Nazi law upon a diagnosis of schizophrenia. Buck lost her lifelong dream of becoming a teacher—the sterilized could not get a college degree. Instead, she became an artist and activist. Buck, who lived to the age of 102, fought throughout her life for psychiatric reform. She created her own form of psychiatric treatment, which she called "trialogue," in which psychosis experiencers, family, and clinicians join together to examine the experience of psychosis. Trialogue seminars still take place today.

Buck also demanded recognition of the Nazi murders of the disabled and the mentally ill. Many of these victims were psychiatric patients gassed in chambers built into six of Germany's asylums. In 2008, Buck told an audience commemorating these murders that there must be "no second-class victims" of Nazi rule.

Psychiatry rooted in biology, Buck believed, would always reduce a condition like hers to something "genetically caused, meaningless, and incurable." Like fellow German Paul Schreber's *Memoirs of My Nervous Illness,* Buck's* On the Trail of the Morning Star* calls for a radical rethinking of what it means to live with and in psychosis. This publication is the first time one of Buck's major writings has appeared in English.

8.29.4 Lividity

Author: Kim Rosenfield

Introduction by: Trisha Low

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0511.1.00

In *Lividity,* poet Kim Rosenfield works within the outskirts of language, draining it of connotation and excess. Using words and phrases culled from linguistics textbooks and language-learning manuals, Rosenfield invites the reader to experience the everyday vernacular as dislocated affect. What happens when language acts as organ donor? When language, the conveyor of our vulnerability, is transposed into new and often failing terrain? Are expressions of meaning vital enough to keep the organism functioning? What happens when meaning loses its moorings?

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.30 April 2024

8.30.1 Masks

Author: T.H.M. Gellar-Goad

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0453.1.00

The mask is the classic disguise. But as alter ego, it reveals as much as it conceals. Why are masks so often creepy, even outside of horror movies? Can a mask change expression while you're wearing it? How much of someone's self can inhabit a mask? Why would anyone make a plaster cast of a dead person's face? And, really, who *was* that masked man? *Masks* unmasks the answers to these frequently (m)asked questions and more.

Masks are the materials for a world of make-believe, from the theater to Halloween, from masquerades to Scooby-Doo. Masks can take on magic or ritual powers. They can preserve and transmit memory. Masks are a makeover tool for appearance and identity, from spa treatments to drag to superheroes. What all these different functions have in common is the mask as physical metaphor, a mirror of the self and society. In another layer of metaphor, our words for ourselves as individuals ("person") and for our self-presentation to society ("persona") both derive directly from the Latin word for mask.

Masks explores one of humanity's oldest cultural objects, traveling from prehistoric remains to ancient Roman funeral processions to Mardi Gras to masked doppelgangers on stage and screen. Its examination of masks across time and the globe sheds new light on the totemic power masks have developed, especially during the COVID-19 pandemic.

8.30.2 Alone in the Dark: Cinephilia and the Heroic Imagination

Author: Doug Dibbern

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0475.1.00

Alone in the Dark is an experimental memoir – or perhaps, more accurately, an anti-memoir or fabulist memoir, some unruly combination of essay, prose poem, and floating reverie that examines the relationship between one's cultural heritage and one's aesthetic devotions. Unlike a traditional autobiography that details the chronological events of a person's life, the book begins with the obsessive moviegoing of Dibbern's early years in New York and then unfurls as a fevered rumination on the role that an excessive love of art plays in shaping ideas about one's identity.

The book opens with the American premiere of the Hungarian filmmaker Béla Tarr's harrowing, eight-hour-long magnum opus *Sátántangó* in 1998 as an emblematic cinephile experience. Dibbern then frames the book by asking, why would anyone devote the bulk of their waking hours to such a compulsive pursuit of a seemingly passive experience of art? Sitting alone in a darkened movie theater, he suggests, is not a passive, but a creative act: developing an aesthetic taste, after all, is central to defining our identities. And taste is the product of two contradictory impulses: the will to simultaneously embrace and escape the values of our cultural backgrounds that made us who we are.

With these conjectures as the jumping-off point, the book commences its discursive explorations, wending and weaving between topics as diverse as Carl Jung's theories of the collective unconscious, Carl Theodor Dreyer's *Ordet,* old family photo albums, nineteenth-century immigration to North Dakota, the actress Gena Rowlands's histrionic mental breakdowns, the self-portraits that the Mandan chief Mato-Tope made in the 1830s, and the dizzyingly joyful suicidal games in Howard Hawks's film about aviation,* Only Angels Have Wings.*

8.31 March 2024

8.31.1 In Defense of Don Giovanni: A Feminist Mythobiography

Author: Luisa Passerini

Translator: Stella Tillyard

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0458.1.00

Who wants to champion the figure of Don Giovanni in the time of Harvey Weinstein and #MeToo? Don Giovanni is a rapist, murderer, serial seducer, and liar. Can he ever be held up as a role model or seen as a figure to be enjoyed? This is the task that the eminent Italian historian and lifelong feminist, Luisa Passerini, sets for herself in *In Defense of Don Giovanni.* As she developed the long arc of her distinguished career, Don Giovanni surprisingly became not only her role model but also a secret object of research.

Taking her method from oral history, Passerini creates a series of characters with whom she discusses the forms and incarnations of the myth of Don Giovanni across time, from its first appearance in early medieval Spain and Commedia dell'Arte to its many European variations and its transposition to the colonial and postcolonial world in the Middle East, the Americas, and Africa. Pivoting round Don Giovanni's best known incarnation in Mozart's opera, Passerini and her interlocutors meet in different locations from Venice and Bern to Paris and Turin. They discuss plays, films, and operas and talk about art, novels, and psychoanalytic interpretations of the myth while also sharing their own life stories, in which Don Giovanni often plays a part that is, by turns, destructive, mischievous, and full of the joy of life.

From his early beginnings in the Iberian Peninsula to recent analysis of the sexuality of colonial conquest and postcolonial revenge and return, Don Giovanni shape-shifts between rapacious hyper-masculinity, comic trickster, and morally vacuous loser whose annoyingly persistent nemesis Don Ottavio emerges as an alternative and ultimately better object of desire. As she tracks Don Giovanni's image across the world and through the centuries, however, Passerini comes to see that it also plays another role, that of a mirror, in which women can see themselves emerge as individuals with their own life force.

8.31.2 Tribulations of a Westerner in the Western World

Author: Vincent Dachy

Introduction by: Mary Burger

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0509.1.00

Someone has taken a trip and taken photographs of that trip and someone else has been invited to watch a slideshow of the trip taken. There is a road, there is an abstract painting, there is a viewer who wishes he could live in a televised loop of a sunset, and another who wonders why people are obese. *Tribulations of a Westerner in the Western World* is a stunner of a first book, a narrated slideshow of inner and outer geographies complete with fifty-two black-and-white photographs taken by the author.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.31.3 Continuum 2: Writings – Scritti – Écrits 2015–2022

Author: Alessandro De Francesco

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0463.1.00

This volume gathers Alessandro De Francesco's essays and theoretical writings produced from 2015 to 2022. It follows the first volume, *Continuum: Writings on Poetry as Artistic Practice,* reuniting essays written between 2007 and 2015.

The title of this new volume could only be *Continuum 2,* given that the underlying concept remains the same: to testify to the seamless continuity of the author's commitment to poetry and art over the years, and to reaffirm at the same time, on a theoretical level, a model of creation and thinking as a continuous flow, not discretized, not quantized, but organic, liquid, without end or beginning — a kind of linguistic translation of the space-time in which every text, like every other object, is necessarily immersed.

Continuum 2 is a trilingual book, containing writings in English, French, and Italian, and it is particularly focused on two lines of inquiry: the author's ongoing meditation on poetic practice, and his new investigation into seventeenth-century art, poetry, and forms of thought.

8.32 February 2024

8.32.1 like a dog

Author: lauren samblanet

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0469.1.00

Taking its cues from the New Narrative writing movement,* like a dog* considers how sexual identity is morphed, hidden, and denied by cultural forces like film, pornography, rape culture, and sexual semiotics. The speaker of *like a dog* writes about her sexuality, sexual trauma, and relationships in the epistolary form to explore how the personal becomes collective and how overt sexuality is necessary for questioning dominant ideologies. The intimacy (or perhaps voyeurism) that is opened through the epistolary form is balanced with commentary on the films of Lars von Trier, primarily *Nymphomaniac*, as a way to move away from the speaker's experiences and into the larger social forces that seek to define us.

Amidst these letters are images from a handwritten journal where blood, hair, vaginal fluids, and other bodily residues are used to direct the shape and content of the writing surrounding them. The tactility of the journal delivers the reader to the body, not as an intellectualized object, but as the physical, messy, oozing force that it is.

Neither fiction nor nonfiction, and inhabiting a realm between gossip and scholarly film analysis, *like a dog* exists in a liminal zone that offers the speaker a site to rip away the layers of cultural conditioning surrounding sexuality and relationships, and to peek at what lies beneath. This interrogation of identity may not lead to answers but the speaker of *like a dog* is able to finally hear her own voice and to begin the work of rebuilding an identity that blooms from within.

8.32.2 Nairobi Becoming: Security, Uncertainty, Contingency

Editor: Joost Fontein

Editor: Tessa Diphoorn

Editor: Peter Lockwood

Editor: Constance Smith

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0418.1.00

Echoing the edgy, disjunctive, ever-emergent city of Nairobi that it explores, *Nairobi Becoming: Security, Uncertainty, Contingency* strives to be several things-in-the-making. It is a historically and anthropologically minded examination of a shifting cityscape, an experimental, collaborative exercise in curated juxtaposition and assemblage, and an interdisciplinary, subjunctive urban ethnography. It brings together curated interventions by twenty-seven artists, scholars, and writers to trace Nairobi's becoming. Methodologically experimental and multimodal, it seeks to balance an appreciation of Nairobi's fragmented character while also recognizing its contingent coherency.

Nairobi Becoming curates an eclectic collection of different voices and interventions to evoke something of the city's manifold guises and historicities – an urban mosaic of partial experiences as well as dawning possibilities for future becomings. Assembling scholarship, literature, creative non-fiction, and visual art, the contributions are arranged around particular themes, while resisting the urge to develop a singular coherent voice. Security – in its various guises – is the linking thread, the point of articulation that connects apparently disparate elements of Nairobi life, from sex work to roadbuilding, goat markets to funerals. Security is here an analytical operator: a concept that refracts the seemingly diverse modalities of life in Nairobi, and, with the related domains of uncertainty and contingency, brings the city's dynamics of fragmentation and coherence to the surface in surprising ways.

If confronting Nairobi's will to coherence amidst the strains of fragmentation is the empirical and analytical challenge of *Nairobi Becoming,* then it is through collaboration and juxtaposition, curation and contrast, and the messiness of assemblage, that this book chimes with the fraught multiplicities of a city-in-the-making. As such, this book is also an exploration of the inevitable tension that exists between curatorial intent and the possibility of allowing each contribution to stand for itself.

8.33 January 2024

8.33.1 The Getty Fiend

Author: Ken White

Introduction by: Michael du Plessis

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0534.1.00

The Getty Fiend, a contemporary medieval melodrama set in Los Angeles's Getty Museum, takes the reader on a tour filled with rock stars and warrior-kings, werewolves and archivists, sartorial Huns and libertine saints, all seen through the keenly dramatic flair of a collector's eye. A cinematic and labyrinthine take on pulp horror, Ken White's screenplay-in-verse is a

monster mash-up of forms and languages, facades and carnal catastrophes, archaic languages and misplaced rhetorics — a campy, fantastical gender-bending transformation into the inadvertently divine.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.33.2 Analogical City

Author: Cameron McEwan

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2024

https://doi.org/10.53288/0386.1.00

In *Analogical City,* Cameron McEwan argues for architecture's status as a critical project. McEwan revisits architect Aldo Rossi as a paradigmatic figure of the critical rational tradition, studying a neglected aspect of his thought — the analogical city — to excavate its potential. McEwan develops a grammar of the analogical city under the headings of Imagination, Transformation, City, Multitude, and Project. McEwan argues that the analogical city is critical, collective, and emancipatory. Analogical thought and understanding cities as analogical might open the conditions of possibility for rethinking the critical project in architecture.

At a time when the humanities and the sciences are threatened by irrational thought, from climate denial to post-truth narratives, and when architecture has seemingly disavowed its critical capacity and political possibility through its commodification as an instrument of the neoliberal city, McEwan offers critical strategies, conceptual tools, figures of thought, and knowledge practices to articulate modes of thinking and acting differently within architectural criticism and practice. Today, knowledge is a common terrain of struggle and thought requires constant reinvention. The task of architecture, and critique more broadly, must be to interpret the world in order to change it. Consequently *Analogical City* proposes modes for imagining the city, the subject, and the world otherwise — towards a more egalitarian and critical architecture of the city.

Ultimately, the analogical city is not a fully developed theory, nor is it only an intuitive, poetic, or purely formal practice, as some critics propose. McEwan argues that the analogical city is poetic *and* political: it always refers beyond itself towards a collective and critical project of the city, and yet it invites a series of formal, spatial, and graphic operations comprising erasure and negativity followed by substitution and remontage.

8.34 December 2023

8.34.1 Dancing with Philoctetes: Reflections on Pain and Remembrance

Author: Abigail Akavia

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0450.1.00

Abandoned by his community, doomed to a solitary existence with his voice as sole companion: can Sophocles' *Philoctetes* still speak to us? What do his screams have to say?

Dancing with Philoctetes: Reflections on Pain and Remembrance juxtaposes a new adaptation of Sophocles' play with an essay describing the process of bringing it to life in a world on the brink of a pandemic. Akavia investigates Sophocles' nuanced portrayal of the fragility of empathy in the face of suffering, and also shares the challenges of embodying and vocalizing Sophocles' text onstage. She proposes that the pandemic and its aftermath offer a renewed perspective on *Philoctetes*' thematization, not just of empathy and disease, but of the longing to return: to home, to health, to what memory holds.

Akavia's treatment of Philoctetes starts out from his body and voice and journeys on to loneliness, toxic masculinity, nostalgia, cancer, dreaming, parenthood, language, ballet lessons, siblings, music, and growing up. Here, scholarship and creative non-fiction combine to tell a story of reading, performing, thinking about, and living (through) tragedy.

Listen to Abigail Akavia reflecting on her adaptation of *Philoctetes* on *TangentCast*:

8.34.2 Signs of the Great Refusal: The Coming Struggle for a Postwork Society

Author: Tedd Siegel

Foreword by: Tyrus Miller

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0488.1.00

In recent years, developed countries have seen the rise of discussions concerning "the problem with work today." Since this literature tends to reflect the frustrations of the professional–managerial class (as well as other workers in globalized services industries in the digital age), it is often at a significant distance from the concerns of the organized labor movement and the traditional Left. Much of this literature presents an unacceptable either/or: workers are encouraged either to "lean in," and become better "human capital," or else to develop forms of palliative care for these same neoliberal selves by means of personal projects of self-optimization, recovery, and wellness.

In* Signs of the Great Refusal,* Tedd Siegel challenges the assumptions supporting these highly constrained possibilities, asking instead what it might take to deprivatize and repoliticize work itself under contemporary conditions, in order to make a broad-based politics of refusal potentially viable. Where postwork, antiwork, and degrowth discussions taking place today often describe and promote various "postwork imaginaries" in which the decommodification of labor is only implied,* Signs of the Great Refusal* is concerned specifically with the "postwork

political imaginary." Taking up a question formulated by Peter Fleming, Siegel asks, "Can the impossibility at the heart of contemporary capitalism be politically activated to oppose and escape work-as-we-know-it?"

8.35 November 2023

8.35.1 Feminist Solidarities after Modulation

Author: Sara Morais dos Santos Bruss

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0397.1.00

Feminist Solidarities after Modulation produces an intersectional analysis of transnational feminist movements and their contemporary digital frameworks of identity and solidarity. Engaging media theory, critical race theory, and Black feminist theory, as well as contemporary feminist movements, this book argues that digital feminist interventions map themselves onto and make use of the multiplicity and ambiguity of digital spaces to question presentist and fixed notions of the internet as a white space and technologies in general as objective or universal. Understanding these frameworks as colonial constructions of the human, identity is traced to a socio-material condition that emerges with the modernity/colonialism binary.

In the colonial moment, race and gender become the reasons for, as well as the effects of, technologies of identification, and thus need to be understood as and through technologies. What Deleuze has called modulation is not a present modality of control, but is placed into a longer genealogy of imperial division, which stands in opposition to feminist, queer, and anti-racist activism that insists on non-modular solidarities across seeming difference. At its heart, *Feminist Solidarities after Modulation* provides an analysis of contemporary digital feminist solidarities, which not only work at revealing the material histories and affective "leakages" of modular governance, but also challenges them to concentrate on forms of political togetherness that exceed a reductive or essentialist understanding of identity, solidarity, and difference.

8.35.2 Solarities: Elemental Encounters and Refractions

Editor: Cymene Howe

Editor: Jeff Diamanti

Editor: Amelia Moore

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0404.1.00

Solarities: Elemental Encounters and Refractions is a transdiciplinary essay collection that explores the physical, conceptual, and political possibilities materialized by "solarity"— a form of relation to the sun and its elemental force upon planetary life. The authors propose that a different set of questions becomes possible when the material specificities of solar become the compass for thought, prompting us to uncover our relationship to the sun. How does solarity materialize in the bodies and lives of humans and non-humans now and in the future? What can we learn if we no longer take the sun for granted? How do we continue to persist on a planet that is so intimately bound up in a state of love, fear, and dependence on this primary source of all living energy? Each of the essays in *Solarities* take solar radiation as an interpretive lens that takes multiple forms, often transforming as it does so.

Solarities draws inspiration from Black ecologies, Indigenous philosophy, feminist science & technology studies, and more-than-human discussions in the human sciences, recognizing the phenomenological and ontological openings they make available. The authors understand solarity as an energy source (channeled through photovoltaic cells, for example), but the essays gathered here focus on the lives that solarity creates or impedes. The experimental task is to find how solarities work their way into materials and processes across our work, seeking out the particular influences of solarity in making being(s). These relations are core to thinking the elemental conditions of solarity, since it is through particular forms of focalizing the sun that life is sustained, or made to wither, across the planet.

In these ways, the elemental condition of solarity is at once hyper-particular and also shared across organic and inorganic bodies, conditioned by physical form and material composition. Throughout the collection, the authors explore how solarity appears or recedes from view when we concentrate our attentions on it, surfacing the existential omnipresence of the sun to open new thought possibilities, inspire new actions, and refract new dimensions of socionatural encounter.

8.35.3 The Pandemic Visual Regime: Visuality and Performativity in the Covid-19 Crisis

Editor: Julia Ramírez-Blanco

Editor: Francesco Spampinato

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0448.1.00

The Covid-19 pandemic has been expressed in various ways through visuality and performance, and some of its more nuanced cultural implications have taken place in a realm that goes beyond words. Through the exploration of the visual culture produced during and in response to the Covid-19 pandemic,* The Pandemic Visual Regime: Visuality and Performativity in the Covid-19 Crisis* highlights the key role played by images in shaping our understanding of the epochal transformations our society is undergoing.

This book argues that visuality and its relationships with the performative have played such a significant role in the Covid-19 pandemic that we can even speak of the emergence of a "pandemic visual regime," a new way of seeing and representing the world under this global emergency.

Through an interdisciplinary framework, *The Pandemic Visual Regime* aims to answer an array of questions: In which ways have the effects of the pandemic been racialized, thereby reinforcing white supremacy? How are our responses to Covid-19 shaped by the Hollywood "outbreak narrative" of films such as *Contagion*? How has design responded to our new pandemic needs? How have infographics affected our perception? In which new ways have we come to inhabit private, public, and virtual spaces? Regarding the latter, what changes have there been in the forms of digital surveillance? On the other side of the spectrum, what forms has mutual aid taken and what have been our forms of relating with nature, both during lockdown and after lockdown was over? All these questions open the field to rethinking the visuality of our post-pandemic zeitgeist.

8.36 October 2023

8.36.1 Artificial Earth: A Genealogy of Planetary Technicity

Author: J. Daniel Andersson

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0406.1.00

Artificial Earth: A Genealogy of Planetary Technicity offers an intellectual history of humanity as a geological force, focusing on a prevalent contradiction in the Anthropocene discourse on global environmental change: on the one hand, it has been argued that there are hardly any pristine environments anymore, to the degree that the concept of nature has lost its meaning; while on the other, that anthropogenic environmental change has become so prevailing that it ought to be conceived of as a force of nature, in the literal sense of the expression. *Artificial Earth* argues that to fully grasp the stakes of this discourse, we need not only understand the contemporary scientific and technological transformations behind the Anthropocene, but also explore the history of an ontological concern tied up with it.

In order to do so, *Artificial Earth* examines reflections on the ontological dualism between nature and artifice within the history of earth science from the late eighteenth century onwards. Paying particular attention to its consequences for how human subjectivity has been conceptualized in the Anthropocene, it then enrolls these resources in an effort to problematize attempts since the 1980s to formalize earth science in systems theory terminology. In sum, the aim is to investigate the historical conditions for the possibility of conceiving human artifice

as an integral part of the earth's terrestrial environment, with the conviction that such an investigation may assist in resolving the aforementioned contradiction or at least to understand it better by tracing its historical lineage.

8.36.2 Widening Scripts: Cultivating Feminist Care in Academic Labor

Author: Mariana Prandini Assis

Author: Michelle Forrest

Author: Angela Henderson

Author: Lindsey MacCallum

Author: Ian Reilly

Author: Ellen Shaffner

Author: Scott Stoneman

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0442.1.00

Widening Scripts: Cultivating Feminist Care in Academic Labor is addressed to scholars, educators, and students devoted to the struggle against precarity, atomization, and the commodification of knowledge. Through shared reading, discussion, and reflection, and gathered around a shared interest in feminist theory and politics, the authors discovered a model of care within academia that helped them to sustain their opposition to dominant academic practices that are diminishing, competitive, and exploitative.

In this book, the authors narrate that discovery and the realization of a desire to share in the assembling of a collective feminist survival kit. In *Living a Feminist Life,* Sara Ahmed offers a wide-ranging killjoy survival kit that includes books, things, tools, time, life, permission notes, other killjoys, humor, feelings, and bodies. As a response to the stress, strain, and profound grief produced by the COVID-19 pandemic, with its viral acceleration of crises already endemic to neoliberal capitalism, the authors mined an evolving cluster of decolonial feminist texts in an attempt to find meaning, encounter moving premonitions, and engage with radical instigations to thought. By co-creating a survival kit through sustained collaboration during the pandemic, they develop a sense of the value of experimentation and risk-taking and learn how to cultivate an inclusive space that allows them to express their views, reclaim accountability, and learn confidently from each other.

Widening Scripts combines collaborative feminist theory, acts of care, and critical dialogue in an effort to open up decelerated, altruistic, and connected ways of doing academic work together.

8.36.3 Evil Twins and the Ultimate Insight: Ayn Rand, Vladimir Nabokov, and the Polarized Politics of Reading

Author: Bruce Stone

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0407.1.00

With the 2020 election, political polarization in the U.S. entered a ludicrous end-stage. Partisanship, once a pseudo-rational system of biases, has devolved to a conflict between incompatible realities. In search of some pathway toward consensus, *Evil Twins and the Ultimate Insight: Ayn Rand, Vladimir Nabokov, and the Polarized Politics of Reading* looks to the works of two iconic Russian-American writers whose literary rivalry mirrors the rift between political parties in the U.S. The matchup has all the markings of an evil-twin narrative, pitting Rand, the muse of libertarian conservatism, against Nabokov, the trickster-genius of the Western canon. Their mid-century novels afford a rare opportunity to arbitrate, by proxy, American political grievances and resolve, in print, its electoral dysfunction.* Evil Twins and the Ultimate Insight* mounts this critical intervention into the Blue/Red blood feud and contemplates, in the cognitive challenges of Nabokov's fiction, a remedy for its polarized politics.

To guard against grandstanding, axe-grinding, deck-stacking, inaccuracy, or obfuscation, Stone's book proceeds by indirection, exploring four scholarly books that all speak to the peculiar relationship between Rand and Nabokov: Gene Bell-Villada's *On Nabokov, Ayn Rand and the Libertarian Mind* (2013), Adam Weiner's *How Bad Writing Destroyed the World: Ayn Rand and the Literary Origins of the Financial Crisis* (2016), Michael Rodgers's *Nabokov and Nietzsche: Problems and Perspectives* (2018), and Peter Roberts and Herner Saeverot's *Education and the Limits of Reason: Reading Dostoevsky, Tolstoy and Nabokov* (2018). Each of these books is seriously flawed, but their numerous interlocking problems conspire to reveal, empirically, via negativa, how literature might tip the scales in America's partisan deadlock. Ultimately, Stone argues that, when our books get tangled up in our politics, their promise—to help us see to the bottom of things and scooch closer to the asymptote of truth and reality—might be something more than a mirage.

8.37 September 2023

8.37.1 Kern

Author: Derek Beaulieu

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0510.1.00

Proposed as a collection of imaginary logos for the corporate sponsors of Borges's Library of Babel, *Kern* balances on a precipice between the visual and nonsensical, offering poems just out of meaning's reach. Using dry-transfer lettering, Beaulieu made these concrete pieces by hand, building the images gesturally in response to shapes and patterns in the letters themselves. This is poetry closer to architecture and design than confession, in which letters are released from their usual semantic duties as they slide into unexpected affinities and new patterns. *Kern* highlights the gaps inside what we see and what we know, filling the familiar with the singular and the just seen with the faintly remembered.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.37.2 The Way Things Go

Author: Louis Bury

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0400.1.00

The Way Things Go contains a mix of poetry, art writing, and life writing about anticipatory grief, or mourning someone or something before it's gone. Each successive chapter in the book decreases in length by exactly one sentence, from a 71-sentence-long opening chapter, to a 70-sentence-long second chapter, to 69 sentences, 68 sentences, and so on down to 1 (a book-length Oulipian "melting snowball"). This shrinking form enacts the book's concerns with loss, climate change, and the passage of time.

At the level of its content, however, *The Way Things Go* is not fatalistic. Its title comes from a cult classic 1987 Fischli and Weiss film, in which objects such as bags of trash, car tires, and oil drums knock into one another in a Rube Goldberg-esque chain reaction. Moving through both personal history (his sister's lupus and heroin addiction, his grandmother's experience as a Holocaust survivor) and more global concerns (the Sixth Mass Extinction, COVID-19, the war in Ukraine), Bury considers the disruptions that occur as "things go," as well as the continuity that remains. The book suggests that recent negotiations between optimism and pessimism with respect to the future reflect people's feelings of vulnerability, particularly people who are used to taking their life's stability for granted, in a world that seems increasingly precarious.

8.37.3 Microbium: The Neglected Lives of Micro-matter

Editor: Joela Jacobs

Editor: Agnes Malinowska

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0396.1.00

Microbium: The Neglected Lives of Micro-matter tells the story of small matter such as bacteria, coral, fungi, lichen, pollen, protozoa, and viruses. With short entries that are organized like a herbarium or similar specimen collection, the book is a "microbium"—both the term for a single microbe and a play on "microbiome."

As such, *Microbium* makes visible the often overseen but huge impact of miniscule matter on human culture and the environment. Each entry is a "microscopic reading" that describes the natural history and scientific discovery of a particular form of micro-matter, while also telling a story about the cultural and artistic roles it has played over the centuries. From the poetry of Emily Dickinson to the "coralness" of coral reefs to contemporary literature about the COVID-19 pandemic, this book places micro-matter under a cultural microscope and translates the significance of the invisible interspecies social realm to the human scale, magnifying the many ways in which micro-matter *matters*. Ultimately, *Microbium* shows the potential of micro-matter to teach us how to revitalize our political and cultural systems, habits of thought, and aesthetic or representational modes.

8.38 August 2023

8.38.1 Recovering the Radical Promise of Superheroes: Un/Making Worlds

Author: Ellen Kirkpatrick

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0353.1.00

Superhero meaning making is a site of struggle. Superheroes (are thought to) trouble borders and normative ways of seeing and being in the world. Superhero narratives (are thought to) represent, and thereby inspire, alternative visions of the real world. The superhero genre is (thought to be) a repository for radical or progressive ideas. In the superhero world and beyond, much is made of the genre's utopian and dystopian landscapes, queer identity-play, and transforming bodies, but might it not be the case that the genre's overblown normative framing, or representation, serves to muzzle, rather than express, its protagonists' radical promise? Why, when set against otherwise unbounded, and often extreme, transformation—human to machine, human to animal, human to god—are certain categories seemingly untouchable? Why does this speculative genre routinely fail to fully speculate about other worlds and ways of being in those worlds? For all their nonconformity, superhero stories do not live up to the idea of a radical genre, in look, feel, or tone. The mainstream American superhero genre, and its surrounding discourses, tells and facilitates an astonishingly seamless tale of opposing ideologies. But how?

Recovering the Radical Promise of Superheroes: Un/Making Worlds serves a speculative response, detailing not so much a hunt for genre meaning as a trip through a genre's meaningscape. Looking anew at superhero meaning-making practices allows a distinct way of

thinking about and describing the creative, formal, and ideological conditions of the genre and its protagonists, one removed from corralling binaries, one foregrounding the idea of a synergy—often unseen, uneasy, and even hostile—between official and unofficial agents of superhero meaning and one reframing familiar questions: What kinds of meaning do superhero texts engender? How is this meaning made? By whom and under what conditions? What processes and practices inform, regulate, and extend superhero meaning? And finally, superhero narratives present a new question: How might we reimagine its agents, surfaces, and spaces? Centering the experiences and practices of excluded and marginalized superhero fans, *Recovering the Radical Promise of Superheroes* reveals that genre meaning is not lodged in one place or another, neither in its official creators or fans, nor in "black and white" conservatism or in a "rainbow" of progressive possibilities. Nor is it even located somewhere in the in-between; it is instead better conceived of as an antagonistic, in-process nexus of meaning undergirded by systems of power.

8.38.2 Rituals for Climate Change: A Crip Struggle for Ecojustice

Author: Naomi Ortiz

Earth: Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0451.1.00

Disability justice and ecojustice are rarely considered together but are in constant conversation in our world. *Rituals for Climate Change: A Crip Struggle for Ecojustice*, combining poetry and the lyrical essay, doesn't contain just one point of view but encompasses dialectical perspectives which often exist in contradiction to each other. A disabled person is in need of plastic cups and concerned about the overwhelming plastic in our ecosystems. Ortiz expands on and complicates who is seen as an environmentalist and what being in relationship with the land can look like.

This book is an offering to explore the spiritual question of how to witness. It serves as a companion to those also grappling with the difficult and often unanswerable questions posed by climate change in the borderlands. By exploring the ways body, mind, and cultures both clash with and long for ecojustice,* Rituals for Climate Change* offers an often-overlooked perspective on climate-grief, interdependence, and resilience. Disabled people know how to adapt to a world that is ever changing without considering them.

8.38.3 Tall, Slim & Erect: Portraits of the Presidents

Author: Alex Forman

Introduction by: Ben Ehrenreich

Afterword by: Patric Verrone

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0508.1.00

After stumbling upon a wooden box containing a complete set of miniature wax mold figurines of US presidents at a flea market, artist Alex Forman began photographing each little man, minus their pedestals. Presented for the first time in book format, Forman's elegant black and white portraits are accompanied by brief biographies composed entirely of appropriated texts cleverly cut and reassembled by the author. What emerges in *Tall, Slim & Erect: Portraits of the Presidents* is not the tired tale of legendary men and their mythical quest for democracy, but rather, a gossip's dream: Jefferson could not ride a horse for months due to boils on his backside; Hayes felt a crazed and tender devotion to his sister Fanny; Wilson remained a virgin until twenty-eight. While playfully shedding light on these powerful men, their quirks, bodily functions, and stained sheets, *Tall, Slim & Erect* ultimately asks the reader to question how history is written and built on hearsay, conjecture, rumor, and repetition.

This title is a second edition, released as part of punctum's Special Collections project.

8.39 July 2023

8.39.1 Resistant Form: Aristophanes and the Comedy of Crisis

Author: Mario Telò

Earth, Milky Way: punctum books, 2023

https://doi.org/10.53288/0445.1.00

Can attending to poetic form help us imagine a radical politics and bridge the gap between pressing contemporary political concerns and an ancient literature that often seems steeped in dynamics of oppression?

The corpus of the fifth-century Athenian playwright Aristophanes includes some of the funniest yet most disturbing comedies of Western literature. His work's anarchic experimentation with language invites a radically "oversensitive" hyperformalism, a formalistic overanalysis that disrupts, disables, or even abolishes a range of normativities (government, labor, reproduction, gender). Exceeding not just historicist contextualism, but also conventional notions of laughter and the logic of the joke, *Resistant Form: Aristophanes and the Comedy of Crisis* uses Aristophanes to fully embrace, in the practice of close or "too-close" reading, the etymological and conceptual nexus of crisis, critique, and literary criticism.

These exuberant readings of *Birds, Frogs, Lysistrata,* and *Women at the Thesmophoria,* together with the first attempt ever to grapple with the comic style of critical theorists Gilles Deleuze, Achille Mbembe, and Jack Halberstam, connect Aristophanes with contemporary discourses of biopolitics, necrocitizenship, care, labor, and transness, and at the same time

disclose a quasi- or para-Aristophanic mode in the written textures of critical theory. Here is a radically new approach to the literary criticism of the premodern—one that materializes the circuit of crisis and critique through a restless inhabitation of the becomings and unbecomings of comic form.